

Research Notes for the Solid Rock Hebrew Bible

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Please note that these are my working files, not originally intended for publication; citations, therefore, are normally extremely vague and abbreviated, and by no means are all my thoughts, research, influences, and such fully or clearly expressed. Caution in using this material and indulgence toward my chicken scratch is requested; nevertheless, it is hoped that there might be a few gems of insight buried in this mine, or least motivation for others to do the work of establishing and explaining the text of the OT better than I have.

Kt-Qr in Daniel + Ezra-Nehemiah (=Aramaic Sections)

The pointing of the nouns with suffixes follows the system Bauer-Leander, which I have not read but is followed by W. Baumgartner in his edition of Daniel in BHS (*quinta*) and in his lexicon. For a different approach, see Rosenthal, §49 (below paradigm), Stevenson, §14.3.

Eastern and Western Schools

The Western School (מדרש) was the more innovative (see, e.g., Ginsburg 200 [PDF loc 216] on their artificial מדרש).

On the *Vorlage* of Chronicles

The book of Chronicles is sometimes adduced as external evidence for a non-M text of Samuel (see, for example, Eugene Charles Ulrich, *The Qumran Text of Samuel and Josephus*, Harvard Semitic Monograph 19, Scholars Press, Chico, CA, 1978, ISBN 0-89130-256-5, 151-164), but the evidence is in our view less than convincing (cf. the similar conclusions of Zipora Talshir, “The Relationship Between Sam-MT, 4QSama and Chr and the Case of 2 Sam 24,” 273-298, especially 296, in: Kristin De Troyer, T. Michael Law, and Marketta Liljeström, editors, *In the Footsteps of Sherlock Holmes: Studies in the Biblical Text in Honour of Anneli Aejmelaeus*, Contributions to Biblical Exegesis and Theology 72, Peeters, Leuven, 2014, ISBN 978-90-429-3041-4).

For an argument against use of G-Kings by the chronicler, see van Keulen, 238-263. The safest approach is probably to take Chronicles as occasionally supporting non-M readings (where assimilation to Chronicles or independent change in the same direction by non-M witnesses is not probable), rather than as supporting one texttype as such over another.

Transcriptional Error

“Interchanges of Consonants Between the Masoretic Text and the *Vorlage* of the Septuagint” by Emanuel Tov 255-66 in: *Sha'arei Talmon: Studies in the Bible, Qumran, and the Ancient Near East Presented to Shemaryahu Talmon*, ed. Fishbane, Michael and Emanuel Tov with the assistance of Weston W. Fields, Eisenbrauns, Winona Lake, Indiana, 1992 makes the following points, among others:

-“There is no direct correlation between table 1 [viz. letter interchanges] and the list of plus and minuses occurring in the LXX.... This situation is actually not surprising. The frequency of pluses and minuses presumably relates to the *Vorlage* of the LXX and reveals in some cases different stages in the literary growth of the books, while the present study of the interchanges of consonants refers to the textual transmission of the Hebrew text and in some cases only to the translators” (264).

-Among the books with the highest incidence of textual error of this sort are: Prov, MinP (but not Hag, Zech), Kings, Samuel (to a lesser extent than Kings), Jer, Eze, 1 chr (but 2 chr notably low rate) (263-64, with some interpretation from me; use “cf.” if cite)

-By far the most common interchanges are *daleth/resh*, *waw/yodh*, and *mem/nun* (264-65). Direction of change is hard to comment on; evidence pretty balanced (265). *Daleth/resh* interchanges alone take up roughly 25% of (reasonably confidently retroverted) consonant interchanges (262).

-Books most likely (due to especially high frequency and/or characteristic nature of the interchange of *waw/yodh* put alongside the Qumran-era scripts) to have been translated into the LXX from a square script are Ezra-Nehemiah, Chr, and (“interestingly,” 266) Ps (265-66). [Note that such does not preclude an exemplar of that exemplar to have been in the paleo script. In Psalms, for instance, there seem to be various errors in M explainable as errors in the paleo script, and while these books are more or less late, the continuing use of paleo scripts at Qumran near the time of Christ suggests that at least some of the post-exilic books might have been written in such a script originally. In the case of Ps, many, especially in the first half of the book, were certainly originally composed in the paleo script; the youngest of the psalms might have been written in the paleo script to follow suit, though these being written in the square script should not be ruled out.]

Frequency of Error Type

With the 1st edition all but complete, I went through the S+- units in the Pentateuch (=about 25% of the OT) and attempted to classify each variant. Of course, many individual cases are debatable or uncertain as to their cause. Note also that some of these variants involve jumping a word boundary as well as the item mentioned. Here the results:

- Aleph/taw (2)
- Aleph/waw (2)
- Assimilation (12)
- Aural (6) [most of these are interchanges of לָא and לוֹ]
- Ayin/samekh (1)
- Beth/pe (2)
- Beth/tsadde (1)
- Complex [that is, combining more than one element, but usually the elements are other items mentioned here, e.g., waw/yodh confusion + metathesis] (13)
- Copying from the wrong place (3)
- Corrupt dittography (13) [NB this is largely a *single* letter, along the lines of בַּךְ for בָּכֶם]
- Daleth/lamedh (2)
- Daleth/resh (9)
- Dittography (2)
- Haplography (1)
- He/lamedh (1)
- He/mem (1)
- He/resh (1)
- He/taw (1)
- He/waw (1)
- Homoeoarchon (1)
- Homoeoteleuton (8)
- Interference of a common word (1)
- Lamedh/taw (2)
- Loss of intervening material (3)
- Mem/nun (1)
- Metathesis (4)
- Near haplography (29) [NB this is largely a *single* letter, along the lines of בַּךְ for בָּכֶם]
- Nun-resh (1)
- Other (1)
- Parablepsis (1)
- Resh-qoph (1)
- Uncertain (7)
- Vertical Dittography (1)
- Waw/yodh (15)

- Wrong word division (2)
- Yodh-he (1)
- Yodh-nun (2)

Reflections: [1] *Near* haplography and *corrupt* dittography seem to take a notable share of the error pool, perhaps because these errors, once made, are less obvious as errors to straight up haplography and dittography. [2] Consonant with Tov's findings, waw/yodh errors are extremely common. [3] Complex errors are notably common; if a scribe goes astray, it is often in *more than one respect* that he does so. [4] Assimilation is not constant, but not infrequent either. [5] Aural error is not very common, but not super rare either. [6] It is interesting that there are various similar letters which are interchanged only once or twice in the Pentateuch, so while visual interchanges outside of waw/yodh and dalet/resh are not what one should *rush* to expect, one should not *discount* such a possibility either.

-Later addition: could it be that on rare occasions in paleo script MSS the letter *taw* and the word divider could be confused with one another? Cf. the readings offered in Davies 1: 2.003.

Frequency of Scribal errors

A modern-day scribe, when asked

(nehemiaswall.com/scribe-toolbox?fbclid=IwAR0PNrDa9Xvt8wLI9FgHr4bOFNZR4QIZ5cZkpJz443i7mr9e7GcLMkFKMt8) if he could write a megillah Esther without a mistake, replied that he had recently done one with only about four mistakes. The rate of error he recognized among modern-day scribes ordinarily to be considerably higher.

My own extrapolation follows: Esther (in L) is 3,058 words. Assuming each error involved only one word, we would expect from an exceptionally accurate scribe one error per 750 words [=about 2 pages in SRO 1st ed.], but a higher error rate on average, many times higher in some cases. Most such errors, however, can be assumed to be obvious blunders, often caught in proof-reading and easily bypassed by a subsequent scribe working from the resulting exemplar.

B/K Interchanges

For discussion of the intrinsic evidence, see J-M pp588-589 (=166l).

Kt b': Josh 6:5, Jdg 19:25, 1 Sam 11:6, 11:9, 2 Sam 5:24, Est 3:4

There appear to be no cases where Kt k' has a Qr b'

Are there more possible instances among the sevirin?

El/Al Interchanges

-Kt-Qr interchanges of these two words seem to occur only at 1 Sam 20:24, Isa 65:7 (kt here assimilation?)

-Since al (along with l) tends to supplant el in late Hebrew (since Aramaic does not have el), the wrongful substitution of al for el is more likely than el for al (though a kind of hypercorrection [i.e., a pseudo-archaism] is just possible)

-The sevirim that suppose a substitution of el for a written al are Eze 25:7, 28:19, 29:3 (all with a 2ms suffix; PDF [02.p1.] loc 332); any or all of these notes written from the perspective of post-biblical Hebrew?

-There are no sevirin in the other direction

-Only change made so far (as of 3rd edition): Ps 18:42

Word Divisions

Since at times scribes were inconsistent in putting in word dividers, might it be the case that sometimes the original text has two words written as one? If so, one could repoint such cases with some sign (e.g. a *revi'a* or *zaeqph qaton*) to indicate the word break. Possible examples:

- Ps 71:1 לישראל /lyashar|el/
- Ps 71:4 למותם /lmato|tam/ (see Kraus)
- Ps 106:7 עלים /al|yam/ (reading G's consonants but pointing with M; see the notes on that verse)
- Ps 107:29 לגליהם (so Kraus; but this is a slight emendation of the consonants)

Link to Ginsburg Massorah

<https://archive.org/details/MassorahMassorethMassoretic/02.p1.MassoraCompMSS.Caph.Tav.Ginsburg.1880./page/n331/mode/1up>

Spelling of Jerusalem (J'lem)

- See HALOT 1: 437a-b
- HALOT notes that in Hebrew (not Aramaic) the spelling is ירושלים except in Jer 26:18, Est 2:6,1 chr 3:5,2 chr 25:1, 32:9 (this last has the directional *he* as well)
- See early BIOSCS essay on this topic
- “Earliest-ever Inscription Bearing Jerusalem's Full Name Unearthed in Roadwork,” Nir Hasson, *Haaretz* 10/09/2018, cites a newly-discovered first-century BC *Aramaic* inscription using the spelling ירושלים *with* the *yodh*
- See discussion (especially in the comments) on ETC blog 10/10/18
- Blau (271 = 4.4.5.6). He points to חרנים as an analogue.
- See Althann (*A Philological Analysis of Jeremiah 4-6*, 203-204)
- See the excursus in Concordia-Josh
- In OG (to go off Ralhfs) both Ιερουσαλημ and Ιεροσολυμα are found, the former strongly predominating. In the NT both forms are again found (so both RP05 and NA27)
- Might the two forms have a similar relationship to the two forms of the name אביגל and אביגיל?

Typography

In FrankRuehl font, g. mukdam (SHIFT + 0) sits over the letter, making it suitable to distinguish vocal schwa and short qamatz; the font also tolerates a dagesh in ayin and chet to distinguish etymology

Link to an article about a program for automatically adding pointing:

<https://medium.com/@morrissalper/unikud-adding-vowels-to-hebrew-text-with-deep-learning-powered-by-dagsh-ub-56d238e22d3f>

Typesetting Apparatus

<https://www.roger-pearse.com/weblog/2025/09/02/how-do-we-represent-the-critical-apparatus-when-we-make-our-critical-edition/>

Resh with a Daghesh

The following list comes from Ginsburg §7 sub ר, page 546^b {of which print volume?} = PDF vol. 4, loc. 127^b:

- 1 Sam 1:6 [gemmination]
- 1 Sam 10:24 [in הראיתם] [gemmination]
- 1 Sam 17:25 [in הראיתם] [gemmination]
- Hab 3:13 [in ראש] [word-initially; after 2nd person singular perfect verb]
- Ezra 9:6 [in ראש] [word-initially; after למעלה]
- Eze 16:4 [in שר]
- Pr 3:8 [in שר]
- Job 39:9 [word-initially; after היקה]
- Jdg 20:43 [the catchphrase is wrong: מנוחה has migrated] [odd] [not in L or JC]
- Pr 14:10 [in מרת] [after יודע]

- Ps 52:5 [in רע] [word-initially; after 2nd person singular perfect]
- Jer 39:12 [in רע] [word-initially; after מאומה]
- 1 Sam 23:28 [in מרדף] [not in L or JC]
- 2 Sam 18:16 [the catchword does not occur in BibleWorks9; 2 Sam 18:16 includes מרדף, which occurs in 1 Sam 23:28 (see above) – is this a mistaken repetition of the latter verse, or does the form מרדף twice in MT-Sam have a *daghes* in the *resh*?] [not in L or JC]
- 1 Sam 15:6* [sic asterisk] [word-initially; after קומו] [not in L or JC]
- 2 Sam 23:28 [in a proper name] [not in L or JC]
- SS 5:2 [in שראשי] [gemminaton]
- Pr 11:21 [in רע; after ינקה]
- Pr 15:1 [in רך; after מענה]
- 2 chr 26:10 [in רב; after מקנה]
- Eze 21:35 [syllable-initial] [not in L or JC]

The following list (from Joey) indicates places where a *resh* has a *daghes*:

- Gen 2:10: וְנָהָר [but note that in UXLC this instance has been removed as being an artifact]
- 1 Sam 1:6: הָרַעְמָה
- 1 Sam 10:24: הָרְאִיתָם
- 1 Sam 17:25: הָרְאִיתָם
- 2 Kgs 6:32: הָרְאִיתָם
- Jer 39:12: רַע
- Ezek 16:4 (twice): כָּרַת שְׁרָךְ
- Ps 52:5: רַע
- Prov 3:8: לְשִׁרְךָ
- Prov 11:21: רַע
- Prov 14:10: מָרַת
- Prov 15:1: רַךְ
- Job 39:9: יָרִים
- Lam 1:1: רִבְתִּי
- 2 Chr 26:10: רַב

In UXLC 2.0, a daghes was added in רבים at the end of Ecc 7:29. This daghes is not in MM (have not checked JC)

Raphe

In WLC (4.20), these are the locations of the *raphe* (thanks to Joey for locating these):

- Ex 20:13, 14, 15
- Dt 5:13, 17, 18, 19
- 2 Sam 11:1
- Isa 22:10
- Jer 20:17
- Zech 5:11
- Ps 119:99

Phonetics

Possibly pre-Tiberian yet of exegetical value:

- waw* consecutive (note, e.g., the case in Isa {})
- mappiq* (see on Nah 1:8)

Possibly pre-Tiberian but may be difficult to correct and/or somewhat confusing to readers

-*patach* -> *kamatz* in certain positions

-*tsere* -> *seghol* in certain cases?

Probably pre-Tiberian but would be difficult to implement and very confusing to readers

-segholates

-bgdkpt (but preserve gemination!)

-see further under “phonetic edition”

Phonetic Edition

If I *did* prepare an ancient phonetics edition, it might be less confusing to use unfamiliar characters and vocalization signs (since, e.g., a *beth* without a *daghesh* would tend to be read as /v/). Perhaps

-letters which in form a hybrid between ancient and modern, with an emphasis on readability; *beth*, *kaph*, and *pe* being least modern-looking

-vowel sign always go *under* letters

-cancellation sign *over* helping letters and etymological *aleph*

-gemination sign goes *over* a letter (to be different than the *daghesh* with its potential for confusion on *bgdkpt* letters)

Tiqqunei Sopherim

-For recently discovered examples, see

<https://www.lib.cam.ac.uk/collections/departments/taylor-schechter-genizah-research-unit/fragment-month/fotm-2021/fragment-5>

Sectional Breaks (=Sections)

A study I would like to see but have not yet is E. J. Revell, “Biblical Punctuation and Chant in the Second Temple Period,” *Journal for the Study of Judaism in the Persian, Hellenistic, and Roman Periods* 1976 181-198 (cited in Carr 231 n57; cf. Carr 77-78, 85-88).

Eveline van Staalduine-Sulman, “*Petuhot* and *Setumot* in Masoretic Manuscripts of Samuel,” 35-55 in: Marjo Korpel and Paul Sanders, editors, *Textual Boundaries in the Bible: Their Impact of Interpretation*, Pericope 9, Peeters, Leuven, Belgium, 2017, ISBN 978-90-429-3539-6, concludes her study in part [p35]: “This investigation into the use of spaces in the Masoretic manuscripts of Samuel results in the conclusion that there is no firm system of putting spaces in the books of Samuel. There are, however, patterns, [p36] meeting two goals: a narrative one and a theological one. Narratives are separated from each other and poems are mostly indicated by *petuhot*, further subdivisions are made by *setumot* [sic no conjunction for this clause]. Theologically important items and exemplary behavior are marked by mostly *setumot*, although a dialogue resulting in an exemplary decision is often marked by a string of *setumot*, concluded by a *petuhah*.” As regard Isaiah, Wim M. de Bruin, *Isaiah 1-12 as Written and Read in Antiquity*, Pericope 8, Sheffield Phoenix Press, 2013, ISBN 978-1-909697-05-8, does *not* think that the major section-minor section distinction can be maintained (p426). On the other hand, he does find a basic demarcation function in the sections (e.g., 427). He notes that when it comes to “superscriptions” (his word, 428) like that in Isa 1:1, “the Masoretes [sic; in fact, the sections at least substantially predate the Masoretes] considered the general function of the superscription to be so natural that an explicit delimitation was not considered needed” (429). At times, the presence of a section seems motivated by certain “words and formula” (429-30), at times by “thematic considerations alone” (431). David J. Clark, “Delimitation Markers in the Book of Numbers,” 1-20 in: Marjo Korpel and Josef Oesch, editors, *Layout Markers in Biblical Manuscripts and Ugaritic Tablets*, Pericope 5, 2005, Koninklijke Van Gorcum BV, AA Assen, The Netherlands, ISBN 90 232 4178 9, shows that 41.9% of break in the book of Numbers occur in connection with “a verb of speaking... in most cases with YHWH as the speaker. This must surely say something about the way a quotation formula is perceived as a discourse marker, but it may well also say something theologically about the importance attributed to the word of YHWH” (10)

The sections in SRO are largely based on the Jerusalem Crown (JC); contrast the situation with orthographic variations (see next section).

{Post-script: From the 1st edition spreadsheet, I derived the following data:

Column C pe=120
Column C samekh=239
Column C no section=146

Column D pe =166
Column D samekh=288
Column D no section=111

In other words, (assuming that the methodology behind the SRO-1 paragraphing is reasonably sound) the direction of error is pretty much a toss-up, except perhaps that original closed sections are the most fragile type of section.

Line Spacing

Malachi Beit-Arié, *Unveiled Faces of Medieval Hebrew Books: The Evolution of Manuscript Production - Production or Regression?*, The Hebrew University Magnes Press, Jerusalem, Israel, ISBN 965-493-160-5, 35ff, "The following are solutions of the first category, those that leave of the final word intact:

1. Dilating or constricting the last (or penultimate) letters in the line according to the space left... Letters were extended only if stretching did not twist their shapes or cause them to be mistaken for other letters. This was the most convenient and flexible practice and is therefore the most commonly found in medieval manuscripts. The fact that only 0.75 percent of the dated manuscripts avoided this practice demonstrates that the device is inherent in the very use of the Hebrew script. The stretching of the last or penultimate letter was achieved in two ways: either the letter as a whole was initially stretched (sometimes even magnified) or a "tail" was attached to one of its strokes *ex post facto*, after the completion of its normal tracing, thus making it reach the left margin line.

2. Minimizing the size of the last letters, particularly when they exceeded the margin, or switching to a cursive mode or current style of script so as to reduce the size of the last letters and make them fit into the remaining space... This device can be grouped together with the previous, opposite practice.

[p36] 3. Flexibly spacing the words in a line. This was the main justification device used in printing. Scribes who normally left minimal space between all the words in a line sometimes did those only towards the end of the line. Hebrew scribes (mainly those using the Sephardic script) might leave extra space before the last letter of the word, or leave extra space before the last word or before the graphic filler or the anticipated next word...

4. Inserting graphic fillers designed in various shapes – partly in the forms of letters, complete or stunted.

Though individual marks can sometimes be discerned in these lines fillers, they usually conform to the shared regional stock of basic types... This practice, widespread in both the East and the West, is attested by 69 percent of the dated codices.

5. Filling up the line with the first letter of the next word, which nevertheless is written in its entirety at the head of the next line. This practice, related to the graphic filler device, was apparently part of the common practice of anticipating next words (which is classified in the second category, detailed below). I believe that the confinement of this sub-practice to single letters makes it similar to a graphic filler (especially when these single letters were not marked, as were the last letters of the anticipating words, by dots or short strokes inscribed above them), as both scribe and reader would have been aware of the graphic function of any meaningless solitary letter in a Hebrew text... and could have hardly conceived of it as a dismembered part of a word. Single anticipating letters are found in 11 percent of copies.

6. Writing slantwise (mostly downward), words that are too long to be accommodated inside the space left at the end of a line... This practice was common only in the Near East and Byzantium. In the Near East, excluding Yemen, it is witnessed in 57 percent of all the dated manuscripts; in those of the fifteenth century it was employed there 77 percent. In Yemen the slating device is found in 65 percent of all extant manuscripts; in those of the fourteenth century it was employed there in 91 percent of the manuscripts. In Byzantium, where the practice was less common, it is found in 31 percent of all the dated codices.

[p37]...The following are solutions of the second category, those that involve bisecting the last word:

1. Anticipating the next word – filling up the space left at the end of the line by writing as many letters of the next word as the boundary margin would allow and then rewriting the complete word at the beginning of the

following line... Sometimes, principally in France and Germany, a scribe would even write all the letters of a long word but the last one, and then rewrite the entire word at the beginning of the next line. In about half the copies produced in all regions there is a tendency to write certain last [p38] letters of the anticipating word segment in a stunted shape, omitting one or two strokes... This time- and space-consuming custom was practiced in all geo-cultural areas in even the earliest extant Hebrew codices and can be found in in 63 percent of the dated manuscripts. Naturally, the distribution of this practice is not chronologically even. In France and Germany, for instance, it is employed in 86 percent of the codices (91 percent in the thirteenth and fourteenth centuries); in the Middle East (excluding Yemen) in only 37 percent (47 percent in the fifteenth century)...

2. Placing exceeding letters above the word segment written within the justification... This custom of crowning the end of the line with overflowing letters [p39] written in superscript is evident in 33 percent of the dated copies regardless of their area of production (15 percent of those in the thirteenth century and 40 percent of those in fifteenth century). While in Iberia, Provence, and the Maghreb this practice is found in 58 percent of the manuscripts (68 percent of those in the fourteenth century), it is present in only 2 percent of the dated codices produced in Germany or France and in 4 percent of those written in Yemen. There was a natural tendency to write the upper letters of those “double-checked” words in a smaller size. In more than a quarter of the manuscripts the practice was confined to the last letter, which was written above the penultimate one. Despite the fact that the two parts of the word are not really separated, the word is not written in a linear manner, being visually bisected. The fluency of reading, though, is not substantially disturbed.

3. Writing exceeding letters vertically (usually upward), along the margin line... This device was not widely practiced; it is found in only 9 percent of the corpus (14 percent in the Franco-German areas).

4. Placing exceeding letters at a distance in the margin... Since considerable space was left between the two parts of the bisected word, readers might miss the marginal completion of the word, particularly when the device is applied in one-column copies of wide margins. This line margin stratagem was employed in 15 percent of the dated copies in general. Its distribution is more marked in Ashkenaz, where it is found in 38 percent of the dated codices... In the Orient this device was extremely rare (2 percent).

Lexitomy – word division, placing one segment at the end of the line and the second segment at the head of the following line, allowing uninterrupted regularity of writing in any script. This, the commonest practice in Latin and Greek scripts and the most convenient justification practice, is present in only 9 percent of all the dated Hebrew manuscripts. It was used significantly in only two regions: Italy, where about half the extant Hebrew dated codices were produced, and Yemen. In Italy alone the word division was practiced in some 10 percent of the codices; in Yemen in 36 percent of the dated codices. However, in about half the dated manuscripts produced in Italy only proclitic morphemes, such as the definite article or various prepositions (up [p40] to three letters, but mostly just one) attached to the beginning of Hebrew words, were cut off and conspicuously marked by infralinear vowel signs in unvocalized texts... This strictly grammatical bisection, coupled with the distinct marking by vocalization signs, casts doubt on whether this variant of the splitting practice should be classified as a dismembering solution or as one that preserves word integrity. Grammatical bisection is noticed also in Yemen, but most in texts written in Arabic (in Hebrew script)... Eliminating this grammatically bound variant from the statistics reduces the practice of unconditioned word division among Hebrew manuscripts to a negligible 5 percent.

In grammatically unconditioned word division in Italy and elsewhere, the first or second segment of the word... or both segmented parts were usually marked by a hyphen sign in the margin. In all these manuscripts the practice appears in a very limited number of lines, and then only in part of the pages (or columns).

6. Abbreviating final words. Abbreviations in Hebrew manuscripts are always confined to mere shortening, usually cutting off the last letter or the last two letters, in most cases the plural or female morphemes, but never contracting words by omitting letters within a word. Moreover, the same abbreviation of word may occur within a line. Surprisingly, this simple layout device... was also not widely employed. Though shortened words are documented in 15 percent of the dated manuscripts, in many copies such abbreviations were not employed any more frequently at the end of lines than within the lines. The very fact that no elaborate abbreviation or contraction system, like that existing in Latin manuscripts, was ever developed in Hebrew manuscripts obviously reflects the preference for reading comfort over any other interest.”

Orthography / Orthographic Variations

Most O-class variations are based on a collation of WLC against the Mechon-Mamre (MM) '17 edition, which says is it based on “the Aleppo Codex and MSS similar to it” (my translation). (This edition is very similar, but not identical to, the Jerusalem Crown edition; there might be some mistakes in this file and in the textual commentary of referring JC when in fact it is MM that is referred to.) The most commonly applied principle is that L is to be abandoned where it differs from MM and where a look at Ginsburg shows apparently little to no support for L in the MS tradition as a whole – i.e., L is idiosyncratic and probably in error. I also departed from L at times, or at times retained L where external evidence was more or less dubious, where internal factors seemed to be at play: Assimilation to a more usual spelling, or visual error (e.g., loss of a *plene waw* after a *resh*). Rarely a defective spelling is assumed to have existed and is adopted based on transcriptional and/or intrinsic considerations based on versional evidence.

On the plausibility of (rather frequently, as it turns out) accepting a Kt in which a word-terminal *waw* (*sans* preceding *yodh*) is interpreted as a 3ms suffix on a *plural* noun, cf. the Secunda transliteration of גִּדְרָתִּי in Ps 89:41 (OG 88:41) as γαδρωθαι (cited in, but for purposes besides those at issue here, Kantor 342-343), which shows that at least by the Origen's day (and therefore plausibly earlier), this suffix was pronounced in such a way that the *yodh* would be dispensable. {That said, I am interested in the diachronics of this: Can it be demonstrated that at a certain prior stage the realization of this suffix was different? In this connection, it is to be borne in mind that haplography of the *yodh* in such Kt-Qr cases – or at least in *some* such cases – is itself a plausible scenario, though, apart from conjecture, the versional and other evidence would have to be assessed on a case-by-case basis in the relevant passages, once those passages had been isolated.}

See also the comments on Isa 36:11 below and the textual commentary on Job 13:24.

Double-duty Letters

It has often been argued that in ancient Hebrew letters could sometimes be used twice, or at least that the OG translators thought so. I have resisted the former contention, and been slightly skeptical of the latter contention, but late in the process of preparing the first edition of SRO I noticed certain recurring variants that led me to do more investigation. I principally looked for variants in the 18th draft for single-letter prepositions coming before a word that happens to start with the same letter. Here are the results:

- Babel: Ps 137:1
- Beit: passim (but note that Jer 29:26 is different)
- Goy: Jer 44:8 (M^A גוי), Zeph 2:9, 2 Chr 32:17 (M^A גויי)
- Meydbah: Josh 13:9
- Menasheh: 2 Chr 15:9, 30:11
- Mitswah: 2 Chr 8:15
- Ma'al: Pr 14:14, Zech 1:4

Notes: (1) with regard to בית, it is *not* simply a matter of an accusative of destination, as cases like 2 Ki 2:3 show. (2) Further, euphonic considerations might lead away from writing בבית more than one might first think, if indeed in biblical times the second letter would *not* have an allophonic phonetic value. (3) Most of these examples occur in late books, and indeed many specifically in the work of the Chronicler. (4) None of the Chronicles verses have parallel passages that might illuminate matters. (5) The form ממושה occurs only once in the whole HB (1 Chr 12:21), and the form וממושה only once as well (v20). (6) The form בבבל, however, occurs a number of times, though nowhere else in Psalms. (7) The form גויי occurs a small number of times, including in MinP. (8) Neither the form ממצוה nor ממצוה ever occur. (9) On the other hand, the previous several data points might be happenstance due to the limited corpus. For instance, the form ממצרים occurs 91x in L, including a number of times in Chronicles.

In the end, the examples given above are so few in number that I must revert to my original conclusion that cases like these are transmissional errors. There is an important exception, though: Cases involving בית are numerous and widely diffused across the corpus, and there is the circumstance that the *name* of the letter matches the *word* so often affected (perhaps certain aspects of the Egyptian writing system influenced Hebrew

scribes on this point); accordingly, the forms בית and בבית are in this edition considered to be orthographically interchangeable.

{Post-script: Another relevant case is גוי in Ezra 6:21, where for the reasons given above I read גויי.}
{See also W-O 10.2.2b.)

Jussive for Indicative

J-M calls these “difficult or impossible to explain” (114l). Dallièrè does not allow for an indicative usage of the jussive, nor MNK. W-O are also puzzled; they seem to suggest textual errors have crept in (34.2.1c). Many of the instances boil down to *tsere* for *chiriq*, so is dittography at work in many instances? But not all cases are like that. Also, a high proportion of these cases come after לֹא, which is especially puzzling. Had the jussive lost its force in Tiberian Hebrew to such an extent that the jussive and the indicative were in free variation from the point of view of the *naqdanim*? That does seem plausible, for in Mishnaic Hebrew the functions of the jussive had been absorbed into the imperfect (so Siegal). So perhaps at least some of these cases are a kind of hypercorrection to the then-obsolete grammatical form of the jussive; further, this hypercorrection might sometimes have been prompted by collocation with לֹא, which, being similar to לא (and these two words are not only graphically and auditorily similar, but in Mishnaic Hebrew the lines were being somewhat blurred; cf. Siegal on negative clauses), caused a certain amount of stress.

As a significant refinement on the above, perhaps the confusion started early in the post-exilic period. Several of the consonantal instances come from Job. Might the influence of Aramaic, plus the simplification of Hebrew brought about by the exile and return in general, have led to this situation? If so, the anomalous jussives in early books might be hypercorrections, but the anomalous jussives in late books might be genuine.

Taking the list from J-M (114l) and rearranging roughly into *temporal* order, we have (asterisks mark cases where consonants are involved):

- Gen 24:8
- Dt 28:8*
- Dt 28:21
- Dt 28:36
- 1 Sam 14:36
- 2 Sam 17:12
- 1 Ki 2:6
- 1 Ki 8:1
- Ps 11:6
- Isa 50:2
- Zeph 2:13*
- Eze 48:14
- Dan 8:1
- Lam 3:50*
- Pr 15:25
- Job 10:16
- Job 10:17*
- Job 15:33
- Job 18:9
- Job 18:12*

- Job 23:11*
- Job 27:22
- Job 33:11
- Job 33:21*
- Job 34:37*
- Ecc 12:7

To this list could be added Ruth 1:8Qr

Comments on specific instances:

-Gen 24:8 Perhaps either a pointing issue, or (cf. OG) just possibly לא is to be read for אל? But אל can sometimes be used in negative instructions, especially where there is some emphasis involved (cf. J-M on negation), as in this text. So MT is probably best retained in any event.

-Dt 28:8 (On the LXX, see Walters 240-241.) OG = MT. SamP does read יצוה, and the final *he* plausibly could have been lost before יהוה; but transcriptional considerations aside, this is a very suspicious witness, especially in a matter of this kind. But in a general sense, that the Samaritans felt a need to correct here does tend to reinforce the notion that the jussive as an indicative is problematic. On the other hand, in this particular passage a rhetorical vacillation between jussives and indicatives seem plausible to me, and so important a (pentateuchal) passage might well have been preserved in its finer points in the oral tradition more reliably than more others have been. So, even if changes are made elsewhere, quite possibly the MT is to be retained in all three Dt verses.

-1 Sam 14:36: Cf. the below discussion on 1 Ki 2:6, and note also that practically the same situation to that in this verse is found that later in the same book (2 Sam 17:12), suggesting a legitimate usage.

-1 Ki 2:6: This is the only case where J-M quite specifically recommends a repointing, perhaps on the basis of the (somewhat) parallel v9. That latter passage notwithstanding, however, an emphatic negation seems possible here, and the pointing is somewhat hard to explain if not original.

-Zeph 2:13 near haplography after *tet*? Or near haplography before *yodh* in the paleo script?

-Ruth 1:9 See the note there and the discussion in NICOT

-Ps 11:6 this is really an exegetical question, as in context a case could be made either for a true jussive or for a future-referring imperfect. NET, preserving the jussive, points to Job 20:23, which uses a jussive with the same verb. This doesn't necessarily clear things up, however. The sense in Job 20:23ff would seem to require an indicative. It could be repointed, but perhaps it would be best to allow both these two forms to stand?

-Lam 3:50 auditory haplography? (OG ambiguous)

-Job 10:17 could the *he* have been lost owing to its position in between two very similar letters?

-Job 18:12 ABAB -> ABA, or near haplography before *resh*?

-Job 23:11 Near haplography seems possible (and OG, so far as its goes, supports reading אטא); alternatively, the word could be the *adverb* אט ("with head bowed," HALOT 1:37a), here meaning "half-heartedly."

-Job 33:21 Perhaps this case (and a few others) the similarity of *beth* and *he* in the paleo script led to the error

-Job 34:37 (see on 33:21)

The overall concentration in late books in general, and in Job in particular (which book also contains the lion's share of asseverative *lamedhs* according to my reckoning), is striking, and tends to suggest that this is something of a diachronic or dialectical matter. Similarly, nearly all instances occur in more or less *poetic* material, not prose. In fact, the exceptions where prose is involved all (iirc)

involve dialogue.

All told, granting that the instances listed above are not all identical in nature, it seems best to grant that—at least under certain circumstances, and especially in late books (most of all Job)—the jussive can be used in places where an indicative would be expected.

{Post-script: An additional case that might be relative: ישרש in Isa 27:6 (cf. HALOT 2: 1659a).}

-ti Ending

See Hornkohl, *Historical Depth* chapter 7; esp. the documentation on p155. My thoughts in a nutshell: the long ending can be (1) genre-specific, marking (a) regional or nonstandard speech or topics (e.g., 2 Ki 4, Ruth) or (b) certain poetic subgenres (e.g., Pss 103, 116); or (2) dialectical variation (certainly Jeremiah and Ezekiel, and possibly Micah).

Ideally, (Vm-type?) adjustments should be made throughout Jer and Eze (and possibly Mic [?4:13] and Ruth), and sporadically elsewhere (esp. Ki and Ps) for consistency. But I would need access to a powerful morphological search engine.

Other potential large-scale but relatively unimportant vocalization shifts: taking away definite articles fused to prefixes; taking away waw consecutive forms; possibly pausal forms and/or sandhi (often, maqqeph) forms; stem shifts as per Hornkohl; -yyim forms (see on Ex 3:18 below)

Enclitic Mem

-“Enclitic Mem in Early Northwest Semitic, Especially Hebrew,” Horace D. Hummel, *Journal of Biblical Literature*, Vol. 76, No. 2 (Jun., 1957), pp. 85-107 Contains numerous possible examples from throughout the OT and at, the end, discussion of possible implications on genre and dating. Near the beginning and around the middle has important discussions of vocalization, though I would like to compare other sources. For instance, if as Hummel says *reqam* has an enclitic mem, does this point to the absence of a final vowel, since it is in this form that the word goes into later Hebrew? Or does it? {Post-script (12/3/19): Probably in very early Hebrew the form was **reqama*, and the final vowel was lost at the same time as other final vowels (e.g., final -u for the nominative case).}

-See essay in “Diachrony” volume

-BHQ (SS *63) notes that “no certain examples of enclitic *m* after a possessive suffix” are to be found, and the enclitic *mem* seem not regularly to occur alongside conjunctions.

-Huehnergard, 68 in: *The Semitic Languages* [via amazon preview] says “Enclitic **=ma* is a topicalizing particle: **ja-mut dajj(:)n-um=ma* 3-die.PCS judge-NOM=TOP 'It was the judge who died.' In Akkadian, *=ma* also topicalized whole clauses, and became the most common clause connector: Old Babylonian *ileqqû=ma izuzzû* receive.PCL.3MPL=TOP divide.PCL.3MPL.”

-Some of the stronger examples (see below for a larger list): Gen 5:29, Jer 11:19 [cf. BDB sub לָחַח, sub root לָחַח], Hos 14:3, Ps 12:8, 23:4, 29:6, Ps 80:8, 15, 20, 84:9, Lam 2:2. But even in these cases a different explanation is usually (always?) quite possible.

-Tentative conclusion (12/3/19): The enclitic *mem* may have existed in *very* early Hebrew, but if so it was soon frozen and non-productive. (The same situation seems to obtain in Phoenician.) Aside from its unimportant presence in forms like רִיקָם and חָנָם, it is not a form to seek.

-List of possible examples from DCH, 1st edition: Gen 5:29 102b 6:13 100a 10:28 102b 14:6 96a Num 21:14 96a 21:18 98b Dt 32:43 96a 33:11 96a Jg 5:13 96a I Sam 1:1 98b 9:19 100b 10:2 102b I King 20:28 100b 22:27 96a (cf. Is 30:20) Is 1:10 96a 1:18 98b 9:18 100b 10:5 97b 11:15 100b 12:8 101b 18:41 101b 19:9 96b 19:12 102b 28:1 96b 29:6 101a 30:20 96b 33:2 98b 33:21 98b 33:23 98b-99a 42:5 101a 42:17 102b 47:14 99a 55:20 101a 67:5 101a 68:28 101a 78:3 101a 80:6 101a Jer 10:4 100b 10:10 96b 11:19 102b Jer 13:24 I will scatter [you] (but cf. Eze 5:16?) 18:15 100b Eze 26:10 99a 27:34 96b Hos 4:18 sov'am "the wine" Hos 5:7 100b 7:6 96b 9:2 13:2 96b 14:3 96b Hos 14:2[H3] "pareym sfateinu" bulls, i.e., offerings of contrition (cf. Ps 51) of our lips OR "p'reym" fruits of Hos 14:4[H5] (x2; notice shift in person; clearly emphatic) Jon 2:9 97a [Against enclitic

mem here, cf. Ps 31:6[H7] (cf. also Ps 9:12[H13]) Ob 13 99a-b Mic 7:19 99b Zeph 1:17 102b 2:8 97b 3:19 100b Ps 5:10 97b 10:17 97b Ps 11:6 pacheym esh 18:28 97a 23:4 102b 49:9 97b-98a 54:5 98a (Inagid-m) 59:6 97a 60:11 97a 65:10 99b 68:17 97a 77:18 97a 80:5 97a 80:6 101a 80:8 97a 80:15 97a 81:13 98a 84:6 98a 84:9 97a 86:14 98a 88:7 97a 89:10 101b 89:51 97a 102:18 98a 104:29 99b 109:13 98a Ps 115 'ezram umaginam hu 119:15 98a 139:16 98a (gilamay) 141:4 97a 147:20 101b Pr 1:18 100a 22:21 97a Job 4:19 101b [y'dak'um (cf. G ad loc)] 8:8 100a 12:25 101b 14:12 100a 15:29 98a 17:7 101b 31:11 100a 31:14 101b 36:7 101b Ecc 4:6 97a Lam 3:26 102a I chr 1:22 102b {HALOT (2:1288b) calls it “still a questionable morpheme in Hebrew.”}

The Conjunction “Pa-”

There is no linguistic reason *not* to allow the existence of such a prefix in theory (note in particular that Ugaritic has both *p* and *ap*, so the Hebrew פֶּאֶ is *not* the reflex of this participle). However, there are no clear-cut examples, at least if conjectural emendation is not allowed (e.g., in Ps 50:10-11 one could emend אֶלְךָ יִדְעָתִי to אֶלְךָ (פִּידְעָתִי). (See HALOT for a similar conclusion.) This includes the inscriptions outside the Hebrew Bible. Since there is not even one clear-cut example, it seems best to conclude that this particular had dropped out of the language by Moses' day.

On לָא "Mighty One"

The suggestion seems plausible on comparative-linguistic grounds and possibly even within Hebrew (cf. HALOT on the root לָאָה). However, I have yet to see a specific example that convinces me. Some examples I have run across but personally prefer to explain otherwise:

-Jer 4:8 (Althann, *Jeremiah 4-6*, 52)

-Hos 7:16 (Althann, *Jeremiah 4-6*, 52; he here makes references to L. Viganò, *Nomi e titoli di YHWH alla luce del semitico del Nord-ovest*, Biblica et Orientalia 31, Rome, Biblical Institute Press, 1976, who cites many more examples)

-Ps 7:13 (CDCH 189^a)

-Job 13:15 (CDCH 189^a)

-Job 14:4 (CDCH 189^a)

-Job 24:1 (CDCH 189^a)

On עָלִי "Exalted One"

Probably not to be pointed עֵל as if from root עוּל; rather something like עָלִי. See Huehnergard (43). It is not clear whether it is legitimate to assume a by-form עֵל, or any other. (In theory the form עָלִי could appear if such was a *direct* borrowing from Ugaritic, but such seems unlikely.) The Ugaritic evidence here seems to be slim: Viganò (35 n⁵) instances Gordon *UT* (3: 193^a), and while this is not the only example (see, eg., *UPN* 35 l⁵), the title seems to be rare (Huehnergard does not cite it in his glossary; I could not find examples in the Baal cycle, though I did not search exhaustively).

Examples that seem worthy of consideration (culled from Viganò): Ps 13:6, 142:8, 57:3 [these first 3 should be viewed together; the last, unless גִּמְרֵ is a divine name, would seem to call for a prepositional interpretation in all three], 7:9, 56:13, 16:6, 86:13 [the preposition is probably preferable in being a word play with תַּחְתִּיהָ in the next line], Job 7:20, 29:4. In the end, none seems really convincing, and since the whole enterprise is, as noted above, a bit tenuous, it seems best everywhere to retain MT (apart from cases like Job 7:20, where unrelated text-critical factors take the discussion in a different direction).

On Milchom/Molekh

The final mem in מִלְכָּם is probably mimation. The pointing is probably dialectical, with the meaning unaffected: See the essay on **milk/malk*, which shows a coalescence of these forms in many languages. Pointing in cases like Zeph 1:5, then, need not be adjusted.

On the other hand, מִלְךְ probably *is* tendentious, and should be adjusted (in Lev 18:21, 20:2, 3, 4, 5, 1 Ki 11:7 [if MT there be sound], 2 Ki 23:10, Jer 32:35). Note that Lev 20:5 seems to show that the form is arthrous

(at least in Leviticus; “the king”); the situation is evidently analogous to אֱלֹהִים which can be a proper name or a noun to which the article may be admitted. (Possibly there are other references to this deity not so pointed: HALOT 1: 592^a suggests Isa 30:33, where repointing is plausible, but in the end seems unwarranted, as the context is a funeral cremation; there is also Isa 57:9.)

Asseverative la(')

See Huehnergard, John, “Asseverative *la and Hypothetical *lu/law in Semitic,” *Journal of the American Oriental Society*, Vol. 103, No. 3 (Jul. - Sep., 1983), pp. 569-593. The pointing, he notes on 591 (cf. n²⁰¹), would be *kamatz* on or immediately before the stressed syllable and *patach* elsewhere.

It can mark the subject, predicate, end of a list (so HALOT), imperfect or perfect verb, but *not* an imperative; *cannot* occur in subordinate clauses (see Huehnergard).

A better term might be “proclitic,” “asseverative” being better reserved for where it “marks the short prefix conjugation verb specifically as injunctive” (Huehnergard, 68, in: *The Semitic Languages* [via amazon preview]). On the same page (viz. 68) he remarks that the proclitic “marks asseveration or affirmation, and could be prefixed to virtually any form [including, from the Ugaritic example he adduces, the suffix tense], with the exception of imperatives.”

In his 1983 article he is unsure whether לָא ever represents this particle, but there is a bit of evidence for this outside of Hebrew, so he entertains the possibility (590^b n¹⁹¹). I would add (1) that there may be some orthographic precedent in cases like לֹא for לוֹ (Isa 48:18) and לָא (cf. Suchard), and (2) there are some quite strong candidates (e.g. Ex 8:22, 1 Sam 20:9,)

He also points out that הִלֵּז is certainly a survival of the proclitic *lamedh*; such could be a frozen form, but since (1) it only occurs twice (Gen 24:65 and 37:19; Isa 58:5 is different) and (2) does not occur with other grammatical words (contrast the enclitic *mem* on forms like חֲנֹם and לָמוּ), it probably rather evidence of a productive particle. It also shows that the particle occurs on the far side of (at least) the definite article, different from the placement of the prepositional *lamedh* (as shown both by the vocalization לֵ and by the the dialectical לֶ). I forget whether he mentions הִלֵּז in Eze 36:35, but this probably also an instance (needs repointing?). {But do these forms occurs in Mishnaic Hebrew? If so, would this not point to a frozen form?}

{At least for the *beginning* of lists, Jenni prefers to retain the preposition in a redefintional function (see Rubrik 171).}

Vocative Lamed

There does seem to be good cross-linguistic evidence for this: See Huehnergard, “Asseverative,” 581 (Amorite), and CDCH (Ben Sirach v^l). The former source thinks it to have been vocalized *la*, like the asseverative; *ibid*, 591 has examples and citations (Dahood on Ps has 75 proposed instances!).

Helping Letters

-The Style of the Gezer Calendar and Some "Archaic Biblical Hebrew" Passages, Ian Young, *Vetus Testamentum*, Vol. 42, Fasc. 3 (Jul., 1992), p. 365 “When we begin to have an adequate corpus of Hebrew inscriptions, a century later than the Gezer Calendar, it is clear that, despite some defective forms, the use of at least final *matres lectionis* is fully under way. Likewise, the Mesha Stone from Moab, and the Aramaic Bir Hadad and Tell Fakhariyeh inscriptions show the full system in operation by the mid 9th century.”

Peculiar Pronouns

-Takamitsu Muraoka (*The Tripartite Nominal Clause Revisited* in: Miller, Cynthia L., ed., *The Verbless Clause in Biblical Hebrew: Linguistic Approaches*, Linguistic Studies in Ancient West Semitic 1, Eisenbrauns, Winona Lake, IN, 1999), building on earlier Semitic scholarship, suggests that certain Hebrew pronouns (principally הוּא but, at least in later books, also הֵם) can serve “highlight any part of speech” (207). Example include Jer 10:3 (*ibid.*) and Zeph 2:12 (208). Similarly הֵן can impart “some degree of prominence to the preceding constituent [in a nominal clause]” (209), in some contexts at least bearing “a ring of immediacy” (210).

Authenticity of Qumran MSS of Unknown Origin

According to Brill (temporarily available video), a number of these from the Schøyen collection have been shown to be fake. I think unknown origin is usually denoted with “X,” e.g. XJob. Thus, pending further investigation, readings/features attested *only* in one of these must *not* be accepted.

Notes from Daley

S. C. Daley, *The Textual Basis of English Translations of the Hebrew Bible*, Supplements to the Textual History of the Bible 2, Koninklijke Brill NV, Leiden, The Netherlands, ISBN 978-90-04-39175-8, 2019, assesses variation units (he excludes cases that where paraphrase or linguistic constraints could be at work) from Gen 49, Hab 3, Pr 139, Pr 14, a sample of conjectural emendations, and a sample of Qumran readings.

He assesses these versions (in chronological order): KJV, LSR, RV, ASV, JPS, JM, AT, RSV, JB, NAB, NEB, NASB, TEV, NIV, HPR, NKJV, NJB, NJPS, NRSV, REV, CEV, NLT, ESV, NET, NABRE, NIV11, ISV. The versions KJV-JPS he puts (p. 440) in the category “minimal”; the versions JM-NEB “maximal”; and the versions NASB-ISV “moderated,” as to the number of departures from MT (in the passages sampled).

The most non-MT are NEB (by far), then NAB, REB, JB, and NABRE.

The least non-MT (in other words, *most* MT) are LSR and ASV (the difference between these two is not significant), then RV, then JPS, then (neck and neck) KJV and NKJV, then (at some remove from the previous items) NJPS and NASB. ESV is not a great deal farther from MT than NASB is, but noticeably so.

NIV, ESV, and NIV11 are approximately on the same level. NLT, NET, and ISV [a substantial percentage of ISV's non-MT readings are Q] are a bit further from MT than NIV11, but not remotely as much as, say, NABRE.

Book of Ezekiel

-Observations on Inner-Scriptural Scribal Expansion in MT Ezekiel

Jake Stromberg

Vetus Testamentum

Vol. 58, Fasc. 1 (2008), pp. 68-86

Issachar

-The Aharon Ben Asher school understood the sense to be יִשְׁכָּר {typo on my part for יִשְׁכָּר?} and so points יִשְׁכָּר, while the Ben Naphtali school seems to understand the first two letters to represent יִש and so points יִשְׁכָּר, while the Ben Mohe school (“otherwise unknown”) for some reason points יִשְׁכָּר (see Hendel, 39).

A BibleWorks search turns up no examples of *shin* followed by *sin* or *shin* by *sin* in MT, nor yet of *samekh* followed by *shin*, but *shin* following by *samekh* does occur 51x.

If the Ben Asher tradition does represent a *Niph'al*, and if this tradition is correct, the orthography might be a survival of a geminate form represented by a repeated letter. But would this be the only such survival in the OT, and if so, why? (Perhaps b/c originally a foreign name – iirc in Phoenician geminates are showed by doubly-written consonants – but again why would this be the only such case in the OT?)

BDB makes a case for יִשְׁכָּר or יִשְׁכָּר (but does BibleWorks9 have a typo here?); the latter has the advantage of a scribal tradition (Ben Naphtali) behind it. Might the latter be influenced by Aramaic אִישָׁר?

As for the LXX, Rahlfs has Ισσαχαρ. Gottingen has such in the main text of Gen 30:18, but the apparatus shows considerable external support for Ισαχαρ. The apparently geminate form is found in (at least) NA27 in Rev 7:7, but RP05 has the single-*sigma* form there.

For lengthy discussion, see Ginsburg (intro) 250-255 (starting at PDF loc 266). His theory of an original יִשְׁכָּר from יִשָּׁא plus שָׁכָר has much to commend it, except that, in an early text, is not clear that *aleph* would drop out from the spelling. {But dropping of the *aleph* is (most likely) attested in (at least) MT-Num.}

What seems to have the greatest footprint in the reading traditions and to respect the orthography of ancient times (which could hardly have tolerated a non-sounded *s(h)in*) is יִשְׁכָּר. The initial vowel might be due to dissimilation; cf. הִישָׁכַם in Dt 13:4.

OT Writing Materials

Several OT passages mention tablets (we leave aside for present purposes the stone tablets of Moses): Pr 3:3, 7:3, Isa 8:1, 30:8, Jer 17:1, Hab 2:2. It is not clear that any of these refer to scriptural books as such, with the possible exceptions of the Isa and Hab instances, though even there the reference seems to be to a temporarily available message and not to the book by that name as such. In all cases ease of use seems to be in view, meaning, I would think, clay (rather than stone) tablets are in view. So, it remains unlikely in my view that any Scriptural book was composed originally on a clay tablet, but clay tablets evidently were in wide use at least as late as Habakkuk's day.

An essay of epigraphic evidence in the volume *Biblical Hebrew in its Northwest Semitic Setting* offers evidence for knowledge of cuneiform and (iirc) Neo-babylonian among those returning from exile.

Pentateuch

On the הָוָה issue in the Pentateuch, cf. Job 31:11.

In favor of the *waw/yodh* confusion theory, such seems to break down with obscure names like ידותון and מעינים.

Places where JC has hw' for L hy' in Pent: Gen 19:20, 26:7, 40:10, Ex 1:16, Lev 5:11, 13:6, 20:18. NB: This does *not* entirely eliminate the number of hy' occurrences in the Pentateuch, only reduces it

Book Authorship

A Massoretic note (Ginsburg, PDF file 3, loc. 345) has משה איש האלהים כתב חמשת חומשי תורה וספר איוב יהושוע כתב ספר שמואל הנביא כתב ספר שפטים ורות ישעיה כתב ספר ומשלי ושיר השירים וקהלת ירמיהו כתב ספר וספר מלכים וקנינות דויד ועשרה נביאים חברו תלים חגי זכריה ומלאכי כתבו ספר יחזקאל ותרי עשר וספר דניאל ומגלת אסתר עזרא הסופר כתב ספר וספר דברי הימים ברוך בוחר בישראל ומנחלים תורה תמימה שלימה מאושרה ערוכה בכל ושמורה דרשו מעל ספר יהוה וקראו אחת מהנה לא בעדרה.

Sequence of Books

Comments re Baba Bathra 14b (Ginsburg, 1): First there the widely-recognized groupings (1) books of the Torah, in *chronological* (as to content, at least) order (2) Former Prophets (=Josh, Jdg, Sam, Ki), in *chronological* (as to content, at least) order and (3) Latter Prophets (=Jer, Eze, Isa, MinP) in *descending* order of size. Then there are (4) the Wisdom books (=Ps, Job, Pr) in *descending* order of size, with Ruth (the smallest book of the group by far) *prefixed* as an introduction, either to the importance of David in the Psalms, or—being in a sense a metaphor for returning from exile—an introduction to the (wholly) post-exilic books; and (5) other Post-exilic books (Ecc, SS, Lam, Dan, Est, Ezr-Neh) in *ascending* order of size, too which Chronicles (the largest book of the group by far) is *appended*.

Possible single letter words:

-o(w)

-e(y)

-ba(') Gen 30:11 ("ba gad"; Kt; cf. G. Intro 140), Ps 68:17[H18] (ba misinai"; see G. Intro p161-2)

-ho(y)

-ko(h)

-k(i) Ex 11:1 (surely his sending will be total), Judges 16:25 ("ki tov"; Qr), Ne 2:8; Hos 3:1 ("for the love of J' is w/ the sons of Israel, although they, etc."), Hos 7:12, Hos 8:1, Hos 9:4, Hos 10:5, Hos 11:10 ("indeed, a lion will roar; indeed, He will roar" [ki...ki like gam...gam?]), Hos 13:1, Hos 13:6(?) Joel 1:15 ("v'kki shod mishaday yavo"; cf. 2:1b; same construction minus conjunction Is 13:6), cf.: ki yulad ben liy, surely a son will be born to me, UGN p56, l14; p63 l16 yada'tikh bat ki anasht, I know you daughter that you are desperate; esp. p117, l27-28 yd'[tk.]... kin.bilht.ql[s]k. I know you... that among goddesses there is no scorn like yours; p124 l21, kbh.btt.ltbt for in it (the council) shame is surely seen; p137, l41 ("surely"?); p138, l53 (very odd); p141, l1 (when); p148, l17 (that); p153, l41-42 (for);

-l(a) surely - see memo "la"; cf. prhps UGN p77, l32 ltrkn.alk brktm(?), you shall indeed surely bless me I shall

go mightily blessed; p105, l34 ym.lmt. Yam, truly he has died; p111, l38-40 lmhst...lkl...listbm... surely I fought, finished, bound; p117, l35; p124 l21, kbh.btt.ltb for in it (the council) shame is surely seen; p127, l20; p129, l3; p130, l12 lyrgm let it indeed be told; p136, l23 (def. emph. in context); p137, l50; p141, l6 ("surely");
 -lo(') Gen 4:15 ("lo ken" vs. "lachen"; see G. Intro p140), cf. UGN p74 l40 yav Lo lo laqotz(??; yb. llqz) he wails: he does not wake; p97 l22 malakiti ['i]m lo malakhti (very dub.; mlkt.[]m.lmlkt) am I king or am I not king; p99 l19 tb'.glmm.lytb. the boys depart they do not sit still; p110, l26 abn.brq.dl.td'.smm I understand the lightning which the heavens do not know; p104, l17-18; p154, l50-51, 60-62;
 -lu(w) Pr 30:1 ("lu iti el" so G. ad loc, but preferable is his other suggestion there ["la'iti el"])
 -ma(h) Ex 4:2 ("ma zeh"; Kt; see Mass. II p54, G. ad loc), Is 3:15 "ma lachem" (Kt; see Mass. II p54; but. cf. G. OT), Jer 10:6 ("how there is none like You!"), Eze 8:6 ("ma hem" in place of "mehem"; Kt; see Mass. II p54)
 -mi(y) Num 23:10 ("umi safar"; G. Intro p168 [he makes it an abbreviation]; see memo on this v), Is 44:24 (if Qr be right, then prhps "mi iti" [who was w/ Me (to help)] vs. "me'iti"), Ps108:10[H11] (mi yancheni; G. apparently did not see this, but cf. him ad loc)
 -l(?), O p153, l45; p155, l14; p163, l24;
 -na(') Ruth1:9 prhps umtsa' na' "and find now" (imp.; but very dub.; pl. imp. in many comparable situations, e.g. Ex 32:27, +plus shld be umats'i [but coloq. "lachem" used in this verse])

Copy and Paste from Old “Parameters” File

Draft 3 updates:

- Ideas for cover images
- Back cover description (three alternative versions are now given, which of course can be mixed and matched, or entirely rewritten)
- Idea added to Table of Contents section

Physical Parameters

Volumes: Two. A natural end-point for vol. 1 (both in terms of cutting the OT in half pretty evenly and in terms of respecting the traditional major divisions of the OT canon) would be to end at (inclusive of) 2 Kings.

Height and width: Same as SRS?

Font size: As large as can be gotten away without making the book too bulky.

Typeface: Keter YG (modified)

Versification: Unobtrusive chapter starters (as with SRS). Guides at the top of the page.

Front and Back Covers

Title: Solid Rock Hebrew Bible

Subtitle possibilities

1. *none*
2. an eclectic text
3. an eclectic text, with key divergences from the Leningrad Codex noted
4. with Tiberian Diacritics [allowing for a companion edition; see “Brainstorms...” below”]

Images:

Question: Same images for both volumes, or different? I think having the same is more standard.

Ideas:

- Some MS (not L; A?) with לוא in Jer 5:12

- 4QGen^{4h} or 4QGen^l, inclusive of Gen 1:9 (מקרה is the point of interest)
- 4QPaleoJob^c (a very fragmentary MS; uses the ancient script; seemingly very reliable text)
- MS 19250 (Kaifung Torah; British Library:
http://www.bl.uk/manuscripts/Viewer.aspx?ref=add_ms_19250_f001r), a possible point of interest being עלהם in Gen 45:15.
- Basically any Hebrew MS other than L, of 2 Chron 6:42 (משיח is the point of interest)
- 4QSam^a on 2 Sam 6:6 (לאחז)
- Any MS (not L) with יהללו thus in Ps 106:1 (viz, as *two* words, not one word)

Back Cover Description:

[Rough draft, version A:] While scribes have transmitted the Hebrew Bible (HB) in its original languages text with extraordinary care for millennia, no one man or woman can be expected to have escaped all error. The present volume – based on investigation of various masoretic manuscripts, ancient manuscripts from the Judean wilderness, the ancient versions, and other sources – this volume prints the entire HB text, with adjustments made to the base text (the Leningrad Codex) made in over 4,500 places. Pastors, scholars, translators, and others readers of the Hebrew Bible will stand to benefit from the present work.

[Rough draft, version B:] Readers of the New Testament have long had the benefit of editions reflecting text-critical research and reflection, but readers of the Old Testament (OT) have so far not had this benefit. The present edition aims to correct this situation. Based on investigation of various masoretic manuscripts, ancient manuscripts from the Judean wilderness, the ancient versions, and other sources, this volume prints the entire OT text, with adjustments made to the base text (the Leningrad Codex) in over 2,500 places. Additionally, over 2,000 other adjustments have been to the diacritics. This edition will be of interest to scholars, translators, pastors, and others readers of the Old Testament.

[Rough draft, version C:]

Ve = 412

VL = 394

Vamp = 728

Vk = 876

P = 420

O = 644

S+- = 1589

Copyright Page

Copyright statement: j

Doctrinal disclaimer: Note that citation of a work does not necessarily imply doctrinal agreement with it.

[Dedication Page (doesn't have to be included)]

We dedicate this edition to the Jewish people, praying for many to recognize in Jesus of Nazareth the Messiah.

Ἀδελφοί, ἡ μὲν εὐδοκία τῆς ἡμετέρας καρδίας καὶ ἡ δέησις ἡ πρὸς τὸν θεὸν ὑπὲρ τοῦ Ἰσραὴλ ἐστὶν εἰς σωτηρίαν

(Rom 10:1, adapted)]

Pagination/Direction

Behind the front (front an English-language perspective) cover, in a left-to-right direction, paginated either in Roman numerals or with an asterisk after the number (1*, 2*, 3*...):

- Copyright page
- Title page
- dedication page [in vol. 1]
- table of contents [volume-specific?]
- introduction [in vol. 1]

Alternatively, if it is not feasible to vary the direction of writing within the volume, the direction of writing can to right-to-left throughout. Such will look strange for the English content, but I've seen reputable publications follow this practice.

Behind the back (from an English-language perspective) cover, in a right-to-left direction, paginated in Arabic numerals:

- table of contents [volume-specific?]
- biblical text

If necessary, a blank page should intervene between the end of 2 Chron and the last page of the appendix so that the biblical text and the introduction do not fall on opposing pages.

Tables of Contents [on the sequence of books see §3.1 in the introduction]

Idea: Maybe have the *entire* table of contents in *each* volume, placing a “1:” or “2:” before each page number to indicate in which volume a given book occurs?

Page Layout

Column(s): Two columns.

Section breaks

See the introduction, §3.3.

Content

Step 1: Use WLC (4.20 or later) as base text

Step 2α: Eliminate

- (a) accents
- (b) *maqquph*
- (c) *soph pasuq*
- (d) *qere* reading (enclosed in <q> </q>)
- (e) *puncta extraordinare* (WLC transcription notes “Type 4”)
- (f) *paseq*
- (g) inverted *nunim* (WLC transcription notes “Type 8”)

Step 2β: Regularize

- (f) large letters (WLC transcription notes “Type 5”)
- (g) small letters (WLC transcription notes “Type 6”)
- (h) suspended letters (WLC transcription notes “Type 7”)

Step 3: Replace section-marking *pe* and *samekh* and replace with appropriate layouts (see SRO_Introduction)

Step 4: Verification: (a) Make desired changes to versification indicators; (b) remove book headings and other WLC-specific extras

Step 5: Chunk biblical material in accordance with the specifications describes in SRO_Introduction §1.1, 1.3, 3.1, and 3.3.

Step 6: (a) Alter text in accordance with SRO_Readings table *and* (b) in accordance with the following

directions:

(α) Everywhere in Hebrew (*not* Aramaic¹):

רוּשָׁלַם becomes רוּשָׁלַם

וּרוּשָׁלַם becomes וּרוּשָׁלַם

בּוּרוּשָׁלַם becomes בּוּרוּשָׁלַם or בּוּרוּשָׁלַם in accordance with whether or not WLC has a *daghes*

וּבּוּרוּשָׁלַם becomes וּבּוּרוּשָׁלַם

לּוּרוּשָׁלַם becomes לּוּרוּשָׁלַם

וּלּוּרוּשָׁלַם becomes וּלּוּרוּשָׁלַם

מּוּרוּשָׁלַם becomes מּוּרוּשָׁלַם

וּמּוּרוּשָׁלַם becomes וּמּוּרוּשָׁלַם

NB: רוּשָׁלַם, with a without prefixes, is to be remain *as is*

(β) Everywhere *outside* Chronicles:²

יְהוָה becomes יְהוָה

וְיְהוָה becomes וְיְהוָה

בְּיְהוָה becomes בְּיְהוָה or בְּיְהוָה in accordance with the presence or absence of a *daghes* in WLC

וּבְיְהוָה³ becomes וּבְיְהוָה

לְיְהוָה becomes לְיְהוָה

וּלְיְהוָה⁴ becomes וּלְיְהוָה

מִיְהוָה⁵ becomes מִיְהוָה

וּמִיְהוָה⁶ becomes וּמִיְהוָה

שְׁיְהוָה⁷ becomes שְׁיְהוָה⁸

(γ) *Within* Chronicles:

All forms of יְהוָה gain (in addition to their present WLC signs in each instance) a cholam after the *he*, and shift the *qamats* under the *waw* of the Tetragrammaton to a *patach*. (This simulates אֲדָנִי as repointed [in non-pausal positions] in SR.)

Step 7: Introduce marginal (=WLC) material, with corresponding sigla in the text, at the bottom of the page, for Ve, +, -, and S category readings.

Brainstorms for Parallel Editions

-Same basic layout as above (slightly bigger font?) but minus the apparatus.

-Combination SR5 (or SR critical NT text?) with SRO text in one volume. Presumably (given LS limitations) no apparatuses could be included and the font size would have to be small and front and end matter made as brief as possible. The NT would start behind the front cover at the OT would start at the back, with the end of 2 Chron and the end of Rev meeting somewhere in the middle. For consistency with the MS-based paragraphing of SRO, it might be nice to have some sort of MS-based paragraphing for the Greek text.

-A paleo edition. Two goals: A text-critical aid, and a (partial, to be sure) simulation of the ancient reading

¹ The Aramaic portions of the OT are: Ezra 4:8-6:18, 7:12-26, Dan 2:4-7:28, and Jer 10:11.

² NB that while the usual basic form is יְהוָה (plus an prefixes), two other basic forms are also found, viz. יְהוָה in Gen. 3:14, Gen. 9:26, Exod. 3:2, Exod. 13:3, 9, 15, Exod. 14:1, 8, Lev. 25:17, Deut. 31:27, Deut. 32:9, Deut. 33:12-13, 1 Ki. 3:5, 1 Ki. 16:33, Ps. 15:1, Ps. 40:5, Ps. 47:6, Ps. 100:5, Ps. 116:5-6, Prov. 1:29, Jer. 2:37, Jer. 3:1, 13, 21-22, 25, Jer. 4:3, 8, Jer. 5:2-3, 9, 15, 18-19, 22, 29, Jer. 6:9, Jer. 8:13, Jer. 30:10, Jer. 36:8, Ezek. 44:5, Hos. 10:3, and Nah. 1:3; and יְהוָה or יְהוָה where the Tetragrammaton immediately follows אֲדָנִי.

³ Josh 22:19, Ps 26:1

⁴ Josh 22:24, Ps 68:21, Pr 21:31

⁵ Gen. 18:14, Gen. 24:50, Num. 32:22, Jdg. 14:4 1 Sam. 1:20 1 Sam. 24:7 1 Sam. 26:11 1 Ki. 2:15 1 Ki. 21:3 2 Chr. 20:4 2 Chr. 26:18 Ps. 33:8 Ps. 37:23, 39 Prov. 8:35 Prov. 12:2 Prov. 18:22 Prov. 20:24 Isa. 29:15 Isa. 40:27 Jer. 51:5 Lam. 2:9 Lam. 3:18 Zech. 10:1

⁶ Pr 16:1, 16:33, 19:14, 29:26

⁷ Ps 144:15

⁸ The form וְשִׁיְהוָה does not occur.

experience. In the interest of both goals, versification ranges will be given at the top of the page as normal but *no* chapter or verse (or verse break) indications given in the text itself. (More costly but in the direction of simulating the ancient reading experience, each of the 24 books could be bound separately.)

-A reader's edition. For the sake of beginning Hebrew students, FrankRhuel or some similar easy font should be used.

-A companion English translation: (1) A translation of SROtxt and of SROmg, with its paragraphing mirroring that of SROtxt. (2) (a) The translation should be quite literal in character, given its purpose. (b) For convenience in preparation, an open domain version could be used (Rotherham or Darby?); (c) the probable archaic nature of such should be viewed as (at least partly) advantageous, in that the old 2nd person singular and plural distinctions will be of use. (3) (a) The versification should correspond to that of SRO, facilitating English-to-Hebrew comparison, but (b) an appendix should chart the differences between English and Hebrew versification, facilitating comparison of other English translations to this one.

-An edition which would feature a reconstructed phonology, along with era-specific script (from early paleo to early square). See the separate file on this.

Gen 1:1

Scholars who favor a construct include Holmstedt (*VT* 2008, LSAWS 10: 214, 305), Hendel (*Steps to*, 36-37), and Rashi. In favor of an absolute: TOTC (50), NICOT (103-108) and NAC (129, 139).

BHQ (77*) notes that SamP supports the absence of the article. *Ibid.* is probably wrong to say (even if with Wevers, whom he cites) that LXX supports the anarthrous pointing, for (1) LXX-Gen is somewhat paraphrastic, (2) the Greek an article is not preferred in prepositional phrases, and most importantly (3) had the construct been understood, the rest of the verse would have been rendered differently. So LXX in fact either supports the article, or, with NICOT and possibly TOTC, supports the absolute position from the anarthrous state. At times much seems to be made of the the *-it* ending on the noun, but this is out of place: Cf. Blau (276, 4.4.6.9) and note the presence in Moses of forms like בכית in Gen 50:4 {?} and שארית in 45:7; ראשית by no means need imply a construct state. (For a complementary explanation on literary grounds, see NAC 1:126-127.) As might be alluded to in NAC 1:138n¹⁰², Jn 1 seems to require the absolute view. Cf. also NICOT 106-107 re the contrast with 2:4b.

In sum, the absolute interpretation is surely correct, though it remains uncertain which vocalization is original. A possible explanation for the anarthrous reading tradition is an acceptance of the Hellenistic doctrine of the eternality of matter, especially if the reading tradition goes back to the late Second Temple Period (which it might, since the synagogue was nascent then; cf. Khan on knowledge of Persian in the reading tradition). It is also possible that the pointing was made on analogy to the fact that (by happenstance, in our view) the word ראשית never occurs elsewhere in the OT with an article (cf. Rashi). Tentatively, we reprint to bear an article.

{Post-script 7/5/21: It is to be noted that if I am reading Holmstedt (214) rightly, while he would point with a *schwa*, he would understand the form as meaning (my paraphrase of his translation), “In [the] beginning, viz. when God created the heavens and the earth... He said, etc.”; that is, in the end – though he emphasizing that *technically* “In the beginning God created etc.” is not correct, that in the end the thrust of the passage. Relatedly, if Holmstedt is right that Hebrew is SV (not VS) (41-50, esp. 48-49), then after בראשית would one expect אלהים ברא, rather than ברא אלהים as actually is found? I am not quite sure on this. But in a restrictive relative, verb usually precedes subject (ib. 152), which supports Holmstedt's analysis. In another matter, probably not *too* much weight should be give to Jn 1:1, 1 Jn 1:1, since John is for literary reasons echoing – not the MT but – the LXX verbiage, whether or not that translation is *technically* correct as it relates to the article. Also, elsewhere where Moses says “beginning” in a (syntactically) absolute way, he uses תחלה (Gen 13:3, 41:21); on the other hand, he does use ראשית absolutely (Lev 2:12, Dt 33:21; but these are in a different sense) as well as in construct (Gen 10:10, etc.).}

Gen 2:2

See Hendel (31-33): Anticipation of the following clause. Also suggestive of anticipation is the very occurrence of הששי in 1:31: Having counted from 1 to 6, what number would a scribe expect next?

Note also the concurrence of P (which seems notably literal / Hebrew-centric in Gen) with G.

Concurs (at least): Oort (1). Retains MT (at least): BHQ.

{Post-script: But see 2 Chr 7:11 for a similar construction, viz. where ויכל summarizes the completion of a project *after* the literal end of it (for the previous several verses describe the festival following the dedication of the Temple).}

Gen 2:3

J-M seems to be troubled as well (p408 n1). But see Jenni.

Gen 2:11

Re החוילה see Holmstedt.

Gen 3:6

The plural reading could be due to dittography, given that the next word starts with a *waw*. The very fact that ותפקחנה begins thus, however, could just as easily explain the singular reading, one *waw* being copied for two. Both readings are thus explainable on transcriptional grounds.

An appeal to the mental process of the transcriber might explain the singular reading: A scribe might, having copied the earlier ותאכל, assume that this occurrence of אכל would be singular as well and unconsciously (or possibly consciously) substitute the singular for the plural. The fact that a small handful of MSS of the LXX have a singular here suggests that the same error occurred more than once.

BHQ (1:9) supposes the plural to be an assimilation to 2:17. There, however, only G has a plural, while Smr has a singular, so Smr, at least, is not assimilating. One should also note the possibility that 2:17 in G is an assimilation to the plural the tradent found in its *Vorlage* here, though this possibility seems remote, given the traditional Jewish emphasis on the moral responsibility of Adam here (see Mathews, 238).

A degree of intrinsic support for the plural might be found in שניהם in v7, inasmuch as the term would seem to emphasize the guilt of both man and woman. A greater degree of intrinsic support for the singular, however, resides in vv12-19, where man and woman are twice listed separately. It could be the case that the singular is an adjustment to reflect the more individualized focus of those verses, but this scenario seems unlikely given that the singular is supported principally by M, which seems rarely, if at all, to engage in this sort of emendation of the consonants in Genesis. Indeed, the fact that M witnesses the singular give ויאכל special weight, though this weight is somewhat lessened by the probability that the erroneous reading – whichever reading is the erroneous one – likely arose accidentally.

In summary, intrinsic evidence seems to support the singular, yet that reading is the easier to explain as an accident than its plural counterpart. We thus incline toward the M reading, yet feel it prudent to place ויאכלו in the margin as being a plausible alternative.

5/3/19 update: Probably influenced by 3:3 (cf. chain of references in BHQ); external evidence weak anyway (as Smr is a poor witness to lean on, especially where assimilation is a possibility).

Gen 3:16

The suggestions that BHQ gives may not bear the necessary meaning, and it is also not clear that the OG would be retroverting either of those words (though such cannot be ruled out). Perhaps the best suggestion is that of NET (i.e., to keep the MT but derive from a different root than traditionally), especially given the observations on the sound-play (cf. NICOT and esp. NAC).

Gen 5:23

Here and in v31, ought ויהי to be read in both instances (w/, I believe, Hendel)? It is true that (1) this is a graphic error *twice* and (2) there are plenty of irregular cases of verb agreement, particularly with the root היה (see J-M 150j). But in this passage there is more than one trigger: not only near haplography, but also assimilation to a more common form (ויהי being vastly more common than ויהי) and, perhaps most importantly, repeated instances in this passage of ויהי. Moreover, one of the two cases occurs in the case of Enoch, whose biography stands out

from the others and so might have thrown off the M scribe's rhythm and further facilitated the error. (It is possible that SamP is an emendation in one or both of these cases, while OG preserves the G reading.)

Gen 8:5

J-M 123sn4 would read וַהֲסִרִים, and just possibly the LXX might support this, but the grammatical necessity and the transcriptional path both seem a bit tenuous.

Gen 8:17

The Qr form is quite puzzling. Perhaps when the Qr was made, הִיצָא erroneously appeared somewhere as a Kt (cf. the textual commentary on Num 1:16), and subsequently that form became הִוצָא by conscious or unconscious assimilation to the usual form or conscious or unconscious swapping of Kt and Qr.

Gen 8:19

Difficult. See Hendel for a defense of G. Yet the path from M to G is quite complex. V's omission of וְכָל הָעוֹף is attractive. Jerome, it seems to me, would more likely have emended by rearranging the word order, especially as the OG was available to him for comparison; deleting וְכָל הָעוֹף seems quite an unlikely solution. (Admittedly, this minus could be an accident.) The terms רֶמֶשׂ and עוֹף co-occur so often (though with variations as to position other matters of exact wording) that MT and G might have independently imported a reference to birds, the latter putting more thought into the matter, the first acting unconsciously and so creating a most strange verbal string.

{Post-script: Yet the resulting syntax from removing וְכָל הָעוֹף is awkward. The verb רֶמֶשׂ need not refer only to insects, however; cf. BDB. Thus the difficult MT is, perhaps, best retained.}

Gen 9:7

Read וְרָדוּ for the second וְרָבוּ here? So (at least) Anchor (57) and (iirc) Hendel. NICOT (311n4) argues on stylistic grounds against this.

Gen 11:4

(First brought to my attention by: {}.) The adverb שָׁם does seem to be *Leitwort* (sp?) here, 5x in 9 verses apart from the present case. As far as שָׁם, it used in v9, but the naming formula occurs plenty of other places without such an emphasis, and in that very formulation שָׁם occurs! Farmer argues that this anticipates שָׁם in 12:2, which his possible. PTW 171 links it to אֲנֹשֵׁי הַשָּׂם, making it an “ominous” note, also possible. NAC makes these points as well. NAC's connection to the naming formula for בָּבֶל is not convincing (he might be right about the play on words wherein the Babylonian etymology is made fun of, though not many of Moses' readers would have known this, and in any case such does not seem to bear on the question at hand). On other other hand, NAC highlights the self-serving לָנוּ of the builders here, but there is no answering לָךְ in Gen 12:2. NICOT notes that “[a] plain (v. 2) offers the least amount of protection in time of crisis,” which might point in the direction of שָׁם, but probably not decisively. NICOT (or was it NAC?) notes a possible kingship connection when שָׁם is collocated with עֲשֵׂה; certainly such is suggested in 2 Sam 7:9 (the Davidic echo of Gen 12:2, where, however, גָּדַל is used with שָׁם). BHQ and Hendel offer no comment.

The word cannot have עִיר as its (suffixed) object, for the form would then be וְנִעֲשֶׂה (as in Dt 30:12). The word עֲשֵׂה in v4 might bear the sense “act”: “Let us build a mighty tower, and [i.e. ; subsequently, in consequence] we will act in our interest, so as not [contrary to our wishes] to be scattered across all the earth.” But this seems rather forced.

v7 וְנִבְלָה שָׁם does seem suggestive of a וְנִעֲשֵׂה לָנוּ in v4; it is hard to know whether the absence of לָנוּ in v7 makes a difference.

Gen 11:30

Re וִלָּד Hendel (59) argues for “graphic confusion” in M: “Although **wald-* is the ancestral proto-Semitic forms (preserved in Arabic and Ethiopic), the shift of word-initial *waw* → *yodh* is one of the characteristic phonological features of the Northwest Semitic language group.”

But the external evidence is weak (note that G, while differing from MT, clearly reflects the presence of a *waw*), and there is also Ex 21:22 (see the textual commentary there) and (possibly) 2 Sam 6:23. As NAC (Gen 2/2: 102 n³⁶) points out, there are conceptual similarities here. Perhaps וֵלֵךְ is a borrowed term (whether directly from Arabic or Ethiopic, or through an intermediary, or from one of the many Semitic languages under-represented by the scanty textual remains) meaning “pregnancy” or “child still in the womb.” (A rough analogy would be the semantics doublets in various Semitic languages resulting from the presence or absence of the *aleph*, e.g. אִזְרַע and זֵרַע.)

{Post-script: In *support* of this, note now that in Ancient North Arabian *waw* and *yodh* (as consonants) appear to be in free variation; that ANA in ways bridges the gap between Arabic and Hebrew; and that the dwelling of Abraham, of Moses (particularly if Sinai was in northern Arabia), and the tribe of Benjamin in roughly the SE of Israel might help explain why an Arabian form of the word was part of their speech, or else of accounts written about Sarah, by Moses, and about Michal.}

-Gen 12:2 vhyh See NICOT and NAC for arguments for the imperative (in the sense of consequence of obedience to the imper of v1). On the other hand, both point out the heptadal structure of the passage, and this clause is one of the seven. Furthermore, the MT pointing can be explained as reflecting Jewish works-based theology.

Yet see *Kingdom through Covenant* (230-235) for an in-depth argument for the MT pointing (not in the sense of consequence *contra* NAC, NICOT, but in the sense of command). {But isn't there an essay or part of a grammar somewhere that argues against such imperatival understandings of weqatal constructions?}

8/4/19 update: See, in addition to the above, Dallaire (LSAWS vol. 9) page 119. Whatever the sense of the passage, the imperatival pointing is probably to be retained, for the construction is not common and could easily have been replaced by the vastly more common *weqatal* construction.

Gen 12:3

On the pointing see Ecc 7:21.

Gen 12:13

Is there any MS evidence for a spelling וְהָיָה? Cf. J-M p195 n1

[Ulrich records no extant MSS for this passage. The edition of the SP I consulted (admittedly not the recent) agreed with MT. BHQ made no comment.}

Gen 14:6

M's בְּהִרְרֵם שְׁעִיר is a bit unusual, but seems not to be objectionable (see Ges 131f). It is tempting to read בְּהִרְרִי from G (a paleo visual error), but (a) this could be a facilitating rendering (as indeed V S T must be doing, since *yodh/mem* confusion is hardly possible in the square script), and, perhaps more tellingly, (b) the collocation הָר followed by שְׁעִיר occurs 15x elsewhere in the OT, but הָר is *never* plural.

Gen 16:11

See J-M 89j.

Gen 21:3

See Driver to Samuel (58).

{Post-script: But see Holmstedt 69ff, esp. 71 n²⁷.}

Gen 21:9

Did אֶת יִצְחָק בְּנֵה drop out from or get dropped from M? So (at least) Anchor (153). But there is no clear transcriptional trigger, and supplying an object here would be just the sort of expansion we would expect. It also could be a gloss on a crux.

Gen 21:17

Is לֹא an error for תֹּא or vice versa? Cf. HALOT 2:1572a (near top) and discussion of putative *et/el* interchanges elsewhere.

Gen 22:12

Should yd' be repointed as a pi'el?

Gen 23:5-6

See Huehnergard, "Asseverative," 576^a: M is linguistically suspect and verses 5-6 and 14-15 point to the revocalization given here. (Repointing לֹי to לִי is an inferior option; see *ibid.*) (note also the pointing of מִנְעֵנִי in 1 Sam 25:34)

Gen 24:16b

Cf. Jdg 11:39, 21:12, Lk 1:34. (1 Ki 1:4 is of course different.) Cf. also Tawil (138b).

Gen 24:27

See BHQ 137*.

Gen 24:33

So Blau, p97 (3.4.3.3)

Gen 27:29a

While it is tempting to take the Qr in light of the form וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲוּ later in the verse, the form with a single terminal *waw* occurs several times in Genesis. Perhaps metrical considerations are at work.

Gen 27:36

In favor of M, see Kalimi, 70.

Gen 30:11

Cf. the OG rendering; it may be a sort of compressed expression, "[I am/see] in good fortune." Cf. the less compressed quotation in Ps 10:6.

DCH records a proper name בִּגְד, but such is probably not relevant here.

Gen 30:15

See BHQ *151-152.

Gen 30:37

The situation is not completely clear to me, but WLC 4.20 and BHQ (79) agree in marking this as an error of L.

Gen 31:7

Re וְהַחֲלִיף see Ges.

Gen 31:16

The word כִּי might be a corrupt dittography of the following כֹּל (which would then take a *daghes*); the construction is a bit difficult. But it might also be the the OG translator is avoiding the difficulty. The כִּי could be explained as asseverative (DCH 4: 388a), or (as I at present [12/10/19] tend to prefer) as used a but loosely, explaining what is meant by their father devouring "our" wealth: The wealth (*viz.* animal property, textiles, etc.) that Jacob takes was, they claim, really for their benefit and so in a crucial sense was theirs all along.

Gen 32:31

Re פניאל: *waw/yodh* confusion is possible, but (1) The MT form might be an old genitive ending, a morphological alternative to פנואל, and (2) the versions might well be leveling a proper name; furthermore, (3) there is 1 chr 8:25 to consider, where G seems to (not altogether certain) support the Kt – though there the reference is to a person (a different person with the same or similar name is found in 1 chr 4:4), not this place.

Gen 34:2

Here and in Josh 9:7 G apparently has החרוי for החרוי. It is very unclear which is preferable on intrinsic grounds. HALOT (1:353a)

Cf. also the situation in Gen 36:2.

Gen 37:17

Is דתינה an error for דתנה? Note the opposite error (viz., near haplography involving a *yodh*) later in the same chapter. On the other hand, note the transcription data recorded in HALOT. Perhaps the place name was called /dotayin/ in the south, and /doteyn/ in the north (thus the spelling in 2 Ki)? It seems best to retain M, if a bit tentatively.

Gen 40:14

J-M expresses doubts about the soundness of the text (112kn2). But might both כִּי and אֵם have their asseverative sense here?

Gen 43:26

Here and in Lev 23:17, Job 33:21, and Ezra 8:18 there are remnants of an abandoned system by which *daghesh* marked non-consonantal *aleph* (so J-M p77 n2).

Gen 44:10

If one were to conjecture, what about לו? But if M (= [at least] OG, VL) is correct, this is an interesting example of a spokesperson (a *mal'ak*?) speaking in the first person on behalf of his master.

Gen 46:21-27

The genealogical information here is difficult (see NAC 2:834-36 for helpful discussion; more briefly, WBC). There may be errors in MT, but if so it seems that most, if not all, predate extant sources; the numerous deviations found in G seem (1) massively to import information from other texts, not (generally at least) to attest to different texts here in Genesis, and (2) to smooth out a more laconic original text (cf. BHQ on 47:21 *ad fin*).

Gen 47:26

Following Jenni (89), who is, after all, an expert on both the *lamedh* prefix and the *pi'el* stem, and has the OG in his support.

Gen 48:1

Cf. Josh 2:2, and Ges to Gen 48:2. The rarity of the construction might have misled the *naqdanim*.

Gen 48:2

Cf. on v1.

Gen 49:6

Against reading כבדי as “my liver,” see the textual commentary on Ps 30:13.

Gen 49:10

The form almost certainly ends in *he*, the *waw* forms being intentional or accidental corrections toward expected spelling.

The שלה reading has for it a considerable range of attestation (LXX, T, V, S, etc.), though these could be corrections or midrashic interpretations of שילה. It also makes tolerable sense, though “He to whom it [what?] belongs” seems suspiciously cryptic (i.e. forced). Eze 21:32 might support this reading, however (but see NICOT-Eze for a contrary opinion; note also OG appears to be different from MT there). A weakness is the difficulty it has in explaining the rise of the שילה reading.

The שילה reading, if a reference to the place overrun by the Philistines, makes no sense at all. If Seebass is right (see HALOT), it could be a word for “ruler,” which would make good sense and explain the other reading (when the word was no longer understood, emendations were sought). The form has good external support (M^{A,L} and most MSS); a weakness is the uncertainty of the meaning (but hopefully some research can clarify the matter), and the possibility that a scribe responsible for the MT (not M; see P V T) accidentally thought he saw the place name.

{Update: further research tends to undermine the Egyptian equivalence imo; impressed by the external evidence, I read (though still somewhat tentatively) שלה—the error (based again on the external evidence) seems rather late, so perhaps a superfluous *yodh* came about via corrupt dittography of the left half of the *shin*.}

Gen 49:24

See HALOT (2: 1547bf), NET, CSB, etc.

Ex

On the Tabernacle Account, see the section devoted to it (below, after ch. 34 comments)

Ex 2:14

Propp suggests reading a participle for נודע, i.e. putting a kamatz under the ayin.

Ex 2:25

For the last two words Propp suggests reading with G wayyiwada’ aleyhem, comparing Eze 20:5. Cf. also Wevers (*Notes*, 24), HALOT sub ידע. But cf. 3:7

Ex 3:10

Re והוצאת, see Dallaire (104).

Ex 3:16

M could be (a) an assimilation to usual usage or (b) homoeoteleuton. LXX usage elsewhere strongly suggests that בני stood in the *Vorlage* and was not in their imagination (an assumption additionally supported by Sam). Finally, the support of P, not strong in itself, lends some support to this theory (especially given the use with which בני could have fallen out of the *Vorlage* of V independently of the ancestor of MT). {Post-script: In the same direction, see the comments in NAC.}

{Post-post-script: But cf. v18 and note that LXX (and to a significant extent, certain other witnesses also, so frequently add “sons of” in such contexts in this book that it seems better to ascribe this to a *Tendez* than to a transmissional error.}

Ex 3:18

Propp prefers to read העברים with one *yodh* with many MSS and Sam. Alternatively, ought עברים elsewhere (at least in the Pentateuch) be repointed to match L here?

Ex 4:2

On Kt-Qr: See Ges 37c. There is no good transcriptional explanation for מה זה becoming מזה, especially not more than once.

Ex 4:18

Perhaps יתר is an error for יתרו (so BDB; corrupt dittography of *resh*?). But there are other-*o* forms like ירחו and דודו; and alternations like און and אונו and like רמון and רמונו (if the text in 1 Chr 6:62 be sound). Furthermore, the base noun יתר seems to be just the sort of noun to which this suffix would be appended. So while a marginal reading would be warranted, it seems best to retain M and see here an alternative morph of Jethro's name.

Ex 4:26

Propp proposes pointing /wayyeref/, pointing to Dt 9:14 etc. But might the latter be rather a niph'al?

Ex 4:31

M's וישמעו and G's וישמחו both make sense. Either reading could be due to aural error, though it seems more likely that G is due to such than that M is, for at a late stage *chet* and *ayin* sounded alike in some dialects, while in earlier stages they sounded less alike. (A scan of how the LXX transliterates personal names that include the שמע root shows that *ayin* in this word was *not* so pronounced as in עמרה; thus we know *chet* did not sound much like *ayin* as that letter occurs in the שמע root.)

The specific form וישמעו is about twice as common as וישמחו in the OT; the root שמע is vastly more common than שמח in the OT (1194x vs. 177x). Thus a scribe might have thought he saw one form when the other was present in his exemplar.

On the other hand, intrinsic evidence favors M, for 6:3, occurring after success fails quickly to materialize, forms a contrast with M-4:31.

On balance, it seems best to retain M, though G is possible.

{Post-script: For further evidence for M, see the (exegetical, not textual) comments in EEC.}

Ex 5:10

BHS tentatively proposes reading ויאצו for ויצאו. Depending on how one resolves the variant concerning ויעשו in v9, transposition just occurred in M and so might have occurred again. Yet v13 would seem to be overly redundant on this account, and the M reading fits with the spatial implications of v6 (the taskmasters have come to the palace to dialogue with the king). Probably G is an accidental transposition, or possibly a deliberate assimilation to v13.

Ex 5:13

BHS seems to misrepresent the versions on the inclusion of לכתם; they have easier readings, but not all the same one. Thus M seems to have given rise to various attempts to ameliorate.

Ex 6:3

See especially KEL (both the translation and the comment sections), with the modification that is this old book, and especially in a poetic section of the book (if KEL is right), an asseverative *lamedh* seems a good choice. If one would rather not turn to the asseverative *lamedh* here, a rhetorical question would be the next interpretive option (though it would not entail changing of the MT pointing); on this see also NAC and the examples cited there.

Ex 6:22

Likewise in Lev 10:4; see Num 3:30 (where the pointing of L is wrong, but A [and SRO 1st ed. following it] has the right form). (It is possible that the text is in error in missing a *yodh*, but more likely assimilation in the version is at work given that the longer spelling is more common in the Hebrew Bible; hence, I have merely revocalized.

Ex 7:9

Propp tentatively suggests pointing /wiyhiy/.

Ex 7:19

על is probably the original MT reading (M?), but OG supports ועל, and על could very easily be assimilation to the two previous prepositions (possibly facilitated further by the two earlier asyndetic occurrences of על).

{But Propp retains M. Cf. 8:5 and the behavior of the witnesses there, not to mention the behavior of GV re the previous על in our verse; and I think there are similar sorts of constructions elsewhere in the book. Cf. on Dt 20:17 below.}

Ex 8:11

Re והכבד see Ges 113z.

Ex 8:22

So, tentatively, DCH 4: 495^a, i.e. asseverative *lamedh* + *waw* of apodosis. Note the irreal prefix tense, which strengthens the case for an asseverative *lamedh* (cf., e.g., Phoenician).

Ex 9:23

See J-M 75g.

Ex 9:30

For the last two words Sam and 4QExc have אדני יהוה, which Propp (303) finds “attractively unusual” and so possibly original. However, the collocation occurs only in direct speech in early Hebrew, not in narrative.

Ex 9:34

Propp proposes repointing /wayyikbad/.

Ex 10:12

For על ארץ מצרים should we read ויעל הארבה? Perhaps the error has something to do with the fact that על ארץ מצרים both precedes and follows these two words? Wevers (151) calls M “odd.” Would live to revisit with Jenni volumes 1, but M probably can stand.

Ex 10:21

Are the last two words of the verse a corrupt dittograph?

Ex 11:3

Propp suggests pointing /weyitten/, i.e. a future tense.

Ex 13:3

Perhaps we should insert בו after יצאתם, as a small word could easily have been lost, especially one not crucial to the sense and occurring in between to *mems*. On the other hand, cf. the construction with היום in Dt 9:7.

Ex 14:2, 9

Talmon (162) proposes reading G over M with respect to הזירה, but for the error to have happened twice seems strange, and M, though the more difficult reading (but b/c an Akkadian toponym), is probably preferable (cf. NAC).

Ex 15:1

M אשירה could be a forward assimilation to the singulars later in the verse and in the next. On the other hand, M-Ex does not seem prone to assimilation, and it appears that multiple tradents were troubled by the (near) juxtaposition of ויאמרו with אשירה: P “corrects” not only אשירה, but also לי. {Check on P text for v2.} Sam “corrects” אשירה to אשרו, which seems to be a differing solution to the same problem. As noted elsewhere, V seems unusually connected to G in Ex. Note also the GV reading in v21.

{Post-script: Regarding Jerome, Walters (245-246) states that throughout “the Pentateuch Jerome

preserved many of the original differences of translation in the Vet. Lat. without consulting the Hebrew throughout and thus giving a fresh and reliable translation.” So, indeed, one must be cautious—and not only in Ex—in using the Vulgate, which might be speaking to the text of the LXX rather than the Hebrew.}

Ex 15:2

Here and in Is 12:2 and Ps 118:14 scattered MSS or versions transmit or interpret זמרת as זמרת. {But double-check critical editions, where available, for G, V, P}

As to scholarly opinion: BDB calls for the latter in all three places; NET prefers the latter in Ex 15:2 but retains MT without comment in Is 12:2 and Ps 118:14. {Fill this out with commentaries on each book, etc.}

As to internal evidence: Haplography is possible in each case, but is it probable that such happened three times in M? Plus the syntax would encourage assimilation toward the suffix form. The syntax is a bit odd, but not impossible. {Look into this further from grammars, commentaries.} It is also a possibility that זמרת is correct in 1-2 passages even as זמרת is correct in the other passage(s). If so, it is probable that זמרת is original in Ex 15:2, for that reading would explain the suffix form in one or more later passages by way of minor stylistic alteration more readily than the suffix form would lead to the absolute form elsewhere. For זמרת to be original to both Is 12:2 and Ps 118:14 is possible in that haplography might have occurred in one passage and assimilation in the other, or possibly (though this possibility seems somewhat remote) either haplography or assimilation occurred twice. Is 12:2 is an unlikely candidate in that G probably reads זמרת, making external support for the suffix form extremely slim. (Although V represents a suffix {what is the translation style of V-Is?}.) Ps 118:14 *might* be more possible as a candidate for זמרת in that Ps 22 seems {but go back over this} more linguistically standard than 2 Sam 22, and a post-exilic compiler *might* have polished things somewhat.

Ex 15:17

Should מקדש be repointed? Propp this MT is a mistake. But see Blau (3.3.2.2.5).

In another matter, should אדני be considered an error for יהוה following a Qumran MS, a Cairo MS, Sam, and many Hebrew MSS? Onq is ambiguous, as it renders both terms with יי according to MM or both with יי according to CAL. In the Pentateuch, אדני with reference to God is not common, and where it does occur it usually occurs in combination with יהוה or in a dispute over proper justice; also, I think everywhere else in the Pentateuch is it vocative. But by what mechanism would this have happened here? Cf. re 9:30 above and Ps 68:27 below. Also note here the lcs cast of the poem, in which the -y suffix might not be stereotyped, but have its original signification.

Ex 15:24

The defective spelling here and a number of places elsewhere might have inclined a naqdan toward interpreting it as a niph'al. There are enough places where the spelling is uncontested and demands a hiph'il though, and Kt-Qr issues involve only *waw/yodh* confusion, so reading hiph'il throughout seems quite plausible. Moreover, Hebrew in post-biblical periods has trended toward the niph'al and hitpo'el forms, so niph'al forms in the Pentateuch could be an unconscious grammatical updating. {Post-script: The last observation is particularly apropos to this lexeme; cf. Jastrow s.v. לון II.}

Ex 18:16

See the textual commentary on Lev 26:46.

Ex 18:26

Here and in Ruth 2:8 (see JM 43c; Pr 14:3, cited there, is different) it is difficult to be sure of the pointing, but

cf. Blau 4.3.5.2.3.3: seemingly M in these two cases preserves spellings which imply a pre-Tiberian phonology (though just possibly in the case of Ruth a different phonology still, one preserved coincidentally at Qumran if /u/ is the middle vowel of their qal imperfect verbs).

Ex 19:13

On the pointing of יירה see Blau 245.

Ex 20:18

So (at least) Propp, well in keeping with the great emphasis in chapters 19 and 20 on fear.

Ex 21:2

Propp thinks לחפשי should be repointed with a schwa under the *lamedh*. But it may be best to keep L as is, barring a much wider intervention in cases of definite articles (or the lack thereof) hidden in prepositions.

Ex 21:3

Propp thinks בגפו should be plural in both cases, and they could be pointed thus. [if so, also v4, no?] But the philological evidence seems weak (cf. HALOT).

Ex 21:8

See Propp, who notes Jer 12:1. (For the pointing, see 2 Ki 2:12.)

Ex 22:19

Against the plus אחרים, see Wevers' *Notes*.

Ex 23:7

It is possible that G's תצדיק is correct (graphic confusion), but various first-person insertions from God do occur in Ex, and after כי לא any command would seem a bit odd, and this particular command would be tautological.

Ex 23:9

M's תלחץ could be assimilation to context, but G's תלחצו is much more likely dittography based on the following ואתם.

Ex 24:14

Propp suggests repointing /yiggash/ as /yaggesh/, comparing Isa 41:21-22.

Ex 25:9

Propp suggests reading כן, M(T) being dittography. But probably M can stand.

Ex 25:19

Propp cites Ehrlich as repointing ועשה here as an infinitive, and doing likewise with וקצץ in 39:3. But see on v37 below.

Ex 25:31

Repoint /wqanah/ as /wqaneha/ (pl.)? Cf. Propp (tentatively) and Num 8:4.

Ex 25:37

M's והעלה את could be a transcriptional error for והעלית את (*waw/he* confusion + corrupt haplography). External evidence possible weighs against this in that P T V agree with Sam LXX: The latter could preserve an original reading in the face of a paleo-script-based corruption, but the former could not. Assimilation to the context makes the most sense, and somewhat unusual imperative forms do occur elsewhere in the legal material of Ex. It

is just possible that the P T V reading is a secondary corruption (assimilation) of a corruption (transcriptional error, as noted) in proto-M, so the indicative form might merit a place in the margin, but it is probably safest to stick with M.

A very similar situation obtains in 27:7 (BHS^a).

In another matter, Propp suggests reading והאירו, M being near haplography (resh+waw -> resh).

Ex 26:8

Propp suggests reading the article on the last word (haplography), but cf. the opposite situation in v17, 27:1; also 36:15, and the oddities surrounding the syntax in the Tabernacle Narrative generally.

Ex 26:24

See BHS^a. M could be an accident, but assimilation (to usual/expected form) seems more likely. The grammars in BW do not cite this verse.

{Post-script: See also the same construction in 36:29.}

Ex 27:19

On לכל see Jenni (1714). He does stamp this verse with a question mark, but this seems a strange place for an asseverative *lamedh*, so a species of poleptic redefinition seems a safer supposition.

Ex 28:5

BHS notes M^c and “mlt MSS” as having את התכלת rather than ואת התכלת. Davidson makes no note here, so unless he simply did not check this unit, very few or no MSS to his knowledge supported it (for van der Hooght agrees with L here); it was not likely the original M reading. {Have not checked J'lem Crown.}

Ex 28:10

Following Ges 134c n⁴.

Ex 28:22

Propp considers שרשת “meaningless,” and follows Sam MSS in reading the same form as in 39:15. HALOT?

Ex 28:22, 39:15

Following the Samaritan interpretation, taking MT to be an avoidance of the qal passive participle (cf. Hornkohl, *passim*). Cf. CDCH.

Ex 28:32

Propp would read ולא.

Ex 29:41

Is /lah/ to be pointed as masculine /loh/ with Propp?

Ex 30:6

Propp, noting the great intrinsic difficulties of M and the unusually impressive external evidence for the shorter reading, would strike out לפני הכפרת אשר על העדת. Corrupt dittography? {Yes—move to Textual Commentary}

Ex 30:8

Propp notes the unusual kamatz under the he of הערבים, but notes that Knauf (1982) lists other examples. M-M also has the kamats; I have not checked J'lem Crown.

Ex 30:21

Does Sam have a defective spelling עלם that could be original?

Ex 32:7

Propp cites external support for reading **לאמר** after **משה**, which could have dropped out due to the following **לך רד**. On the other hand, the phraseology **משה לאמר** occurs many times in Exodus, the only other exception being the nearby and similar 33:1, so probably the variation is intentional.

Ex 32:11

See J-M 16f.

Ex 32:15

See Propp, noting v19-Kt, 34:4 and Dt 9:15.

Ex 32:22

Propp tentatively suggests reading **פרוע** for **ברע** with Sam, noting v25 (unless, as he warns, that might be the source of the Sam reading here). But M seems to make more sense.

Ex 32:29

Propp suggests reading **לתת** (M being dittography across a word boundary). But probably M can stand.

Ex 32:31

For **אנא**, Sam has **הנה**, G has **אנא אדני** and P has **אנא אדני אלהים**. Probably M is to be retained as difficult but not impossible and as explaining the other readings. Cf. J-M 105cN3.

Ex 32:32

Propp tentatively (iirc) wishes to keep M, but notes that Aejmelaus (1987) thinks M cannot stand and that with the versions **שא** is to be inserted after **הטאתם**. But see J-M 167r.

Ex 33:5

Is **ואדעה** to be repointed as a *hiph'il* with Propp?

Ex 33:13

BHS notes that OG renders “show me yourself.” This is probably a paraphrase. See further the research notes on v18 below.

Ex 33:18

BHS gives the OG as “show me yourself”; if correct, it is *possible* that this reflects some *Vorlage* and that M is an orthodox corruption to avoid an anthropomorphism. However, there are a number of objections to this approach: (1) It is not clear what Hebrew would underlie this one; (2) it is the (O)G which elsewhere in this book avoids anthropomorphisms of this kind (the *place* where YHWH stood); (3) this is probably not the correct text of OG (external evidence for the reading which represents MT – importantly, in not an especially literal way, and so not likely to be a later Hebrew-based corruption – is strong, the minority reading is probably, as Gottingen points out, probably an assimilation to v13, and there are no real quibbles in the MS tradition regarding this same phrase in v13).

Ex 34:6

The double **יהוה** in M could be dittography, but G* (so BHS assesses the LXX tradition {; have not checked Gottingen}) with its single **יהוה** could be haplography or stylistic “improvement.” Intrinsic evidence must accordingly decide. A possible line of evidence would be the theory that the first person whose name fails to appear in an exchange is the one making a concession: The long reading would retain Yahweh's position, allowing for Moses to drop out in v9 (though he might already have done so in v5b).

Ex 38:20

See on Ps 47:5 below.

Tabernacle Account

The LXX is from about 35:4 and on shorter and sequenced differently than M. The first 34 chapters weigh heavily against G as a strong witness, but could a mixed exemplar have occurred? If so, the same would have had to occurred in the same place in M (a most unlikely proposition indeed) or the LXX in 35-40 renders a different text from that rendered in 1-34 while M preserves the same texttype throughout. Note that the latter scenario (a) would tend to dovetail with theories that the last chapters of the LXX proceeded from a different Greek hand than the earlier chapters and (b) in itself does not answer the further question of whether the text of LXX-35-40 is (α) while different in origin from LXX-1-34, still inferior to M or (β) better than M, which latter text would then occupy a middle ground in quality between (the text witnessed by) LXX-1-34 and LXX-35-40. If α is correct, then we have evidence (as probably already seen in the case of Est) that a free approach to the text did not always add, but rather at times compressed and resequenced (such *might* *might* *crucial* implications from 1 Esdras and LXX-Jer). If β is correct, then evidence is furnished (if such was needed in any case) that a text (in this case, M) can depart from its ultimate source in large-scale ways yet remain faithful in numerous (most?) small details. On these general matters, see also the introductions to Jeremiah, SS, Esther, and Ezra-Nehemiah in the textual commentary and the comments on Jdg 6:7-10 in the same file.

1/26/19 update: An important possibility is that (a) the final chapters of LXX-Ex do as some theorize proceed from a different hand from the earlier chapters and that (b) the differences in content between the LXX Tabernacle Account and the M Tabernacle Account are operative purely at the level of translation. In other words, the LXX translator for the TA was of a similar school of translation of that responsible for LXX-Est and 1 Esdras. (In this scenario, LXX-Jer would not be analogous, for (a) the translation style is more literal than Ex, Est, 1 Esd, (b) there is Hebrew-language external support for a short type of text, and (c) there is intrinsic evidence in favor the G-Jer text, e.g. גְּבוּכַדְרֶצֶר.)

2/27/19 update: Aeijmaelius (sp?) has an essay arguing for a Hebrew *Vorlage*. As a supporting argument (as I recall), she notes the absence in G of certain “P-source” items. My reaction: How much of P is missing? (Can use tanakh.us to check for P sections in this section.) If only some, this is not a strong argument. If much or all, is this because P was identified on the basis of certain linguistic or stylistic traits, in which case that might be a sign, not of P, but of a scribe who made certain interpolations into the Pentateuch and/or other portions of the OT?

5/6/19 update: If one assumes a short *Vorlage* behind OG-TA, internal evidence – most importantly, the command-fulfillment sequence – favors G. However, it is not clear that such is to be assumed. While some argue for a different translator or a reviser for OG-TA – in which case a *Vorlage* differing from that underlying the former part of the book might have been employed – the burden of proof would seem to be on those arguing for a radical discontinuity in the composition history of OG-TA, and it is far from clear that such discontinuity can be demonstrated, as seen in the researches of Wade, Wevers, and Aeijmaelius. That being the case, the secondary nature of the *Vorlage* of the OG up to this point weighs against the case for a primary nature of *Vorlage* of the OG-TA. How then is the OG to be explained? Perhaps as exhibiting a very similar approach to OG-Est and OG-Ezra-Neh, i.e. resequencing to suit its own purposes and eliminating that which is redundant or fails to suit the purpose of the translator. In addition, it is to be considered whether command-fulfillment expansions (e.g. in the SamP) evidence an early scribal consciousnesses of that phenomenon, such that while some scribes attempted to fill these out, some rolled them back – and the latter approach would be most expected in Alexandria, where there was some sensitivity to the redundancies of the Hebrew Bible that proper Greek style eschewed (on this see the book about Alexandrian scholarly influence on Jews in antiquity). It is to be granted to Aeijmaelius that the OG-translators, including that of Ex, were “faithful” to their text, yet faithfulness did not in all quarters mean strongly literal translation (cf. the modern English version debate, as well as the Syriac translation techniques of late antiquity); OG-Ex is generally considered among the least literal books of the OG

tradition, is it not? In some, there is a case to be made (a) that the translator was responsible for the shape of the OG-TA, and consequently (b) M-TA is to be considered approximately as reliable a witness as it was for the earlier portion of the book.

Ex 36:32

The plus of צלע after לקרשי could be original, for the loss of words does not always have a transcriptional cause. On the other hand, it could be an assimilation to earlier in the verse (notice that המשכן follows לקרשי in L here and that צלע preceeds המשכן earlier in this verse), and external evidence does not seem to be strong – van der Hooght reads with L, and Davidson records no MSS with the plus, and the Cairo MS does not seem to be the strongest witness in Ex.

Ex 39:8

M's reading could be due to haplography, but the parallel construction in 28:15 favors M.

Lev 4:8

Re the first על, see BHQ, which makes a good case for reading אה. Yet the style, even in seeming formulas, in Lev varies considerably, and it seems to me hard to make the case that the versions cited in favor of אה certainly read so (and were not merely facilitating via loose translation); על w/ כסה is a legitimate construction (see BDB sub כסה). So, while the case is a difficult one, I lean toward retaining M(T).

Lev 5:15

On the pointing here and elsewhere in Lev (and Num 18:16), see *Handbook of Biblical Hebrew* vol. 1, re epigraphic Hebrew

Lev 7:3 etc.

See Talmon (166). It would seem, however, that his argument would turn on a G priority theory in Lev (quite a claim indeed), for the error (whether the error is M or G or LXX) is repeated several times (7:3, 8:25, 9:19).

Lev 8:16

Really the problem is the lack of a *maqeph* in L, but cf. on Ps 47:5.

Lev 8:31

NAC points out that though the words are formally attributed to Moses, they ultimately reflect God's authoritative direction. An active voice might then be preferred. 9:21 can only have added to the confusion (there some witnesses interpose יהוה אה, but this is probably an orthodox corruption). It might be an argument for the active voice in the four passages just mentioned, but cf. Ex 16:24 and Lev 9:5: These passages report obedience to commands as mediated through Moses as obedience to him, but are in narrative, nor reported speech.

On the other hand, 10:16-18 seems pretty clearly to reflect Moses particularly, so it seems best to use a passive vocalization throughout the relevant passages (here, v35, 10:13, and 10:18). Or, taking a slightly different tack, the perfect tense of צייתי more naturally alludes to a prior event, especially given the phrase כי כן in 10:13, which seems to give grounds, not introduce something new.

Lev 9:4

It is hard to be certain, but pointing as a participle seems better than as a perfect. The latter might reflect a Masoretic attempt to allegorize the “appearance” of God rather than identify it with a coming manifestation.

Lev 9:22

Cf. BHQ to 3:2 (64*-65*).

Lev 10:19

Perhaps the peculiar pointing of הִיטב here is a scribal slip that happened in a very early pointed text and was transmitted to (all? most?) extant MSS. (Ges 100k points out the oddity without trying to explain it.)

Lev 11:31

See BHS a. The reading מכל is on intrinsic grounds surely an error (cf. v43, etc.). A possible explanation for G is *beth/mem* confusion. I am less sure of how to explain Sam, as it did not, to my knowledge, pass through the same Herodian phase that G did, and I am not very familiar with the Samaritan script (but if *beth* and *mem* are similar in it, there is no problem explaining the issue). (BHS list no Sam variation from MT in v43, though this might be selective citation or reflect use of an out-of-date edition of Sam-Lev.)

{Post-script: A look at Yardeni shows that *beth* and *mem* are not particularly similar in the Samaritan script.}

Lev 14:43

See J-M 56b n2.

Lev 15:3

The long plus, on which see especially BHQ (cf. further NET, WBC, NICOT; also Ulrich?), is a difficult case. It is indeed quite possible that some sort of visual error led to its omission; yet its different placement (2-3 placements, depending on how the Q evidence is assessed), the fact that – or so it seems to me – sense can be made of MT, and the possibility of a sort of stylistic assimilation to later in this passage all lean me to retain MT, if tentatively. (A discussion-point – difficult to know whether it is a secondary matter or in fact tied up with the larger question of the authenticity or inauthenticity of the plus – is the spelling of הָאָ in the witnesses.)

{Post-script: While this is far from absolutely decisive, looking over other readings of the Q MS in question I get the impression that that MS comes from a line of an interventionist tradition (indeed, perhaps somewhat akin to–though by no means identical with–the proto-Samaritan tradition); such provides further fuel for me to be reluctant to accept the plus here.}

Lev 16:15

The G plus (BHS “a”) is probably an assimilation to similar passages (NB key words like שָׁחַט and זָקַן): Cf. 1:5, 11, 4:4, 15, 24, 6:18. Additionally, the trigger for loss of material is at best near haplography (final *mem* to *he*), and that only if the error happened in the square script (esp. post introduction of final letters).

Lev 18:23

BHS' recommendation to remove the *mappiq* from לַרְבֵּעָה on the basis of 20:16 is a bit confusing, since there the word אֶתָּה follows, making pretty clear by analogy that here a *mappiq* is required. MT, in other words, should almost certainly be retained.

Lev 20:10

See WBC for an interesting discussion. The minus is tempting, but the external evidence is very weak – far more likely to be an inner-greek error or emendation than the original reading. The reading וְאִשָּׁר for the second occurrence of אִשָּׁר is also intriguing, and the asyndetic reading could be near haplography, but this too could be an emendation to avoid what either *is* or *could easily be misread as* a tautology.

Tentative solution: Retain MT, and, borrowing from a source cited in WBC, interpret as making a statement and then immediately clarifying the matter to avoid (a tendentious, or an appallingly ignorant, to be sure) misunderstanding: “[As for] a man who commits adultery [or perhaps “has sex with”??] with a married woman – [that is], a man who [verbs] with the wife of another – the adulterer and the adulteress shall assuredly [both] be put to death.” Sex with *one's own* wife is not worthy of death; sex with *another's* wife is referred to.”

Lev 21:11

Re BHS “a”: It is tempting to see נִפְשָׁה, especially given the defective spelling, as *he/taw* confusion for נִפְשָׁה

(Num 6:6). However, as WBC (344 n^{11.a}) notes “4QpaleoLev supports MT.” Since the **נפש** reading predates the square script (in which alone to my knowledge *he/taw* confusion is a real possibility), almost certainly MT is preferable (as a stylistic variation on the expression).

Lev 22:18

Pace BHQ's wish to read **הִגֵּר הִגֵּר**, see WBC and note 19:33 as proof of the existence of this syntax with **גֵּר** in Leviticus.

Lev 24:11

See BHQ. The Smr reading is indeed appealing, except that this quite a weak witness to follow on its own, and the reading leaves the other readings difficult to explain. BDB cites this verse sub **ה**, and it is perhaps important that many of the similar usages of the article it cites are in Leviticus or in legal sections (iirc) of Exodus. Thus, if tentatively, I retain MT.

Lev 25:20

Rendsburg (330 in Huehnergard FS) says that **הֵן** here as meaning “if” is a late Hebrew feature. BDB *sub loc* (II), however, gives a different account of the semantics (note also the semi-modal functions of the prefix conjugation). (I have not done a thorough search, but there seems not to be external omission for a variation here, though as just indicated such is probably not necessary.)

Lev 25:31

See BHQ. However, while a *waw* could have been lost before *gimmel*, such does not explain the following singulars (the verses BHQ cite do not, it seems to me, establish a grammatically fixed phraseology). Rather, the *idea* of “unwalled cities” seems to be the subject of the verb.

Lev 25:34

11QpaleLeva has **הִיא**, for which **הוּא** could be a graphical error; but this MS seems weak (see on 15:3 above); and perhaps in Moses' dialect the use of **הוּא** here would not be anomalous.

Num 3:39

The cancellation marks suggest that originally the M text lacked **וְאֵהָרֶן** (Sam and P and probably a secondary assimilation to v16); it is possible that the minus is original (note the G plus in v16). However, a search of the phrase **פָּקֵד מִשָּׁה** in this books turns up such a uniformity of **וְאֵהָרֶן** that its omission here in an accident (loss of a single word).

Num 4:27

G appears to read **וּפְקִדָּה**, and it is possible that M is corrupt dittography. However, 2nd person plural verbs occur a number of times in this context, so this is unlikely.

In another matter, in note “b” BHS says “**בְּשִׁמוֹתַי** ut 32” when neither M nor G there has **שִׁמוֹת** for **שְׁמוֹתַי** as far as I can see. Perhaps “ut” is a typo for “it,” the editor's intent being to recommend reading **בְּשִׁמוֹתַי** with OG in v27 and **שִׁמוֹתַי** by conjecture in v32.

Num 5:22

See BDB sub **צָבָה** I (BHS concurs).

Num 7:12

With OG insert **נְשִׂיא** (Cf. HALOT 1:727b, WBC)? Probably not: the pattern which will become firm for tribes 2-12 is not yet established, this first tribal heading containing (as if by quasi-metrical compensation) an element (למטה) not found in the other tribal headings, and the second tribal heading, though it does have **נְשִׂיא**, has it in a different position.

Num 8:14

See v3.

Num 10:29

Probably *חָתָן* means “related by marriage,” and so the meaning “brother-in-law” is permissible here. While some contend for a distinction in meaning between *חָתָן* and *חָתָן*, we, if tentatively, take them as synonyms.

Num 11:15

The MT vocalization seems to stem from a non-recognition of the possibility of *אָתָּה*. In L, at least, there is this note: *ג' בלשון זכר*.

Num 11:31a

Revocalized as a hiph'il (so BDB sub גזר; Holloday [BibleWorks9], BHS). Note that *רוּחַ* must be the subject of *וַיִּשָּׁע* later in the verse.

Num 14:5

While M could be a doublet or conflation, it could also be a condensation in (O)G T¹, especially as the phrase *וַיִּקְהַל עֵדָה* occurs in Ex 12:6 (here G agrees).

Num 15:24

Re *לִחְטֹאת*: The spelling could be phonetic, but would *aleph* be rendered so weakly so early in Hebrew? If this was a later text the choice would be easy. BDB (sub *חֲטָאָה*) thinks MT is an error, and this seems possible as near haplography in the paleo script (cf. Talmon re *aleph/taw* confusion) or alternatively as a late Hebrew spelling carelessly made by a scribe working in an error when the latter spelling was current (but this second explanation is weaker than the first in that there are few candidates elsewhere in M-Num for such conscious or unconscious spelling updates). OG might be safely retroverted (*περι αμαρτιας* very often = *לִחְטָאָה* in OG-Num). There is no Q evidence.

Note also *מִצְחֵי* in Num 11:11 (cited in Ges 23f) and also note *וַיֵּאָצֵּל* in 11:25 (if the text there is sound; see BHS).

Num 16:1a

“behaved presumptuously.” See HALOT (1: 430a): root *יָקָן*, *hiph'il* stem.

Num 17:25 [in English, v10]

For *וַיִּתְּכֵל*, the *pi'el* of *כָּלָה*, BHS and WBC (at least) prefer *וַיִּתְּכֵל*, the *qal*. But The subject is the *מִטָּה*: The grumbling will not, Moses supposes, cease on its own, but if the rod's presence will bring it to an end. Note also that the grammatical subject is rather far removed, such that the *pi'el* is arguably the harder reading, making its retention in the reading tradition hard to account for apart from its authenticity.

(Curiously, several English versions [including the ESV, at least that in BibleWorks9, and NAU] and NICOT render as if the form is a 2nd person singular *pi'el*, then though the form would be *תְּכַלֶּה* as in Lev 19:9; the KJV is among these versions, so perhaps this is an example of a poor rendering in the KJV transmitted to later, even much later versions [ESV and NAU do descend, albeit with intermediary steps, from the KJV].)

Num 21:32

Re Kt-Qr, cf. Blau 4.3.8.4.18 p. 247.

Num 22:5

NICOT (also, at least, NEB, NET, CSBm, NLTm) proposes repointing /*amo/* to /*amaw/*, this being a place name. See the main part of that commentary for more information.

Num 24:7

On מִצָּאָג vs. מִגֹּג, *lege* מִגֹּג. External evidence is strong (e.g. Aquila). M might be assimilation to Samuel, or transposition + *aleph/gimmel* confusion (in the paleo script) or aural error. *Gg* is attested in Ugaritic (but in what sense?; have not yet checked UW) and possibly Akkadian (HALOT 1: 182a). This VU was brought to by attention by Rydelnik (NACSBT 3: 38-39).

מִצָּאָג

מִגֹּג

{Post-script: Yet while Aquila proves this reading existed in Hebrew at an early stage, it still might be a (1) Hebrew-language exegetical rendering, (2) a visual error, especially in the paleo script, or (3) the former in G and/or SamP and the latter in the archetype which led to the MS Aquila used. What most inclines me to change my mind is that soon (v20) Amalek will be specifically mentioned as facing coming destruction, so the Amalekite king would be a referent that fits the context better. Indeed, Amalek was Israel's "earliest archrival" (NAC 421). Also, there is a case to be made that scribes would, accidentally or deliberately, have more likely substitutes Gog for Agag than the reverse.}

Num 26

Are some of the *lamedhs* in this chapter (e.g., לְנִמְרוֹאֵל in v12a) proclitic/asseverative? Jenni (2114) classes them as possessive, however.

Num 28:2

The defective spelling may be a mistake, as JC, M-M, Ginsburg (w/o footnote) and Koren all have a plene with UXLC here, and Q evidence is lacking. That said, according to Kennicott there are a number of MSS that so read, and a defective spelling of מַעוֹד is quite rare (but does occur at least x3 in the Pentateuch).

Num 30:11

Possibly for בֵּית (O)G should be followed by reading בְּבֵית, but cf. on "Double-duty Letters" above.

Num 31:3

Repointing הִקְלִצוּ (cf. BHS) seems possible, but probably not necessary (cf. BDB).

Num 31:5

For וַיִּמְסְרוּ BHS and BDB tentatively read, citing OG, וַיִּסְפְּרוּ. This, however, probably not necessary: See HALOT 1: 608 (which takes OG as supporting MT). (Different is the case of לִמְסַר in v16.)

Num 32:7

Re Kt-Qr: is Qr an example of hiphilization a la Hornkohl?

Num 35:4

Commentators and editions do *not* generally recommend following G's אֱלִפִּים. See Tyndale.

Dt 1:8

As BHQ (q.v.) comments, it is difficult to decide whether M is superior as the harder reading (but not impossible in that referring to oneself in the third person is allowable in BH) or whether M is an assimilation. It seems safer to stick with M, but G would probably earn a place in the margin if there was one.

Dt 1:44

For a convincing case for this reading [viz., תִּעְשָׂקָה] "just as bees are *smoked out*" see the Joosten essay in the Jenner FS (M.P.I.L. XIV).

{Post-script: But in the parallels adduced in NICOT, the bees are ones driving out, not being driven out;

and I am not sure Joosten is right to describe עשה as “bland” in any case, especially if it is to fall under HALOT עשה IV, in which case we could render “just as bees turn this way and that,” or “just as as bees swarm.” Also, following P along is thereby avoided.}

Dt 2:27

On the difficulty of knowing the G *Vorlage* see Tov, *Text-Critical Use* (97-98). Certainly dittography in M is not to be ruled out altogether, however.

Is the repetition wholly unnecessary and therefore to be considered an accident? Or is it emphatic (“on the highway and nowhere else; no trespassing of private property will occur!”)?

{Post-script: Note WBC's favoring of MT, and the punctuation: “I will pass through your land on the road. On the road I will go. I will not turn, etc.”}

Dt 2:37

Weinfeld wonders whether וכל אשר should be כאשר with G.

Dt 3:3

Weinfeld quotes (favorably, *irrc*) an opinion that השאיר should be repointed as an infinitive. This seems plausible in light of infinitives in Exodus—although there it tends to be legislative sections, not narrative as here. But *cg.* Gen 18:12 on the construction with בלתי.

Dt 3:11

For הנה G reads הנה. M is obviously anomalous as to its spelling, but G seems odd as well with its two “beholds.” Visually it seems a bit more likely to go from an original *lamedh* to a secondary *nun*, and certainly correction of a perceived error is possible in G.

Dt 4:7

BHS fails to note this blunder by L, but WLC does, and, if I am not mistaken, BHQ also does.

Dt 4:21

The BHQ comment makes good sense until the external evidence within the LXX tradition is examined: The short reading (that is, without סט) is in 19:2 supported by MS 59, in 19:8 by MS 108 Slav Ostrog, in 21:5 by the Alexandrian tradition (as per H-P), and in 24:9 by MSS 30 57 73 77 131, i.e. scattered, uneven, and generally unimpressive support. Only here is the short reading, it seems to us, arguably original. This being the case, we are to believe that the phrase יהוה אלהים occurs only here in Dt, while the phrase יהוה אלהיך occurs 212x in the same. G can be explained as a transcriptional error in the angular script (see HBCE-Pr on that point), if indeed the short reading is original to the LXX in 4:21 (and such is due to a Hebrew *Vorlage*, not the translator forgetting actually to write this small pronoun).

Dt 4:48

For שאין, should שרין be read? BHQ gives P as so reading by assimilation to 3:9. It gives Sam as reading שיהון and G Aquilla Symmachus and Vulgate as “indet.” Rahlfs has Σηων (many MSS Σιωv). BSV has “Sion.” NICOT (Craigie) reads with P, pointing out, among other things, the similarity of *aleph* and *resh* in the paleo scripts. But since P is unlikely to have preserved an original reading in a case like this, following it here would in effect be a conjectural emendation.

Dt 5:9

The form without the conjunction could, as BHQ notes, be an assimilation to Exodus, yet the external evidence for that strong is striking, and a conjunction could also have crept in by mistake. Note also the proximity of this variation unit to the evident transcriptional error in M in v10.

{Post-script: Such a strong impulse to harmonize with Ex is in evidence in this passage that M must be

preferred.}

Dt 5:27

See HALOT 1:100b and cf. J-M.

Dt 9:23

BHQ argues that M is an assimilation, and it is true that an אֲנִי could have dropped out due to homoeoarchon (and נָתַן presumably then emended). Yet after (soon after; not necessarily immediately after) the string הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר in Dt, the participle נָתַן is actually very common (BibleWorks: . הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר נָתַן yields 27 examples, with only one of those cases involving a perfect נָתַן), so the G reading (if G indeed read אֲנִי נָתַן or נָתַן) could easily be an assimilation. Given this circumstance and the general trustworthiness of M in this book, it is surely wisest to retain M.

Dt 9:27

BHQ argues that M is a theological correction of Smr דָּעָהוּ, referring to God. (G is difficult to assess.) While this, or a mere transcriptional error, is possible, it is to be noted (1) that very rarely is the verb יָדַע used of God in this book (8:2 = 13:3; 31:21; 34:10 [obj. Moses]), and of these, only 31:21 can really be argued to be parallel in thought to Smr here; (2) 9:7 and 31:27 provide fairly clear conceptual parallels to M-9:27, the latter, indeed, using יָדַע; as to Smr, (3) it could either (a) be an assimilation to the third-person pronouns in the previous verse, (b) an spontaneous confusion of two similar letters, or (c) a transcriptional error prompted by conscious or unconscious reflection on the grammatical forms in the previous verse.

Dt 10:1b

Re לֹחֶת: NB that WLC reads L differently than BHS does (transcription note “n”).

Dt 12:5

While someone (Harstad?) has suggested that לְ resumes the earlier אֵל (cf. J-M 133d), taking it (with Dahood) as an asseverative *lamedh*–retaining, in this early book, its emphatic force–seems the most plausible explanation.

Dt 15:18

So Ges 128c.

Dt 18:5

BHQ calls M an assimilation to the usual, but BW searches do not seem to make a clear case for this, and external evidence is against its view.

Dt 19:3

See *How Old is the Hebrew Bible?* (52-53) for an interesting case for the G+SP reading. But as they themselves say, the case is not so clear (cf. HALOT s.v.). Something to revisit, but it seems safer to retain MT, as G might be a facilitating reading.

{Another possibility to consider is whether to point with MT but read a defective spelling with SP; or to point tikeyn, viewing MT as an unusual plene spelling of a piel imperative from tkn}

Dt 20:1

JC has a defective reading here, but see Ginsburg. {Subsequently followed JC+(at least)MM.}

Dt 20:17

On the unexpected asyndeton (apposition??) cf. Josh 9:1.

Dt 21:7

On the validity of the Kt see Ges 145k.

Dt 22:29

BHS reads L as having an erroneous *mappiq* in שלחה, but WLC does not so read, i.e. it reads L as having the correct form. Thus no entry appears in the spreadsheet.

Dt 24:14

BHQ notes that G is the harder reading, yet this weighs against it if it is due to mere scribal oversight. The M word is not common, and so a more common form could easily have been substituted in G.

Dt 27:4

See THB 1A: 327a and Eugene Ulrich, “The Old Latin, Mount Gerizim, and 4QJosh^a,” 361-375 in: *Textual Criticism and Dead Sea Scrolls Studies in Honor of Julio Trebolle Barrera*, ed. Otero, Andrés Piquer and Pablo. A. Torijano Morales, Brill, Leiden/Boston, 2012 {I do not own this book; got it on inter-library loan}. Interacting with the latter source (which argues that Gerizim is the earliest documented reading, but conjectures an original absence of any specific placename):

- The fragment discussed on 364-66, the authenticity of which is unclear, has, as Ulrich notes, הרזרים. This monoliteral form is, as Ulrich elsewhere notes (362, citing Plummer, Reinhard, “AP̄TAPIZIN: A Criterion for Samaritan Providence?” JSJ 18 [1987], 18) points to a Samaritan scribe. In other words, this fragment would appear to be specifically Samaritan and thus offer nothing new to the discussion, given the SP for this passage.

- “Based on what we know about the OL, it seems highly improbable that it was translated from a specifically Samaritan Hebrew or even a Samaritan Greek MS” (364). Certainly a Hebrew-language Samaritan source is extremely unlikely. Yet the OL reproduces a variety of forms of the LXX from one book to another; is it not possible that a Samaritan-influenced Greek version (not necessarily the Samareitikon, but something like it) lies behind OL-Dt or that MS 100 was corrected against such a Greek text?

- The substance of the above might be available in Ulrich's *Developmental Composition*.

Given the reliability of M elsewhere in the book, the possibility should be entertained that the majority reading is not an orthodox corruption; rather, the minority reading might be a heterodox corruption.

2/13/19 update: While orthodox corruption is a distinct possibility, there are two explanations for why MT might be correct: (1) The Gerizim reading might be an emendation, not for sectarian readings, but for smooth out difficulties of a geographical sort: cf. Rosel, *Tradition and Innovation*; (2) more likely, given the lack of a word division, the Gerizim reading is Samaritan in origin, and the presence of a Samaritan-made MS is to be accounted for on the grounds of the less-than-total separation between the groups in antiquity: see Knoppers.

2/19/19 update: A very similar line of argument to (2) immediately above is to be found in “Septuagint and Samareitikon” by Jan Joosten, 1-15 in: *From Author to Copyist: Essays on the Composition, Redaction, and Transmission of the Hebrew Bible in Honor of Zipi Talshir*, ed. Cana Werman, Winona Lake, Eisenbrauns, 2015.

Appendix: The בחר readings in LXX; of the relevant passages here, is where there is external support for the perfect reading:

12:5 72 Bo

12:11, 14, 18, 21, 26 none

14:23 72

14:24, 15:20 none

16:2 16 OL100

16:6 none

16:7 OL100

16:11, 15, 16, 17:8, 10, 15, 18:6, 23:17, 26:2, 31:11 none

{8/14/21 update: The cases of 12:5 and 14:23 are difficult to account for. The OL support for a perfect tense in 16:2 and 16:7 is more interesting in that seems like plausible evidence for correcting the OG. But if in these places there was a Hebrew *Vorlage* בחר, such might only represent near haplography of the *yodh* after the preceding אשר. And while indeed יבחר could be argued to be an assimilation if in a minority of cases בחר was

originally written, the prevalence of יבחר in Deuteronomy is *so* overwhelming that any cases of בחר would most likely be clerical errors, especially given the preceding אשר in each case and the frequency of scribal errors elsewhere involving either *yodh* or *resh* where those two letters are adjacent.}

Dt 27:19-20

The closed section found in L is lacking in some witnesses, and might have been secondarily added here to conform to the pattern. On the other hand, it is found in at least one other major Masoretic MS collated by BHQ and in the Greek tradition by (at least) G^B (see https://digi.vatlib.it/view/MSS_Vat.gr.1209, image 226, middle column, second full paragraph for v19). A closed section, it seems to me, would easily be lost by accident, so it seems best to follow the easier reading, which = M^L.

Dt 28:11

See B. Kantor (2023, Cambridge series) 170-171.

Dt 31:1

Certainly ויכל משה לדבר is ancient (since with is in Aquilla; and since there, possibly it has an inadvertent origin), but it is probably an assimilation (perhaps inadvertent in some and purposeful in other witnesses) to 32:45. That passage is crucial not only as an explanation for the G reading here, but also because the previous verse (assuming that in this context ויבא can be taken as a synonym for וילך) provides a model for how our verse ought to read. Only at 32:45 do Moses' deuteronomic words come to a conclusion. We have here a sort of double ending, of which the gospel of John may be an echo (at least is operating on similar literary principles).

Dt 32:8

The reading בני אלהים is widely accepted here, yet there is a case to be made for M.

(1) The general trustworthiness of M and the general untrustworthiness of G in this book should put the burden of proof on the G reading.

(2) “Given... ישראל at the end of v. 8, a causal כי here does not make much sense” (BHQ 141*). To be fair, BHQ on the same page goes on to say that “[i]t is more likely to have been asseverative.” Such may be possible, but it is dubious. Ges 159ee and J-M (various places; see word index) see usage along these lines in counterfactuals and perhaps in cases where a claim is likely to be disbelieved, neither of which obtains here. Similar again is MNK 40.29.

(3) M preserves the same or similar wording in Gen 6:2, v4, Job 1:6, 2:1, and 38:7 without complaint. G-Job does try to avoid the wording, but M-Dt does not seem to share many characteristics with G-Job, so to see the same practice in both is inappropriate.

(4) Before בני ישראל here there occurs the phrase בני אדם and the verb יצב. The former could easily trigger memories of Gen 6:2, v4; the latter, Job 1:6, 2:1. Thus four of the five definite places where בני אלהים or בני האלהים occur are verbally reminiscent of this text, such that the G reading might be an assimilation. Note that the verb יצב has a different sense in Dt 32:8 than in Job, so trying to flip this argument around and say that intrinsic evidence favors G is partially successful at best.

Note also the reading βασιλευ των θεων in LXX-9:26 (attested, according to BHQ 78*, “partial[ly by]... Theodotion... here, and [elsewhere only by] Greek Esther 4:17r”). If this reflects a Hebrew original, presumably מלך אלהים, perhaps a *tendenz* is in evidence. (Cf. also G-17:14ff with BHQ and the comments below on v43.) But this line of evidence is tenuous.

Dt 32:11

The word is singular in Job 39:13, plural in Ps 68:14, and (as regards the consonants) ambiguous in Dt 32:11 and Ps 91:4. Each time it is collocated with כנף; this latter word is plural in each instance except Job 39:11. Given that pattern, and the likelihood that that defective אברתו would be interpreted as singular rather than plural by the *naqdanim*, it seems preferable to repoint in Dt 32:11 and in Ps 91:4, though not with great confidence.

Dt 32:43

See the textual commentary.

Dt 33:2

See HALOT for some evidence that the word (grammatically feminine, evidently) means “angels.” The LXX either reflects such knowledge or, as BHQ proposes, is an emendation of אשרת; if the latter, אשרת need not be original, but rather a transcriptional error (from a scribe who was not thinking about what he was writing). Cf. Noonan,

Josh 2:13

The Qr appears to be a linguistic updating (cf. modern Hebrew).

Josh 3:4

JC has וביניו with *no* Kt-Qr note. L^{Kt}, then, could be corrupt haplography. However, Ginsburg agrees with L and records no MSS as not having a Kt-Qr or as reversing the two, so A and/or JC may have erroneously absorbed the Qr (which is the orthographically “standard” form) into the text.

Josh 3:11

Re הברית, see Ges 128c. Depending on what it is probably an inner-greek VU, OG probably supports a reading ברית, but this may be facilitating, especially as there is no clear transcriptional cause why the definite article would be added. WBC cites an opinion that may be correct: “Behold, the ark of the covenant! The Lord of the whole earth is passing before you!”

{But is the *he* a corrupt dittograph? Should recheck (1) whether there are related cases of anomalous definite articles, esp. in Josh (cf. below on v14); and (2) how firm the case is for OG so reading.}

Josh 3:14

BHS cites “vrs” as supporting ארון for הארון, but V is no help, P is highly suspect, and OG most likely does *not* support this (cf. Cambridge). Also cf. on 3:11 above, and note v17, where a meaning “the ark, <apposition> the covenant of Yahweh” is all but necessary.

Josh 3:16

The Kt-Qr issue here apparently perplexes all around. Given this, it seems best to retain the Kt.

Josh 4:2-3

Boiling makes interesting transcriptional arguments in favor of readings singulars for the first two words of v2 and the first word of v3, but the scenario is somewhat complex, the OG is a very suspect witnesses in matters of this kind, and 3:9-12 might suggest that 4:1-3 is a somewhat abbreviated version of the formula {Yahweh tells Joshua; Joshua tells the people} found throughout the initial chapters of the book.

Josh 4:8

Boiling wishes to insert את יהוה after צוה, appealing to visual error, but this feels like a G explication.

Josh 4:8

For למספר שבטי Boiling wishes to read בתם לעבר, but this may be a visual error (notice the broad similarity between these character strings); the position of M’s verbiage is admittedly a bit odd, but

Josh 4:9

Boiling seems to prefer reading אבנים after אחרים, but this feels like a translation-level clarification.

Josh 4:24

BDB sub ירא and sub מען and Ges 74g and, less confidently, BHS propose reading an infinitive יִרְאֶתָם over MT perfect verb יִרְאֶתָם. The proposition למען is not elsewhere used with the perfect. Yet is such impossible? And how is the strange vocalization, apparently firmly implanted in the Masoretic reading tradition, to be accounted for? The answer is not clear, but I do not think that this is not the only anomaly is the pointing of roots ירא or ראה in MT, and elsewhere it appears that there are early oversights in the vocalization tradition, and the relationship between the reading tradition and written pointing is far from clear (the latter might inform the former more than present documentation shows). Cf. on 11:3 below, for example.

Josh 5:1

A difficult case, tied up with a related textual crux (5:6; on the OG there see the Cambridge text and apparatus) and indeed with questions of authorship. On the former point, I am inclined to retain M(T); and on the second, I am inclined for various reasons to see Joshua as responsible for the general shape of the book (comparable to Moses as it relates to Deuteronomy; cf. esp. Concordia). It seems, then, that M(T) is best, though (here and in 5:6) a marginal reading would be warranted.

Josh 6:9

The Kt-Qr here is very difficult to resolve, so tentatively Kt has been retained.

Josh 6:13

The Kt-Qr here is very difficult to resolve, so tentatively Kt has been retained.

Josh 7:21

Re Kt-Qr, cf. J-M 79m.

Josh 8:17

See NICOT 140-141. Could וּבֵית אֵל be a partial assimilation to v9? Possible, but unlikely: The sequence there is different, and OG is probably trying to escape the difficulty inherent in M (cf. van der Meer *passim*). Moreover, NICOT 141 notes that 12:16 is not elsewhere explicated; perhaps Bethel had combined forces with Ai, or Joshua immediately pivoted to capture Bethel as well. Seeing as OG is not a strong witness as M is a *lectio difficilior* (cf. NICOT 141n33) without a clear transcriptional explanation, it is probably to be retained, although a marginal reading might perhaps be merited.

Josh 11:3

As BHS notes, in v8 the place name ends in *-eh*. Indeed, everywhere else in Josh the place name so ends, although (1) consistency is not common throughout the rest of the OT (see, e.g. the book of Chr), and (2) the *-eh* form is problematic insofar as *seghol* is a Tiberian-era allophone, though perhaps in some way reflecting an early state in which the ending was not identical in sound to the feminine ending

Josh 13:7-8

The G plus appears to retrovert thus (my own work): מִן הַיַּרְדֵּן עַד הַיָּם הַגָּדוֹל מְבוֹא הַשָּׁמֶשׁ תְּתִנֶּה הַיָּם הַגָּדוֹל גְּבוּל וְשִׁנִּי with the verse break (on this point following BHS) following גְּבוּל. BHS proposes homoeotetuton, but there are two problems: (1) How to account for עֲמוֹ in M-v8 (cf. NET; the absence of this word in (O)G BHS does not note); (2) the apparent incoherence of the verse if this plus is added, even at the expense of עֲמוֹ. The first issue can be resolved on the theory that it is an attempt to bring sense to v8 after the loss of this material by h.t. (2) Perhaps the *waw* on וְשִׁנִּי in the plus is specifying (“And as for the two tribes, that is, the the half-tribe of Mannaseh, etc.”), but this seems at least as strained as the M reading.

Postscript: After having written the above I came across the Barrera essay in *Florilegium Lovamiense* (=Martínez FS), where this VU, and nearby VUs (or pseudo-variants, as the case may be) in some detail. His reconstruction (bolding differences from the one I had made above, and adding to his pointing): מִן הַיַּרְדֵּן עַד הַיָּם הַגָּדוֹל מְבוֹא הַשָּׁמֶשׁ תְּתִנֶּה הַיָּם הַגָּדוֹל יְגֻבּוּל וְלִשְׁנֵי הַשְּׂבָטִים וְלַחֲצֵי שְׂבָט הַמְּנַשֶּׁה. This reconstruction is probably better as to

the first two items (on the first item, p444 notes 18:20; on the second, note the OG phraseology earlier in v7); on the third item, however, while there is an unusual lack of an article in a genitive matched to an articular form in $\tau\omega\eta\mu\iota\sigma\epsilon\iota\ \phi\upsilon\lambda\epsilon\iota\varsigma$, suggestive of a lack of an article in the original Hebrew, the same equivalence is to be observed in the earlier, undisputed portion of v7, and in both cases Μανασση appears without an article even as the Hebrew *does* have one (though it must be conceded with respect to this second argument that the Hebrew construction is a bit unusual and the translator, in his search for smooth Greek, might not have wished to reproduce it). Thus we have $\text{מִן הַיָּרְדֵּן עַד הַיָּם הַגָּדוֹל מְבֹאֵשׁ תְּתִנֶּה הַיָּם הַגָּדוֹלִיגְבֹּל וְלִשְׁנֵי הַשְּׂבָטִים וְלִחְצֵי הַשְּׂבָט הַמְּנַשֶּׁה$.

As far as evaluating the VU, the matter remains difficult. Barrera is in favor of the (O)G reading, but on the assumption that the (O)G minus of $\text{אֲשֶׁר לִקְחוּ בַחֲלָתָם אֲשֶׁר}$ in v8 is original (he [p445] takes it to be an emendation via importation of wording from 18:7). But this assumption is problematic if, as we take it, the M text in Josh is generally reliable, and especially so if van der Meer is right, as we suspect he is, that the OG translator (cf. van der Kooij, THBS 1, on OG-Dan) was averse to redundancy (note the semantic similarity in the clause following).

We are left, if still with hesitation, to reiterate our earlier conclusion, that M is preferable as being the better witness and as being the harder reading where transcriptional factors do not seem to be what led to (Hebrew-language or Greek-language) adjustment(s) to the text.

{Post-script: Look into the (possibly relevant) discussion of 22:32 in Tov, *Text-Critical Use* (97-98).}

Josh 15:53

HALOT and commentaries are quite uncertain, and the MS tradition is much divided. The Kt has been retained in the face of the uncertainty.

Josh 16:1

Is לְמִי יִרְחוּ a corrupt dittograph? Jenni (3: 269) flags these words as textually uncertain. But see NICOT.

Josh 18:19b

Re *second* Kt-Qr: OG is different from 15:4, 18:12, 14 ($\alpha\upsilon\tau\omicron\upsilon\tau\omicron\upsilon\eta\ \delta\epsilon\alpha\chi\omicron\delta\omicron\varsigma$ in each case) and might agree with MT. But perhaps the difference is simply translation-level variation for the sake of variety, something easy to imagine in OG-Josh. On the other hand, if the original text was תִּצְאוּרָה , perhaps there was a transposition resulting in תִּצְאוּרָה (matching the Qr), with the grammatical number of the OG being loose and/or made on the analogy of the other verses mentioned above. The presence of the Qr is perplexing; perhaps in this case the Qr *does* go back to a MS reading (a MS related to G, or one in which the same error occurred independently); but at least as likely, the Qr points to a reading tradition reflected also in (O)G, in which case the reading mentioned is tendentious. V P T all point to the Kt, or just possibly to תִּצְאוּרָה or something similar. Lacking clarity, we retain Kt.

Josh 18:28

So BHS. The form הַיְבוּסִי , with and without a conjunction of course, is very common in the OT (did BibleWorks9 search for יְבוּס with an asterisk at each end), including in v16, so M is probably an accidental assimilation.

{Post-script: But Josh and Isa both seem rather frequently to exhibit peculiarities with regard to the definite article, so much so that, at least for the time being, it seems safer to appeal to unknown linguistic or stylistic factors (perhaps a dialect shared in part by the two of them?) than to text-critical factors where matters are unclear. Perhaps here (and in a number of similar cases) a marginal reading would be merited.}

Josh 21:20

See BHS. It is possible that גִּירָלִם is a transcriptional error for גִּבְרָלִם , but the same error in the same witnesses would seem to recur in v40, which is suspicious, especially as the latter term is more than twice as common as the former.

Josh 22:1

BHS lists “mlt Mss” as having הַמְנַשֶּׁה . While L could be due to haplography after the preceding word, nowhere else in the book does this form follow מְנַשֶּׁה , so intrinsic evidence is against it, and the articular form could be due

to dittography or to assimilation to those places where *המונשה* *does* occur.

Josh 22:14

Jenni (3: 277) flags the second *lamedh* as uncertain. Asseverative *lamedh*? But a subspecies of specification feels more likely, especially in a narrative/list of this kind.

Josh 22:21

Boiling prefers to read with MSS אל for את, and Ginsburg adduces G as well. But דב"ר can take a wide variety of prepositions, including את at least once (in Genesis).

Josh 22:23

M seems very difficult; NET proposes an answer which is to be considered. Perhaps ואם was lost by corrupt haplography after הזה or because so often repeated in this passage or simply by oversight of a small word.

Josh 22:34

Jenni (3: 146) flags this as uncertain. OG seems to rework the whole verse. Tentatively, I retain MT: “And the Reubenites and the Gadites called out with reference to the altar: ‘Surely it is a witness between us that Yahweh is God.’”

Josh 24:3b

On the Kt-Qr cf. J-M 79m.

Josh 24:8

On the the Kt-Qr cf. J-M 79m.

Josh 24:22

Are the last two words to be deleted with G as an *extremely* rare instance of a gloss in M? For v23 has Joshua speaking with no introduction; neither Concordia nor GKC, J-M, or MNK has any explanation. WBC thinks a gloss (?). Would like to check {Miller’s book, *Representation of Speech in Biblical Hebrew Narrative*}. Had it been the case that the OG translator was troubled by the lack of an introduction of Joshua, would he not more likely have added something than subtracted? But in M as we have it, Joshua challenges the people 3x, and they respond 3x. Most likely, OG either thought this redundant, or G accidentally skipped over two relatively small words.

Josh 24:23

האחרים seems not to be a plausible form, so if G's *Vorlage* was different, it probably was נכר, as BHS tacitly suggests, which is unlikely to have been lost by haplography. Most likely the gloss is the translator's.

Josh 24:31

MT is an inner-M auditory error, or possibly M is an auditory error an V and P have paraphrased.

{Post-script: But note the intertextual link with Jdg 2:7. The singular is preferable.}

Josh 24:33

Boiling adds from G v33x-y, though he thinks that these are part of a Josianic redactional layer. Cf. NICOT 359n1 on Dt-Josh-Jdg linkages. Is there a chance this material is original, lost in the manner of the LE of Mark? Probably not, given other G additions in this book (e.g., a few verses previous) and at the end of Job, Psalms

Jdg 1:19

BHQ records here an error in L, but it is unclear where, as the main text seems to correct it. WLC appears to have misread L as being correct, meaning that no correction in SRO is necessary.

Jdg 1:31

MT אַפֶּק might be a transmissional error, or perhaps the parallel passage is an assimilation to similar place names; cf. BDB.

Jdg 2:21

BHQ, following BHS, gives the OL as omitting וימת, but this appears not to be the case (see Barrera, 447-448 in *Florilegium Lovaniense* (=Martínez FS). Rather, it supports the Greek-language MS tradition of και αφηκεν, representing וינה, which makes much better sense here and could easily be due to transcriptional error (both words four letters, the first two the same; in the paleo script, *mem* and *nun* could easily be confused, while in the square script such confusion remains possible, to accidental substitution or a guess at a broken exemplar is more likely; in the square script *chet* and *taw* are very similar, or in either script the other could have been supplied by a fatigued scribe or one trying to make sense of a difficult exemplar).

{Post-script: while OG indeed probably read וינה for וימת, such is probably a scribal error, for this verb needs an object.}

Jdg 3:13

The move from the plural ויירשו to the singular ויירש is easy to explain for exegetical reasons, but the accidental or deliberate move from the singular to the plural is difficult to explain. That said, the plural does seem to be sensible, as reflected in NET and NIV84 [haven't checked NIV11] (this final clause shifting focus from Eglon to the Eglon-led confederation). For a rather similar shift in grammatical number involving this very verb, note 11:21-22.

Jdg 3:23b

Re וַיָּעַל: Contra BHQ, the LXX does seem to support וינעל, though it is not impossible that it supports ונעל. If the error occurred in a modern script (cf. on 2:22 above), the loss of *yodh* in between *waw* and *nun*, all similar in appearance, is easily explainable.

The pointing is pausal.

{Post-script: But a search of the basically completed spreadsheet on 8/4/21 turned up only *three* proposed changes comparable to this one, viz. Jdg 16:18b (reading וַיָּעַל for וַיָּעַל), and 2 Ki 23:15 (reading וַיָּעַל for וַיָּעַל), and in fact none of those changes appears to be necessary, or indeed particularly probable. In the present instance especially it is hard to imagine why this error would have occurred. Ges 112tt does cite this verse as a textual error, but also requires emendation in a fair number of other verses. At least pending further MS evidence, it seems safer to assume dialectical or stylistic variation.}

Jdg 5:5

BHQ, NAC, and KEL all agree on this revocalization, viz., not from נוּל as in M but from זלל II.

Jdg 5:16

{Perhaps read חקקי? Cf. the nuanced (over-clever??) discussion in Walters (206-207).}

Jdg 5:24

NAC (240 n⁴³⁷) points out that the common *beth/mem* confusion explains Lk 1:42. Reading מנשים for בנשים twice in this verse would make good sense, yet the external evidence is against it: Ralphs presents the non-A text of LXX as εν γυναιξιν in the first case but απο γυναιξων in the second (the A text reads εν γυναιξιν twice, but here the second occurrence has likely been assimilated to the first by way of inner-Greek corruption; it seems less likely that the non-A text was separately translated from a *Vorlage* which had been spared corruption in the first case but not the second). Thus likely external evidence supports בנשים only in the first case, and given the repetitive nature of this poem, it is almost certain that the same form occurred twice in the original. Note as well that the blessing formula is different in the LXX (reflecting, indeed, M, which does *not* have ברוכה) from that

found in Lk 1:42. The latter formula might be adapted from SS 1:8, from a loose recollection of the present passage in the LXX, or it might well have arisen independently of either source.

Jdg 6:7-10

It is difficult to be certain whether these verses are original or not. In favor of including them, a few sources {cite} suggest that they dropped out in between the two open sections, a scribe presumably skipping resuming after the wrong empty space. But are there parallels for this error? It is possible that this Q MS is a highly abbreviated text in the manner of G-Job, but such is quite speculative, especially as the abbreviated nature of LXX-Job is more likely due to the translator than to the *Vorlage* (see below). The transmissional scenario by which Q could be correct here is a bit complex: M inherited one (or more?) large-scale additions; G sprang from a related text and added many small-scale additions; Q reflects neither strain. Such is not impossible however; MT no doubt reflects a spectrum of text types across the 24 books.

In favor of excluding these verses, they feel like some of the additions in M-Jeremiah, specifically here taking their cue from Judges chapter 2 (note for instance *בְּקוֹלִי שָׁמַעְתֶּם* in 2:2 and 6:10). Suspicious is the presence of *וְאָמְרָה*, elsewhere altogether a late form; similarly *וְאֶתְנָה*. The word *אָדוּת* occurs nowhere else in Jdg, nor does the phrase *אִישׁ נָבִיא*. The phrase *כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה* occurs nowhere else (though *כֹּה אָמַר יְתָח* does). The phrase *עֲבָדִים מִבֵּית עֲבָדִים* occurs nowhere else, even as the exodus is mentioned at several different places in the book, nor does anything resembling in meaning *הַיּוֹשְׁבִים בָּאֶרֶץ*. It is striking that Q later has the form *שִׁפְרוּ* for *אֲשֶׁר שִׁפְרוּ* in M: While this prefix could be a late form, it does, in a definite wrinkle in the distribution pattern of the form, occur in the prose (as well as poetry) of Judges, so it could be original to the author, the M form an assimilation to more common usage. (In 6:17 Kennicott lists only one MS as dropping the prefix from *שָׁאֵתָה*, but the Massoretic scribes might well have been more careful in such matters than were those responsible for its M-derived archetype for this book.) Note also the probable absence of 21:18b in another Q MS (see BHS 6*). There the long reading might well have been inspired by 21:1, and transcriptional error does not readily explain the short reading.

Proverbs and Kings would be examples of the LXX inheriting a text with macro-expansions like those in Sam-Ex, Sam-Dt, L-Sam, M-Jer, and G-Dan. LXX-Job is an interesting case: The song of Job's wife is not likely to have been inserted by someone interested in brevity; more likely, G-Job contained some macro-expansions like GM-Jdg, but in that case the translator, more and more as he went on (see THB), wished to abbreviate. Thus LXX-Job comprises two strata at odds with each other, one at the textual level and the other at the translational level.

It must be noted that the tendency to abbreviate is not limited to LXX-Job, for the lack of Hab 3 in the Qumran scroll is most likely due to abbreviation. Likewise two Q MSS of SS attest most likely to abbreviated versions (see Introduction to Song of Songs below). Thus one or both of these short readings in Jdg could be due to abbreviation. Assessment is difficult because, as BHQ notes, the MSS are so limited in extent. Yet to judge by the Q-SS MS that ends at 5:1 (see the Introduction to SS below in this file) and by the Hab MS {ought this matter to be discussed in its place, rather than *assuming* the long reading to be correct?}, and to some extent LXX-Job, abbreviation tends to be fairly large-scale and to focus on ending the book early. In the cases of Jdg, it would seem that if a similar abbreviating tendency were at work the final chapters of the book, sitting as they do outside the main flow of the book, would be edited out, not merely as small clause as in 21:18. The 6:7-10 reading is more likely to be an abbreviation, though if the MS that bears it comes from the same tradition as the MS bearing the 21:18b reading, such would tip the scale in favor of the short reading in chapter 6. There SP on the one hand and Q-Hab on the other show that opposite tendencies existed, and arbitrating can be difficult, as in, perhaps, the SS Q MS that does *not* end at 5:1. Here the intrinsic evince of *שִׁפְרוּ* and especially of *וְאָמְרָה* makes the short readings in Jdg preferable, if not by a large margin.

All in all, it seems best tentatively to prefer the shorter reading in both these cases.

11/3/18 update: Cf. the comments on “Tabernacle Account” in Research Notes. Yet in *this* case (i.e. Jdg 6:7-10) intrinsic (viz. linguistic) evidence points in favor of the *short* reading, so Jdg 6:7-10 might furnish evidence that those who worked with a free hand could also *add* considerable material. If so, whether the same sort of free hand could both add and subtract remains an open question.

11/15/18 update: Regarding the ואתנה argument above, consider such verses as Num 8:19, Jdg 12:3 (!), 1 Sam 2:28 (check text here), 2 Sam 12:8 (check text here), Jer 32:9 (unless G has the expected form? {look into this; at least it might merit a marginal reading}), noting also occurrence in Job and Psalms. The latter two books may evidence a poetic alternative (but examples occur in the prose opening to Job), which might not bear on the matter at hand (historical narrative) from a pre-exilic time of writing (if Jdg be such; revisit commentary introductions on this point). Note also that it is *at least* as likely that שאתה is a linguistic updating as that it is an autographic form. Perhaps Q is comparable to the short texts of SS, where abbreviation and linguistic updating *may* be found together; alternatively, we have linguistic updating and *accidental loss* (due to jumping from one sectional break to another or for no readily discernible reason).

2/2/19 update: Ulrich notes that נביא occurs nowhere else in the book. Not only is this an intrinsic factor in terms of authorial usage, it might be important implications beyond mere word-count: Judges was apparently written early in David's reign at the latest (see 1:21), and Samuel clarifies that in the days of Saul the term was ראה. Thus the author of Judges probably would have used ראה, not נביא.

5/22/19 update: The previous argument on usage is strong, though נביא is used a handful of times in the Pentateuch. Also, NAC (254-255) points out that איש נביא answers to אשה נביאה in 4:4, and that there are literary arguments for the originality of the passage.

The possibility of loss due to the sectional breaks (both closed in Ginsburg; both open in M^{ALC} acc. to BHQ), as mentioned in the secondary literature, and of abbreviation in the later passage, remain conceivable. The seemingly random deletions in sources like 4QJer^a and G-2 Esdras point in this direction.

11/9/19 update: The argument of a Davidic *terminus ante quem* from 1:21 is tenuous. Cf. Concordia to 1 Ki 1: 5 (especially n³).

Jdg 4:24

Following Ges 113h n2; note also the section on infinitives in he-lamed verbs.

Jdg 6:25

Possibly ופר should be פר as (apparently) G (see the discussion in NAC 266-67), but it is not so clear that there is external support for this, and even if there was, it would be hard to explain transcriptionally and is likely unnecessary (cf. HALOT 2: 1604a); the *waw* here might be explicative.

On the repointing (here and in vv26, 28) see HALOT loc. cit.

Jdg 7:21

The Kt-Qr here is difficult. The hiph'il of נוס is rare but not unattested (see BDB); the Kt could be due to the rarity of this form. On the other hand, the Qr could be due to transcriptional error in a Hasmonean hand. Intertwined too is the rarity with which רוע refers to a cry of despair (see BDB). If the subject of ויריעו is the Midianites, then the Qr is most likely correct. If the subject is the Israelites, then the Kt is most likely correct. G supports the Qr, and as emendation only (not transcriptional error) would explain the move from ויניסו to ויניסו, the evidence for the Qr seems better.

Jdg 9:8, 12

See Ges for the pointing adopted here. On the other hand, following Blau p224 (4.3.5.2.4.1) the original form might have been מלוקה passing at some stage to מלוקה.

Jdg 9:46

It is generally thought that M has engaged in theological polemics here, but if so, why not also in v4? G might rather be an assimilation to v4. Since dislike of בעל is very ancient yet has never been universal, it is plausible to speculate that from ancient times two versions of this place name, one euphemistic, were in circulation, and the author of Judges considered them interchangeable.

Jdg 11:34

Perhaps ממנו is an error for ממנה (visual error, or mechanical assimilation to לו, or one facilitated by the other; cf. Ges 135o n³); but see J-M 149b.

Jdg 12:4

The short reading here has no obvious transcriptional causes, though admittedly some witnesses to the LXX attest to other short readings for various reasons. The plus has the feel of the type of addition one would see in the SP or M-Jer; cf. some of the other pluses earlier in the present book. See BHQ *88-*89 for further discussion.

In the end, the external evidence and the lack of clarity on internal evidence makes keeping M (=LXX^{B,A,majority}) preferable.

Jdg 13:5, 7

See J-M 89j.

Jdg 13:12, 17

If this variation occurred just once, the singular might be preferable, but for a singular דברך to have become plural, in the fact of יבא, *twice* is most improbable.

Jdg 16:21

The Qr would perhaps merit a marginal reading, as the Kt is apparently a later form (see BDB), yet this book displays other apparently “late” (regional?) readings, like ש prefix.

Jdg 19:21

Re Kt-Qr in WTT (BibleWorks9) see WLC 4.20.

Jdg 20:48b

A confusing case: the version of UXLC used for the first edition read /mtom/, which was adjusted as a VL-class reading to /mtim/; but a later version of UXLC changes the reading to /mtim/, though MAM has /mtom/, but I changed by mind (prodded by an Anchor volume) to read /mtim/ and to reclass as Ve. The spreadsheet now lists /mtom/ in column C, since this was in the base text at the time of the publication of the first edition, and has /mtim/ in column D.

In summary: I have swapped columns C and D (relative to the first edition), and changed the tag from VL to Ve.

1 Sam 1:5

Perhaps the lack of an OG correspondence for אפים is due to the fact that the translator did not understand the word and therefore abstained from offering a rendering.

1 Sam 1:16

Is לפני an error for להיות לפי, or some such? Cf. BDB (“rare and dub” IIRC) sub פנה; DCH (sub לפני) seems not to recognize this usage. But see NICOT for a case for M(T).

1 Sam 1:24-25

עָמָם וַיְבִיאֻהוּ לִפְנֵי יְהוָה וַיִּשְׁחָט אֲבִיהוּ אֶת הַזֶּבֶחַ אֲשֶׁר יַעֲשֶׂה מִיָּמָיו לַיהוָה וַיָּבֵא אֶת הַנֶּעֱר

Very difficult. MT might be impossible, but it is not clear that OG/Q is an improvement: As Driver points out, Very difficult. MT might be impossible, but it is not clear that OG/Q is an improvement: As Driver points out, והנער is redundant; Samuel is, all told, brought 3x, by a different group each time; sacrifices are multiplied. The last two items in particular make OG smack of a doublet (on the Hebrew level, as Q shows). Note in this connection the not-unrelated changes made by G later in v25, both (at least) of which are hard to see G as superior to M by any stretch.

HALOT on נער conjectures נזיר, which seems pretty plausible on transcriptional grounds, but have not

really looked into the intrinsic evidence, and as far as I know external evidence is lacking.

OG παῖδιον could translate יֶנֶק, which bears some resemblance to נָעַר and for which the latter could be an emendation in light of the fact that early in v24 Hannah is said to have “weaned” Samuel. Can יֶנֶק refer loosely to a young child?

HALOT notes, though not in this connection, strong evidence for a root נָעַר meaning something like “shriek”: Perhaps we should point נָעַר and render “was weeping.” Possibly a literary connection with Moses as an infant would thereby be revealed. Cf. NAC (59-60) which documents many literary links between Moses and Samuel. The philology here is uncertain, but seems promising.

1 Sam 2:3

Concordia (71) seems to contain an oversight: It gives the OG αὐτου as supporting the Qr, but this is not the case. Rather, OG seems to read οὐαλ; the αὐτου in question is associated with επιτηδεύματα, the two Greek words together (if αὐτου does not originate with the translator, who sometimes paraphrases) would seem to represent עליות, or perhaps עֲלִילָתוֹ. The Kt could be a transposition of ואל, but (1) it seems a bit off to repeat אל in parallel lines, and more significantly (2) such is *not* compatible with נִתְכַּנּוּ, and it is difficult to account for that form arising from הִכָּן. (O)G, then, seems to be some combination of error and emendation/ free translation.

Since there is little support for the Qr, and G indirectly supports Kt (being a transposition of it), it seems best to retain the Kt. If pointed as a negative marker it produces nonsense, but if pointed as an asseverative it makes good sense, and that particle, if anywhere present, is to be found in an ancient poem such as Hannah's.

1 Sam 2:9

Cf. the parallelism (so Concordia, 74).

1 Sam 2:27

See Concordia 97-98. While עֲבָדִים could, as it pointed out there, be due to homoeotetuton, it also could be an addition. A search of מַצְרִים in Samuel shows nowhere where the word is collocated with this word or something similar, and מַצְרִים and פֶּרַע appear in similarly close connection in 1 Sam 6:6. In short, M is to be preferred.

1 Sam 2:32

Concordia's view (100) that MT contains a somewhat lengthy doublet from v29 is strange, especially as Q there seems to borrow wording from here (cf. *ibid*, 99), such that the Q minus here is not really a minus but a transposition. Such a move in MT would be out of character, in our view, of how the witness can fairly be characterized as whole. MT is, furthermore, makes sense: See NET and the first footnote there.

1 Sam 3:7

See Hornkohl (330f).

1 Sam 3:16

Jenni (143) seems to think אל should be read for את. Cf. OG πρὸς? But cf. 9:24 (which he also flags, but for which the external evidence is even less clear).

1 Sam 4:7

On בא as superior to באו see Concordia. ((O)G is an assimilation to v8.)

1 Sam 5:11a

Apparently for מות Q has יהוה. M could be an orthodox corruption, but neither it nor G protest in Zech 14:13, to which Q here could be an assimilation. Moreover, the last two letters (67%) of מות are visually similar to the second half (50%) of יהוה, so it might be a mere scribal slip. The external evidence, in any case, is not strong (in that מות is not sustained elsewhere, including in G, and Q is not a reliable witness).

{Post-script: In further defense of M, could the intent be “Mot,” which set expression the later writer

Zechariah objects to and uses “Yahweh”?

1 Sam 5:11b

Note the general visual similarity of כבוא ארון to כבדה מאד יד, especially at the beginning and the end. Either could plausibly come from the other, and either could be seen as assimilation to one or more verbal cues in the near context. It is slightly easier transcriptionally to derive G from M. It is possible that the G reading, if it is not a mere slip, was inspired by the idea that v10 indicates that the Ekronites protested the moment they saw the ark coming. However, that verse need not demand that the refusal was immediate, and indeed v12 indicates that many actually died (which might also be indicated by מהומת מות in our verse, if מות there does not indicate merely intensity; moreover, the gathering of the *sarnim* in v11 could not have been instant). Thus, M seems preferable.

1 Sam 6:3

See Concordia 143 on the possibility of reading with G Q אתם. But cf. Ges 116s.

1 Sam 6:20

The reading יהוה הקדוש הזה is probably due to homoeotetion (*he* to final *mem*).

1 Sam 7:2

In defense of M, see Tawil (234).

1 Sam 9:1

For the author of Sam, the constituent elements of בנימין are separable. Cf. Driver on this verse.

1 Sam 9:9

See the essay in *In the Footsteps of Sherlock Holmes*. Usage elsewhere in Sam suggests לשאול over לדרוש here, and it is possible to explain M in at least two (possibly complementary ways): (1) Both words are five letters, with the 1st and 4th being the same, and another letter changing position; (2) The root דרש has not yet occurred in Sam, while שאל has, so assimilation might have occurred.

On the other hand, looking at the data in the essay just cited, it is possible that diachronically the root דרש began to supplant שאל in the mantic sense even in ancient times (I have in mind the book of Kings, especially if the possible G witness to שאל at certain points is assimilation to usage from earlier in Reigns). Indeed (on this point note the reference to NICOT the essay supplied), this very verse refers to a diachronic phenomenon (viz. how נבא had supplanted ראה by the author's time)!

{Post-script: 1 Sam 10:22 seems to have שאל in the mantic sense (and OG concurs there), so it seems that the semantic distinction was not firmly held at the time / in the dialect of the author of Samuel. Furthermore, G's שאל here in 9:9 might be an assimilation, or even *avoidance* of דרש because at a still later stage of Hebrew (viz. when the OG was translated) the latter term referred not to mantic inquiry of God but to study of God's written revelation.}

1 Sam 10:13

See Concordia 194 on text and meaning. Perhaps OG is to be retroverted הגבעתה. This might seem to contradict the first clause of v10. However, (1) observe לקראתו there, which suggests that what is meant by the first clause is that they were *about to* enter Gibeah, or that the clause allows that they were *in the process* of entering Gibeah, when near in or around the approaches to the city they were met by the prophets; moreover, (2) v14 *could* imply that Saul only then arrived in the city.

If so, M במה here could be an emendation to avoid the appearance of a contradiction. It could also be mere error (*gimmel/beth* haplography + *ayin/mem* confusion + *taw/he* haplography).

However, items 1 and 2 are both less than decisive. As to the second in particular, he who speaks in v14 not Saul's father but *uncle*, to whom Saul would not likely have approached immediately on reaching his home city.

1 Sam 10:25

For לִבִּיתוֹ G Q have לִמְקוֹמוֹ. One could be a transcriptional error for the other; if so, the latter seems slightly preferable as original since it is longer. In terms of intrinsic evidence, however, M is supported by 2 Sam 6:19, where M G agree on לִבִּיתוֹ. (Cf. also 1 Sam 23:18; 26:25 lends a small measure of plausibility to לִמְקוֹמוֹ, but the expression is different.)

1 Sam 11:2

The word בְּרִית could have fallen out after אָכַרְתָּ, but the presence of the word in Q and the fact that בְּרִית is often omitted in such constructions, including several times in Samuel (see BDB sub כָּרַת), argues against this view.

1 Sam 11:8

Has בָּבְמָה fallen out by homoeoarchon after בְּזֹבֶק? (On the meaning such would bear, cf. Concordia 194.)

1 Sam 12:8

The Hebrew *Vorlage* behind OG καὶ ἐταπείνωσεν αὐτοὺς Αἰγύπτου could represent a phrase that fell out by homoeoteteluteton. However, (1) the earlier plus καὶ οἱ υἱοὶ αὐτοῦ is harder to account for on transcriptional grounds and suggests an expansionist *Vorlage* here, and (2) the verse is at any rate a highly compressed summary (if this verse was all we had, we would think that Moses and Aaron settled the people in the land), making unnecessary an explication of why the people, having traveled to Egypt, would then cry out.

1 Sam 12:23

See Ges 126x.

1 Sam 13:1

Jumbled Thoughts from Earlier Work (see below for more recent):

Omission in king lists mentioned by Tsumura rests on slim evidence, it seems. Probably this verse is spurious, added, like much material in Jer, on the basis of other material elsewhere. Specifically, a formula expressing the accession age and length of reign of the king was sought. Probably this was supplied on the analogy of Ishbosheth (2 Sam 2:10), but the MS which gave birth to the M tradition had lost the word אַרְבַּעַיִם through oversight (if not polemic), leading to various emendations in various MSS (reflected in the Lucianic text) and versions. Such a scenario, though requiring an intermediate stage between G and M, explains the extant data well. Paul's 40-year age for Saul in Ac 13:21 might have been based not on any MS tradition but on inferences from the text: Saul was evidently young when made king; a similar age can be supposed for Jonathan when he became an officer; Mephibosheth was only five years old when his father and grandfather died (2 Sam 4:4); these facts suggest that the length of Saul's reign was approximately the sum of the age of two men fairly young men, and the number forty is not only consonant with these considerations but reminiscent of the forty years of wandering in the wilderness before reaching the promised land. One possible explanation of the MT is that the author of 1 Sam did not know the years in question (cite McCarter). Two considerations oppose this view, however. First, why would he know that the second number ending in two? (Did I see this somewhere?) Second, Paul felt he knew the length Saul's reign (see Ac 13:21); how would he know if the author of 1 Sam, so closer to the events, did not? (That Ac 13:21 is apparently a round number makes it unlikely that the Lucianic text is merely supplying the NT text, since the number if not exactly the same, not to mention the probably ancient roots of the Lucianic text. Note, too, that there is good reason for Paul to use a round number here: He is implying a comparison between the 40 years' delay in entering the Promised Land as mentioned in Ac 13:18 and the delay before the commencement of the Messianic line that began in David.) Closely connected with this VU is that in 11:1, where again the Lucianic has a plus over against MG. For a detailed defense of the long reading in 11:1, see Ulrich on Samuel and Josephus at Qumran.

5/30/19 update: As I write, I tentatively am holding to M-priority in Samuel, though I remain prepared to accept sporadic orthodox corruptions even in M. Something of this scale, though, seems unlikely, so arguments

in favor of the plus are to be sought.

Althann's proposal is unlikely. The ESV version seems to be special pleading. Tsumura's proposal, though at least as old as Jerome, it would seem, seems a very great stretch, at least because I am not inclined to see this section as poetry. McCarter (cited by Tsumura, *iirc*) suggests that the author of Samuel did not know how old Saul was at his reign's commencement or how long it last, but (again I think this analysis of McCarter is from Tsumura; maybe Concordia) this does not explain the numeral שתי. Concordia's approach is interesting, but relies on a conjecture, as no source known to me actually puts the accession age of Saul as 40. A theory I came up with *against* the plus might have relevance here, as offering an explanation for the form found in (proto-)MT and the permutations in the versions: I supposed that ערבעים or שלשים originally came after בן when the interpolation was composed; the numeral, due perhaps to corrupt haplography (in the paleo script), subsequently dropped out, causing the confusion seen in LXX^L V T P. (This is also a conjecture, but one connected to a secondary source, and so in no more objectionable in my view than a conjecture concerning the original text of the OG.) The problem here is that שתי later in the verse is unparalleled in the sense required (see Concordia); there must have been another number associated with it, and accidental error *twice* in *one* verse of the *same* sort of item (numbers) seems special pleading (combined with conjecture!).

At present, the best argument seems to be thus: In Akkadian scribal tradition (see Worthington, 22; cf. Tsumura comments), a damaged or defective segment of text was sometimes not (or only partially, exclusive of conjecture) restored. The author of Samuel, then, might have examined some ancient record for the purposes of writing this notice; the text being damaged, the author of Samuel declined to conjecture concerning the accession age and the other number associated with the length of his reign, but did copy שתי, since that word was clear to him. This theory is similar to McCarter's, but less speculative (relying as it does on ancient scribal practice, not psychoanalysis) and accounts for שתי. (If this is thought to pose a theological problem, parallels are not absent: For instance, Jesus himself declaimed knowledge of the timing of the *parousia*. The author of Samuel here is simply being honest, transmitting what he can but not fabricating knowledge he lacks.) In this case G might have omitted the verse because it, like most commentators today (unaware of the relevant historical background), could make no sense of the verse (nor could later versions, as mentioned); however, it is also to be considered whether G omits the verse for some other reason, for the same apparent lack of sense does *not* afflict 2 Ki 1:17 (see further next paragraph).

What this VU *might* hang on is how one resolves the M plus in 2 Ki 1:17 (see research notes). If what is most probable there is that an accession-plus entered M despite M being a far more conservative text of Kings than G is, then the same could have happened here (and in 2 Sam 5:4-5, though there it is 4QSam^a that attests to the minus). On the other hand, the problem with שתי would still persist. Indeed, perhaps it is rather 1 Sam 13:1 that gives the clue for 2 Ki 1:17, for the plus in 1 Sam hardly makes sense as an interpolation.

1 Sam 13:2

Commentators are divided as to whether איש ought to be read with G P, and someone pointed out the similarity to the following מִי־שָׂאָל; but probably it is not necessary, and may indeed be something that exists only as a translational device.

1 Sam 13:3a

Here Concordia recommends reading בגבעה and similarly in 14:2 and 14:16; BDB recommends reading גבע in v16 and in Jdg 20:10 and Jdg 20:33. But it is not clear why this error would occur, especially not 4x. גבע is apparently the grammatically masculine counterpart of גבעה, so it does not seem implausible that these two forms were legitimate alternative, freely interchanged in very ancient times (though perhaps the latter had become standardized by the time the OG was translated).

{Post-script: But see the map in Concordia (Fig. 18 = p. 245). Are Geba and Gibeah in fact two different locations? Look into the archaeology and such. HALOT 1: 175^a cites some scholarly opinion that seems to support the validity of this equivalence, though not in connection to 1 Sam 13:3. A more extensive theory of equivalence is cited in WBC 122 ^{3.a}.}

{Note also that certainly גבעה, and according to OG also גבע, can be a common noun (“hill”) in addition

to a place name. Some of the confusion might be from using the noun as a common noun rather than a place name in some cases (e.g., 14:16).}

1 Sam 13:3b

Here some (cf., e.g., HALOT 2: 1572b) recommend reading *ישמעו* for *יפגעו*. M could be an assimilation to the earlier *וישמעו* (or, less likely, an avoidance of the idea of wrongdoing on the Israelites' part, if the verb was read as "sin" rather than "rebel"), and G is certainly possible. But (1) G errs graphically in the very next word, so reading with it on the word but against it on the next word is (not impossible but) suspect; and (2) the verb *שמעו* in v4 seems to pick up on the verb at the end of v3 as found in M. So G, not M, is here probably inadvertently in error.

1 Sam 13:8a

On the pointing (as *niph'al*), see Driver (77 [the printed scan may be defective here; see the PDF (loc. 232)]).

1 Sam 14:12

See Concordia 249 re *המצבה*. BDB concurs in seeing a ghost form. However, it is not clear how MT would have come about transcriptionally, while it is not clear whether OG differs, and if it does, whether such would not simply represent linguistic leveling.

1 Sam 14:41c

See Concordia 263-264.

1 Sam 14:45

The suggestion that *חלילה* is a dittograph (cited in Concordia p. 265) is plausible on the face of it, but cf. 20:2. It is rather a compressed idiom.

1 Sam 14:48

On *שסהו* see BDB *sub loco*.

1 Sam 14:51

On Davidson's suggestion (56^b = PDF loc75) of *בני* for *בן* with Josephus, see Concordia (279).

1 Sam 16:7

Re *אשר*, the reading (with OG) of *כאשר* is tempting, but such is hard to explain transcriptionally, and unnecessary. {Post-script: Indeed, unnecessary; cf. Holmstedt 232ff. "It is not that which man sees [that Y sees]."

Re the P reading noted by Joosten (see this discussion in NICOT), *כנגד* might be an error for *נגד* (loss of a single letter; overlooking a word division). Note that *כנגד* occurs *only* in Gen 2 in the OT, and that *נגד יהוה* occurs elsewhere in Sam.

1 Sam 16:7

Regarding Joosten's interpretation of the P here, note the (implicit) corrective in Morrison (MPIL 11), viz. that P (like OG, though independently and by different means) is making the "laconic" (Concordia's word) MT more intelligible with a supplied reference to God.

1 Sam 18:1

On the Kt see Ges 60d.

1 Sam 18:6

Even taking G-priority in the Goliath story, the words of this verse in M, up to *הפלשתי*, might be genuine, lost in G due to homoeotetelueton with *הלחמי* in 17:58.

1 Sam 18:14

This anomaly in L was first corrected in UXLC 1.4

1 Sam 19:18

See Concordia 374: “in the pasture settlements.”

1 Sam 20:2b

In support of the Kt see (if a bit tentatively) Driver’s *Tenses*. Near-haplographic loss of an initial *yodh* is not impossible, but also not hugely likely here.

1 Sam 20:12

See Concordia 391. Yet external evidence is weak, and M has a very similar minus in 20:23 where accidental omission, though not impossible, is less likely than here – coincidental omission of the same word twice seems unlikely. Rather, we seem to have a stereotyped formula that need not always be fully expressed verbally.

1 Sam 20:13

Following BDB and Ges.

1 Sam 20:16

The word אִיבִי feels like an orthodox corruption, especially considering related VUs in this book. The OL (according to Sabatier) here is sadly lacking, and Cambridge does not list support for an omission.

1 Sam 20:23

On the possible inclusion of נָךְ see above on v12. (O)G seems to have a clarifying plus here.

1 Sam 20:24

Re Kt-Qr: Ulrich shows no data. It is possible that Kt is an error (cf. v27 ad fin), but note the alternation of ‘al and ‘el in v25. Most likely, then, Kt is stylistic variation or substitution of what for the author was altogether synonyms.

1 Sam 22:13

Kt-Qr: We have pointed as a defective אָלָךְ; another option is to read אָלִי, assuming corrupt haplography in the square script.

1 Sam 25:6

For לְחִי it is tempting to read לְאָחִי w/ V, but this seems slender external evidence, especially as G seems to = MT. See the commentaries for extensive discussion.

1 Sam 25:7

See J-M. Since they are utterly at a loss, and this an isolated case, not a chain of related vocalizations, this is probably simply a mistake, though identifying the mistake is admittedly difficult. Perhaps tritography, or perhaps a remnant of a Palestinian system (cf. on Gen 43:26) in which system *seghol* and *patach* were in something like free variation, or perhaps an anticipation of הִייתָם later in the verse. The first possibility is the most likely, for the same error seems to occur in Ps 128:3 (J-M p295 n2).

{By way of explanation, katamz resembles seghol in some hands (when not all the portions of kamatz connect to each other). Does this mean that not only M-Sam, but MT-Sam, derives from a single archetype?}

1 Sam 25:23

Perhaps לִפְנֵי is to be read w/ G, but Concordia (476) BDB (sub פָּא) and Holladay (sub פָּא) don't think so, and

while the loss of *nun* would not be hard to picture, the addition of *aleph* is hard to account for. Since at least w/ **בא בשנים** the author of Samuel uses slightly unusual expressions (also contrast 1 Sam 14:19 w/ 1 Ki 22:34, Lam 3:3 [if the text there is sound], 2 Chr 18:33), perhaps that is the case here.

1 Sam 25:24

אני could be a dittograph, but similar usage is attested elsewhere (including in 2 Sam); we incline towards seeing its absence in the versions as simplification.

1 Sam 25:29

Cf. HALOT and the following *waw consecutive perfect*. The defective spelling probably misled the *naqdan*.

1 Sam 26:22

According to Ralphs {have not checked Cambridge edition}, G supports the Kt here {at least depending on how one interprets the OG}. Sense can be made of this: “The [=your] spear, O King!” (ESV, at least, takes this approach.)

1 Sam 27:8

It is tempting to emend the OG Γελαμψουρ to Τελαμ Σουρ to the like, the point being that this could then be retroverted as containing a place name **טלם**. But the *gamma* could just as easily be representing the *ayin*, and the place name is plural, not singular, in 15:4. See further NICOT.

1 Sam 28:7

See Concordia 520-521. One might argue that one the first two words in the noun phrase **אשת בעלת אוב** as a doublet. However, Nah 3:4 supports the usage of **בעלה** here (Concordia 521), such that this is the less problematic word of the two, yet OG (γυναῖκα ἐγγαστριμυθον) seems to preserve **אשת** here. Probably M is sound here, and OG either translates loosely or it or its *Vorlage* dropped **בעלת** because it did not understand it.

1 Sam 28:23

See *Metathesis in the Hebrew Bible* (24).

{Post-script: In view of the number of such cases, this is probably *linguistic*, not *textual*, metathesis. See Concordia to our verse.}

1 Sam 30:5

On **הכרמלי**, cf. the textual commentary on 1 Sam 27:3.

2 Sam 2:2

On **הכרמלי**, cf. the textual commentary on 1 Sam 27:3.

2 Sam 2:8

See Concordia for strong argumentation against retaining **איש בשת**.

On the other hand, euphemisms might have been operative even in very early times: Cf. **ברך** in Job and in 1 Ki 21:10.

2 Sam 2:9

On **האשורי** see Concordia (31).

2 Sam 2:15

As Concordia (32) notes, the matter is difficult to decide. However, the author of Samuel frequently uses **בני** in this sense, including in v25, and the minus could be haplography. We assume G to have the defective spelling of M, while Q expands the spelling to **בנימין**.

{Post-script: In light of (virtually) the same variation occurring in 2:31, it seems best to retain MT, as the same error twice in the same witness over a short stretch seems unlikely.}

2 Sam 2:29

מחנימה is unlikely, at least for the reason of Q's reading in 3:27.

2 Sam 3:3

Re the Kt-Qr: The Kt is unlikely to be an error, for the same spelling occurs in 1 Sam 25:32 and in 2 Sam 17:25. Perhaps there were two forms of the name were in circulation (like with many English names today); one took גיל as a noun constructed on the analogy of הָיִל, the other (here) as a 3rd person qal singular (with the father as the subject; on the form cf. שֵׁת from שֵׁת, though I do not know the reason for vocalic discrepancy). (On the other hand, the Kt-Qr in 1 Sam 15:18 might be different. See there.) {Post-script: After writing this, I found inscriptional evidence for the validity of the Kt form in Davies' *Ancient Hebrew Inscriptions* (vol. 1, iirc).}

On הכרמלי, cf. the textual commentary on 1 Sam 27:3.

2 Sam 3:25

BDB refers to Driver on “inexplicable” Qr form. Perhaps at one time the Qr was a Kt, and the two were accidentally swapped in transmission at some point?

2 Sam 3:28

Re מאחרי כן see the note on 15:1 below.

2 Sam 3:39

Among the commentators is Walters (270-274), who ultimately concludes that the true text seems just out of reach in present documentation. Could the text be וְכִי הוּא רַע וּמִשּׁוּךְ לַמֶּלֶךְ, meaning, “And surely he [=Abner] was a friend, and one annointed [that is, appointed to the generalship] by the king!” or “And that he was, etc.”?

The form וְכִי is not especially common in the OT (such instances as do occur are temporally spread out, but tend to cluster in the Pentateuch), but does occur a substantial number of times elsewhere in this book (1 Sam 19:4, 22:17, 24:19, 2 Sam 5:12, 16:10).

M's רַךְ provides a counterpoint for the later קָשִׁים, but G's רַע underscores the fact that David, so far from seeking Abner's demise, was a supporter of his; so, both readings have points in their favor here.

M's הָיִם feels odd here, and it might be accidental assimilation either to the previous verse or to the repeated (but semantically somewhat different) use of the form a few times elsewhere in the wider context (to the combination of these two factors).

2 Sam 4:1

It is possible that איש בשת dropped out after וישמע due to the visual similarity of the two letter-sets, and that the form was mistaken for מפי בשת in G. However, in v2 Ishbosheth is again referred to as בן שאול, where again (O)G has “Mephibosheth.” That the same error would occur twice in M – and the same separate corruption in G – seems unlikely. Rather, the narrative intends either to suppress Ishbosheth's name in order to highlight his weakness (cf. the essay in *The Literary Dimension*), or to place the emphasis on the fact of his being a Saulide.

2 Sam 4:6

See A Linguistic Inquiry Solves an Ancient Crime: Re-examination of 2 Samuel 4:6, Emmanuel Mastéy, *Vetus Testamentum*, Vol. 61, Fasc. 1 (2011), pp. 82-103 *Defends the MT here (the first word might need re-pointing, but perhaps not, and it may be preferable as the harder reading to explain – why would the Massoretes preserve such an obscure vocalization if not based on definite tradition?)*

See further the detailed essay in Bodner, *The Artistic Dimension*, which ultimately prefers the M text, particularly based on the literary consistency of חמש.

2 Sam 5:1

On the validity of the construction **וַיֹּאמֶר לֵאמֹר**, note 20:18.

2 Sam 5:2b

Kt is haplography before the following **אֵת**. It is possible that **וְהַמְבִּי** is an original, defective form, but (a) this would highly unusual, (b) there is, as just mentioned, a clear transcriptional explanation ready at hand, and (c) and obvious error earlier the verse (see the preceding comment) suggests that the M scribe was inattentive at this point (or being very faithful to his perception of a damaged and/or hard-to-read exemplar).

{Post-script: In light of similar **בּוֹא** examples elsewhere (1 Ki 12:12, 21:12, 21:29, 2 Ki 3:24), probably Kt is rather an unusual defective form.}

2 Sam 5:4-5

See Driesbach, 231-32. The absence of **בִּירוּשָׁלַיִם**, attested in OG^B, from MT might be due to bear homoeotetuton (*he* and *mem* in the modern script); if Driesbach is correct that these verses were (see 4QSam^a) originally lacking, this would be an inner-M corruption after the ancestor of M broke off from the source of OG. Alternatively, **בִּירוּשָׁלַיִם** could be a Samaritan-style (for lack of a better term) plus answering to **בְּחֶבְרוֹן**.

2 Sam 5:6a

Cf. Driver, and on the form see BDB **אָמַר** *niph'al*.

2 Sam 5:6b

Following Driver.

On the meaning of the verse, the quotation marks in

2 Sam 5:21

M's **עֲצִבְיָהֶם** is probably *not* an orthodox corruption, in light of (at least) 1 Sam 7:3, 8:8, 26:29, 28:13. Rather, OG is either a paraphrase (or, more likely, given its practice in the examples just cited; contrast its rendering in 1 Sam 31:9), a translation of a *Vorlage* which had assimilated to 1 Chr 14:12.

An alternative explanation: M is a transcriptional error for **אֱלֹהֵיהֶם** (aural error + *lamedh/tsadde* confusion + *beth/he* confusion). **אֱלֹהִים** in reference to other than YHWH, and **עֲצָב** in the sense of “idol,” both occur elsewhere in both Sam and chr, so it is hard to get traction on intrinsic evidence.

2 Sam 6:6

See Concordia (105): M could be due to homoeoarchon. However, the author elsewhere uses compressed expressions, and probably none of the ancient versions cited qualify as hyper-literal, so I incline toward the minus.

2 Sam 7:21

One could read **לְהַדִּיעַ** with 1 Chr 17:19, but cf. below on v27.

2 Sam 7:27

The parallel (1 Chr 17:25) has **גִּלְיָתָה** rather than **גִּלְיָתָה**, but is such the preservation of an unusual spelling or a standardization from the perspective of early-LBH orthographic standards? The green book, in its chapter on inter-book differences, notes that Sam and Ki are unusually modern in their spelling. I've noticed sometimes archaic spellings in Chron, meanwhile. Perhaps this is because these two books suffered more heavily in the realm of spelling updates in textual tradition. Or, contrariwise, were their authors rather ahead of their times in their spelling styles from the outset?

2 Sam 8:3

[Re Kt-Qr:] External evidence is strong in favor of the presence of the word. Perhaps it was lost due to near

homoeoteteluton as *resh* and *taw* have a similar appearance in the square script.

{But Concordia (150) notes that quite a number of passages use פרת w/o נהר to refer to the Euphrates.}

2 Sam 10:3

See on 1 Chr 19:3 below.

2 Sam 11:1

Concordia (189-190), citing Yeivin, notes that in the MS (though not in WLC, at least not in version 4.20) has a *raphe* over the *aleph*, suggesting that a plural of מלך is intended. Still, the pointing is anomalous; perhaps a mixed form? “A considerable number of Masoretic manuscripts have the usual [consonantal] spelling” (Concordia 190), but this reading, absent from A L and the “majority” (Ib.) of MSS, is surely secondary (conscious or unconscious emendation, or misunderstanding of a Masoretic note; similarly, the versional evidence (from which P {but verify w/ Leiden} is conspicuously absent) probably attests to interpretive translation (though in the case of G quite possible to a *Vorlage* which had seen emendation). Admittedly, M could be an assimilation to v4, but this would be forward assimilation over a not-insignificant stretch of text to a section verbally different from the present one. Most likely this is an unusual spelling of “the kings” with a few parallels elsewhere (e.g. Hos 4:6, if the text there is sound). Indeed, as Concordia (ib.) points out, a similar phenomenon occurs later in this same chapter (v24). There is also רש in 12:1 and 4. It is perhaps worth nothing that in Samuel the absolute plural of מלך occurs elsewhere only once, viz. 2 Sam 10:19 (the verse is not far removed in space from 11:1, but is part of a different pericope and so *might* reflect different source material, on which point I have yet to check the commentaries).

2 Sam 11:4

Concordia (191) notes some evidence that the OG might have had ויבוא אליה. In that case (and here we go beyond what Concordia discusses), M could be an emendation to lessen David's guilt. However, the passage as a whole manifestly displays David's guilt, the M text would seem virtually to be required by the preceding ויקחה (at least in conjunction with the previous discussion of her being on the roof of another building and of David sending messengers to inquire), and G (or an inner-greek and/or Latin or inner-latin error) could easily be mechanical assimilation in a series of masculine verbs.

2 Sam 11:24a

On the two Kt-Qr matters (here grouped together b/c of proximity and similarity), see Concordia (196, citing Ges 75rr) and the comments above on v1.

2 Sam 12:2

See Ges 126d. A similar situation obtains in v4, so this would seem not to be a mere error. Perhaps there is a distancing effect in the lack of an article here? NICOT seems ambivalent.

{Post-script: See Holmstedt 75. The fact that the reading tradition has preserved a less obvious form in two non-consecutive verses, together with the fact that the same construction occurs elsewhere in the book (Holmstedt *ib.* cites 1 Sam 16:23) makes the M pointing preferable to twice repointing the preposition as having an embedded article.}

2 Sam 12:4

See Ges 126x and on v2.

2 Sam 12:9

See WBC.

OG^L has ενωπιον αυτου for OG^B εν οφθαλμοις αυτου. It is possible that the OG *Vorlage* was לפניו, for which בעיניו could be an assimilation to common usage (“evil the eyes of” occurs numerous times in the OT, while “evil before” occurs only in Neh 2:1, 9:28). On the other hand, the two forms are graphically rather

similar, to the one might simply be an error, and firm evidence for the other is only late.

2 Sam 12:22

Re Kt-Qr see Driver.

2 Sam 12:24

Concordia (224) and WBC (159) support Qr, as do P (I *have* verified w/ Leiden) and T (so Concordia and BibleWorks9). OG and V are ambiguous; Driver and NAC do not comment, and NICOT (198) seems ambivalent, but notes that “special circumstances” were at work with Hannah and Samuel, thereby undermining the case for Qr here.

Tentatively, we prefer Kt for three reasons: (1) The Kt is usually to be preferred where there is not strong evidence for the Qr; (2) the initiative in the larger context seems to be with David – he responds in a Job-like fashion to God's sovereign hand, comforts his wife, etc.; (3) the possible nuances of the name שלמה (see esp. Concordia 224-225) connect with the story of *David*, as does the name ידדיה (on which see NAC 376).

2 Sam 12:30

Many commentators favor pointing “Milkom.” But the statues were of *kings*, not *gods*, and it seems to me that things would be phrased rather differently if an *idol* rather than a *man* is referred to. Plus, David putting in on his own head seems to be make better sense as in MT.

The same issue applies in 1 chr 20:2. Curiously, there seems to be a doublet in both places (inner-greek assimilation?).

2 Sam 13:20

Re האמיון, see Driver (232): It is quite possible that M(T) is corrupt, but so far from certain that it is best to retain it.

2 Sam 14:13

It is possible that for ומדבר OG reads ומעלם (i.e. a *hiphil* participle from עלם; on the pointing see HALOT 835a), if (with BDB) חשב is meant in a negative sense (cf. HALOT's citation [834b] of Ps 26:4), and also for כאשם reads להתאפק, i.e. “For the king conives [lit., “conceals this matter”], hardening himself not to, etc.” But the sense is difficult, as is the retroversion, and in the end M may make better sense. Interestingly the revised version of OG seems to have ומפי for ומדבר, but such is probably an error.

2 Sam 15:1

As Concordia (275) notes, מאחרי כן is unusual. However, *contra* Q, M is probably correct, as the same form occurs elsewhere (2 Sam 3:28, 2 chr 32:23).

2 Sam 17:12

See Ges 122l.

2 Sam 17:16

Marked as a problem in W-O 11.2..10g #61, but see J-M 152fa.

2 Sam 18:3b

Re Kt-Qr: The former could be *waw/yodh* confusion, but as the *hiph'il* *does* occur elsewhere (2 chr 28:33), and Sam contains some non-standard forms elsewhere (eg. לעביר in 19:19), we retain Kt.

2 Sam 18:12

OG (Rahlf's) with καὶ εἶπε appears, based on usage elsewhere, to represent ואנכי. Probably the possibly of

vocalizing וְלֹא as here rather than as a negative did not occur to a tradent, who emended by deletion of לֹא.

2 Sam 18:22

See (among others) Jenni (3: 94).

2 Sam 19:1

The OG reading בְּבָכְתוֹ, is possible, though perhaps a bit strained, and it is derivable from בָּלַכְתוּ by a faint shaft on the *lamedh*. M, then, seems preferable on both intrinsic and transcriptional grounds.

2 Sam 19:7

It is not impossible that the Qr should be read, but cf. 18:12, which strongly suggests לֹא over לוֹ here. G might have had לוֹ, since (1) it apparently did not understand וְלֹא in 18:12, and (2) Q so reads, but this is probably an emendation (if not an aural error) in the G text.

2 Sam 20:5

Re Kt-Qr: See Concordia (380), who with some explanation cites Ges 68i.

2 Sam 20:14a

A difficult variant unit in a difficult verse (cf. Concordia 382-384 on the verse as a whole, p. 383 for this VU in particular). Here is our tentative solution: V (electi; the omission of the conjunction on fuerant as a rendering of וַיִּקְהֻלוּ is either paraphrase or recognition of the resumptive *waw*) has the true reading, בְּחָרִים, which in MT became בָּרִים by loss of a letter (admittedly without clear transcriptional cause, but the difficulties in the verse might have taxed the scribe into the error), a ghost form, and in G (ἐν Χαρτί; only here in OG) became בָּחָרִי by loss of the last letter (perhaps corrupt haplography in the paleo script). (P = MT, or nearly so. P understands בָּרִין as if it were the Syriac for “sons” with the Hebrew plural. The loss of the article is harder to explain, and probably does not originate with the translator as it is a bit odd. Perhaps the P *Vorlage* had suffered haplography or assimilation to the morphologically anarthrous forms in the verse so far?)

BDB sub בָּרִים cites “many” as likewise preferring the M reading.

{Post-script: For an explanation with a good linguistic basis for MT (=“the chosen ones”) see *The American Journal of Semitic Languages and Literatures* Vol. 34, No. 2 (Jan., 1918), pp. 130-31. G is to be explained not as above (which in any case did not account for the loss of the initial *he*), but as transposition + *he/chet* confusion + loss of a single letter (*mem*).}

2 Sam 21:9b

The reason for the Qr is hard to see, unless it is because הֵמָּה is more common than הֵם in Sam. Those responsible for the Qr readings might also have hypothesized haplography before the following הֵמָּה, which indeed is possible. Yet The Kt seems firmly entrenched in the MT tradition, and as there is no compelling reason to hypothesize הֵמָּה behind G, it seems best to retain Kt, if a bit tentatively.

2 Sam 21:12a

Re *first* Kt-Qr: Abbreviated spelling (cf. בֵּית שֵׁן for בֵּית שָׁן earlier in the verse; NICOT points this out, though I don't recall if it makes the connection explicit.)

2 Sam 21:12b

Second and third Kt-Qrs: Difficult. Could be wrong word division, especially as Sam rarely uses the article with פְּלִשְׁתִּים (if the Qr is accepted, the *pe* should have not {?} *daghesh*; cf. 23:16) (cf. later in our verse), but there are exceptions, while שָׁם occurs 91x in Sam but שָׁמָּה *never* occurs.

2 Sam 22:8

Ps 18:8 supports the Kt; the Qr could be an unnecessary correction or corrupt dittography.

2 Sam 22:15

Ps 18:15 supports the Kt; the Qr could be an unnecessary correction or dittography.

2 Sam 22:42

Viganò (13) relates a proposal to point לָא here, and עַל in the parallel passage (Ps 18:42). But MT seems easier, especially when it is recalled that Samuel is among the books that seemingly interchanges the prepositions אֶל and עַל, which would seem to be at play. At the least, that fact seems a more likely explanation for the difference than supposing that the not-rare לָא would be changed to the rare עַל.

2 Sam 23:1

For הָקָם עַל, Q has הָקָם אֶל, while OG has οὐκ ἀνέστησεν κυριος, which could represent הָקָם יְהוָה or be a loose translation of הָקָם אֶל (if the former, such could substitution of a more common word for a less common one). If Q is correct (as to אֶל; the spelling of הָקָם is probably a *plene* expansion, a very common move indeed in Q), M could be aural error. Driver (274; he knew OG, but not Q) accepts MT, as does Concordia (440-441).

2 Sam 23:5

Ges (135m) points out the difficulty of suffixed יִשְׁעִי being coordinated with unsuffixed חַפֵּץ. OG seems to match M on this matter, but I may need to verify {particularly with Gottingen if possible}. Might יִשְׁעִי be a noun of the type עֵדִי or רִגְלִי, i.e. an absolute form meaning something like “salvation” or “savior”? There is a name יִשְׁעִי attested extrabiblically, though this might be a shorted form of יִשְׁעִיאל or the like.

2 Sam 23:9

Re דָּדִי (=second Kt-Qr), note that OG^L reflects the Kt; cf. also 1 Chr 27:4.

2 Sam 23:20

Re first אֲרִיאֵל: Very difficult. OG seems to have had בְּנִי after שְׁנֵי; in 1 Chr 11:22 there is very slight Greek evidence for such. But even supposing these reading to be correct (and the passages are still rather mysterious if they are), if אֲרִיאֵל is a proper name, the form should be מְמוּאֵב for מוּאֵב – and so Driver emends – but there seems not to be any external support for such. Some suppose, perhaps correctly, that אֲרִיאֵל is some sort of a technical term (“paladin”); the difficult here is the grammatically singular form. The case is a mystery.

2 Sam 23:35

Re Kt-Qr: G= Qr; in the parallel passage (1 Chr 11:37), M = Kt here, and G = Qr here. It seems more likely that an error in G in both passage lead to assimilation in the other than that M has erred in the same while in both passages.

1 Ki 1:47

Intrinsic evidence favors Kt inasmuch as such language is used frequently elsewhere in the historical literature, e.g., v17. Qr could be *kaph/mem* confusion in the paleo script or assimilation to the more common form. Given these two quite plausible paths from Kt to Qr, it is probably not too significant that G agrees with Qr.

1 Ki 2:29

On the long plus in G see Concordia (322).

1 Ki 3:13

כִּי כָל יָמַי could be corrupt dittography, but this seems quite a stretch. G could be corrupt haplography in the paleo script. WBC (46) thinks that M is an addition “under the influence of v. 14.” But it is more likely in our view that the translator omitted the phrase here precisely because of its occurrence in v14, i.e. in avoidance of a redundancy offensive to good Greek style.

1 Ki 3:27

Is OG מן etc. loose translation, deliberate emendation, unconscious assimilation to the previous verse, or the preservation of an original reading? In the 1st edition of SRO, the interchange between al and lo occurs only in Isa 2:9, Ps 40:12, 41:3—though errors surrounding the grapheme לֹא are, it should be noted, many and various. Neither J-M (see 123o), nor HALOT, NET, CSB, or NEB seems to object to M here. But if לֹא here is used for emphasis—would not such be found on the lips of the mother, not Solomon? On the other hand, is this instance (like Dt 21:14, the only other perspective usage of לֹא with the cognate infinitive construction) judicial in formulation? On that point, note the repeated use of המלך in these verses and המשפט in v28. A MS from the Cairo Genizah so reads (Cambridge Semitic Languages and Cultures 3: 435), but Outwaite suspects assimilation to previous v.

1 Ki 5:5-6

Concordia (427-428) does not like the paragraph (ס) here. JC and Ginsburg agree with WLC, and the latter has no note. However, the Massoretic list (p. 488 = PDF file 4, location 69) given *no* section after v5 but *does* have one after v6. {Other sources potentially to look into: G, V (MS-based paragraphing in BHV?), P (but I don't know Leiden-Kings)} It is not clear how strong his reasoning is, however, or what the make of the external evidence.

1 Ki 6:5 (also v10)

That the same Kt-Qr occurs twice suggests that the Kt is right both times. The lexicography is obscure: Cf., e.g., HALOT 1: 427^b and 428^a.

1 Ki 6:6

On the Kt-Qr see on the previous verse and further Concordia 491-492.

1 Ki 6:33

HALOT (2: 1179b) wishes to read רבעית differently, questionably with (O)G, but the matter is obscure, and it seems safest to let M stand.

1 Ki 7:23

According to BDB the same Kt-Qr occurs in Jer 31:39 and Zech 1:16. The same error is unlikely to have occurred in the same direction three times, so the Kt has been retained throughout.

{Post-script: Jer 31:39, however, is probably an exception: See the textual commentary there.}

1 Ki 7:28

The OG transcription presupposes a plural, which is easier, but (1) *he/taw* errors do not appear to be common, and (2) G seems consistently to have a plural for the singular in (at least) this chapter (else the translator had trouble reading his MS and consistently understood this to be what he was seeing), so likely the same here. Rather, M is to be retained (identifying the type of architecture as a concept, before moving on to talking of the multiplicity.)

1 Ki 7:45

This Kt-Qr is difficult. The Qr האלה is tempting, yet (1) although it is supported by many MSS (Davidson confirms BHS on this point; indeed, he accepts the Qr) and T, it is easy to say how the change could be made many times from Kt to Qr (the former is difficult, and as a specific letter sequence occurs only 42x in the OT, in Kings only in 1:39, while the latter is relatively easy and as a letter sequence occurs 292x in the OT), while the reverse change is hard to explain, apart from careless transposition, and yet had a major impact on the MS tradition (a certain number of MSS, among them L and A, and P, and likely indirectly OG and V, as we will see). (2) The minus (OG V) makes good sense, but explaining the other readings is difficult (Corrupt dittography

seems a stretch), while the minus could be a secondary development via corrupt haplography if the Qr is the basis or via tradents ignoring words they do not understand if the Kt is the basis (and in both versions, the OG especially, this would not be an unexpected course of action).

In favor of Kt, not only does it explain the other readings (emendation / accidental transposition, and skipping over) but the Tent has been mentioned several times in Kings, and 8:4 seems to indicate that the Tabernacle served as a storage place for the vessels. The Kt could then be an accusative of location. In other words, a superficially difficult reading but one that ultimately works and which explains the others.

1 Ki 7:48

In favor of בבית: Haplography is a ready explanation, but so is assimilation, for the phrase בית יהוה occurs many times in the context.

{Post-script: But cf. (admittedly for Syriac, but the usage is strikingly similar; and note the possible Aramaic affinities elsewhere in Kings) Nöldeke §243. In Jer 29:26 the situation is probably different).}

1 Ki 8:26b

The tradition is pretty evenly divided between Kt and Qr. The latter could be an assimilation to the parallel passage. The niph'al of אמן is attested with both a singular and plural דבר as its concern. The Kt is preferable for three reasons: (1) It is probably (though admittedly not certainly) the original reading of the M tradition; (2) it is the harder reading (a plural noun with a singular verb); (3) the form דברך is not securely attested in Kings, while דברייך is.

1 Ki 8:35

See NET.

1 Ki 9:5

On מעל כסא cf. 2:4.

1 Ki 10:26

Cf. 2 Chr 1:14 (and BDB).

1 Ki 10:28

Cf. BHS.

1 Ki 11:39

On the pointing of the first word, see JM 24e (also Isa 41:25, Dt 24:10).

1 Ki 12:5

Against the suggestion to repoint עד, see the parallel passage (and further, Concordia here).

1 Ki 12:9

Could an inner-M assimilation to the previous verb, but note the parallel passage; unlikely the same error twice.

1 Ki 12:7

Concordia favors the Qr, partly on the basis of the parallel passage, but the external evidence for the Qr is not much to go off of and I am reluctant to appeal to chr without strong transcriptional and intrinsic factors calling for such.

1 Ki 12:8

J-M views the verse here (also 21:11) as “garbled” (p560 n3). But there does not seem to be good evidence—or, to my eye, the need—for alteration, granting a bit of a strange sort appositive structure.

1 Ki 13:33

So Ges 109f. The *naqdan* might have been influenced by מלא.

1 Ki 16:19

Cf. the notes on 2 Ki 21:17 below. M^A swaps Kt and Qr, but the *plene* spelling could be an assimilation.

1 Ki 16:24

See J-M 91b.

1 Ki 16:34

See Tov, *The Greek and Hebrew Bible*, 159-60, for an argument for the omission of this verse (with LXX^L).

1 Ki 17:1

Revisit (cf. J-M p281 n4).

1 Ki 17:14

As BHS apparently notes (the intent of its note is not completely clear to me), 6:19 gives support for the notion that the Kt is not an error, but a legitimate dialectical variation. Such would, moreover, not be surprising in this book. Transcriptional explanations are possible (here, corrupt dittography with the following *yodh*; in 6:19, mechanical repetition of the terminal *nun* of the preceding word but (especially when viewed in combination rather than isolation) strained).

1 Ki 18:6

See BHS b, noting also 7a. The latter plus is probably a separate matter, being G assimilation to the latter part of the present verse. With respect to the present verse, the minus could be an emendation based on the improbability of the claim that a king was wandering the wilderness entirely alone {precisely this scenario is suggested by a source cited in Concordia 2:1342-1343}. On the other hand, the plus could be a mechanical anticipation of the end of the verse, with its very similar wording (or even, if the plus in 7a is correct, to the two-fold occurrence of the word in a short span to follow).

Concordia retains MT; WBC reads the minus.

Given the unreliability of OG in 1 Ki and the unusual nature of the plus (were G accepted), it seems best to retain MT.

1 Ki 18:7

See BHS d. Perhaps *kaph/mem* confusion (in the paleo script) + transposition + addition of *waw* (either by way of emendation or by way of dittography based on the first letter of the following word).

1 Ki 19:1

M(T)'s ואת כל אשר הרג is a bit troubling, and some read either ואת אשר הרג or ואשר הרג. Of the two, the former is much more likely than the latter. But Holmstedt does not object, and there do seem to be at least somewhat comparable examples elsewhere, while this is exactly the sort of thing that translators would tend to smooth out. The safest approach, then, is to retain MT, if a bit tentatively.

1 Ki 19:18

Difficult. There may be something to be said for the 2nd person reading in G^L, yet is this compatible with Rom 11:4 (check Romans commentaries and NT use of OT commentary on this point)? If the G^L reading is accepted as the OG here, we have plausible external (viz. G) and internal (viz. homoeotetelueton of לי after the 1st person perfect qal ending) evidence, but G^L is not generally considered of primary importance in this section of 3 Reigns (though it is far from replicating MT!). (The V reading is not strong external evidence, and is suspicious

as possibly Jerome's assimilation to Rom 11:4.)

1 Ki 21:8

Kt could be corrupt dittography, but external evidence for this is very weak, and internal evidence seems equivocal.

1 Ki 21:10

Some OG witnesses have *maledixit* or *maledixisti*, which could point to קלל or קללת, respectively, for MT ברכת. But Kauhanen (317) thinks an inner-Latin emendation, which is eminently possible, Latin speakers, unlike OG users, having little to no exposure to the ברך "curse" euphemism.

1 Ki 21:25

See J-M p201 n1.

1 Ki 22:7

M^A and, according to Ginsburg, a handful of MSS and early editions, have מֵאָתוֹ, but this seems like an easier reading, whereas מאֹתוֹ is incorrect by the standards of many but reflects a particular dialect.

1 Ki 21:23

Reading חלק is quite unlikely due to the weak external evidence, the possibility of assimilation, and the rarity of the term חל. Moreover, the latter seems very nearly a synonym for חלק in a context of this sort: See CDCH.

2 Ki 1:2

See BHS ("cf. vers"). Apparently MT an inner-M error (haplography).

{Post-script: But the same issue occurs in 8:8, 9; as it is unlikely that M suffered haplography in all three places, and that an idiom is at work (note the slightly unusual זה), M is everywhere to be preferred.}

2 Ki 1:17

Part or all of this verse seems to be an interpolation based on the re-worked chronology found in G-Kings. See Hendel, Ronald S., "The Two Editions of the Royal Chronology in Kings, 99-114, esp. 107, in: *Textual Criticism and Dead Sea Scrolls Studies in Honor of Julio Trebolle Barrera*, ed. Otero, Andrés Piquer and Pablo. A. Torijano Morales, Brill, Leiden/Boston, 2012 {I do not own this book; got it on inter-library loan}

If so, perhaps MT and OG are both interpolated witnesses, like Prov and Sam (the former according to me, the latter according to Jason Dreisbach)? Or, if solid evidence of such is elsewhere lacking, perhaps a patchy exemplar used for the M tradition was here supplemented by an expansionistic text in the G tradition (but not, evidently a direct antecedent or descendent of the MS used by the OG translator(s); it would be good to check Göttingen and/or Cambridge on this verse). The situation would be similar to 2 Sam 5:4-5, where, according to Driesbach (see also research notes), the normally solid OG shares an interpolation with MT where 4QSam^a, normally not a pristine representative of the G text, witnesses the short text.

{Post-script: But see Kitchen *On the Reliability of the OT*, chapter 1, who sees multiple systems in place, making for a very complex situation, yet finds the MT virtually or entirely pristine (does not specifically discuss this VU). Moreover, the essentials of this M-plus are found in the even lengthier G-plus after the next verse.}

2 Ki 3:2

Cf. 1 Ki. 14:23, 2 Ki. 3:2, 10:26, 10:27 (we have repointed there), 17:10, 18:4, 23:14.

2 Ki 3:19

Against dropping מִבְּחֹר וּכְלֵי עֵיר, doublets occur more often *before* the genuine material, while this could have been lost from (O)G either due to haplography or to avoidance of redundancy.

2 Ki 3:25

It is possible that השאיר should be repointed (cf. HALOT 2:1377a), but the grammars I checked do not object to MT as it stands. (Burney, 271-272 suggests a more thorough reworking of this verse, but his solution, though interesting, seems to be depend in part on a conjecutre.)

2 Ki 4:23b

Re the *second* Kt: The question is whether the dialectical *-i* feminine occurs with participles. If so, Kt is to be preferred. If not, Kt can be ascribed to mechanical assimilation to the previous word (in its Kt form).

2 Ki 5:1

It seems worth entertaining whether גבור חיל is a corrupt dittograph of מצרע. Seems a stretch, however, and these words could easily have been omitted from (O)G as contradictory to what follows.

2 Ki 5:12

The Qr seems much preferable on intrinsic grounds, yet it is hard to believe that the only external evidence for a reading would be T P where those witnesses, being Aramaic, are precisely the witnesses most likely to emend based on geographical knowledge.

{Post-script: Actually, the Kt is probably a legitimate form: cf. Lipiński on b/m interchanges in Semitic.}

2 Ki 6:11

Cf. BDB sub פ (either BDB, or the BibleWorks9 representation of it, wrongly cites v12). The root is מגן, “deliver over.” On the form possibly cf. Ges 52s. “Who betrays us?” M substitutes a single letter, probably under the influence of a late Hebrew construction, plus exhibits *waw/yodh* confusion; this slight adjustment, which has ancient support (OG), alleviates what would seem to be a linguistic anachronism. Also, though BDB disagrees, I don't think אָל by itself can easily be explained as bearing the sense that would be necessary under the M reading; לָ would be better for that purpose.

{Post-script: But see WBC, noting further that this might be a sort of Aramaic parody, like the examples given in the article {} . Burney (285) also has some detailed comments here, and seems on the whole to prefer MT.}

2 Ki 6:30

OG has עמד. Verse 26 confirms MT here. OG is simply a visual error: *Beth/mem* confusion + *daleth/resh* confusion.

2 Ki 7:6

On the basic concept see WBC and especially HALOT. The absence of the article is a bit problematic, but elsewhere there is demonstrable inconsistency, even in parallel terms, of arthrous and anarthrous states in biblical Hebrew. (The other cited verses seem not to hold up: In most, the reference is to importation, then resale *to the Hittites*, who would hardly buy with the Israelites as a middle man if the ultimate source was the Musrim, but would if the ultimate source was the Egyptians; the reference in Deuteronomy, meanwhile, uses “return” language, and so can refer only to Egypt.)

2 Ki 7:13

Re Kt-Qr: While Kt could be dittography (cf. Ges 127f), there are a few other examples of this sort of construction, especially with ישראל, that cannot be explained this way. Note also the (dialectical?) anomaly in the previous verse (בהשדה).

2 Ki 8:25

Possibly this verse should say the *eleventh* year with G and 9:29. Hendel, “Two Editions,” 109, thinks that 8:25 and 9:29 should both read *twelfth*, but there does not seem to be textual support for *twelfth* in 9:29 (there e*

readings δεκατω ["tenth"]. Or perhaps M is correct in both places (check commentaries on how to reconcile the apparent discrepancy).

{Postscript: Steinmann (*From Abraham to Paul*) does not handle this explicitly, but if I am reading him right, he thinks that MT can and should stand (I believe that one verse uses a Judean system of calculation, the other verse, an Israelite).}

2 Ki 8:28

//2 chr הרמים which might mean “the archers” and might represent the original text here (cf. Burney, 296) (if so, this would be a place where chr preserves a reading that predates the M-G split). However, הרמים in a late book like Chronicles might be an alternative spelling of הארמים, given the weakening of the guttural sounds in late Hebrew.

2 Ki 9:18

On the orthography, cf. Crellin p. 240

(https://crewsproject.files.wordpress.com/2022/01/the-semantics-of-word-division_print_1.pdf).

2 Ki 9:28

Regarding BHS a: It is not clear to me what the MS basis is for BHS's reconstruction of the OG. As for the similar but different pluses in P V, does this indicate that the problem they saw in M was real?

{But it is not clear that P *does* have any plus, which much weakens the case for one, especially as V might be following the lead of OG here.}

2 Ki 10:10

The idiom in the *plural* in Jdg 23:14 and 1 Sam 3:19, but in the *singular* in Jdg 21:45 and 1 Ki 8:56. That last passage, being part of the same book as our verse, shows pretty clearly that the intrinsic evidence is on the side of the singular (=M). And there is a transcriptional explanation for the plural (=G): Dittography before יהוה.

2 Ki 10:15

BHS says “ins ויאמר cf [GPV].” I have not looked into P here, but BSV gives the original text of V as lacking any plus here (and inner-latin corruption to smooth over the difficulty – or, less likely, to conform to the OG – is not hard to imagine), and OG has καὶ εἶπεν Ιου, which, unless we assume that the translator made the subject explicit (possible to be sure), represents not ויאמר but יהוא. Whether the plus is one word or two (but especially in the latter case), a transcriptional cause for the minus is somewhat hard to see.

Tentatively, we propose that (1) the minus is original, (2) the phrase ייש ויש being, like אמן ואמן or in later Hebrew לא ולא, emphatic and (3) Jehonadab being the one soliciting an extension of a hand (Jehu's hand), which is given (ויתן ידו). (Possibly in support of this view is the idea that the first person whose explicit name drops is the one who acquiesces.) (4) Some tradents subsequently failed to follow the train of events and, assuming that it was Jehu who solicits the hand, made an attempt to clear matters up. Admittedly, v16 could support the idea that the joint venture was Jehu's idea, but such does not seem *necessarily* to follow.

2 Ki 10:24

That is, “The man *who suffers to escape* any of the men” (Burney 305, emphasis original).

2 Ki 10:29

Cf. the parallel בן later in the verse. The loss of *beth* here was possibly facilitated not only by the following *beth*, but also by the preceding *resh*, since the top of that letter looks rather like the top of a *beth*. Also, בית occurs in L 1028x, whereas בבית occurs only 178x.

{Post-script: But cf. on 1 Ki 7:48. M is probably efficient writing, and it is far from clear that OG's εἰ here even reflects a different *Vorlage* given the translation style.} {And note in any case parallel constructions like that in 2 Sam 2:32. M can certainly stand.}

2 Ki 11:14

Repointing w/ OG השירים has some plausibility (WBC accepts it), but cf., from the parallel account, 2 chr 23:9.

2 Ki 12:10

It is hard to be sure what we are looking at V P, especially given the interest of those versions in clarity; T has inner-aramaic variants that are difficult for me to assess. G^L clearly reflects Kt. A clear difference is seen in the origin of the text carried by G^B in the Kaige and non-Kaige sections, for in 3 Reigns מימין is rendered εκ δεξιων, but here in 4 Reigns 12:9 [according to the Cambridge versification; =PDF loc 152] it has παρα λαμβιν. Now παρα there *might* indicate a *Vorlage* מימין, but I suspect such to be an inner-M secondary reading, reflecting a harmonizing impulse found also in the Qr.

While Kt could be a visual error, for this error to have taken place *twice* (viz. once, most likely, in proto-M; and certainly in G), especially to create an expression nowhere else known (though the form בימין, with different vocalization and meaning, occurs in Isa 41:10), seems less than likely. Accordingly, we tentatively take the Kt to be a legitimate expression, though the matter is difficult.

2 Ki 14:2

Kt corrupt dittography? But NB OG. Parallel passage = morphological hypercorrection? Kt appears to be an alternative morphology (cf. BDB).

2 Ki 16:3

Cf. 2 chr 28:3 (as noted by BHS) and OG here (ibid).

2 Ki 16:18

We have tentatively kept the Kt (on the pointing of which see HALOT 1:557^a) because this word, whether Kt or Qr, is basically unknown, so it seems best to keep M(T) until further evidence is forthcoming. (CDCH 208b lists “covered way,” “bench,” “divan,” “fence,” and “rampart” as possible meanings—none of which seem to make much sense in context.)

2 Ki 17:7

Re the OG plus noted in BHS “a”: M does seem unusually terse, so perhaps the phrase was dropped by accident (though there is no clear visual trigger). On the other hand, similar phraseology is apparently added in (O)G-Kings several times elsewhere (2 Ki 1:18, 22:13, 23:26), perhaps inspired by phraseology frequent in chr (see 2 chr 12:12, 19:2, etc.).

2 Ki 17:14

See BHS “b.” The *mem* could have been lost due to visual similarity with *samekh*, though it certainly could have been added also (in some of the versions surely the sense is simply smoothed out by the translator). More data on the author's style in such matters would be helpful here.

2 Ki 17:16

Re Kt-Qr: The Kt is valid (שָׁנִים) but does *not* have an enclitic *mem*. Cf., e.g., J-M 100c.

2 Ki 18:11

BHS sub נוה thus reads, noting the wording וישב אותם in a similar context in 17:6.

2 Ki 19:23

It is difficult to be sure how אדני should be pointed here. If it is pausal, as is suggested the causal nuance of the following *wayiqtol* and the summarizing nature of the clause in which אדני is situated, then MT should probably be retained. So also Isa 37:24.

2 Ki 19:24

Tawil (208b) wants to read *zerem* for *zariym*, but I am not aware of external support for this.

2 Ki 20:7

Re ויחי: Note the Isaiah parallel, the lack of a specified grammatical subject, and the apparent reference to a *future* healing in v8.

2 Ki 20:12

The loss of ויחי could be due to (1) its small size, (2) near haplography after חזקיהו, which ends with a smaller letter as ויחי ends in, (3) visual similarity to the following word (itself a VU, but not likely in a way that affects this VU), (4) the fact that the verse is sensible without it, (5) or some combination of these. Note that the parallel passage has a synonym, not this exact word (though G could be an assimilation to v7 of our present chapter).

{Post-script: But there seems to be a pattern of assimilations and/or pluses in G, over against a comparatively laconic, yet intelligible, M in this section.}

2 Ki 21:13

So Ges 113h n².

2 Ki 21:17

In the other cases where the phrase אשר חטא occurs in Kings, the subject is plural.

2 Ki 22:5

NB this situation is not to be confused with that in 1 Ki 7:48, for here the external evidence, and possibly also the syntax, are different.

2 Ki 23:4

Cf. HALOT (2:1423a) and Burney (357). There seem to be arguments for and against adjusting the reading here. {Marginal reading, or revisit?}

2 Ki 23:7a, b

“woven dress[es]” (HALOT 1:166b).

2 Ki 24:10

Re Kt-Qr, cf. Ges 145o.

2 Ki 24:15

On the pointing of the Kt see BDB.

{Post-script: But see now HALOT 1:21b.}

Is 1:2

Perhaps with Q הארץ is to be read? For then there would be alliteration between האזינו and its subject as between שמעו and its subject (cf. Young *ad loc*). However, not only is the external support dubious, but the second verb is more precisely והאזינו, and in the acrostic poems the conjunctive *waw* is given its full force; in other words, if in the second line of Isaiah’s poem strict alliteration had been sought, the subject of the verb would have had to begin with *waw*, or else asyndeton would have been used.

Isa 1:20

See Tawil (119a-b) together with (less confidently) ICC (“charobs”); the pointing follows CDCH and Jastrow, however.

Isa 1:25

Tawil (160a) makes a good case for an emendation, but see ICC.

Isa 2:4

Re וְהִנֵּיתֶם: See THBS 3: 47-48. Since the change from וְהִנֵּיתֶם to וְהִנֵּיתֶם occurs several times in Q MSS (relative to MT), perhaps MT has itself suffered that error here. However, (1) as noted there, the diachronics here and gradual and uneven, (2) Q could be an assimilation to earlier in the verse, and (3) Isaiah prefers the longer form overall (see Isa. 2:4, 13:16, 36:12, 49:23, 51:7, 56:7, 58:1, 59:5, 7-8, 60:8, 65:2, 66:4, 18 ← from BibleWorks 9 = all occurrences of feminine plural absolute nouns with a masculine plural suffix).

Is 2:22

[from email to Joey 11/29/17:]

Thanks for pointing this out! Assuming the LXX originally did not have v22, and such seems to be the case, this is a significant VU. I can only answer provisionally at this point, but I'm pretty sure the verse is authentic. M in Isaiah does not, as far as I am aware, show many major expansionist tendencies, but LXX-Is is famously drastic in its approach to the text. THB concludes that there are few textual differences between M and G in Isaiah, even as the LXX is vastly different because of interpreting renderings. I have been aware of some time of a heavily targumic/midrashic approach on the part of the Isa translator; what's new to me from THB (though sadly it's not developed in detail there) is that there is also a Hellenistic element. Most relevant to this VU is this statement (489b-490a): "LXX-Isa is also marked by a large number of minuses and pluses and it has been demonstrated that often these are due to stylistic preferences also known from classical rhetorical style in the Hellenistic period." The Vulgate seems unanimously to support the presence of v22. As far as I know, that version is exceedingly close to M, so this is to be expected.

Isa 2:10

While OG could easily be assimilated to verses 19 and 21 (so can der Vorm-Crouchs 292), (1) those verses are *so* formulaic that it seems intrinsically likely that Isaiah would have used the same refrain here – i.e., intrinsic evidence from authorial usage seems to ought weigh arguments for assimilation to authorial usage – and (2) the absence of this expression from 1QIs^a and other witnesses shows that that the urge to assimilate in such a case is *not* universal.

{Post-script: Yet the collocated phraseology in vv19 and 21 are not identical, so “so formulaic” is an exaggeration. Given the weak textual basis of OG, it seems best not to depart from M here.}

Isa 3:12

For מְעוֹלֵיכֶם it seems to be that OG either read or understood מְעוֹלֵיכֶם (I am inclined to the latter interpretation of the OG, i.e. that he never saw any Hebrew text other than MT); either way, there seems to be little to no external evidence for reading עָלְלוּ (so NET) or the like.

That said, the word need not mean “child.” It could simply be the polel participle “be violent, oppressive,” with נָגִישִׁי being understood as a plural of majesty (like אֲדוֹן). In that case one may wish to point וְנָשִׁים, though understanding “women” here might not be a *non sequitur*. Furthermore, the verse as a whole condemns faulty leadership, not predatory economics.

Isa 3:16

Tentatively following J-M 75v, here and in 1 Sam 25:18b. For a possible different approach (to the vocalization), cf. THBS 3:90.

(Ps 105:28 is different: See the textual commentary there. J-M also lists הַעֲשׂוֹם in 2 Ki 23:4, but this is odd indeed as WLC 4.14 (=4.20), MM, Gi, and VDH all have עֲשׂוֹם; K lists a very small number of MSS for הַעֲשׂוֹם.)

Isa 5:18

NICOT cites Dahood's suggestion that שׂוֹא here = Ugaritic “sheep.” However, this identification appears not to be correct (cf. Huehnergard: The Hebrew cognate is שָׂה, not שׂוֹא* or שׂוֹא; perhaps for this reason, CDCH lists no such entries). This being the case, the best reading of the verse seems to be that of MT.

Isa 5:28

Tawil (319b) wishes to repoint MT, possibly rightly, but see ICC.

Iaa 5:30

There are suggestions to repoint the last word (see CDCH 244a-b and, tentatively, HALOT 1: 884a), but it is probably best to leave the obscure form as-is (cf. ICC).

Isa 6:11

ICC (26-27) makes a good case for reading תִּשְׁאֵר. It is something to revisit, but I still tend to prefer M (rarer term).

Isa 7:1

ICC (139) makes a strong case for reading YHWH (note that the scroll agrees with M in 6:1, making its different reading here more suggestive. Still, MT is far from impossible and the YWHW → adonay error is common, so, pending a more comprehensive study of all related points of variation, I retain MT.

Isa 7:3

Viganò (3) raises a proposal (from Watson?) to point אֵל here, but in v13 Isaiah is clearly referred to in the third person, so chances are he is here as well.

Isa 7:20b

See Ges 126x.

Isa 8:2

ICC (204-206) argues for the reading וְהָעַד for diachronic reasons. I would like to revisit this and related cases, but this would require fairly in-depth linguistic investigation; and in the present case, it is hard to see a plausible path from Q to M.

Isa 8:8

See ICC (232).

Isa 8:11

Re BHS “ב”: It is possible that the verb should be repointed as a perfect, but a preterite prefix-form sometimes appears after a temporal marker (like Ex 15:1), so it seems best to retain the MT pointing, which is indeed a bit hard to explain apart from originality.

Isa 10:13b

I believe this is one of those places where the Kt in one place is the Qr of another (see ICC).

Is 10:9

Is כלנו an error for כלנה, made at a time when a terminal *he* often stood for /o/? Or, conversely, is כלנה elsewhere to be repointed?

Isa 10:10

ICC (486) leans toward the plural הַאֲלִילִים, noting that the singular occurs nowhere else. However, external support for the plural is rather weak (G is best explained as a separate corruption based on M, thus indirectly supporting M), and the plural could either be emendation or corrupt dittography (note the visually similar first two letters of the following word). Admittedly, M could be near haplography, but on balance M seems somewhat more likely to be original.

Isa 10:11

The form הִלֵּא is almost certainly correct; cf. ICC and esp. J-M (under interrogative clauses).

Isa 11:14

Re כַּתָּף see HALOT 1: 506b, NEB, BHS, BDB (this last, tentatively); cf. Ges 93hh.

Isa 11:15

See Talmon 160-61.

{Post-script: But see ICC (682-684).}

Isa 14:12

It is possible that הִלֵּל should be repointed הִלָּל (see esp. HALOT), but the evidence is not altogether clear, and the reading tradition must have come from somewhere, so provisionally it seems best not to deviate from MT unnecessarily.

While it is possible that G read על כל for על (so, tentatively, BHS), it is also possible to interpret OG as reflecting על כל, if indeed the *Vorlage* differs from M at all. With such an obscure verb, it seems hazardous to delete the preposition, since we hardly know the collocations of the verb, and all the more with the uncertainty of the testimony of OG.

Isa 16:10

So QPVTG. Near haplography after the preceding final *nun*; else, assimilation to the preceding לָא.

{Post-script: But Isaiah seems to favor asyndeton in ways that are fairly unique to him, e.g. 27:4 [where, to be sure, some witnesses read וְשִׁית].}

Isa 16:14

Textual or pointing adjustment has been proposed—see HALOT 2:1378b (where v4 is a typo for v14)—but it is not clear if adjustment to MT is necessary.

{But it fits the parallelism much better and is explainable both positively in terms of the frequent usage of the qal stem in ancient Hebrew and negatively in terms of the nonexistence of the qal stem of this verb in later Hebrew on account of which the naqdanim often struggled in cases like this}

Isa 17:10

1QIsa^a reads שְׂכַחְתִּי, and Ulrich (2:484) suggests that this is the “morph bi-form... 2nd fem sing perf.” Such is intriguing, but this ending seems not to occur elsewhere in Isaiah, is against 4QIsa^b ad loc, and 1QIsa^a is not a very compelling witness. Perhaps a mechanical backwards assimilation to the letter / sound with which כִּי terminates?

Isa 19:18

Most likely the primal M reading is הֶהָרִם: So almost all MT MSS, and Aq Th P (via transliteration; did they do this because they did not understand the word or simply because it is a place name?). T has a conflate reading. V translates הֶהָרִם, but was this his *Vorlage*, or a tradition known to him? Much the same question poses itself with regard to Sym (is Jerome dependent on him?) 1QIsa^a has הֶהָרִם, but it at best a weak representative of the M text,

though it is on the other hand a very weak representative indeed of the G text if it is to be grouped with G.

For G all we clearly have is OG, which transliterates הַצִּדְקָה. Such is certainly tendentious, but is it a pro-Egyptian diaspora polemic, reacting against הַהֶרֶס, or an anti-idolatry polemic, reacting against הַחֶרֶס (understood as a reference to אֵוֶן)? The liberties OG takes with the rendering of this passage suggest that the Jewish diaspora in Egypt is *not* what came to the translator's mind, though there may be debate on this point in the secondary literature. If so, perhaps what (ultimately) lies beneath OG is in fact הַהֶרֶס, i.e. there was fundamental M-G split with regard to this word, only an alternative reading (or rabbinic interpretation?) of הַהֶרֶס as הַחֶרֶס.

If יִקְרָא is future-oriented, it makes little sense, inasmuch as On is an ancient and famous locale; but it can be sensible if the sense is present (“one of these five cities is [now] known as On”). The intrinsic evidence along these lines seems ambiguous.

Most object to הַהֶרֶס as a judgment term in a salvation context, yet note the previous word! The comments of Young are perhaps a bit eisegetical, yet he may be on to something, viz. judgment and purging of idolatry precedes mercy and worship of God.

It seems best, then, to retain MT, though the matter remains unclear.

Isa 20:2

Re BHS “a”: While the external evidence cited for וְנַעֲלִיךְ is impressive on first glance, and MT could be near haplography in the paleo script (loss of *yodh* before *kaph*), (1) the loss of a similar letter *before* another letter may be less likely than if it were *after*, (2) most of these texts/versions have a significant facilitating element, Aq being the exception; (3) in collocation שֶׁל with נַעַל plus רֶגֶל, the latter two terms can be singular (Ex 3:5) or plural (Josh 5:15); (4) the form וְנַעֲלִיךְ could be a mechanical assimilation to the preceding מַתְנִיחַ. Note that the spelling רֶגְלִיךְ in L later in the verse is probably incorrect (see the textual commentary there). A decision is hard to make; tentatively, we retain L here.

Isa 23:12

On the Kt see Jer 2:10.

Isa 24:3

Against inserting פִּי here, see Tov (*Text-critical Use*) 68, noting also 25:8.

Isa 25:8

Against inserting פִּי here, cf. Tov (*Text-critical Use*) 68.

Isa 28:4

WLC has transcriber note 1, but note MM has the same form, so this seems not to be an L-specific infelicitous pointing.

Isa 29:22

Cf. Viganò (31-32). While MT is sensible (“concerning the house of Jacob”), it is awkward, and this pointing fits Isaiah's distinctive style very well in that he often elsewhere uses apposition to the proper name in the formula כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה (e.g. אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל in 37:21, גֹּאֲלֶךָ וַיִּצְרֹךְ מִבְּטֶן in 44:24; see also 38:5, 43:1, 43:14, etc.), even at times, as apparently here, apposition which has particular reference to God's fore-knowing of the elect.

Isa 30:6

Cf. NET {+other commentaries?}.

Isa 32:1

With BDB, I suppose mechanical anticipation of the following prefix (alternatively: vertical confusion with the visually similar לַצִּדְקָה).

An alternative approach would be to see an asseverative *lamedh*, but if the parallelism is somewhat

against this, and the mechanical explanations given just now seem more likely.

{Post-script: Yet would a letter inserted by *lapis calami* be placed in its appropriate position, viz. *after* the conjunction? Cf. also Watson (*Classical Hebrew Poetry*) on this verse. Tentatively, a mere pointing change is here made, but a marginal reading would surely be merited.}

Isa 35:7

See HALOT 1181b *ad fin* and the cited Ges passage (115k, iirc).

Isa 36:11

For החומה we might perhaps read the defective החמה on the basis of the quotation in 2 Ki 18:26. However, (1) the same variation viz-a-viz 2 Ki occurs in the very next verse, and (2) the phrase על החמה is always defective in Kings. So the defective spelling in Kings is quite possibly a feature of that author's spelling habits, *not* evidence of an original defective spelling in Isaiah.

From another direction, while there are a number of cases of Ki beings defective where Isa is plene, a range of different searches leads me tentatively to include that the author of Ki is distinctly defective in his preferences, while Isaiah is distinctively plene is his preferences—at least as present evidence goes. I would like to see more concrete evidence that MT-Isa is (to a much higher degree than MT-Ki) afflicted in its transmission as it relates to orthographic matters before concluding that scribal error, not the author of King's preferences, has led to these discrepancies.

Isaiah 36:12

On the spelling of החומה, cf. the previous note.

Isa 37:18

For a rather complicated argument (basically for accepting the 2 Ki reading) see Talmon 295-97.

Isa 38:21-22

Tov (Intro, 310-11) argues that these verses, apparently absent originally from 1QIsa^a or from its exemplar, are secondary. Yet the position is odd, external evidence is not strong, and the short reading could easily be due to homoeotueluton.

Isa 40:6

Re חסדו: A difficult case, as it relates to both external and internal evidence.

External: OG has δοξα ανθρωπου, which would be a unique equivalence (NICOT 44n⁸). While this reading could be an adjustment to 1 Pet 1:24 (where there is a various concerning ανθρωπου, but such is beside the present point), it more probable that the latter passage confirms the OG reading here. There is good ground for retroverting הדר (see. e.g., OG-2:10). P has יאיוחה, which is not a common word in Syriac. The fact that it is used in P-1 Pet 1:24 suggests that its reading here could be based on that passage. I do not know, however, if P-1 Pet or P-Isa was translated first. I also do not know {check THB} whether P-Isa knows OG-Isa. Looking at occurrences of הדר elsewhere in MT-Isa, P tends to use the Syriac cognate, but in 53:2 uses זיוה; the upshot is that *if* P is not here following 1 Pet 1:24, יאיוחה would be a plausible rendering of הדרו. The same is *not* true of חמדו. The situation is very similar for V: Jerome might be matching his translation of 1 Pet 1:24 (I'm not sure which book he did first) and/or showing the influence of OG-Isa (which he certainly knew); on the other hand, his translation does seem to retrovert well to הדרו, but not well to חמדו. T has תקפהון, which is hard to explain. WBC cites an opinion that חסד can mean “strength,” which is quite uncertain but if so could explain this phenomenon. In sum, G most likely read הדרו; P and V, if they are based on a *Hebrew* text (rather than on the OG or on a Greek, Syriac, or Latin text of 1 Pet 1:24), also likely reflect הדרו.

Internal: In terms of intrinsic evidence, “glory” could pick up on the thought expressed otherwise in 40:2, 12ff. But “dependability” (I got this translation from at least one of the commentaries; while the semantics of חסד are much debated, note in this connection Ps 62:13) fits well with ודבר אלהינו יקום לעולם, which seem to

stand in contrast to the beginning of our verse. In terms of transcriptional evidence, either reading *could* be a graphic error for the other, but as חסד is almost 10x more common in the OT, it seems more likely that הדר would be confused for חסד than the reverse. On the other hand, חסד might have been replaced, in G, deliberately for the reason that (as witnessed by the usual OG equivalence ελεος) the sense of the word in the *late* Second Temple period increasingly phased into *mercy*, which does not make good sense here. (Perhaps a similar rationale underlies T?)

Tentatively, we retain M, as apparently better on intrinsic grounds, and as (possibly) better explaining the rival reading.

{Opinions: McKenzie (16) follows M, but tentatively. }

{Post-script: See DCH (2nd ed.) for an important philological suggestion.}

Isa 41:24

Re מאפע *Pace* Davidson, BDB, and McKenzie (33) מאפע should *not* be read, for not only is the external evidence weak (not only is it restricted to V T Saadia, but OG εκ ηης most likely reflects מארע, a *pe/resh* visual error read as Aramaic, which at as to the final letter, which is the crucial point here, agrees with MT), but there is now ample evidence that אפע is a real word that bears an appropriate sense (see HALOT).

Isa 41:25

IIRC, the issue is not the need for a passive sense per se (else qal would be suitable), but specifically the need for the niph'al stem with this lexeme in such cases.

Isa 42:5

So BHS here and BHQ-Ecc 111*.

Isa 42:20

Re Kt-Qr: The Qr seems to be an assimilation to the infinitive פקוח later in the verse, but such is unnecessary, since an infinitive can follow a finite verb, and the difference between תשמר and ישמע suggests a difference. G *might* have read ראיתם by corrupt dittography, or *possibly* ראות, but its rendering of this v is sufficiently paraphrastic to make any such retroversion hazardous indeed. V P T support M.

{For what it's worth, McKenzie (45) reads 2pl, citing versions and MSS.}

Isa 42:22

"In holes." Note the parallelism with "prisons." (NET's note has a *he/chet* error, reflected also in its transcription [the latter b/c done by an editor??].) {Cf. McKenzie, 45.}

Isa 43:9

Another option is to read יגידו with 1QIsa^b (cf. 1QIsa^a ויגדו), but while MT could be haplography, Q could be dittography or assimilation, and it seems to me problematic to have a *plural* verb with מי as the subject. The plural verbs beyond ישמיענו, which we re-point, are part of a separate stich, and the shift in grammatical number there can plausibly be ascribed to stylistic variation on Isaiah's part. {McKenize (52) seemingly takes the approach I do, though tentatively.}

Isa 44:5

See on 41:25 above.

Isa 44:9

Re המה: A difficult case. THBS 3:312 seems to think that the minus is preferable. MT transmits cancellation dots, and המה could be corrupt dittography after ויעילו. But dittographs usually come *before* the true text, and, while each of the versions (viz. OG P V T) is difficult to retrovert, each (especially T) seems more likely to support the *plus* than to support the *minus*. 1QIsa^a has המה "placed supralinearly" (THBS 3: 312), a circumstance

which is difficult to assess: It could be a self-corrected error coincidentally matching up with the effect of the cancellation dots, or awareness of the variant; either way, it seems to attest, at least indirectly, to the existence of the long reading. Those cancellation dots, meanwhile, where found in *MT* often (always?) seem text-critical, i.e. conjectural, in intent, not merely self-correcting.

Lacking clarity, we retain *MT*. {McKenize (66) does not comment, though he does emend ויעדיהם to ויעבדיהם.}

Isa 47:13

Re מאשר: Some (e.g. WBC, McKenzie (90), NICOT tentatively) prefer אשר, for which there likely is (versional) external evidence, while others (e.g. BDB, though without comment) retain. Dittography is indeed possible, but the external evidence is a bit suspect, and it seems sense can be made of *MT* as it stands (see, for instance, Rotherham) or by revocalization such that מאשר is a form of מה אשר.

Isa 51:17

While כוס *could* be a gloss on קבעת (so, e.g., McKenzie [120]), the external evidence is dubious (Sym here and (O)G P in v22), and this could be a version of Isaiah's love of repetition.

Isa 52:5

Not all agree (see NET), but this appears to be a mixed form (see Ges 55b).

Isa 52:6a, b

Cf. Jenni (3: 284) and comparable forms a couple of times elsewhere.

Isa 53:8

See GKC §103f n³ (p302)

Isa 56:7

McKenzie (150) follows Iqisaa, saying “Heb. is awkward without a verb.” But the external evidence is dubious, as the need for a plus here.

Isa 57:19

HALOT 1: 677^b calls for reading the Qr, but ib. 696a note a Ben Sirach *v.l.* that lends intrinsic support to the Kt.

Isa 58:14

See WLC note “n.” (BibleWorks9 has instead a Kt-Qr here, but BibleWorks9 is based on WLC 4.14, whereas SRO ed. 1 is based on the text and transcription notes of WLC 4.20.)

Isa 59:3

See Ges 51h.

Isa 59:5

It is possible that *MT*'s בקעו is haplography (THBS 3) for the imperfect, but it is hard to be sure, and the external evidence for such is not extremely strong. {McKenzie does not comment.}

Isa 63:4

As BHS notes, 54:1 points to this vocalization.

Isa 63:1-6

Perhaps repoint wayiqtol and w'yiqtols? (Such is apparently the premise of an essay which I have not read in ed. Wasserman, *Studies in Isaiah*.)

Isa 63:3

On the Q reading see CDCH sub 7י. While M could be an emendation to avoid an impropriety, probably not, for (1) ancient literature, including early Rabbinic literature, is not averse to sexual discussion; (2) Q does not fit the context; (3) Q could be a sectarian reading disrespecting opponents in Jerusalem, since in the Qumranites' view sex was not permissible within the city limits of Jerusalem (Rendsburg, TGC).

Isa 63:18

While it seems possible that the *lamedh* is marking the object, Jenni (3: 273) is troubled, and, deferring to his expertise, I assume that is not the case. Instead, I hypothesize an asseverative *lamedh*. (Note the nearby form, and elsewhere in Isaiah.) But, as it happens, the (probably mistaken) idea of the *naqdan* that the form is arthrous leads to the correct pointing for our purposes.

Isa 65:4a

In defense of M, see Tawil (246b).

Isa 65:7

Re Kt-Qr: It is hard to rule out that the Kt is assimilation to earlier in the verse or aural error, but in such a matter the ancient versions of are of little help (esp. OG), and the difference between these prepositions is subtle or nonexistent in certain contexts and/or dialects, so it seems safest to stick with MT, at least pending further research. {McKenzie does not comment.}

Jer in general

G adds אלהים or אלהי after כה אמר יהוה in 22:30, 23:37, 39:26, but these are most likely unconscious assimilation (perhaps at the LXX level?)

The THB table on the OAN gives slightly different references because it attempts simultaneously to account for certain G minuses; Zeigler's table is arguably easier to understand

Jer 1:18

Concerning ברזל ברזל, see Talmon 323-27. Apparently Janzen favors the long reading as well: See p. 119.

Jer 2:3

The “Lucianic” (in the terminology of Zeigler, Talmon) text of LXX-Jer reflects אבא, for which תבא could be a transcriptional error (so tentatively Talmon 142). Yet (see *ibid*) either form could be an assimilation to similar phraseology elsewhere in Jer, and this texttype within the LXX is not thought to particularly strong. Thus MT probably ought to be accepted along with the majority of Greek MSS.

Jer 2:8

It is possible that לא should be pointed as an asseverative and איה יהוה be understood in a derisive sense. However, this exact phrase occurs in the sense of invoking God in 2 Ki 2:14, so איה יהוה could be a good thing in which case the present context would require a negator. More importantly, probably, just two verses before (v6) the same phraseology was used, with the idea of *not* invoking God. While it might be possible to point as an asseverative in both, it seems best to retain the negative (=MT) pointing.

Jer 2:15

Re Kt-Qr see Ges 145k.

Jer 2:16a

From root רעע II “shatter”; s0 (at least) NET, OTL.

Jer 2:18

The גיהון of G does not seem to make sense and is probably a transcriptional error (illegible first letter, last letter similar in some scripts).

Jer 2:19

The LXX εδοκαησα might represent הפצתי (cf. Mal 2:17; εδοκαεω most often renders רצה), of which פחדתי could be a transcriptional error (transposition plus an illegible letter?). On the other hand, הפך seems never to be used with the preposition אל, and G could be a transcriptional error.

BHS proposed reading פחדתי אלי on the basis of VP, but while assimilation of the suffix on אלי to that of אלהיך several words earlier could have happened twice (once in MT and once in G), such seems a bit unlikely.

Jer 2:24

OG supports Qr (αυτης). Kt resulted from the left half of the *he* being illegible or overlooked, an error attested on occasion elsewhere.

{Post-script: But as ICC (43) notes, “the incongruence of למד remains”; so the Qr “is a response to this [grammatical] difficulty” (*ib.*). So I retain Kt and understand the desire to be that of the desert, which has imprinted its ways on the donkey.}

Jer 2:31

Though I am not certain, I think that the יה termination here is an artificial device of the massoretes. There is not good evidence for an intensive sufformative *ya* (contrast the NET note on SS 8:6 with Lipiński 229-231), and the other case cited by NET (*l.c.*), Jer 32:19, falls rather under a different heading, viz. feminine nouns in *iyya* (e.g. רמיה).

Jer 2:36

So (among others) HALOT (1:272a).

Jer 3:5

JC has the Qr w/o a Kt, but Davidson list no other support for this, and it could easily be an assimilation to the earlier Qr forms in the verse (which did not exist in the main text, to be sure, but to a learned Masorete such as {} would have been in his mind).

Jer 3:8

On internal grounds, the Qr seems to be preferable, and the Kt is explainable as transcriptional error (see Talmon 141). The LXX MS support for εδεν = Qr is very weak, however (48 51 96 231 233 239). If elsewhere a Qr is allowed by itself to overturn Kt+G, then the Qr is probably preferable here.

{Yet see Talmon 143; M (=G^{majority}) is probably safest.}

Jer 3:22

G probably reads משבריכם (so a footnote in an essay in the XIV Congress of SCS volume). This is probably a visual error (and the same error occurs in the Vulgate elsewhere; see *ibid*). It does suggest a defective reading stood in the G *Vorlage*, yet, unless all defective readings are to be preferred, the *plene* spelling is probably preferable in this instance, for the defective spelling of this word is much more common in Jer (and the OT as a whole) than the *plene* is, such that the G reading could be an unconscious assimilation.

Jer 4:2

Perhaps G has יהללו את אלהים בירושלם. The conjugation in M might be an assimilation to the preceding verb. The word בירושלם presents an ambiguity: Will the nations praise the God who is in Jerusalem or praise God while themselves in Jerusalem? If the latter, M might have been unable to bear this thought and deleted it piously.

There is no clear transcriptional cause for the loss of the last few words of G, and it would seem to be out of character for either the translator or his Hebrew MS to have added such an expansion (I have found no clear parallel elsewhere in the OT). On the other hand, if G is to be accepted, the parallelism might be thought to suffer, and it is unclear how ובר is to be understood.

13:20 is a similar situation, for ירושלים might have been added there in G, or lost in M (though due to homoeoteleuton, not pious omission); that variation unit should be perhaps be decided in the light of this one, or vice versa.

Jer 4:7

Althann (50) prefers מַאִין (“certainly there is no”), but while this plausible in itself, the expression מאין ישב is common (as BDB sub אין notes), so MT seems preferable here. The situation is different in 10:6, 7.

Jer 4:8

On Althann's repointing of לא see *On לא* “*Mighty One*” near the beginning of this file.

Jer 4:19

Note that while it is difficult to rule out that נפשי is an accusative of place (or, even less likely, manner), this word is probably the subject of the preceding verb/participle. This being the case, Kt שמעת seems impossible, and easily explains Qr שמעת as an emendation (via omission of the final letter). Now, שמעת *could* be supported by OG ηκουσεν, but given that OG-Jer is toward the literal end of the spectrum and given OG tense-related practices elsewhere (in my own study in OG-Psalms, about an 89% correspondence where text-critical considerations are *not* figured in), it seems more likely that it read שמעה. This form has good external support and intrinsically forms a nice grammatical balance to אחריש. Assuming an original sequence שמעה נפשי, such could have become נפשי שמעת via *he/taw* confusion + corrupt dittography (*nun* → *yodh* + *nun*, admittedly across a word break), facilitated by the earlier 1st person singular forms in this verse.

{Post-script: See Althann (88): It seems that נפשי is vocative, as are מעי (x2) and קירותי, and שמעת is the alternative morphology of the 2nd person feminine singular (subject נפש).}

Jer 4:27

Althann would point לא here (also in 5:18, 30:11, 46:28; in 5:10 וְכָל־אֶל he would repoint אל), in effect reversing the meaning (much the same effect could be achieved by repointing לא in the four relevant passages as an asseverative). Yet (1) 30:11 and 46:28 seems pretty clearly to require a negative, (2) 5:18 starts with the words בימים ההם, which expression (or its equivalent בימים ההם) elsewhere always (3:16, 3:18, 31:29, 33:15, 33:16, 50:4, 50:20) introduces *encouraging*, not *discouraging* news; and (3) the putative meaning in 5:10 (“and end of El,” i.e. a total elimination, p. 148) is strained if not impossible. In light of these factors MT is preferable here (and elsewhere).

Jer 4:29

Althann prefers a proposal to retain MT צרה, but the evidence for *צרה seems strong, and *he/chet* confusion plus the increasing rarity of the latter term makes alteration of MT preferable, though a marginal reading would probably be merited.

Jer 5:1

Is there a doublet here (Walters, 268-269)? {probably not, but could revisit; cf. Gottingen, text and apparatus}

Jer 5:2

On לכן see Althann (120).

Jer 5:3

Repointing כְּלִיָּתָם as כְּלִיָּתָם = “their kidneys.” See Althann (123-124).

{Post-script: But notice the repetition of מאנו later in the verse, and that the verb there lacks an explicit subject. Probably MT is correct, and the verb is parallel with (and additionally sounds similar to, adding to the poetic effect) the earlier הִכִּיתָה אֶתָם.}

Jer 5:7

On the Kt see Althann (135), who (1) points to Ges 65b and (2) observes that the Kt offers a better balance of syllables for the poetry.

Jer 5:13

See Driver to Samuel (58 n¹).

Jer 5:24b

It is quite possible that the Qr יורה, supported by G, is correct, in which case Kt is a transposition. Yet (1) Althann (176) seems to show that the stichometry is superior with the Kt (though oddly on p. 178 he refers explicitly to יורה), and (2) M-Jer seems at this writing (11/25/19) to be in quite good condition, making the Kt preferable, lacking a strong case against it.

Jer 5:31b

An idiom for acting wickedly (a variation on the phrase occurs in Ps 125:3); so, with convincing argumentation, Althann (191-192).

Jer 6:7a

See Althann, 209-210.

Jer 6:7b

The root is קור, the meaning “gush”: See Althann, 210.

Jer 6:18

The first word is to be grouped with v17: “We will not listen to the Just One” (Althann 245). The meter is thus improved (ibid.), and הקשיב improved syntactically: This verb very often (usually?) has an object, that object nearly always marked by a preposition, that preposition often (usually?) *lamedh*. (BDB lists a number of absolute usages, but each of these, apart from the (semi-?)poetic 1 Sam 15:22, is in the imperative, and at the head of a general call to attention, which does not obtain here.)

Jer 6:19

It is difficult to be certain – both words occur in Jer – but M is probably preferable in that (1) it seems easier to envision מהשבותם becoming משובתם than *vice versa* (omission of a letter, followed by transposition), (2) the most recent use of either word was 5:6, so G might be an assimilation, and (3) the suffix there in 5:6 is different, apparently, from that here, such that intrinsic evidence would seem to weigh against G (although Jer does not seem to be consistent in his use of these endings, as in the case of אבותם vs. אבותינם). G, then, is probably a mere scribal slip.

Jer 6:26

Based on usage elsewhere in the book, השד in G is surely haplography.

Jer 6:27

The meaning is “assayer”: Althann (266-267; 271).

Jer 7:18

Regarding the pointing of מלכת השמים here and in 44:17, 44:18, 44:19, 44:25, see BDB and NAC 108n¹¹:

Probably the MT pointing, reflecting an ancient tradition, is theological in nature, avoiding the idea of a female regent in heaven and pretending as though what is referred to is merely the work מְלָאכָה of God in the expanse.

Jer 7:23

While M could be an unconscious assimilation to the phraseology found elsewhere (cf. Dt 1:31, 5:33, Josh 2:22, 24:17, 2 Ki 21:21), the predominance of 1st person forms in the present verse would very much make for assimilation, perhaps at the level of the translator rather than the *Vorlage*; moreover, transcriptionally the forms are rather different.

Jer 7:24

The G plus here is probably a corrupt dittograph.

Jer 7:30-8:3

On this section see the essay in the STJD volume which I own (maybe *Haish Mosheh?* Or the *Humanities* volume?) and “Sin of Omission or Commision” by Joseph Riordan, an essay in *Gottest Wort im Menschenwort* (Georg Fischer FS published by Peter Lang: Österreichische Bibische Studien 43).

Jer 8:7

Re Kt-Qr see BDB sub סוס I.

Jer 8:13

For ילך McCarter (48) would read וילן with some MSS. So NETmg. But L can probably stand.

Jer 9:6

As de Waard notes (42), transcriptional error readily explains the short reading, while the long reading was most likely in the *Vorlage*, not a creation of the translator (here he cites another source). Ultimately he prefers to keep M. NICOT and WBC both incline *away* from MT but do not commit themselves.

Since there is a transcriptional explanation and G is the easier reading, we adopt it.

{Post-script: Yet the transcriptional explanation is *possible*, not, it seems to me, *probable*, and OTL (implicitly, but Allen is very thorough!) prefers MT.}

Jer 9:9

There are three G divergences from L here, the first two noted in BHS and the third in Janzen. The first is transcriptionally difficult either way, but intrinsic evidence favors M (see NICOT); the second favors M (homoeoteteluton in G; בְּכִי וְנָהִי occurs nowhere else in the OT, making addition unlikely); and the third, while possibly from v11 (so Janzen), could be accidental. Taken together, we probably have a fatigued G scribe here.

Jer 9:23

The apparent G reading (if not merely LXX) וּמִשְׁפָּט would certainly deserve a place in the margin, if not the main text, yet the external evidence is sporadic enough (note that V sides with M here) that we might have a polygenetic addition of the conjunction here.

Jer 10:2

The use of אֶל here is probably correct (cf. BDB's citation of this passage sub אל) though apparently this preposition is not connected with לִמַּד elsewhere (BibleWorks9 search: 'lmd al; cf. BDB sub לִמַּד). The sense is arguably rather like עַל, but Jer is one of the books in which distinctions between these two propositions are blurred. Viganò (3) proposes vocalizing אֶל, but the phrase כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה is never followed by אֶל, by אֱלֹהִים, or by a form of אָדוֹן.

It is difficult to say whether G's *Vorlage* had דְּרָכֵי, given the LXX's inconsistency with regard to grammatical number with many nouns.

Jer 10:6

מֵאִן means “there is certainly no(ne)”; see, e.g., Althann (50) and BDB sub מֵאֵ re Arabic usage.

Jer 10:13

{Do not recall checking Janzen, etc. on this}

It is interesting that OG does not represent לקול תתו here, but does in 51:16 (εις φωνην εθετο ηχος). It is possible that the translator felt he did not understand the unusual construction (on which see Althann, *Jer*) as he worked on chapter 10, but attempted a stab at it in chap. 51 (note the Peshitta non-revision of earlier material).

Alternatively, the *Vorlage* lacked it here. In that case, the omission might be accidental (though no clear trigger is present), due to a lack of comprehension (assuming the construction was no longer linguistically productive at the stage of redaction), or original. In the first two cases, the error / faltering of confidence did not obtain in chapter 51; in the third case, the present verse was assimilated to 51:16. The last scenario in some ways has the best explanatory power, yet intrinsic evidence (the sense of the first line, and also metrics) is much against an original absence of these words.

Jer 11:2

Contra BHS, G probably did *not* have ואל for M's ועל; see 18:11 and the LXX there. These prepositions are all but interchangeable in such cases.

Jer 11:15

It is difficult to decide between בעד and בעת. Either could be an assimilation, or perhaps G represents a faded exemplar (if it went through a square script).

Jer 11:19a

G is taken to read נשיתה (from שית; this is the second proposal of BHS), and this reading is taken to be a transcriptional error (loss of a single letter).

Jer 11:19b

בלחמו perhaps from לחם (see BDB to that word) with enclitic mem; see further de Waard 59. Jeremiah does use כמו and למו elsewhere in his books, if that helps.

{Post-script: But the enclitic *mem* in a case like this is quite dubious (see the section near the beginning of this file. Is there external support for בלחז, in which case M(T) could be accidental substitution of a common word facilitated by the visual similarity of the two forms? On the other hand, MT makes sense if לחם is taken in a loose sense (“food”).

Jer 12:4

While האלהים could have fallen out (or possibly אלהים, but OG ο θεος) after יראה might be a case of near dittography in the square script, Jeremiah does not often use the absolute (not construct) form אלהים, and still less האלהים, except where a contrast with false gods is very much in view. There does not appear to be evidence of inner-M corruption, while in the paleo script this error is unlikely. Thus intrinsic and transcriptional/transmissional considerations strongly suggest that the plus is not original, being either a G corruption or a pseudo-variant (=explication at the translation, not *Vorlage* level).

Jer 12:14

There is no clear transcriptional grounds for השכנים to become שכני, although the former reading would certainly be easier. It seems, especially in the light of 18:14, probable that the LXX translator *thought* he saw השכנים or some such.

Jer 12:17

G's ישובו for M's ישמעו: While visual error could in theory be responsible for the variation, more probably it is not, for the same interchange occurs in 34:10.

Jer 13:18

Jer generally uses the plural imperative of אמר, but the singular occurs in 18:11 (and 48:19, though the situation there is different), so it seems safest to retain the unexpected reading of M here.

Jer 13:18b

An original ולגבורם is possible but unlikely. See NAC, NICOT.

Jer 13:19

Following Ges 118q. Note Amos 1:9. Dittography of the *he* with which כלה ends, plus insertion of helping letters in a שלמה misread via visual error as שלמם (perhaps more specifically: *waw* inserted via corrupt dittography of [the right half of] *mem* + *he*/final *mem* confusion + insertion of the most usual *yodh* the masculine plural).
{But this is probably not necessary: See J-M (150e) and ICC.}

Jer 14:1

Given the consistency of the LXX on אשר היה in Jer, ויהי surely stood in the translator's *Vorlage* (as BHS notes). The phrase אשר היה דבר occurs only 4x elsewhere in Jer, but ויהי דבר occurs 21x. Thus G might be an assimilation to common usage. On the other hand, the partial support of P (BHS has it in parentheses) might lend support to the G reading, though again this could be independent assimilation (what is the P reading? Is it a secondary development from ויהי, or an independent development from אשר היה? The former case could tip the scales in favor of G, the latter in favor of M).

Jer 14:22

Check Zeigler regarding BHS's claim that LXX originally read נקוה (without the conjunction; BHS deems M dittography).

Jer 15:1

Just possibly an object for שלה is to be supplied via the (O)G את העם הזה. But ICC thinks M can stand, and it might be an infinitive rather than a finite verb.

Jer 15:4

BDB rightly appeals to *linguistic* (not textual) metathesis; note that this Kt-Qr occurs several times and so is unlikely to be mere textual corruption in each case.

Jer 15:15

אל לארך אפים תקחני seems impossible: God's ארך אפים is never elsewhere something he might be blamed for. The suggestion {of whom?} to point ארך seems to be an expedient and is not very satisfactory. Rather, with Viganò (8) we prefer to point אל and to group with word with what precedes (“You know, YHWH; remember me and visit me, / and avenge me from my enemies, O God! / In your patience receive [on the sense cf. DCH 4: 565^a] me; / know how I bear on your account reproach”). It then balances the earlier יהוה and possibly provides better metrics.

{But does this really resolve the problem? Why would Jeremiah say that it would require patience of God to assist him?}

{Since writing this I came across HALOT 1:88b, where לארך is prescribed, and I am much inclined to defer to that authority.}

Jer 15:17

G appears to read נִאָחֵזֶל (pointing correct?; see NETS on the meaning). Perhaps M is a transcriptional error (in

the square script; aural error, transposition, and confusion between *zayin* and *waw*), but aural error seems more likely in G; indeed, this could be a pseudo-variant. On the other hand, the partial support for the LXX in P could be significant – look into this {check Leiden edition}. Moreover, aural error in M seems to occur in 25:3.

Jer 17:13

There does not seem to be external warrant to deviate from Kt. Perhaps God is speaking (cf. Isa 45:24 for the thought)? Or Jeremiah, insofar as those who mock God's prophet mock God?

Jer 17:19

Re Kt-Qr: NET notes that there is no other mention of a “People's Gate” elsewhere, so it is hard to get traction of intrinsic evidence. The OG λαου σου {so BibleWorks9; verify w/ Gottingen}, if it not a paraphrase of the Qr, represents עַמִּי, which reading could be interpreted in one of two ways: (1) The original reading, of which Kt is a corrupt haplography (in a script where *beth* and *mem* closely resemble one another), or (2) corrupt dittography from the Kt, in which case G constitutes indirect support for Kt.

{Post-script: Elsewhere there are cases of an anarthrous noun in a construct case. That this is evidently a place name would increase that possibility. On the other hand, perhaps it is *not* a specific gate (so WBC p. 238), in which case the Kt is preferable. Either way, the Kt seems best; and also because of the great uncertainty of the case.}

Jer 18:16

The Kt could be an error (cf., e.g., HALOT 2:1656^b-1657^a), but what would really be parallel to other passages would be לְשִׁיקָה or לְשִׁרָקָה. It might be an alternate morphology.

Jer 21:9

The same Kt-Qr occurs in 38:2, so probably the Kt is preferable in both cases.

Jer 21:12

See Talmon 157 for an argument on transcriptional grounds that we should read with M תִּצֵּת. Talmon wishes to read this in 4:4 as well, but the LXX seems to confirm M there. Since G here could be a transcriptional error and 4:4 seems sure in תִּצֵּת, it is probably better to read with M here.

Jer 22:30

In favor of M, see Tawil, *Lexical Studies* (21).

Jer 23:22

Janzen (117) makes this due to haplography, and while this is uncertain due to the waw, there seems to be an unwitting error earlier in the verse (וְאֵת עַמִּי) suggesting fatigue in the G scribe here.

Jer 24:1

The LXX και τους πλουσιους is difficult to account for. It could represent וְהַעֲשִׂיר, which could then be construed as a corrupt dittography of וְהַחֲרִישׁ. Just possibly וְאֵת הַמַּסְגֵּר was then lost by homoeoteleuton, unless it was never there to begin with (being an import in M from 2 Ki 24:14, v16). Yet it is also possible that και τους πλουσιους in fact renders וְהַמַּסְגֵּר, for (1) the LXX misunderstood this word in its other occurrence in Jer (29:2), (2) it seems strange to say corrupt dittography occurred twice *in different ways* in G with respect to the same phrase (see 29:2 and the commentary on it), and (3) G might have been thinking of סָגוֹר as in Job 28:15 (in Hebrew; LXX there is different).

Jer 25:3

G might have read מִן שְׁלֹשׁ for בְּשָׁלֹשׁ. A bit unusual (graphic error + skipping a word + missed word division), but hardly impossible.

Jer 25:4-5 (cf. v6)

M seems to have been restructured so as to make Jeremiah make statements about God rather than speak as his mouthpiece.

{Post-script: Yet v6 near the end abruptly in M shifts to God speaking in the first person. Note also that *נתן יהוה* in v5 could conceivably be a misreading if *נתן* stood in the *Vorlage* and was misread as *נתתי*. The question of abbreviations should be revisited, especially in the light of XJer (see THB). [Yet see beginning of this file on “X” fragments.]}

Jer 25:9

As Gruber points out (*Marbeh Hokmah*, Hurowitz memorial volume, p274; VP library), 43:10 has *את*.

{Post-script: But this may not really be parallel, and so be beside the point.} Gruber thinks that this is an example of *אל* bearing the meaning of *את*, but I would rather change the text. But there seems to be no external evidence for *ואת* here (viz., before *נבוכדראצר*): P is at best ambiguous, since it has the *ל* prefix before both objects of the verb *לקח*; V clearly reflects *ואל*, as does T and the inner-OG plus.

Jer 25:23

G's reading (LXX: *Πως*) is probably a transcriptional error. Cf. HALOT.

Jer 25:34

Re *תפוצותיכם* see the essay in the Huehnergard FS.

Jer 25:36

Yeivin (284) lists this verse, along with Pr 30:17 (but SRO reads in a way that obviates that case) and Ecc 2:13, as the only places where the prefix + yodh combination is thus pointed. Such is probably an intrusion from Late Antiquity (cf. Kantor 2023).

Jer 25:38

While M could be interpreted as assimilation to earlier in the verse, the phrase *חרב אפו* never occurs elsewhere in Jer, while *חרון אפו* often does. So transcriptional error as a criterion partly lets us down here, it would seem. But only partly: The words *חרב* and *חרון* are visually similar, to transcriptional error almost certainly explains G, the (as regards intrinsic evidence) harder reading.

Jer 26:6

The issue of *הזאתה* is commented on in the commentary file, inasmuch as it would merit a marginal reading if marginal readings were still in use.

Jer 28:1

See BDB sub *שנה* ad fin. This usage seems to be characteristic of Jeremiah.

Jer 29:7

On *העיר* see the commentary (marginal reading).

Jer 29:8

BDB suggests a possible retroversion of G (*אתם מחלמים*), but against this note the Aramaic evidence adduced by HALOT. It is safer to stick with M.

Jer 29:9

The form *שקר* is probably an accidental (or intentional in the case of P) assimilation.

Jer 30:5

It's possible that G is correct, but M seems to fit better (in the poem) while G (or LXX) might be an assimilation (to the general context in which 2pl is common).

Jer 30:7

As WBC notes (though it does not ultimately depart from MT, since it “is not impossible”), G's form, of which M is easily understood as a transposition (again, WBC), when read as the end of v6, improves the meter.

[But the syntax of G feels strange, the metrical argument here is dubious, and metathesis could have easily have afflicted G. On the syntax of M (v7), cf. the thought in 2 Ki 6:5. ICC (at least) prefers M.]

Jer 30:16

That is, “surely”; cf. HALOT on לכן and {Althann or Dahood?} on כן.

Jer 30:16

M seems intrinsically superior, as less redundant and involving a play on the sounds of the previous line. G might be due to a mangled exemplar or a fatigued scribe. A similar situation obtains in v19, where (see BHS) G has apparently misread similar letters and produced a redundancy.

Jer 30:19

See the comments on v16 above.

Jer 31:2

G's מִצָּחֵי is corrupt dittography + addition of a helping letter; הַם is *mem/nun* confusion. Cf. the comments on 30:16 above.

Jer 31:8

Attached to the beginning of the next verse: So NICOT; WBC notes the issue well but keeps M as G “would deprive this verse of any indication of the destination of the returnees” (111 n^{8c}), but no explicit indication of destination is necessary with שׁוּב, especially not in this theological sense.

Jer 31:13 re יְהוָה

As an essay on Aramaic in the LXX in *Helmet on a Hill* points out, יְהוָה is “characteristic” of Jeremiah, and there seem to be parallels to this passage. Indeed, although de Waard claims the opposite, G might have been motivated in its interpretation of these consonants by an interest in safeguarding Jewish practice (the M text could – and probably should, given the New Covenant context – be understood as ascribing by elipsis the rejoicing of the virgins to that the men as well). That the verb חָדָה in this sense is rare in the Hebrew of the OT could lend support to the G interpretation, yet the force of this observation is greatly reduced by the LXX employment of Aramaic (see the essay already cited), and its rarity does, in fact, mean that, all other things being equal, its employment here would seem to be unlikely.

To sum up, the M pointing is almost certainly correct given Jeremiah's style, the possible avoidance sought by G, and the LXX use of Aramaic.

{Post-script: Probably LXX is not avoiding anything, just translating; in fact, M might be avoiding putting women in the (eschatological?) assembly by twice (v4 and here) apparently replacing קהל with מִחֹל; yet cf. the comments on v4 in the textual commentary.}

Jer 31:13 re לִשְׁשׁוֹן

Inasmuch as the long reading has strong intrinsic support from Est 9:22 (as pointed out in THB 1B: 521^a) and the short reading is explainable as near haplography (*mem* and *nun* being similar in the paleo script), M, which bears the long reading, is preferable.

Jer 31:14

Revisit לוי בני plus in G w/ Janzen, etc. (A pro-Hasmonean insertion in 2Jer-LXX? The phrase הכהנים בני לוי occurs elsewhere only in Dt 21:5, 31:9)

Jer 31:15a

See BDB sub רמה II.

Jer 31:23

There are many difficulties in the latter part of this verse, but on the whole the LXX seems secondary, for at least the following reasons: (1) The parallel in Zech 8:3 (see the essay in the *Journal of Hebrew Scriptures*) supports M; (2) the phraseology ἐπὶ δακτύλου σου τοῦ αἰγίου σου is awkward Greek; (3) the underlying Hebrew the former would seem to presuppose is awkward Hebrew, for it is hard to construe the Hebrew without נוה; and (4) G/LXX seems to have several transcriptional errors or misreadings in the preceding verses (scan BHS apparatus). Tentatively, we propose that the MS from which the LXX translator worked was marred: (1) נוה was either absent or unreadable, (2) הָרַקְדָּשׁ was either difficult to read הָרַקְשָׁדָּשׁ or הָרַקְדָּשׁוּ was present due to dittography from the following verse (the former being patently corrupt, the latter a correction of the former without knowledge of the original reading, and (3) the phrase יְבָרַכְךָ יְהוָה was misread in some manner, possibly aided by a prior haplography of the double *kaph* (in a script without final letters). {Should check Janzen, commentaries on this.}

Jer 31:40

The Kt might well be a corruption, but there is little to no credible external evidence for this.

Jer 32:6

{Some notable comments here on meta-theory for Jer}

G (or LXX?) is probably an assimilation to frequent usage elsewhere. It is inconsistent with the first-person narration in the next verse. Intrinsically difficult or impossible. If the error was in the *Vorlage*, this shows the faithfulness of the translator in his rendering. If the error is with the translator, either (1) he started to paraphrase and changed his mind part way through; (2) his attention was lagging and he either (a) failed to notice his error or (b) did not bother to correct it; or (3) his exemplar was faded, damaged, or poorly written at this point. Cf. the comments on 31:2 above and especially on 32:8 below.

{Post-script: Oddities continue to be found in verses beyond v8 (on which see below); the cumulative effect is striking, and it made me recall the theory, held in various forms by the likes of Thackeray {sp?} and Tov (though disputed, in some measure, in BIOSCS 39) that a different hand is at work (in some significant measure) in LXX-1-28 and LXX-29ff. It may be that from 29 and on the LXX is to be handled more carefully, not as reflecting ultimately a different *Vorlage* but as concealing the same through a less literal technique.

Jer 32:8

G's *Vorlage* for M's לֶךְ קָנָה וְלֶךְ הִרְשָׁה is not entirely clear (LXX ἀγοράσθαι καὶ οὐ πρᾶσθαι), but a plausible scenario is as follows: The first word was rendered with an infinitive of purchase in a manner similar to that seen in LXX-v7. The next few words were damaged in his exemplar, or became confused in his tired mind, and לֶךְ and קָנָה apparently being overlooked and וְלֶךְ הִרְשָׁה becoming זָקַן וְאַתָּה. Such would be facilitated by the lacking of final letter forms, and if the final *he* on קָנָה was missing, לֶךְ might have been as well. See also the note on v6 above.

Jer 32:28

Cf. BHS a-a. Transcriptional error could explain M or G, or, as this is possibly the less literal half of LXX-Jer, the translator might be paraphrasing/targumizing in order to avoid direct ascription of the fall of Jerusalem to God (note the passive voice).

Jer 33:4

(O)G seems to have מלך for מלכי, whether by emendation or by dittography, but see 19:13.

Jer 33:22

Re the final two words of the verse, cf. J-M p385 n2

Jer 34:10

See the comments on 12:17 above.

Jer 34:15

The repeated third-person forms in this verse in LXX are hard to understand, particularly given (a) the word היום and (b) the second-person forms in the next verse. The two forms are only a letter apart, and the end of v14 is in the third person, so perhaps the translator thought he say third-person forms here, yet grew in attentiveness as he copied the following verse (on the failure to correct himself see the textual commentary on 2:2 and the essay in *Studia Aramaica* on the Peshitta in which a failure of translators to go back over their earlier work is noted).

Jer 36:2

G's ירושלם is probably an assimilation, assisted by the visual similarity of this word to ישראל.

Jer 36:26

The long minus in G is probably due to haplography (so THB 1B: 523^b {}; also Janzen?). (The same THB page adduces haplography in 11:22, but I am not convinced that the short reading is not better there.)

Jer 37:4

The same Kt-Qr occurs in 52:31, so the Kt is probable in both cases.

Jer 37:21

See J-M p400 n3.

Jer 38:9

Ges (1111) doubts the text here, and it does seem odd indeed. A simple repointing may fix the problem (וַיִּזְמַת), and the defective spelling may have led to the error on the part of the *naqdanim*.

Jer 38:11

A common emendation (found, e.g., in the ESV, though not in the NET q.v.; on the history see THBS 2, pp 234 and 439-440) is for תחת to read מלתחת, “closet.” But space in old Jerusalem was limited, so it is dubious whether rags would have been kept in a wardrobe; rather, clothes fit for the royal family and staff were likely kept there, and old clothes discarded. In the ANE (cf. the TC lecture in the Mesopotamia series on “internationalism”), trade of token luxury items, including fine garments, was common between kings, and such fine garments would naturally be kept in the treasury, as the attested OT text here has it, rather than the wardrobe. Moreover, Ebed-melek's status explains his ability to get into the treasury, whereas his role in the story would be less remarkable if he merely accessed an old wardrobe. Thus no emendation is needed.

Jer 38:15

Marginal reading: G an assimilation or M an attempt to fill out the scope of the demand?

Jer 39:3

For a possible repointing, see HALOT 2: 1357bf. However, MT is difficult to account for apart from originality, no?

Jer 40:3

See Ges 126x.

Jer 41:1

G's אֱלֵעֶשֶׂה is probably merely a transcriptional error for אֱלִישָׁמַע (cf. 2 Ki 25:25).

Jer 44:8

M^A has גִּי, but this is probably simply a *lapsus calami* (cf. 2 Chron 32:17 in L and see the discussion under “Double-duty Letters” above).

Jer 44:25

Reading “you women” here would seemingly require emendation also in v24; *two* rather complicated and interrelated errors in M seems improbable. Rather, the men are included in the discussion as their wives' spiritual overseers (cf. v19, Jn 4:16).

Jer 46:15

In defense of MT, see Tawil (260a).

Jer 46:17b

{NB intrinsic evidence for G-Jer especially weak here:}

G appears to have נָכוֹ after פָּרַעָה. The section heading (v13) cites the imminent coming of Nebuchadnezzar. Kitto 1:739-40 tentatively supports the idea (raised by NICOT) that it was Hophra, not Neco, during whose reign Egypt was invaded, although it was Neco who was turned back at Carchemish (1:739, citing Jer 46:2). Thus intrinsic evidence favors M here. This is not a fatal objection to G-Jer, as the long reading might be an accidental assimilation to Jer 46:2 (note also the probably error in the next verse, discussed below; the scribe responsible for G might have been inattentive at this point in his work), but it certainly is not a point in its favor.

{Post-script: Kitchen *On the Reliability of the OT* 24 gives the dates for Necho II as 610-595; Hophra (=Apries) as 589-570.}

The pharaoh under whom Egypt was invaded by Nebuchadnezzar is probably Apries or Amasis (ed. John Boardman et al., *The Cambridge Ancient History Volume III Part 2: The Assyrian and Babylonian Empires and other States of the Near East, from the Eighth to the Sixth Centuries B.C.*, 2nd ed., Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 1991, ISBN 0 521 227178 p. 719); cf. also WBC.

Jr 46:18

Contra Janzen (79), G is probably in error. (1) The word הַמֶּלֶךְ before יְהוָה and after נָאִם is so rare as easily to be skipped over by mistake, and not easy to account for as an interpolation, and its presence here helps to explain the interpolation in M in 48:15. (2) κύριος ο θεος is vastly more common in the LXX than κύριος παντοκράτωρ, so it could be an assimilation, and Jeremiah never elsewhere says יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים, making it unlikely that he would do so here.

Jer 48:7

יְהִי *could* be an error for יִהְיֶה (not the following word, and also the *daleth*), but the sense appears to be suitable, so it seems safest to stick with MT in view of the lack of definite evidence, intrinsic or external.

Jer 48:9

See HALOT (1:426a) and BDB.

Jer 48:27

The Qr here is unnecessary, for יִשְׂרָאֵל here refers to the nation, not the man, and therefore is grammatically feminine.

Jer 50:38

See OTL.

Jer 51:3

See de Waard, 214-216 (after each אָ there is a poetically omitted relative pronoun), but perhaps modify the understanding of this construction: “As to him who bends his bow, / and as to him who rises up in his armor [I say]: / “Do not pity the choice men; / devote to destruction all its host.”

On the Kt-Qr issue, see the textual commentary.

Jer 51:28

The LXX is much divided, but BSQV may be due to h.t. A possibility to consider is that the Old Latin (elsewhere accepted as original, and here certainly a difficult reading, in the Greek) presupposes וְכָל אֶרֶץ for וְאֶת כָּל אֶרֶץ. This reading may be impossible (in the Hebrew), but might be an oversight, in which case M is preferable.

Jer 51:58 (=OG 28:58)

In what is clearly an error, but an interesting one, G in place of אַש reads רַאשׁ, i.e. corrupt dittography of the preceding *yodh*. (Cf. NICOT to Hab p. 315.)

Jer 51:59

For אֶת G reads מֵאֶת, the effect being that Seraiah (sp?) went on behalf of, not with, King Zedekiah. Steinmann (*From Abraham to Paul*, 160n²³⁵), WBC, and OTL all comment on this, but are all ambivalent, so it seems best to retain M.

Jer 52:25

Was he lost by near haplography after תַּו in the word סֹפֵר? Cf. Walters (309), who cites Aquilla. But it seems to me that the G, by omission, and some ancient Hebrew MSS, but adding the article, ameliorated the unusual syntax, which (looking at, e.g., the book of Kings, which has other similarities to Jeremiah) is not impossible

Isa 32:13

So Ges 128c.

Eze 1:14a, b

Transcriptional error. Vulgate, and also Symmachus in the second case {presumably Sym non-exant in the first case}, support the true reading. OG does not have this verse. See Van Rooy p505 in *Florilegium Loviense* (Martinez FS).

{But see WBC for a better explanation.}

Eze 4:6

Tentatively, we follow the Kt, not L which seems to be idiosyncratic, but of A, and being an alternative morphology of הִימָנִי attested elsewhere as in 2 chr 3:17 (Kt) and as a personal name in Num 26:12, etc.

{Post-script: This note was based on the BibleWorks9 Kt הִימָנִי; WLC 4.20, by contrast, agrees with A^{kt}, entailing a shift from “S” to “Vk.”}

Eze 4:15

It is hard to get traction on whether the Kt or the Qr is preferable, so tentatively we retain the Kt.

Eze 5:7

=“Because you acted even more ungratefully than the nations around you did, even less disposes to follow the

light that you had”; cf. CDCH 228b and HALOT *sub* מִנִּי. (The form here is a suffixed *hiph'il* infinitive.)

Eze 8:6

Re Kt-Qr: While the Kt could be in error (cf. OG), we tentatively take it to be the pronoun הֵם with the interrogative מֶה prefixed (as in Ex 4:2 etc.).

Eze 10:17

See J-M 80k ad fin.

Eze 13:6

See WBC for discussion of this difficult verse. No solution I have found seems entirely plausible or satisfactory. Tentatively, I advance what as far as I know is a new hypothesis: וְקָסָם is an infinitive absolute used as a verbal continuation (cf. וְנָתַן in 23:46 and numerous similar constructions without the conjunction elsewhere in the book).

Eze 13:11

The syntax is poetical: “And will generate [lit. “give”] hailstones falling, and a windy blast tearing.”

Eze 16:7

Just possibly we should read רַבִּי with (O)G(?), but more likely this is a case of the grammatical masculine superseding the feminine as often (cf. J-M on concord), here prompted by the suffix.

Eze 16:36

There is some discussion as to the first letter of the tenth word. WLC had a bet; UXLC starting at 1.8 has a kaph, noting also Breuer. But JC and MM have a bet, as apparently OG {would like to verify that with an apparatus}. {To be clear, SR has a bet.}

Eze 16:43

A pious emendation. Cf. HALOT (2:1183a).

Eze 16:59

Re Kt-Qr: Eze uses seemingly old orthography elsewhere (e.g., Kt-12:14).

Eze 17:5

See Tawil 336a in defense of M.

Eze 17:7

CDCH (179b) reports that some MSS have כִּנְפָה. Should revisit, at least when more MS info is available—I’m thinking of the ongoing work on the Firkovitch collection here.

Eze 19:4

HALOT 2: 1572b makes an interesting suggestion that could be achieved by repointing, but it is not clear that the repointing is superior.

Eze 20:4

G reads הַשֹּׁפֵט for the first הַתִּשְׁפֵּט in M; either reading could have resulted from the other by transcriptional error (Talmon 143).

Eze 21:21

See Talmon for a theoretical restoration from the versions of הַתְּחַדּוֹ (M being corrupt dittography). But might not

the versions be grappling with the same linguistic oddity?

Eze 21:31

On the infinitives see Ges 113bb n³.

Eze 22:16

In light of the ancient versions possibly ונהלתי should be read, but I've had a hard time coming up with convincing (to me; contrast WBC) transcriptional explanation for the error. Ezekiel uses defective / archaic orthography elsewhere.

Eze 23:38

WBC's explanation for the OG minus of ביום ההוא would be convincing except that OG lacks the *same* phrase there in v39. We take v39 to be a recapitulation in slightly differently words of vv37-38: Both describe (the latter [viz., v39] with greater specificity via the temporal prefix ב on שחטם) idolatry (and murder) followed immediately (thus highlighting the hypocrisy) by entrance into God's holy Temple.

Eze 23:42

Kt-Qr: Obscure, so Kt retained.

Eze 23:48

This *could* be a nitpa'el form, especially as Ezekiel is (somewhat) late; but J-M is uncertain, and only *one* other example in the HB occurs (viz. Dt 21:8), and that probably by error (see there). So probably it has been mispointed.

Eze 28:12-19

-Did the Masoretes Get It Wrong? The Vocalization and Accentuation of Ezekiel XXVIII 12-19

Hector M. Patmore

Vetus Testamentum

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Eze 29:4

The Kt could be a mere error, but HALOT seems to recognize the validity of a singular חחי, and there are other non-gentilic nouns with this ending (at least Kt-2 chr 24:25). Perhaps related to *חחה as a by-form of חוח.

Eze 29:16

An adaption of an emendation suggested by a source cited in WBC, noting the parallel with 28:24.

Eze 30:5-6

Re WBC's suggestion re כה אמר יהוה, the theory is appealing, but there are two problems: (1) The phrase does occur elsewhere in the book, if rarely (11:5, 21:8); (2) there is a section break between verses 5 and 6, and I am unaware of external evidence for its omission (unless OG).

Eze 30:6

The Kt-Qr is could doubtful.

Eze 33:31-32

See J. Lust in *From Author to Copyist*

Eze 34:31

עמי could be a dittograph (is the visual similarity of וישבו to ושמעו partly responsible?), but on the other hand its

absence from G P could be due to its difficulty, and there seems to be a parallelism between ויבואו אליך כמבוא עם and וישבו לפניך עמי.

Eze 34:3

Some would repoint ההלב, but see 33:19. (The latter passage was brought to my attention by BDB, which was to read בשר w/ P in the latter passage, but such seems quite dubious to me, for multiple reasons.)

Eze 36:3

A mixed form (so Ges, which, however, seemingly has a typo, or else the BibleWorks9 transcription of it does; cf. BDB on עלה *niph'al* and comparable constructions from WTM). The *qal* appears in a collocation with שפה in 47:12, but the sense there is different; here the *niph'al* seems to be required.

Eze 36:37 (and v38)

If this passage is original, perhaps the problematic phrase צאן אדם can be pointed as “flock of Edom,” which might mean “prosperous” or “at the expense of your recently denounced enemy” or both. The idea occurred to me skimming the Johan Lust essay in *Studies in the Hebrew Bible, Qumran, and Septuagint*, VTS 101, pp.387-401 {I do not have this; Van Pelt library}, though this is not his argument.

Eze 38:13

So OG points, as WBC points out. It is admittedly not certain that this pointing makes more sense than MT does, but in favor of the pointing adopted here, this noun occurs in Josh 18:24 (but here it might not be our noun, but some other, and in any case evidently part of the place name) and, more to the point, SS 7:12 and 1 Chr 27:25, these last two references in late books and in the grammatical plural, as here, and the last reference seems to be in a somewhat similar context.

[Eze 41:6

Revisit w/ Walters (*The Text of the Septuagint*, 33). He restores with Rahlfs a Greek text (τριακοντα και τρεις δις; based on MS Q) in which שלוש שלשים פעמים stands for M שלוש ושלשים פעמים}

Eze 41:9

For בית we might read בין, but, particularly in a late book, the former might be the preposition “between” (so e.g. HALOT).

Eze 43:13

WBC's solution והיקה אמה is weak for two reasons: (1) The external evidence for such is weak, and (2) the other nouns of comparable import in this verse lack a possessive suffix. Better is to retrovert OG κολπομα βαθος (NB: βαθος is nominative) as והיק אמה or חיק אמה (the omission of the article may be stylistic, or perhaps its presence in M is assimilation to the preceding וטפה; against the latter option note ואמה רחב later in the verse), the article on האמה in MT due either to a mistaken expectation that והיק was in the construct state or to corrupt aural dittography, a phenomenon seen elsewhere in MT-Eze.

{Post-script: But a very similar situation (viz. an unexpectedly arthrous האמה) occurs in v14 (also v17), and for the same, rather unusual, error to have occurred twice, is less than likely. Evidently some stylistic matter with which modern scholarship is unfamiliar is at work?}

Eze 43:15

Following (at least) L^{Kt}, JC (=MM; w/ no Qr in either), and Ginsburg^{Kt}.

These comments also apply in v16.

Eze 44:28

See WBC along with BHS. I do not have {Gottingen} to check, but BSV does *not* favor that V reading, and it is

supported by less than half the witnesses which BSV cites on that page. I suspect it is an inner-latin corruption; even if it is the original V reading, such might be based on the OG, but that OG reading still, it seems to me, goes back to an emended text. NET (at least) interprets the M text in a way that makes intervention unnecessary.

Eze 45:3

Qr could be correct (see WBC), but varying usage for numbers would seem to be possible.

-Eze 48:35 shma/shammah see Ginsburg

Hos 1:2

See Ges 130d.

Hos 3:1

The form אֶהְבֵּת could be a pa'ul form (Ges 50f), but (a) this form is uncommon, not elsewhere attested for this verb, and tends to occur with intransitives, and (b) it is paired with וּמִנְאִפָּה, clearly a participle. It is also to be noted that the Massoretes seem to have intended a true passive here, given their pointing of the logically parallel אֶהְבֵּי later in the verse. Certainly the sense must be active, and most likely the pointing was *ohevet*.

Hos 4:6

The reading וְאִמְאָסָךְ is perplexing, and might well simply be a mechanical error due to the fact that *aleph* appears after in every other even-numbered consonant slot in the word (if so, this would increase the probability that more or all Massoretic MSS stem from a single exemplar in this book). On the other hand, the reading וְאִמְאָסָךְ has rather weak external support from Hebrew-language sources, and it is probably impossible to know which reading G knew of. The difficult reading might reflect a phonological system unknown to the Tiberians (Blau does not cite this passage). The correct resolution of this variation unit remains unclear. {Unless strong contraindications from historical linguistics emerge, the non-L reading should be removed from the margin, in light form like וְקָאֵם elsewhere in Hosea and in the Twelve.} {Perhaps the dialect of Hosea and/or of the MinP compiler/editor represented the 2ms suffix as -כּk.}

Hos 4:11

The *waw* conjunction is absent from a number of Massoretic MSS. Given this fact and the frequency with which this conjunction is added by scribes in the MS tradition, the reading without the conjunction might be original. On the other hand, external support for the conjunction is strong (including M^L and M^A), and it might have been dropped accidentally due to the fact that the letter *yodh*, very similar in appearance, immediately follows or owing to a scribe seeing the conjoined synonym תִּירוּשׁ and wrongly thinking that what he had seen was יִין וְתִירוּשׁ, a natural enough noun phrase. Note as well that Hosea seems to favor several items in a row with the conjunction, as in 2:20-22.

Hos 4:18

On the pointing change see HALOT 1:545b ad fin.

{Post-script: Preferable in context is “her [the nations; on the change in gender see v19a] rulers”; cf. VT “shield of Abraham” essay” (other places where this pointing adopted: Gen 15:1, Ps 47:9, 59:12, 84:10, v19; NB that in quite a number of places where repointing *could* take place the “shield” metaphor has seemed to fit the context and therefore been allowed to stand as in MT). On the pointing מִגְּנִי in (at least) Ps 59:12, cf. יִצְרֵנוּ in Is 64:7.}

{For another take, see Noonan s.v. מִגְּנִי.}

Hos 8:9

=“they came to”; see (at least) CDCH 328a and ICC (noting the latter’s appendix, which proposes that Hosea uses a nonstandard dialect).

Hos 8:10

Regarding מלך שרים in Hosea 8:10, {BHQ} 63* astutely observes, “Despite the strong attestation of the copula in most of the v[er]s[ion]s..., it is probably to be regarded... as a result of failure to recognize the title of the Assyrian king, ‘king of princes.’”

Hos 8:10

Regarding ויחלו see Ges 111w n¹.

Hos 9:2

Some editors (see BHS 1001, NEB 248, and BHS 944^b {check Ginsburg}) suggest ידעם (cf. CDCH 147^b), whether pointed as a perfect or as an imperfect. As BHQ (*64) points out, it is not certain that G does so read, but such does seem likely. Either reading could have arisen due to an error of sight, and intrinsic evidence is not decisive. It seems best to retain the M reading but to accord the apparent G reading in the margin.

Hos 9:13

If the sense is “become,” היה or a verb of motion would seem to be required (Jenni 3: 33 *ad fin*; he classes cases like Pr 10:7 differently, *contra* ICC). Jenni (270) flags this verse, though he interprets צור as a different lexeme than does ICC. Taking כאשר ראיתי to be calling back מצאתי in v10, I take the *lamedh* here to be asseverative and understand this to mean, “When I first saw Ephraim, he was a planted tree [i.e., well-situated for success]; yet this same Ephraim [following ICC on this point], etc.” As with so much of this book, however, the matter is obscure.

Hos 9:16

See 8:7 and BDB.

Hos 11:5

The M reading לא is impossible (see v5c and 11) unless pointed לָא (KEL cites an article arguing that M לא here is some sort of alternative spelling for לו; we have not read the article, but consider such unlikely). G almost certainly had לו in place of this form, and seems to be a reliable guide in this portion of Hosea. The verb יכל in combination with the preposition ל does, admittedly, usually have a more overt military sense than is found here (cf. BDB 408^a), but subterfuge is often hinted at in the verb, and here the gradual mastery of a horse's reluctance is a plausible picture. The LXX tense-form utilized for the following verb (κατάφευγεν) implies ישב, the root of which, however, was misidentified. M identifies the root correctly, but seemingly makes the spelling *plene* out of habit.

{Post-mosaic: But אוכיל almost certainly means “feed” (the parallel line is “loosening the yoke from the jaws”), and אכל does not elsewhere collocate with ל, or anything comparable. Therefore, an asseverative is preferable.}

Hos 12:1a-b

A positive connotation seem unlikely, to a degree from the verb itself (if the verb רוד is indeed present) and especially from v3. The Syriac/Targumic pointing seems likely: “As for Judah – the people of God still roams aimlessly, even (see BDB 252b near top) the people of the faithful Holy One.” The preposition represented in M can hardly mean “as it relates to” (so BDB, CDCH; not yet check HALOT).

Hos 13:7

The M reading is difficult to make sense of in context and might reflect the mere accidental loss of a letter of anticipation of the peculiar (and therefore memorable) ואי soon to appear in this passage (v10 and v14).

{Post-script: But this might be a dialectical form, and it is hardly certain that G read ואהיה, and if it did, that could simply be a normalization. M is retained, though a marginal reading could be warranted.}

Hos 13:9

Either reading could have arisen from the other owing to the similarity of *beith* and *mem* in some early scripts. NET (1692 n¹⁴) argues that the “interrogative... harmonizes well with the interrogatives in 13:9-10.” Other editors (see BHS, NEB) concur. On the other hand, NAC (19A:259-60) suggests that **כי** be rendered “from me” (with **בעזרך** explicating this word), and the notion of God as the source of judgment fits well with v11. It is difficult to determine whether or not G had the word **כי**; if it did not, the insertion of this conjunction in M is difficult to account for. It is likely the case, then, that G misread this line, accidentally skipping over **כי** and confusing **כי** with **מי**.

{Post-script: It is also possible that **כי** is a corrupt dittography, possibly of **מי** but more likely of **כי**. The NAC suggestion is difficult to evaluate, for on the one hand Hosea is possibly written in a non-standard dialect, and on the other hand there is much uncertainty regarding “northern” dialect(s) (some really Judean?) in general, including the use of **ך** in the sense of “from.”}

Hos 14:1

Possibly the aleph in **תאשם** is a corrupt dittograph of *taw*, but see ICC for arguments that (esp. in Hosea) the meaning is “bear the punishment for guilt.”

Hos 14:6, 7

Elsewhere in MinP, including Hos (14:8), **לבנון** is unambiguously anarthrous.

Joel 1:18

=“are shattered” (cf. HALOT 2: 1564b). A spelling typical of MinP.

Joel 2:23

The expression **כראשון** occurs elsewhere only in Lev 9:15, so M could be an assimilation to more common usage. The *kaph* reading, however, does not represent a common expression, though it does seem to be a favorite of Ezekiel's (Gen 8:13, Num 9:5, Eze 29:17, 30:20, 45:18, v21). The combination of a fairly even split in external evidence (notice the alignment of the Vulgate with G) and the ease with which *beith* and *kaph* are confused in some scripts make a decision difficult. Marginal reading?

Joel 4:1

In favor of the Kt, the *qal* can be transitive when the object is **שובת** (BDB sub **שוב**).

Joel 4:21

Editors are divided: Ginsburg, NEB, Davidson, KEL (145-46) and NICOT (117) favor M's **ונקיתי**, while BHS, BDB (667^a), NET, NAC (19A:396-97) and, tentatively, HALOT (1:720^b) favor G's **ונקמתי**.

The M reading is surely the more difficult: The word **דם**, when construed in the singular, refers to shed blood, not guilt (NAC 19A:396), and “the text [of Joel] nowhere else mentions any such sins [as M would imply] on the part of the Jews” (ibid, 397; see ibid, 397 n⁵⁷ regarding the approach adopted in NICOT 117). (Such defeats the intrinsic arguments in favor of M cited in KEL 146.) M can be explained reasonably easily on the assumption that the G text is original here, for only a single letter separates the two readings, and **ונקמתי** could have become **ונקיתי** in anticipation of **נקיתי** later in the verse. (Possibly *mem* and *yodh* could be confused in the paleo script, though we are unaware of example of this {look into}, and the direction of change {footnote Tov} would be difficult to determine in such a case, making G as easily the original text as M in this scenario.)

A complication is determining whether G also reflects a different *Vorlage* for **לא נקיתי**, inasmuch as the LXX has **καὶ οὐ γὰρ ἔσθωμεν**. The scenario BHS posits (that G read **ולא אנקה**) is difficult to imagine on transcriptional grounds. More likely, **נקיתי** is rendered as a future-oriented perfect (and thus emphatic), the LXX translator interpreting **לא נקיתי** as an independent rather than a relative clause (as many modern translators do, probably rightly as well shall see). The **καὶ** might represent a different *Vorlage*, but if so, the conjunction

would not necessarily be original (scribes often supply *waw* in comparable cases), and it is quite possible that the LXX is simply avoiding what would be a harsh instance of asyndeton.

The G reading itself is not without difficulties. In addition to the difficulties just mentioned with respect to interpreting the *Vorlage* of the LXX, there is the question of how to construe *לֹא נִקְיִי* if *נִקְמָתִי* is read. On the face of it, G has God saying that he will avenge blood that He has not (!) declared innocent. One theoretical solution is to change the pointing on *לֹא* from the negative *לֹא* to the asseverative *לֹא־*, in which case one can understand something like, “And I will avenge the blood of those whom indeed I reckon innocent.” This solution is inadmissible, however, for as Huehnergard (592) notes, this asseverative particle cannot occur in subordinate clauses. Another option is to take *לֹא נִקְיִי* as an independent clause with an implied object (the offending nations of v19) and v21 as a triplet (not a couplet): “And I will avenge their blood / I do not hold [these nations] guiltless / For the LORD dwells in Zion.” Yet the insertion of “these nations” seemed forced, as does a triplet formulation after so many doublets in a row. There are, moreover, probably too few words for a triplet in this case. Almost certainly, then, *לֹא נִקְיִי* is relative, not independent. A refinement makes the *mem* after *דָּם* enclitic: “And I will avenge [the (article omitted b/c poetry)] blood-guilt which [viz.] I have not (more smoothly: I have never) declared innocent, for the LORD dwells in Zion.” The question here is whether *נִקָּה* can, when the sense is “make or consider innocent” can have an object whose referent is a wicked deed or person. It appears that it can (e.g. Ex 20:7).

Intrinsic and transcriptional evidence seems to favor G, yet the unit is certainly difficult. Thus G occupies the main text, but M remains in the margin.

{8/11/19 update: Some notes before an important additional argument: (1) The distinction between *דָּם* and *דָּמִים* is not necessarily as firm as stated above; even NAC, from whence the position comes, leaves some wiggle room. That said, (2) the idea of the sin(s) of the covenant people are not in view in this context, making the idea of pardon unlikely, and (3) the emphasis in the immediate context on the attacks of the enemies make the idea of recompense very fitting. (4) In the paleo script *mem/yodh* confusion is certainly possible.

I had rejected reading *וְלֹא אִנְקָה* on the basis that (a) transcriptionally a move from there to M was quite unlikely and (b) the addition of a conjunction and the switch to the future tense could easily have taken place on the Greek level, or, to advance this line of attack, even on the Hebrew level. The second point remains a possibility, but as to the first, (α) an initial *aleph* could have been lost due to haplography from the preceding *לֹא* or *וְלֹא*, (βa) *he* and *yodh* are similar in some paleo scripts, (βb) *taw* and *he* are similar in the square script, in which script *yodh* is small and so easily supplied or ignored, more so than on average after a similar-looking letter like *nun*, and (γ) given the probable error earlier in the verse, it is not unlikely that M erred again soon afterward, or that the line was damaged and an attempt was made to repair it (cf. Longacre's essay to in the *Humanities* volume of the Judean texts series; under this scenario an accidental move from *וְלֹא* to *לֹא* is possible). Reading *וְנִקְמָתִי דָּמִים וְלֹא אִנְקָה* is smoother than *לֹא נִקְיִי דָּם*, on which see above, and certainly more sensible in context than *לֹא נִקְיִי דָּמִים*. Intrinsically, the use of *וְלֹא* here seems to be found elsewhere in Joel: 2:7, 19, 26, and possibly 27.}

{10/8/19 update (by way of footnote): NICOT 117n⁴⁷ objects to retroverting the OG *ἐκδικαίειν* as *נִקָּה* because the former apparently translates *נִקָּה* in Zech 5:3. However, given the graphic similarity of *he* to final *mem*, the G *Vorlage* there might well have read *נִקָּה* via visual error.}

{11/03/23 update: Both retroversions are tenuous, but particularly the the *וְלֹא אִנְקָה*. Additionally, the intrinsic factor that Jer 25:29-30 is either cited in or cited by Joel 4 makes the M reading much more likely. See Allen regarding the syntax, adding that Joel 4:16c-17a is a nearby confirmation that Joel would follow up a verbless clause with a *waw*+perfect referring to the future. Note as well (cf. HALOT) that *דָּם* in the singular can indeed refer to guilt. The meaning, then, is “Will I hold those murderers guiltless? I will not! For Yahweh dwells in Zion.”}

Amos 2:7 (+8:4)

See HALOT 2: 1375b and Tawil 390b, noting also the propensity of MinP toward vocalic *alephs*.

Amos 5:8-9

Dijkstra (Pericope vol. 5, 127; cf. 135) wonders whether the sectional break is secondary here. Yet not only is the external evidence strong (M^{ACL} and others) for a closed section, there may be intrinsic evidence: The participial form with reference to God with which v9 starts is stately indeed (cf. Ps 104, etc.), and reminds one of the unexpected closed sections within the priestly blessing of Num (someone in a different Pericope essay supposes the solemn, stately nature of the passage to be the reason for the pauses), so the closed section might be here to add gravity to the description of a mighty God.

Amos 8:14

On the pointing of באשמה see 2 Ki 17:30 and Livingstone in Geller, Greenfield, Weitzman, ed., *Studia Aramaica*, 142. (NICOT objects that this reading would assume a post-Assyrian date for Amos, but Tayma (as Wikipedia spells it) was ancient, so there is no reason to think that knowledge of this god had not already spread in the pre-Assyrian era, particularly given Tayma's status as a trade nexus).

Amos 9:3

The conjunction on the first word of the verse, lacking in G (so most MSS of the LXX), would easily have been supplied by assimilation. On the other hand, an inner-greek corruption is not to be ruled out, nor faulty memory or other oversight on the part of the translator. The M form achieves greater balance. The case being doubtful, the M form, which carries none of the risks of retroversion, is retained, but the apparent G form would merit a place in the margin.

Amos 9:12

It is difficult to tell whether the LXX stems from transcriptional error, a targumizing exemplar, or targumizing translation (cf OG-4:13, though that might be simply a transcriptional error). If there was a consonantal text reading ידרשו שארית אדם, it is much easier to derive this sequence from M ידרשו את שארית אדם than the other way around: While *daleth/resh* confusion is not a problem (nor would it would in the other direction), and while the insertion of a helping letter in אדם understood as אָדם is certainly possible, as is the insertion of a second *yodh* after *daleth* had become *resh*, the insertion of את is quite difficult to explain and the syntax is strange (assuming that Zeigler is correct in his short text; the plus του κατω is probably from Ac 15, as he notes). Particularly given the strength of M in this book, its text should be retained, especially when such an unusual sequence of events would have to be posited in order to get to its text. Note with BECNT-Acts that what James highlights in Ac 15 is “called by My name,” which is not at issue, so if we are correct in positing the priority of M over LXX here does not affect the argument in the Jerusalem Council.

{Post-script: (1) NB the discussion in 113 of the Sailhamer FS against the backdrop of the whole essay. (2) An alternative to consider: If with some OG witnesses με is to be inserted after εκζητησωσιν, we could read ידרשוני שארית אדם. Then וכל הגוים would fit syntactically somewhat better. MT could be explained as transcriptional error (*yodh/daleth* confusion plus loss of י after ו plus addition of a helping letter; note on the latter point that if אדם is the original text, the pointing אָדם might be required) followed by insertion of את; or as an emendation avoiding Gentile inclusion. But against this theory, the OG reading in question is dubious, there are the factors noted in the previous paragraph, and something of a parallel text in Ob 19.}

Joel 1:15

Taking M as a starting point, it is very hard to explain the origin of the G text (the Syriac might be due to dittography), so M is probably errant here. The Syriac reading (placed in the margin) could easily explain the other readings (G being due to dittography, M being due to homoeotetuton), but this reading has rather weak external support. The G (and Vulgate) reading also readily explains the other readings (the Syriac reading being due to moderate, the M reading to severe homoeotetuton) and boasts fairly strong external support, so it is probably correct.

{Post-script: G's 3x would seem to overload the meter (cf. NICOT); M's 1x possibly is too short, which could argue for P's 2x, but this is not clear, and again P is not strong external evidence. Some intrinsic evidence: The word אהה is never repeated in the OT. Indeed, in the ESV “woe” never occurs more than once in a single

verse in the OT. Related transcriptional evidence: In the ESV NT, “woe” *does* occur more than once in a number of verses, most notably in Rev 8:13, where (in both RP05 and NA27) it occurs *three* times in a row; the OG translator, then, *might* have been influenced by this. In the end, then, it seems safest to retain MT.}

Ob 1:13

A 2nd person singular with an energetic ending: See NICOT 157n¹¹. Allen's pointing seems to be off, however, based on a BibleWorks9 search of such forms (e.g. תקחנה in Eze 5:1).

Ob 1:7

“Those who eat with you.” See NICOT 150 n²⁷ for a detailed discussion.

Ob 1:17

See NICOT 163n¹²; so also BHS.

Ob 1:21

See NICOT 163n¹³; so also BHS (which, however, also proposes an emendation). Seems to jive better with v17 and the theme of a chosen remnant (Edom being a foil: not chosen, so not surviving).

Mic 1:12

The שַׁעַר of M could be dittography (note following letter), but the שַׁעַר of GS could be dittography or assimilation to the phrase שַׁעַר יְרוּשָׁלַם that occurs 9x (not counting Ps 122:2) elsewhere. Mic 1:9 suggests that Micah would use the singular, and the phraseology there is different enough and far enough removed from our verse that assimilation in M is unlikely.

Mic 2:5-6

See Pericope, vol. 3, pp. 90, 95-96. The nature of section (open or closed) is probably impossible to deduce from the OG, but the pattern within Mic suggests an open.

{Post-script: In Pericope vol. 5 re Zech, the divergence is paragraphing between OG and MT appears to be very wide indeed, even though in the same volume (see on Ugaritic cultic texts) the correspondence is Leviticus is very close. Provisionally, it appears that (1) the faithfulness of Greek translators to paragraphing varied, and (2) the MinP translator was not very faithful, making a change here based solely on OG testimony {unless a fuller collation of the Hebrew tradition would turn something up?} very tenuous indeed.}

Mic 3:7

It is possible (see BHQ) that אֱלֹהִים is an error for אֱלֹהִים, but מַעֲנֶה and the verb עָנָה appear not to be used with this preposition elsewhere, but they *are* collocated with אֶל, supporting M here. (NAC, KEL, WBC do not directly comment; BHQ declines to follow G without comment.)

Mic 5:5-6

Against changing L's paragraphing here see Pericope 9: 148-149.

Mic 5:14-6:1

Against changing L's paragraphing here see Pericope 9: 148-149.

Mic 6:10

For the problematic הָאֵשׁ we tentatively put הָאֵשׁ: An apocaphated 1st person common singular *qal* from נָשָׂה, “forget” (pointed on the analogy of the verb נָטַח when apocaphated; note the interrogative prefix and its form before an *aleph*). (Reading הָאֵשׁ would be preferable, perhaps, given 6:11, but there seems to be no external evidence for this.) Short prefix tenses do occur elsewhere in MinP (at least: Hos 12:5), and Micah is an old prophet (cited by Jeremiah's contemporaries as a past figure). Either the preterite sense is at this stage of Hebrew

a bit bleached, or the parallelism with **הַזִּכָּה** in v11 is past-future: “Have I forgotten? ...Will I acquit?”

Nah 1:5a

G probably has **הַהָרִים** for M **הָרִים**, which would then balance with **וְהַגְבָּעוֹת**. M could be due to haplography. However, Ges 126k (*rem.* 2) points out that arthrous and anarthrous nouns can appear in parallel (it cites the present verse, which is admittedly debatable, and 2 chr 3:17, where the text-critical case against MT is weak indeed); that this is poetry makes this syntactical variation all the more plausible. Indeed, M has a chiasm with respect to the articles:

הָרִים

וְהַגְבָּעוֹת

וְהָרָאץ

וְהַתְּבֵל

Finally, note that G appears also to have **וְהַתְּבֵל**, from which it is much harder to derive the M form. So it appears that G has leveled these four nouns to the arthrous forms.

{The one thing that *might* be said for G is metrics. But as this is uncertain at best, M seems more than safe to retain, at least until firmer metrical evidence is available.}

Nah 1:5b

Concerning the proposal to repoint **וְהָרָאץ**, see NICOT (Renz) and also note the *absence* of the necessary sense in Tawil 249-250. In other words, MT should be retained.

Nah 1:6

Jenni (3: 264) flags this, and G seems to have **מִלְפָּנַי** or **מִפְּנֵי**. M could be assimilation to the more common form (**לִפְנֵי** being ubiquitous in the OT) or, if **מִלְפָּנַי** is understood, near haplography after the preceding *he*. However, I doubt that M is really a problem.

Nah 1:7a

Jenni (3: 36) puts under rubric 1157 along with Ps 48:8. Is **טִיב** here a verb? In any case, pointing with an asseverative *lamedh* is probably unnecessary.

Nah 1:8

BHS' **בְּקִמְיוֹ** is attractive (as far as the sense and the parallelism), but the suffix would seem to be a conjectural emendation. DCH proposes deleting the *mapiq* and rendering “opposition,” which seems plausible. Now, the *mapiq* is probably artificial in any case (cf. Blau p. 173 §4.2.3.5.2n), so altering it, at least where no *lapsus calami* is involved, is arguably as inconsistent as repointing to or from a *waw* consecutive. Yet for an edition that is basically Tiberian, and one designed to be user-friendly, I think making changes of this nature (viz., this case and also *waw* consecutives where applicable) is advisable. A future, more scholarly edition can handle cases like this as part of a much larger overhaul of the pointing system.

Nah 1:14

Cf. HALOT 2:1325b together with Renz.

Nah 2:2

See NICOT (Renz) 112 n^a, though he ultimately does not opt for the adjustment. Eze 9:2 seems especially suggestive to me.

Nah 2:3

=“the Lord lopped off.” See HALOT 2: 1382a and the helpful discussion in NET (though they ultimately stay with MT).

Nah 2:14

See NICOT (Renz) 148 n^b. Note also forms elsewhere in Nahum like מקומה.

Nah 3:19

Reading גהה for כהה cannot be ruled out entirely, but DCH shows evidence for a word כהה in ancient times which, it seems to me, fits this passage.

Hab 2:4c

Re נפש, note first of all that ישר does not seem to bear the meaning “find pleasing” *pace* OG (Heb 10:38 adopting this reading as a rendering which, though inexact, nonetheless captures the spirit of the biblical teaching, as well as representing the version his Greek-speaking audience would be familiar with); the only possible examples of this meaning are Isa 45:13 and Ps 119:128, but in both cases other meanings are possible (“make level” in the former and “go straight on in, i.e. be firmly committed to” in the latter). Also, see NICOT (Robertson) on the parallelism. So G נפש is either a visual error, or an assimilation to an erroneous אמונת (see below) if that error occurred priorly, or an emendation or free / exegetical rendering.

Hab 2:4d

It will become important to be aware that, while the preposition on the front of אמונה that appears here should could, on transcriptional grounds, be thought to be either a *beth* (so M) or *mem* (so G), for either could be due to transcriptional error in an early script. The verb היה elsewhere takes the former where the source of life is in view, and indeed uses the latter when recovery from a threat to life is in view, so the *beth* is preferable on intrinsic grounds. The NT (Rom 1:17, Gal 3:11, Heb 10:38) uses εα, but such is merely following the LXX where its imperfection leaves the sense of the passage intact.

The NT citations of the rest of the word, however, are difficult to explain. Might μου be secondary (as in W^c as recorded by Ralphs)? If so, perhaps the original form was אמונתה, which form was early misread as אמונתו and then regularized to אמונתו. The original LXX readings appears sometimes to be poorly preserved; sometimes, to judge by Jeremiah 10 (see also THB 1A regarding the OL), only in versional evidence. Another suggestion is באמונות (HALOT 1:62^b-63^a). This suggestion is doubly attractive in that it involves fewer steps and appeals to transposition, an error apparently instanced in M's עפלה. Reading באמונתה or באמונות faces the difficulty that such a form, i.e. the *beth* prefix but not the *waw* or *yodh* suffix, is nowhere unequivocally attested. But either could be attested in the Syriac בהימנותא. This difficulty here is that the Syriac is of a late date and has a penchant for easy readings; BHQ, moreover, suggests (118*) that the NT citations are themselves the source of the Syriac rendering. Nevertheless, the Syriac attests to an early form of the M text, so it is plausible that one of these readings is original to M and informed Paul and the author of Hebrews (or Paul, who then influenced the author of Hebrews) as to the necessity of adjusting the LXX reading. Perhaps this scenario is correct, or perhaps Paul was paraphrasing a bit to make the sense clear (“the faith that he has”). The simplest solution is to retain M here.

{Post-script: Re the NT passages, perhaps Paul is paraphrasing the OG, omitting μου since – although quite possibly the intent of the translator was “faith in me,” something Paul would agree with – the phrase could be misunderstood as meaning “the faithful lifestyle of which I set the standard.” Or perhaps Paul here preserves the original OG reading, but if so, the OG was (before its later updating to be more literal) paraphrasing a bit in removing the possessive pronoun *without* warrant from the Hebrew text (a common practice in P and in, iirc, OG-Isa).}

Hab 3:13

It is possible that some MSS have משיחך, but (at least) M^L, M^A (I looked at the photos), Ginsburg, MM have משיח. There is other strong external evidence for the singular (see BHQ). The OG MS division is divided (B and S have a singular; most other witnesses have a plural). There are intrinsic argument either way; the M^L form could of course be a defective spelling of the plural; but in terms of the spelling, the defective is most likely correct.

Hab 3:16b

This is an interesting exegetical question indeed, basically coming down to whether Habakkuk is anticipating “with awesome sympathy” (those words, or something like them, are used by NICOT-Robertson iirc) (1) the (eventual) downfall of the Babylonians (NICOT-Renz, KEL, NAC [but allowing for the alternative interpretation], WBC, NET) or (2) the (relatively more immediate) downfall of Judah (NICOT-Robertson). The preceding portion of the poem points to God's deliverance of his people, while the following verse depicts trust *despite* impending trouble, so to some extent the question is whether to group this verse with what precedes (option 1) or with what follows (option 2), but in general absence of section breaks here there is ambiguity it seems. On the face of it, his deep distress seems to point to option 2. The parallel line is אָנוּחַ לַיּוֹם צָרָה, and if the verb is one of repose, perhaps option 1 is to be favored; if one of anguish, perhaps option 2 is preferable. That the term is one of anguish is (*pace* WBC) suggested by the previous lines of the verse (as well as by the predominance of synonymous, not synthetic, parallelism in this poem). Also, the verb עלה is quite fitting in describing invading Babylonians coming to Jerusalem, but not so obviously fitting for trouble coming upon *them*. All that said, an asseverative *lamedh* seems preferable here (“when the people who invades us comes up”). Its presence here is fitting for three reasons. First, a poem with some possible archaisms is a good location for such. Second, Habakkuk loves sound plays, so that the first two letters of לַעֲמֹךְ play off of the first two letters of לַעֲלֹךְ. Third, to the extent that the asseverative imparts a certain emphasis, the “people that will invade us” presents an awful climax to the rising horror of the verse.

Zeph 1:5

Re pointing of במלכּם: See esp. NICOT for argumentation against adjusting the pointing. In the end it makes little differences; the sense is essentially the same. (WBC provides some striking devotional thoughts, viz. that in this passage three errors of increasing subtlety are condemned: Open idolatry, syncretism, and orthodoxy lacking actual engagement with God.) Yet it seems that there is evidence that Molech/Milchom continued to be worshiped (indeed, Josiah himself moved against it), and of a close connection between this deity and Baal (see Kitto 3: 197^b [full discussion of this deity is *ibid.*, 197^a-198^a]), so the change in pointing here adopted seems most reasonable.

{Post-script: The reference probably is to Milchom, but the pointing need not be changed. See the special section devoted to this subject near the top of this file.}

Zeph 3:6

See on 2:14 above.

Zeph 3:15

The third word could be pointed מְשַׁפְּטִיךְ (so BHS) and אֵיבֶךָ taken as a collective reference to enemies (IBHS, followed by NAC). Yet the immediate context (v11ff) stresses the removal of sin from the people and their moral purification, and the following statement that God is in their midst hearkens back to many a text that links the presence of God to his people's holiness (Ps 15, etc.; perhaps most fully developed in Ezekiel, a later book yet surely drawing on earlier material). So likely the third word here refers to sin-guilt, and possibly the enemy here is Satan. It is not clear whether he is elsewhere so named in the OT, but Zechariah will later depict Satan in a similar context, and Isaiah would seem to refer to him in similar terms as well.

Zeph 3:20b

Since the use of the infinitive is more of a late feature and seems unattested in Zeph apart from the stereotyped מִהֵרָ, the infinitive קִבַּצְךָ is tentatively taken as in construct with עַתָּה; the *waw* is explicative (“In that time I will do good to you, even in the time when I will gather you, for etc.”).

Hag 1:10

שָׁמִים: See WLC transcription note “k.” (WTT in BibleWorks9 has the expected form for some reason; accidental correction?)

Hag 1:12

See NICOT 62 n^a.

Zech 1:10

Re הַהֲדָסִים: BHS records an aberrant L pointing, but WLC has the correct form.

Zech 2:2

The syntax of M is not anomalous (as per WTT on וירושלים and ישראל and ירושלם are similarly grouped in Mal 2:11; NICOT also points to Joel 4:16, though the case there is perhaps a bit different. Nevertheless, the plus could be a corrupt dittography of ישראל; cf. the textual commentary on 6:13a, and note that in G a very similar error occurred in v4 (viewing these two verses together was suggested to me by BHQ, though it prefers to see G-v4 as an assimilation to G-v2, which, however, it, by circular reasoning, explains as assimilation to G-v4!).

{Post-script: But the את before ישראל would have to become ואת to be sensible, and while the OG can be retroverted thus, the transcriptional path becomes strained. We have, rather, either a G or an OG intervention whereby the scattering of Jerusalem is avoided.}

Zech 2:12

This is a difficult case, for it does seem quite possible that that L^{kt} is an emendation (cf. the comments on Jdg 10:16). Yet confusion between *waw* and *yodh* is not impossible, especially in the Herodian script, and if כִּי הִנֵּנִי etc. is read as the word of the Lord (a reading easily triggered by the first words of the verse) rather than as the words of a prophet (whether Zechariah or perhaps Jesus; cf. שלחני and the extensive commentary in NICOT 197-202). Yet for an emendation to have nearly overwhelmed both the G and the M traditions, but not quite G in its entirety, seems unlikely; indeed, knowledge of the tradition of the Emendations of the Scribes might have led to the insertion of עֵינִי in some sources. According to Weber-Gryson, most key MSS of V reflect עֵינִי, but several reflect עֵינִי. I am reluctant to enter into textual criticism of the Vulgate at this point, but one does wonder: Might Jerome, familiar with Jewish tradition, have written *oculi mei*, while later tradents, familiar with the MT tradition corrected this to *olui eius*? If so, however, such might not lead one to favor עֵינִי, for Jerome might have heard word of the tradition and believed it but not actually seen a Hebrew MS with עֵינִי, or at least not one accurate on this point. BHS, BHQ, Ginburg, NAC favor עֵינִי; NICOT and NEB (196-97 n^e, 201-202) dissent; NET has one reading in the translation and another in the note; Davidson appears not to comments in either his introduction or his edition. M^{kt} is tentatively retained.

Zech 4:7

The reading הָהָר might earn a place in the margin (haplography), but is probably not correct. See NICOT (286^f) and references there.

Zech 5:11

Apparently a mixed form (so BHQ 139*; see also [at least] BHS “ב”).

Zech 6:13

It is possible if ο ἱερεὺς is the correct reading of the LXX (so Ralphs but not H-P; the MS tradition seems to be quite divided) that we should read הַכֹּהֵן with M being due to haplography. Note (a) that such might affect the interpretation of the passage (it would mean that the priest and the Branch are *not* the same person *pace* NAC; such might be the case even on the MT reading: see NICOT), and (b) that G could be due to dittography.

Zech 9:13

M might be an assimilation. Yet two factors weigh against G: The agreement with T suggests that these two rabbinic-sourced versions (G less so than T, to be sure) might be independently evidencing some *tendenz* here. Second, the consonant string בִּנְיָ occurs 47x in L, but בְּנִי over 1,000x, so that the G reading might be owing to

an accidental substitution of a more common form by a hasty tradent.

Zech 14:3

BHS has L bearing an anomalous form, but WLC has the correct form.

Zech 14:5

Re אצל HALOT 1:82a makes a suggestion that seems to have merit. On the other hand, NICOT makes an interesting suggestion (the river going *through* Jerusalem; cf. “there is a city that makes glad the city of God,” Rev 21) based on MT. One to revisit, but for now it seems best to retain MT.

Zech 11:2

BHQ (144*), demurs (“dialectically different but identical in meaning”). BDB prefers Kt.

Mal 1:7

The suffix on גאלנוך is slightly unexpected, though far from impossible. G might have read (if OG is not paraphrasing) גאלנום (NICOT, perhaps following BHS, says גאלנוהם, but I think that is not correct [cf. ידענום, Isa 59:12]); if so, M is plausibly an error, including in an early Aramaic-style script, in which Malachi might well have been written. But there is no clear masculine plural antecedent (the best candidate is להם, understood collectively; but note the *singular* participle מגאל which qualifies it), and the visual error might have been *from* (rather than *to*) the letter *kaph*. Also, there is a somewhat similar mismatch between question and answer in 2:17, and while reading with (O)G הוגענוהו is *possible*, it seems somewhat of a stretch, especially given the character of the witness for it. In short, M seems preferable (here and in Mal 2:17).

Mal 2:15

M's יבגד is slightly unexpected, and perhaps it is a visual error (but I suspect Malachi was written in a modern, not paleo, script) or an assimilation to the frequent use of 3ms in the surrounding context (but note the 2mp almost immediately before this word). But the external evidence is suspicious, and using a 3ms in a generic sense seems to be part of Malachi's style (1:10, 2:12, 3:8). So M is preferable, though not overwhelmingly so.

1 Chr 2:1

Re the discrepancy in number with the parallel passage, see Concordia-1 Ki.

1 Chr 3:16

See Allen 2: 96. I wonder, though, whether יה and ה as endings on personal names are interchangeable for this stage of Hebrew? There is a parallel case to be handed in the same way as this one (currently the following item does *not* appear in the readings file):

11:23 ברכה see *ibid*, 96-97

1 Chr 4:12

For רכה WBC proposes to read רכב and see here a reference to the Rechabites. Such would be interesting – note NAC re the Kennizites in the near context. The name עיר נחש could be problematic, unless עיר means something other than “city” here. Also the OG tradition should be looked into (Ralphs differs from WBC and BDB [sub רכה] here); and G at any rate could easily be an error. As WBC points out in the comments, אנשי suggests a place. The Rechabites seem perhaps to have been gentiles.

1 Chr 4:19

See Allen 2: 137. The external evidence seems quite a stretch; rather, the c2 O reading is probably an inner-Greek assimilation to v18.

1 Chr 4:41

The Qr does not appear to have external support, and elsewhere there is support for the *yodh* form.

1 Chr 6:7

For עֲמִינַדָב WBC reads יִצְהָר, but while on intrinsic grounds this is appealing the external evidence seems not to be there. WBC lists G^{AL}, but according to Cambridge, the Lucianic MSS have a plus, not a replacement. A is among those witnesses that apparently correct to the MT in v25, so it seems not to be the strongest witness {and THB says that A is not a strong witness as well}.

1 Chr 6:12

WBC here adds “And Samuel his son” with G^L, but this external evidence is not particularly compelling. WBC concedes says “The connection, however, may have been assumed by the writer.” He was a famous person, obviously, and the Chronicler seems sometimes to digress to address especially important or notable points.

1 Chr 6:62

Assuming the locality is referred to in Josh 21:35 as in 19:13, 1 Chr 6:62, might this be a place where chr witnesses an earlier text? Resh/dalet confusion is certainly polygenetic. Something to revisit

1 Chr 7:31

Re Kt-Qr, see esp. HALOT. The vowel following the *beth* is somewhat uncertain.

1 Chr 8:8

See HALOT 2: 1516a.

1 Chr 8:12

Some (Allen 2: 115; BDB) propose שָׁמֶר for שְׁמֶר, but the intrinsic evidence does seem to bear up.

1 Chr 8:25

Re Kt-Qr, cf. on Gen 32:31 above.

1 Chr 8:37

Allen 2: 96 argues for רַפְיָה, but M's רַפָּה is probably an alternate spelling (compare Kitchen, *On the Reliability of the OT*, 19-20).

1 Chr 9:33

The Qr is hard to rule out, but the Kt seems like it might reflect a late Hebrew formation (like נְחִינִים in Neh), influenced by Aramaic?

1 Chr 11:33

See on 3:16 above.

1 Chr 12:23

J-M p504 n3 proposes emending יִבְאוּ, but this does not seem necessary, nor does OG support.

1 Chr 17:17

See *Kingdom through Covenant* 400-401 for intrinsic arguments in favor of MT.

1 Chr 19:3

For וְלִהְפֹּךְ HALOT (1:253b) would read וְלִחְפֹּךְ, and OG seemingly supports this. However, the same verb occurs in 2 Sam 10:3, and assimilation seems unlikely (both because the passage is not famous and because the verbiage differs a bit from one passage to the other), as does this precise error *twice* in widely separate passages;

furthermore, this error would most likely occur in a fairly modern script, which further narrows the scope of when this might have happened. (Neither Allen nor WBC comment.)

1 Chr 20:2

See on 2 Sm 12:30 above.

1 Chr 25:9

Revisit w/ Walters (155-158), who reads גדליהו השני with V, which Walters take to here be “a pre-Jerome Latin text which clearly reflects a LXX text in agreement with the original uncorrupted Hebrew” (156).

1 Chr 26:9

See Allen 2: 95 on this VU, noting that קהה there is surely (but double-check BHS) a typo for קהת.

1 Chr 27:27

=“vinedressers”; so HALOT (1:498b *sub* כרם I).

1 Chr 29:1

Revisit w/ Walters (142-143): he argues that, in a doublet, G shows a “preferable” (143) אשר for M אהד. (Holmstedt does not comment specifically on this passage.) Chet/shin change is unusual, but perhaps such was prompted by anticipation of the following בחר.

1 chr 29:11

See Allen 2: 129. However, reconstructing the OG here is difficult, making it unclear whether its *Vorlage* really read as Allen supposes. Moreover, this might be a case of *lamedh* functioning in a genitive marker (cf. the VU in 15:16; Wise, *Literacy*; other literature on diachronics in chr?).

1 chr 29:16

Re Kt-Qr: Qr is probably an emendation to the grammatical gender of כל. The Kt is to be explained under Ges 122q or 122s.

2 Chr 1:14

For ועם G seems to have read והעם עם (also in 1 Ki 10:26). This would alleviate the oddity of shifting from the proposition ב to the proposition עם, but for this error to have occurred twice seems odd (though perhaps in M one text was accidentally assimilated to the other), and it further introduces the difficulty of understanding how the army could be said to be stationed in Jerusalem (and by implication, Jerusalem *alone*).

2 Chr 2:2

See HALOT 1: 313a – the cunieforn shows the vowel should be.

{Post-script: The matter is not so simple, however. Consider some data points:

In Gen 32:21, we find the spelling פניאל for פנואל (iirc Hendel thinks this is simple a *waw/yodh* error, but the *yodh* might be an old genitive ending).

המוטל is twice (2 Ki 24:48, Jer 52:1) spelled המיטל (admittedly the OG versions {according to Ralphs, at least} have Αμυτα(α)λ in both cases). (HALOT points out that טל is the Aramaic reflex of Hebrew צל.)

sub אהומי, HALOT (1:31a) notes the Akkadian name *Ahuma* (“it is a brother”).

Not only is there such a large number of occurrences of variation along these lines that appealing to *waw/yodh* error in *every* case is unlikely, it turns out that there are *multiple* reasons to contemplate i/u variation in (somewhat) medial position in proper names: (1) The old nominative *u* and the old genitive *i* would both (a) tend to be retained in proper names, and (b) tend to occur in medial position; (2) Akkadian proper names would have been a major influence in Phoenician, Syrian, and other such locales and (though probably to a lesser extent) in Canaan (given Canaanite scribes' indebtedness to Akkadian practices); and perhaps it is also worth

noting that (3) the Hebrew passive marker /u/ and the Aramaic passive marker /i/ occur in the much the same position, again medial. The upshot of all of this is that there might have been a great deal of *linguistic* (not textual) variation (perhaps even confusion) in whether /i/ or /u/ occurred in such positions, to the extent that something approaching free variation might have been in force.

All this, together with translators' eternal propensity to level proper names and the general trustworthiness of the MT, call for retention of forms like חורם and ידותון, even if the exact linguistic or historical reasons for the variation or not clear in all cases (most notably perhaps ידותון; but other questions concerning the etymology of that name are muddy as well).}

2 Chr 2:3

Some argue that בנו was lost due to haplography, but corrupt dittography in G seems more likely to me.

2 chr 3:4

The source of the error is admittedly not easy to trace, but the verbiage [היכל הבית+] seems necessary. On the form of the plus and for the validity of the retroversion cf. OG-1 Ki 6:3.

{Post-script: But see 15:8 and WBC there. It seems the Chronicler was a bit laconic to our taste in describing the architecture of the Temple at times.

2 chr 4:10

Perhaps add בית after מכתף, see on 3:4 above.

2 Chr 4:11

In the space of a single verse, M(T) is inconsistent on the spelling of חירם, so allowing for basically free variation between the two forms (see on 2:2 above), one might argue that *waw/yodh* error has entered the picture here. In the source text (1 Ki 7:40), the name is spelled חירום the first time and חירם the second time. In the present verse, it is חורם the first time and חירם the second. The spelling חירום is unique to Kings and the spelling חורם unique to Chronicles. In the present verse there is only external evidence for חירם as a consistent spelling. It seems safest to retain MT. Indeed, perhaps there is a clined scale at work here by which the Chronicler turned the right-distant form חירום of Kings into the medial חירם and the medial חירם of Kings into (his preferred) left-distant חורם.

A similar situation obtains in Gen 4:18.

{Post-script: Cf. J-M p39 n1}

2 chr 5:1

For Allen 2: 129 would read את with G in harmony with the verbiage of 1 Ki 8:27. Yet while transcriptional error in M is possible here, M does make sense and may accord with diachronic developments (cf. the constant addition of conjunctions in G and in scattered Hebrew MSS elsewhere). The case being uncertain, we stick with M.

2 chr 6:22

The verb ונשא here is a bit obscure, but HALOT is happy with in, and the *naqdan(im)* for 1 Ki 8:31 handled it the same way (rather than ונשא).

2 Chr 6:28

Is בארץ שערי a case of a construct chain whose meaning is strictly the reverse (here, “the gates of the land”; cf. the passages cited by BDB near its reference to this verse sub שער)? Or does κατεναντι represent לפני (as often in 2 Chr)? In the latter case, surely this is a nonsensical error in G, since the besieged do not find themselves *before*, but *behind*, the gates of their cities. A variation on this is that the OG translator saw, or thought he saw, מקדם used the Aramaic sense. If so, this is even more likely to be an error, since not only does the word not make sense here, but it does not occur in this sense in the Hebrew Bible (קדם does occur as a preposition in the Aramaic portions, but this is probably beside the point).

2 Chr 7:21

Since **במה** in this sense seems to be unparalleled, it is tempted to posit visual error and to read **למה** (cf. 1 Ki 9:8 על **מה**). However, it is striking that **χατὰ τινοῦ** occurs nowhere else in the Greek Bible, suggesting that the Hebrew which is rendered is likewise unique.

2 Chr 8:16

Against reading **מיום** or **מן היום** for **עד היום**, this is transcriptionally very difficult to explain, is not prominent in the Chronicler's usage by any stretch, and for M(T) there is something of a parallel in 2 Chr 29:34. {But the parallel might not be apt, and perhaps M here is to be explained as anticipation of the following **ועד**?

2 Chr 8:16

WBC (99) defends MT, pointing to the last clause of 1 Ki 9:25 as the Chronicler's source text. Such might indeed have been his source text, but the wording is in any case far from identical. There are other problems with MT: If **יהוה שלם בית יהוה** is a complete clause, it would feel far more natural with **הָיָה** (which is characteristic of late books in any case, as the “stats” tab in BibleWorks shows) and perhaps inverted word order; not to mention a conjunction. Also, **ולתכן כל מלאכת שלמה** is itself a summary statement; to have another after the two (cf. the Research Notes on this verse) seems redundant even by Hebraic standards. These problems are alleviated if these three words are not an independent clause but a part of the *second* descriptor of the extent of Solomon's “work.” But how then to construe **שלם**? Now, WBC (and iirc a source cited favorably in HALOT sub *עד ad fin*) retroverts OG the relevant part of OG as **עד קִלַּת שְׁלֹמֹה בֵּית יְהוָה**, but another possibility that presents itself to my mind is **עד כלות שלמה בית יהוה**, i.e. appealing to metathesis (admittedly across a word boundary) facilitated by an unusual spelling of Solomon's name.

But since again 1 Ki 9:25 (on which see Tawil 403a) may be the source, and since this spelling is unattested, I tentatively opt for a simpler solution, viz. to reposit **שלם** as a *pi'el* verb. Asyndeton of this kind does seem to be of a piece with later Hebrew style (cf. e.g. 2 Chr 9:10 **הביאו**, if the text there be sound).

{Post-script: But as to the spelling, cf. **ירחה** in 1 Ki 16:34, which is as a one-time alternate spelling of **ירחו** indirectly supports the plausibility of such an orthographic interchange here.}

2 chr 9:1

Cf. Est 9:4. Probably omission of a letter / substitution of a more common noun for a rarer one.

2 chr 11:20

Allen 2: 120 suggests **שלמות** as in 1 chr 23:18, 26:28, but this seems to be a different individual (see BDB).

2 Chr 11:22

Pace Ges 147a, note the examples in J-M 154d.

2 Chr 12:1

Against reading **בְּהִכּוֹן**, cf. 1:4 w/ OG.

2 chr 14:6

The suggestion in Allen 2: 98 is quite interesting, but against it see WBC.

2 chr 15:16

See Allen 2: 104. M could be a doublet, but is there firm external evidence for synonymous doublets not attributable to corrupt dittography elsewhere in this witness? G could be an accidental omission of a word starting the same way as the next word which is similar in size, or a stylistic “improvement” such as seen elsewhere.

2 chr 16:4

=“in the west” (WBC).

2 chr 18:33

It is possible that the Kt is corrupt dittography or some similar error. The Qr, however, could be omission of the smallest letter, haplography (all four letters in this word resemble one another on the upper half), or assimilation to M-1 Ki 22:34 (or, less likely, to Lam 3:3 [and that if the text is sound], or, less likely still to M-1 Sam 14:19). Perhaps the idiom shifted over time for a singular יד to a plural ידים: In G-1 Ki 22:23 and in G-1 Sam 14:19 is found. If so, the relatively late date of chr would argue for the singular here, which seems to have the stronger external and transcriptional factors in its favor.

2 chr 20:1-2

In defense of מארם, see McKinny, *My People as Your People*, 42.

2 Chr 22:5

The form הרמים is not “the archers,” but “the Aramaeans”: see 2 Ki 8:29 and Blau 3.3.4.3.2.

2 chr 29:14b

Re Kr-Qr: Quite difficult; Qr could be right with G, or it could be an assimilation. Cf. HALOT.

2 Chr 29:34

Is ישרי an error for שלמי or something similar? OG has πρὸς τὸν μωϋσ.

2 chr 30:10

G-2 Chronicles 30:10 apparently (so Allen 2: 95) readings בארץ אפרים for בהר אפרים, but the former expression is about ten times more frequent in the OT than the latter is; accordingly, G is here deemed an assimilation.

2 Chr 31:7

Cf. HALOT (1:417a) and Ges.

2 chr 31:4

See Allen 2: 99. This seems a stretch for assimilation, and if there is not a good transcriptional explanation, MT is harder but not impossible and a good witness. The last three letters of בתורת are extremely similar בעבודת, and both words start with *beth*. The difficulty is in the word בית. Perhaps it was lost by haplography, or perhaps an original בתורת became בעבודת by transcriptional error and then either בית in the *Vorlage* or οίκου in the translation by way of emendation / targumizing clarification.

2 Chr 32:31

Following (at least) Jenni (3: 203), NEB, CSB, NIV ('84, at least). On the pointing, cf. J-M 35c2.

2 Chr 33:14

Adapting a suggestion in HALOT (1:739b), we might point נִסְכָּב. However, it is not totally certain this is necessary, and out of well over 300 occurrences of סביב or מסביב in the HB, *none* is spelled defectively.

2 chr 34:21

Allen 2: 130 would read דברי יהוה, but G could easily be dittography or assimilation to הספר earlier in the verse, and, while Allen cites 2 Ki 22:13 in support of G here, that passage reads דברי הספר where chr has דבר יהוה. Moreover, elsewhere in chr it is always דבר יהוה, never דברי יהוה. Thus, external (M) and internal (authorial usage supports strongly, and transcriptional error or assimilation readily explains the competitor) evidence point to the singular form with M.

2 chr 34:25

Re Kt-Qr: A search for the root קטר in chr shows a marked preference for the *hiph'il*.

2 Chr 35:3

Pointing as a *polet* (cf Ges 55b), though it is possible that both M and G are corrupt at this point.

2 chr 36:10

See

<http://evangelicaltextualcriticism.blogspot.com/2017/09/jechoniahs-uncle-and-text-of-2chron-3610.html#comments>

Intro to Psalms

Places where Ginsburg prefers a P reading in this book:

-7:3
-7:5
-8:2
-11:1
-15:4
-20:6
-20:8
-22:10
-22:31 (x2)
-30:13
-31:11
-37:18
-37:35
-37:36
-39:2
-49:20
-52:7 (or 9?)
-55:20
-55:22
-58:3

[is this list complete, or did I stop there?]

Ps 1:1

G T have הָאִישׁ for אִישׁ.

M could be an assimilation: The phrase אִשְׁרֵי הַגִּבּוֹר occurs 4x (Ps 34:9, 40:5, 94:12, 127:5), and an anarthrous word never intervenes between אִשְׁרֵי and אִשֶּׁר. (An arthrous word need not be linked to אִשֶּׁר, e.g. 8:4.) On the other hand, G T could be an assimilation to 112:1.

Which would fit better in the psalm? Curiously, the psalm seems bifurcated: Allowing for a repointing of בְּמִשְׁפָּט in v5, vv5-6 seems clearly (lack of article, concise wording, tight parallelism) to be classical poetry, while vv1-4 (ponderous lines, repeated use of אִשֶּׁר, use of the article in v4a [and consequently probably also in כְּמִן, v4b]) seem to be either elevated prose or a non-classical type of poetry. This lean of evidence would seem to point, albeit inconclusively, toward M.

Ps 1:4

The MT pointing of כְּמִן should be retained: See on v1.

Ps 1:5

Re במשפט see on v1 above.

Ps 2:9

The NT allusions (Rev 2:27, 12:5, 19:15) to this passage clearly reflect the LXX. But do they substantiate the G text as such, or merely draw on language with which John's readers would be familiar? The book of Revelation was mainly addressed to Christians lacking knowledge of Hebrew, so for them the LXX would be the only point of access to Psalm 2. Yet Psalm 2 in its LXX form would have been accorded special importance and prominence by them, given its appearance in Ac 4. All this would suggest that John is not necessarily speaking to the text. Furthermore, from a Jewish perspective John might have been playing with words, since the Hebrew consonants are susceptible to more than one interpretation. The MT pointing would certainly seem to fit the parallelism well. It might also be a dialectical form on a par with בר later in the psalm. On the other hand, in the immediate context of the psalm (as well as in the NT references) authority is the main point being made, destruction of enemies being an important but subsidiary idea. The nature of the ruling and the purpose of the rod might be somewhat ambiguous in the first poetic line intentionally, so that the second line can dramatically clarify.

Ps 2:12

David (for his authorship of Ps 2, cf. Ac 4:25) can hardly have had an Aramaism such as this in his writing, and the supposition of a later editor is in this case improbable in my opinion since there is no particular reason he would replace David's בן with בר here but nowhere else. (Pr 31:2 is a different case, for Lemuel's first language might have been Aramaic, or a Hebrew-Aramaic kluge.) For the revocalization, see HALOT [and NET].

Ps 3:5

Against the (admittedly ancient: Aquilla, Jerome, etc.) idea of repointing ויעניי cf. Jon 2:2.

Ps 4 *passim*

In favor of the perfect pointings, cf. TtT 1:32. A similar transition occurs at least in 143 to 144. Note as well that at least most occurrences of בצר in Psalms have a past time-reference. On the other hand, repointing חנני and שמע would require a highly unusual move for David, stringing two perfect tenses together.

Ps 4:8

The words תירוש and יצהר are collocated several times elsewhere (Num 18:12, Dt 28:51, Isa 24:7, Joel 1:10, 2:24, Neh 10:38, 2 Chr 31:5). G could be a harmonization, but it is more likely that M has suffered from homoeoteleuton here. {Actually, this addition may be of the sort seen in Jer.}

Ps 6:6

Following Kraus (1: 160).

Ps 7:7

On the pointing of אלי see Viganò (9-10). The collocation עזר plus אל occurs nowhere else.

Ps 7:10a

See Kraus.

Ps 8:2

The morphology of נתן is complex and uneven, yet the form תנה in M might be impossible to make sense of (cf. Holmstedt 203). No simple solution presents itself, but the scenario which perhaps best explains the various readings and produces a sensible text is the following. The original form, attested in the Vulgate and the Syriac, is נתתה. In the case of the MS from which the LXX was translated (and not necessarily the MS or MSS from

which the entire G tradition derives), a mental processing / retention error led to a *nun-taw-nun* sequence instead of a *nun-taw-taw* sequence, which form was then understood as נְתָנָה (the gender of the subject being glossed over or going unnoticed). In the case of the MS behind the Massoretic texttype, a transposition swapped the initial two letters, and oversight dropped the second *taw*, leading to a nonsensical form.

{Postscript: The above scenario is unlikely. The consonants of M are almost certainly to be retained, though it is difficult to decide on pointing. It is, however, to be observed that the specific form נְתָנָה is relatively common in the OT, while any form of the root תָּנָה is extremely rare. Hence, the pointing of M could be an assimilation, while the LXX correctly vocalizes תָּנָה. And while the M understanding (viz. of the root נָתַן + הוּד) has parallels elsewhere (Num 27:10, Prov 5:9, Dan 11:21, 1 Chr 29:25), the sense found in the G vocalization has subtle but perhaps significant parallels itself (Ps 57:6, which is Davic; and Ps 113:4). Indeed, with the possible exceptions of Prov 5:9 (and likely not even there), the instances cited for M have to do with a *transfer* of authority, not a *recognition* or *ascription* of authority, as in the G parallels. Thus the G vocalization of the M consonants is tentatively adopted.}

Ps 9:15

See HALOT 2: 766a.

Ps 9:17

So (at least) HALOT and Kraus.

Ps 10:8a

See HALOT (1:344a).

Ps 11:3

Dahood does not comment on this, but his translation seems to imply repointing pa'al as a participle. If his proposal to understand tsaddiq as a reference to God is accepted, perhaps this repointing should be adopted. That is, if the quicked are no longer being quoted; if they are, perhaps MT should stand, the idea being a cynical, "What has God ever done?" fitting the atheistic theme frequently found in Book I of the Psalter. But the imperfect tense in the first line is a bit hard to explain on that account. A famously difficult verse, it certainly does resist easy solution.

Ps 11:4a

Re anarthrous בשמים: The matter is not certain (the article is used in v3a), but the parallel line and the psalm as a whole suggests it.

Ps 11:6a

See the section on jussives near the top of this file re ימטר.

Ps 11:6b

Commentators are pretty universal in condemning פָּחַיִם. P's פָּחַיִם has much going for it (M is in this case metathesis), but it comes from a suspect source (not least in this book). Sym apparently has פָּחַם, which also seems possible (M is either an addition of a helping letter on the basis of its interpretation of the form, or else corrupt dittography in a paleo script; Kraus favors Sym); and Sym preserves original readings elsewhere in this book in my judgment (at least: 102:24, 119:119). But might פָּח mean something like "wind," "storm"? Cf. CDCH and the parallelism with רוּחַ.

Ps 12:6

In defense of M see Kraus (1: 207). (O)G suffers from aural error, facilitated by the archaic syntax.

Ps 15:4

David uses the unassimilated article elsewhere (36:5).

Ps 16:9

On γλωσσα see the textual commentary on Ps 30:13.

Ps 17:1

G possibly reads צדקי. While this is appealing as supplying a parallel to רנתי, it is not clear that צדק can mean “a just cause” or “a case deserving of vindication,” as the context would seem to require (it would rather mean “righteousness” or “vindication,” neither of which is not parallel to “cry for help”). The same objection obviously applies to MT. The reading צדיק, which might = M, found in Aquila (P V {verify these}) would be a parallel to בלא שפתי מרמה, the verse having an ABBA structure; the G reading would be explained an accidental transposition of the *yodh*, MT by accidental deletion of the *yodh* (assisted by its small size and the frequency of the word צדק, though admittedly צדיק is common as well).

{Post-script: But שמע does not collocate with צדיק elsewhere...+}

Ps 18:3

Though he would apparently handle things differently than I, Viganò (10-11) points out the parallel (which he says is 2 Sam 22:3; this is either an error for verse 2, or perhaps Italian-language versification is different) where לי appears. (Incidentally, this parallel would seem to support the idea that *chataph-schwas* do not count for the metrics.) 2 Sam-Concordia (416) points to Ps 144:2, which also supports this repointing.

Ps 18:14

Re the pointing of בשמים: Comparison with 2 Sam 22:14 should that this would *should* (with MT) be pointed with the article, since in 2 Sam 22:14 the parallel is מן שמים, which has a number of syllables corresponding to בשמים *with* the article. (The verbiage throughout the rest of these verses in the same.)

Ps 18:36

Re וענותך, cf. the parallel passage. The only way to reconcile the two passages seems to be to read thus (viz., a *plene* spelling here of the root ענה).

Ps 18:42

Re על see the research notes on 2 Sam 22:42.

Ps 19:5

The subject of the verb שם is likely to be the sun (grammatically masculine in the next verse) in that the forces of nature in the first half of the psalm are personified; thus understanding the *lamedh* as asseverative makes good sense.

Ps 21:2

Re יגיל: In WLC 4.14 (=WTT) there is no Kt-Qr here, but in WLC 4.20 there is. We have tentatively pointed as an indicative, for the non-existence in ancient times of the *seghol* makes the *plene* spelling problematic if it is not an indicative (which is somewhat unexpected, which fact explains the existence of a Qr); corrupt dittography from יגל seems less than likely.

Ps 22:30c

Options:

(1) Reading ונפשו with M...

(a) Read לא and point as a negative (ESV: “even the one who could not keep himself alive”). The emphasis is then on the mortality of man, resurrection implicit in the call for such as have died to worship God.

(b) Read לא and point as an asseverative *lamedh* (“for his soul he has indeed given new life to”). The emphasis is

then on resurrection as such.

(c) Read **לֹא** and point as a reference to God (cf. Viganò, 86-87; “for the Mighty has given new life to his soul”). The emphasis is then on resurrection, and more particularly on the God who effects such.

(d) Read **לֹא** and understand as ethical (lit.: “and his soul toward him has had its life,” i.e. “he lives for him”); probably on this model **חַיָּה** should be repointed as a *qal*. Probably also this clause should be grouped with what follows, not what precedes.

(2) Reading **וַיַּחְיֶה** with G V {what has P?}...

(a) Read **לֹא** and point as a negative (“and my soul which he did not leave alive”). The emphasis is then the right of God to impart death.

(b) Read **לֹא** and point as an asseverative *lamedh* (“and my soul which he has indeed given new life to”). The emphasis is then on resurrection as such.

(c) Read **לֹא** and point as a reference to God (cf. Viganò, 86-87; “for the Mighty has given new life to my soul”). The emphasis is then on resurrection, and more particularly on the God who effects such.

(d) Read **לֹא** and understand as ethical (lit.: “and my soul toward him has had its life,” i.e. “I live for him”); probably on this model **חַיָּה** should be repointed as a *qal*. (This seems to be the G and V understanding.) Probably this clause should be grouped with what follows, not what precedes.

Evaluation: 1d, 2a, 2b, and less so 2d all seem too strained to really be considered. Option 2 in general seems problematic in that first-person references disappear in this, global, section of the psalm. This leaves options 1a, 1b, and 1c. Arbitrating between the last two might turn on how likely **לֹא** is to appear *anywhere* (cf. the section near the beginning of the research notes file); in any case the asseverative *lamedh* is pretty well established. But what of 1a? Popular with the English versions, this fits well with the context, and the *waw* on **וַיַּחְיֶה** is naturally read as continuing the line of thought. On the other hand, the prefix could bear the sense “for,” and, if the statement lacks a negative particle, could give an explanation (viz. resurrection provided from above). But would not a grammatical plural be more fitting here? In the end, then, option 1a seems best.

Ps 26:2

On the Kt see Ges 46e.

Ps 26:7

On **לִשְׁמִי** see Ges 53q.

Ps 27:4

An echo of Ps 23:6b, where only *shavti* can be (an infinitive there makes no sense, and if the root were *yashav*, the form would be *v'yashavti*; moreover, the whole psalm pictures successive journeys, not unending remaining-in-place); the idea here is that wherever David might go, in the end he wants always to return to the Tabernacle, there to gaze on the Lord

{Post-script: But what of DCH suggestion by a by-form here?}

Ps 27:8

It would seem that in between his hand edition and the Gottingen edition Rahlfs changed his mind from **ἐζητήσεν** to **ἐξητήσεν** (from **ἐξαίτεομαι**, “I ask”), but I suspect this latter reading is an inner-greek corruption, and in any case it would almost certainly still represent the root **בָּקַשׁ**. That leaves the choice between **ἐζητήσεν** (rell) and **ἐξητήσα** (B ' A 2030 LaR Aug). The latter could easily be an inner-greek corruption (especially if the former was, at least a times, written **ἐζητήσε**), and a shift from **בָּקַשׁ** to **בָּקַשׁוּ** is hard to envision. Thus, I suspect **ἐζητήσε(v)** is OG, especially as in certain scripts (e.g., 1QIsa^a) *pe* and *waw* are quite similar (note the following פָּנִי).

We have, then, two possible readings, viz. **בָּקַשׁוּ** and **בָּקַשׁ**. Both could be pointed either as 3rd person indicates or as imperatives.

I do not know where the ESV or NASB got their renderings from if not conjecture.

With the repointing **בָּקַשׁוּ**, sense can be made of the MT if the following word play is understood: The

first בקש is persecution, the latter devotion (“My heart said/says to You, ‘They [viz. my enemies] are seeking [to kill] me! [Yet] I will seek You!’”). Admittedly, collocating בקש with פנה nowhere else has a hostile sense.

Ps 30:9

The majority of Massoretic MSS read יהוה here, but a sizable minority (over 50 MSS according to Kennicott) have אדני. This situation is peculiar: In certain other cases (e.g. Ps 2:4), a minority comparable in number supports יהוה in place of a majority reading אדני (in such places, אדני is preferable, at least as far as the question of the text of M is concerned, insofar as it has greater numerical support, is the rarer word, and might be an aural assimilation to יהוה on the part of scribes universally trained to vocalize the Tetragrammaton in the modern manner). One might suppose that the juxtaposition of יהוה and אדני (if original) caused many scribes to assimilate the second term to the first, but, while a few scribes might have erred thus, it is difficult to claim that the substantial majority did so when so little confusion in the MS tradition obtains in 35:22. This reasoning would point to יהוה here. On the other hand, the G reading of אלהי is most readily explainable as a misreading of אדני, lending a degree of support to that reading. At a loss, we print the majority reading, but consider the minority to have nearly equal weight.

{Post-script: In light of M^A and the apparent fact (cf. THB) that the proportions in Kennicott-Ps might not always be accurate, אדני seems the preferable reading, though יהוה could be in the margin if there was one.}

Ps 31:11

Adapting BHS' retroversion בָּעֲנִי. The tone in this psalm is not *contrition*, but *trust*; the situation is not *failure*, but *persecution*.

Ps 34:10

On the pointing of MT, see Ges 7500.

Ps 34:22

On the pointing issue, see *Hamlet on a Hill* (318).

Ps 35:25

BHS proposes adding האז on the basis of G. Haplography and dittography are both possibilities, as is assimilation. In the latter case, the double form occurs more often and elsewhere in Ps, so if assimilation is at work the single occurrence is more likely. Metrics possibly favor the singular occurrence, depending on how one breaks up the lines.

Ps 36:2

Taking נאם as a rare verb of speech synonymous with אמר, and infinitive could mean to think, especially with a self-referring לב. Combined with the S reading later in the verse, we can render: “The lawless plans to act wickedly within his mind” = “The lawless plots evil schemes.”

Ps 37:35

Kraus prefers עליץ for עריץ, and this seems plausible. Yet does not this verse play off the *resh* sound?

Ps 37:37

See BHS re תם and ישר. Yet might MT pointing be correct? Verse 34 depicts the terrible end of the wicked; perhaps the idea here is to spot the righteous *man* and imitate his ways, something a bit more concrete than clinging to righteousness.

Ps 38:21

The form רדופי is peculiar (J-M §65 n²), and so perhaps the *waw* is to be considered a corrupt dittograph of the *daleth*, but it is probably a legitimate form (Ges 61c).

Ps 39:1

There is to my mind to plausible way to have this name (if indeed it is, with BDB, a single name) consistent throughout the OT, for

-One could follow OG's ἰδοθουν (so Rahlfs, but perhaps better, with Gottingen-2 Chr, ἰδοθουμ or ἰδοθουμ, but such is beside the point for our purposes here; there appears to be no plausible case for ἰδοθ- or something similar as the original text of the OG), but such requires changing the consonants of L so many times that it becomes unlikely, especially as in the OG we have a translation, and translations have a long history of levelling proper names

-One could follow V's Idithun (I *have* verified from BSV), but again, this is a translation, and is suspiciously consistently, and may well have been influenced by the convention set by the OG

-P's ידחון is not helpful (and at any rate the version lacks the Ps superscriptions), unless perhaps, by some Syriac spelling convention I am not aware of, this spelling assumes one or the other vowel in the key place; even if so, however, P is possibly the least trustworthy of the ancient translations in a matter of this kind

-One could follow the targumic tradition (here I refer to the TAR module in BibleWorks9), which consistently has ידחון (but no text is apparently extant for Neh 11:17), but once again this has the appearance of leveling.

-The plus in 1 Chr 16:42 (see Allen?) does not provide much traction either, for if ידחון was mechanically copied over from earlier in the verse, such only reinforces what was in M(T) at the time of that error.

Thus, while *waw/yodh* confusion is certainly a common error, the situation remains unsatisfactory. Especially given the extremely limited Hebrew-language MS evidence extant from very ancient times for Chr, it seems best, provisionally at least, MT spellings (meaning here and in 77:1 and in Neh 11:17, the Kt).

{Post-script: But note the following: In Chr, the name הירם appears erroneously (see on 2 Chr 2:2) several times as הורם. This error is in the same direction if an original */Yidhithun/* is posited. Moreover, *outside Chronicles*, which has such errors elsewhere as just noted, the */i/* form predominates. Thus it *does* appear plausible for read/point consistently.}

{Post-post-script: But in favor of retaining the inconsistency in MT on the spelling of ידחון vs. ידחון, see the research notes on Chr 2:2.}

Ps 39:5-6

In favor of M see Kalimi, 74.

Ps 40:7

The concept of “body” is central to the argument of Heb 10:4-10, and it is not clear that M can mean this – if indeed it means anything at all! But transcriptional considerations seem to point to a solution: OG's σωμα εα κατηκουσω (Ralph's ωτια is {a conjecture?}) could be retroverted as גויה הכנות, in which case אֲזִנִּים כְּרִית might be due to transcriptional error due to a damaged or illegible exemplar (cf. the Longacre essay on trying to make sense of damaged exemplars):

-*gimmel*, a rare latter, was thought to be *aleph*, the difference between the two being not much more than a small stroke on the top right, which part of the scroll might have been difficult to read through some blemish

-*waw* and *zayin* are similar

-*nun* and *yodh* might be confused (especially in the paleo script), or *nun* might have been added. This is the hardest change to account for, but further options are corruption dittography or addition due to a conscious or unconscious expectation that the first word was אֲזִנִּים, certainly a more common word than גויה

-*he* could easily have been confused for final *mem* and moved to the other side a word divider hard to make out

-*nun* and *resh* are somewhat similar

-*waw* and *yodh* are easily confused

Alternatively, if the change from G → M took place in the paleo script, perhaps the reading is גויה כְּנַת, but this change is harder to explain.

{Post-script: An important datum to reckon with is the possibility that σωμα might be an inner-greek corruption for ωτια (See the essay in the XVI Congress of IOSCS, esp. p. 125), viz. ΗΘΕΛΗΣΑΣΩΤΙΑ →

ΗΘΕΛΗΣΑΣΣΩΜΑ, and where an OG reading which *disagrees* with MT can be explained as an inner-greek corruption, the reading with *agrees* with MT is preferable (at least as far as the OG textual history goes). This scenario seems more plausible than that posited above, especially as there is important external evidence for the $\omega\tau\sigma\alpha$ reading (though the $\omega\sigma\mu\alpha$ reading must be fairly early, given its wide attestation and presence in Heb 10:5). Meanwhile, the MT's אֲזִנִּים כְּרִית *does* seem sensible, bearing the sense “obedience you have enabled”; cf. the collocation of אֲזִנִּים with semantically similar verbs in senses similar to that required by the context here in BDB sub אֲזִנִּים *ad fin.* }

Ps 40:11

The form לִקְהֵל, though strange, does not seem impossible (BDB sub כָּהֵן does not think so; HALOT does not explicitly object, but does list this instance separately from the others; Jenni does not object, though the subcategory he puts this into does not seem to me to make a particularly strong case for it). Perhaps בִּקְהֵל is an assimilation to v10 and/or other similar passages with that form. Yet it would not be too surprising for ל and כ to interchange, since both particles are so common, and there is significant M evidence for כ here (many MSS [but not van der Hooght {sp?}], Aq, Sym, Th, T according to Davidson). G's $\alpha\pi\sigma$ might represent ק, which would either be a form to which כ changed in the herodian script or the form from which כ came by visual accident or (textual or translational) adjustment *ad sensum*, later, within the M tradition, to shift by lexical similarity to ל. So, to simplify a bit, we could have:

- l*, which shifted to *b* early in an influential substream of M and to *m* in G;
- b*, which shifted to *l* in what became the M mainstream and to *m* in G; or
- m*, which shifted *l* and then to *b*, or to *b* and then to *l*.

The first option seems to be the one which most plausibly explains the other alternatives, and I retain it, though tentatively.

Ps 46:3

BHS proposes בהמוג or בהמיר, but BDB sub מור explicitly thinks that MT is fine.

Ps 47:5

See J-M p54 n1. Arguably, correcting this anomaly in MT (L?) is not strictly necessary for SRHB, since the *maqeph* has been removed. Yet the later sign can be inferred from the *seghol* elsewhere, so this change is helpful—consistent, anyway—unless a more massive overhaul of the phonetic system is one day made, in which case the issue in these three places (viz., here and 60:2, Pr 3:12) would be obviated.

See also ib., n2.

{Post-script: In Ex 38:20, UXLC 1.5 (SRO 1st ed. was made based on 1.4) a change was made dropping the *maqeph* in between the first and second words of the verse. For consistency with the principle sketched above, the first word should be repointed to have a *cholam*. So re 1.6, Jdg 4:13.; and so in in later editions of UXLC }

{Note that Ps 35:10, Pr 10:7 can, if only for reasons of consistent use of the Tiberian system, be retained, for they are the only cases of כל “bear[ing] its own accent” (Kantor 2023, 143).

Ps 47:10

For discussion of this potentially theologically significant verse see not only the commentaries but the essay in Bodner, *The Artistic Dimension. Kingdom through Covenant* discusses as well.

In short, עָם עָם is without external support, עָם does not make much sense in context, and עָם, though dramatic, is not unprecedented in the OT and should most likely be read here.

Ps 48:14

So BHS. Contextually this pointing is much better, and the *mapiq* could easily have been lost in transmission.

-Ps 52:3 for chesed, chosed, or chasod? But would a participle or an infinitive absolute be used this way? A

related option is to keep the MT pointing but understand as “the profanation of God [objective genitive] is perpetual.”

Ps 55:16

Re Kt: This is a noun meaning “destruction”; cf. HALOT 2:447^a. (Note the pointing differs from that proposed in WLC 4.14.)

Ps 57:5

(Assuming BHS is right about the text of P...; have not double-checked Leiden) While P's כלבים is unlikely, at least on external grounds, to be original, it is interesting in that it suggests that P-Ps was translated from a *Vorlage* predating final letters, for כלבים could be corrupt dittography after בתוך. On the other hand, given the loss of the *aleph* from לבאים, it could be an emendation or an unconscious adaption to a more common word.

Ps 59:11

Some MSS, V, and T have w/ Qr חסדי, in which case the preceding would should, w/ MT, be pointed אלהי. This is possible, but external evidence seems to favor חסדו, which also makes sense.

Ps 59:12

Cf. Vigano 23 and v14

Ps 49:15

Re Kt-Qr: CDCH adduces evidence for a lexeme *tsur*, “spirit,” which could make sense here, but there does not seem to be solid external evidence for this.

Ps 60:2

See Concordia to 2 Sam, p. 158. The exact explanation there need not be adopted: שמנה could in any case become שנים by mistake. But is there external support? Gottingen lists no variants. {OL, Lieden, BSV}

Ps 60:7

While the Qr (=O)G matches Ps 108:7, there this poetic line has evidently been reworked to sit in a new context, and here the Kt fits intrinsically. So the Kt seems preferable.

Ps 61:1

The plural form is firmly attested elsewhere; it is very unlikely that the MT pointing is correct.

Ps 61:7

Ges (48g) and Kraus (2: 8) prefer to read a jussive here. This could be achieved by repointing the *chiriq* to a *tsere*. But is in fact an indicative not preferable here?

Ps 61:8

BHS suggests that the problematic מן is a (corrupt) dittography. This seems possible: *mem* and *yodh* were similar in some ancient scripts, and doublets are sometimes placed first. The trouble is that the external evidence seems weak: 2 MSS, Aquilla, Sym, V according to BHS. The G reading (τις, an emendation or a free rendering as if מן was מה?) seems firm according to the Gottingen seem secure.

Ps 62:2

While כי could have been lost due to homoeoteteluton after נפשי, three considerations weigh against this: (1) If meter is appealed to, the refrain in v6 has לאלהים where v2 has אלהים; the presence of כי there might be making up for the metrical gain of adding כי where it was not in the previous instance of the refrain (viz. v2). (2) If the M hyparchtype was stychometric, נפשי might have been on a separate line from a putative כי, making the

haplography explanation almost impossible. (3) G and P are not strong witnesses in a matter like this.

Ps 62:9

For **עַד** בכל **עַד** BHS suggests with OG **עַד** כל **עַד**. Either could transcriptionally be derived from the other. **עַד** is, however, nowhere else collocated with **עַד**; usually it stands by itself or with **בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל**. The phrases **עַד** and כל **עַד** are both common enough for assimilation to have occurred.

Pending more decisive evidence, it seems best to stick with M.

Ps 64:5

Is the last word to be pointed as a *niph'al* /yeyra'uw/? Cf. Kraus (2: 23). But such a spelling seems improbable. Does the plene spelling **וַיִּרְאֵהוּ** in v10 have any connection to this matter?

Ps 65:2

See Jenni 3: 107 and Kraus 2: 27 n1a for a case for repointing, but note (1) the references Kraus adduces do not seem to quite fit, and (2) the idea of silence before God occurs in 62:2, 6, and the idea of love and silence go together in Zeph 3, and (3) if our verse is taken as three lines (the fronted **לֵךְ** bearing full metrical weight), we have a pretty nice balance with the final, three-line verse of the poem, as well as a rhythmically pleasing lead-in to v3 which, though two lines long, starts with a two-word line #1.

Ps 68:18

For **בָּמֹה**, **בָּמוֹה**?

Ps 68:27

Jerusalem Crown has **אֲדָנִי** for L's **יְהוָה**. Other external evidence? Internal? This psalm has **אֲדָנִי** in vv11, 17; and the neighboring psalm (68) has several occurrences. But it is hard to know whether this suggests the originality of **אֲדָנִי** here or whether it is what prompted assimilation.

Ps 68:22

So Ges 128c (new pointing based on Num 6:5).

Ps 68:33

In going through the instances of **אֲדָנִי** for pointing, I came across this v and left **אֲדָנִי** as found, presuming this word to be that which bears the final pause of the v (taking **סֵלָה** as liturgical, though of cause original to the psalmist or to the Spirit-led editor of Psalms). Such suggests, however, that I should go through the other occurrences of **סֵלָה** and make the word that precedes it pausal in at least most cases.

Ps 69:4

So BHS (w/ some notable witnesses). There is a problem with the participle, viz. grammatical concord with **עֵינַי**, and L's pointing can be explained as avoiding the implication that God is not dependable or worth waiting for (but the psalmist is only saying how he *feels*, not how God actually *is*).

Ps 69:19

נִפְשׁוּ, used this way, is not elsewhere the object of this verb, or indeed of a verb of motion (**שׁוּב** and **נִשְׂא** being used in non-spatial ways); cf. DCH 5:726^a-727^b.

Viganò (28-29) brought this possibility to my attention, though his approach is different.

Ps 70 margin

As BHS notes L has **לֵעַ** for **עַ**. Perhaps the *lamedh* was unconsciously added in anticipation of writing **לְמִנְצָה**, the first word of the psalm. Such support the sort of mechanical assimilation posited by Allen in the second volume of his series on Chronicles.

Ps 70:2

Kraus points to the parallel passage (40:14) with its רצה, for which, however, there does not seem to be external support here. Does our verse have one or more asseverative lamedh(s)? Or, more radically, is the last word of the previous verse to be grouped with this verse and repointed as a (*plene*) niph'al infinitive, possibly with an asseverative lamedh, i.e. /lhizaker/ or /lahizaker', "be reminded to, etc."? If so, is the same approach to be taken in 38:1-2? (On ZKR niph'al, cf. HALOT 1: 270a *ad fin.*)

Ps 71:6

If indeed per BHS G V have a Greek/Latin equivalent for עזוי, perhaps this is an aural error of the mind, since *ayin* in some cases sounded then like the ancient *gamma*, which letter could easily become mixed up with the Hebrew *gimmel*?

Ps 71:12

Tentatively, we take the Kt to be the adverb חיש plus the (old accusative) adverbial ending (cf. Blau pp. 266, 269).

Ps 73:2

Re *first* Kt, see BDB sub בטה.

Ps 73:9

See J-M 75g.

Ps 73:24

BHS suggests that OG supports בכבוד, but this seems not to be the case (Gottingen lists no variants here).

Ps 74:19

"to the wild beasts" (chaya is a negative sense is usually plural)

Ps 76:5

Need to check Leiden and Gottingen here, for BHS cites P only has having a 2nd person verb, while BibleWorks9 gives OG as so reading (have not checked P at this point); do both sources have this, or only one?

Such a reading could be corrupt dittography {in which script?} (note the beginning of the following word) or emendation; MT could be corrupt haplography {in which script?}. Most likely, MT is original, as it makes good intrinsic sense, though a bit difficult at first glance, and, as mentioned, explains the other reading.

Cf. also the textual commentary on v12.

Ps 80:8

The word סלה is used fairly often in this part of Psalms and could have been lost due to homoeotelen. But NICOT, which pays some attention to סלה, makes no comment, nor does WBC, and G adds this elsewhere in Psalms.

Ps 85:5

BHS and BDB (sub פּרר) propose various possible other readings for וּפּר, but while on the face of it these options have some appeal, note 89:34, where it seems fairly clear that OG reflects the *same Vorlage* as MT there (BHS gives V and P as supporting אָסִיר, but if this is so, it is, especially in the case of P, probably as assimilation to 2 Sam 7:15, a verse noted as relevant by BHS) and the verb is used in a similar sense (and similarly, though not as firmly, altered by BDB, again sub פּרר).

Ps 86:2

For *elohay*, revocalize *elohey*? But see J-M 121r. That explanation seems plausible, given the other passages cited, and the Massoretic pointing would be hard to explain if secondary.

Ps 86:11

Although *יהוה* in the sense required by this verse is found in “Middle Hebrew” (so HALOT s.v.), there is no other example in the OT (there is only textually dubious example in Ben Sirach; see again HALOT). David is virtually the only OT writer to use the root *חדה* in the sense of “rejoicing” (Ps 21:7), so it is certainly possible that he would do so here. The LXX interprets it as *חדה*, but this might not mean too much (see the comments on Jer 31:13). KEL favors MT (and so apparently BHS and NET), NICOT calls MT “awkward” but is willing to accept it. Ginsburg favors the LXX interpretation, as does NEB. In the light of David’s usage elsewhere and the possibility that MT reflects a later semantic development, we tentatively adopt the LXX pointing.

Ps 88:17

Kraus’ (2: 192) suggested emendation can be adopted via pointing (cf. the spelling *מלושני* in 101:5). The same verb is pointed with a *patach*, not a *kamatz*, in the requisite position in 119:139, but in our verse the form is pausal (cf. J-M 32c). The result = “with Your terrors You have silenced [=destroyed?] me.” Kraus (ib.) calls “MT ‘clumsy’--is it some sort of auditory dittography occasioned by the unusual spelling?”

Ps 89:2

BHS gives various sources as supporting *לעולם*, but, apart from the Hebrew MS evidence (which, to go off Davidson, is not strong), this might be a pseudo-variant (note, for example, OG and V translations of *עולם* in the next verse). While it is possible that *עולם* here is an assimilation to *עולם* in v3, it seems at least as possible that *לעולם* is an assimilation to common usage (indeed, if OG reads *לעולם* in v2, it might so read in v3 as well!). Given the uncertainty of both the internal and the external case for *לעולם*, it is best to retain *עולם*, especially since this very psalm (once again, v3) adduces intrinsic support for this usage of the accusative.

Ps 89:19

Reading two asseverative *lamedhs* here is possible, but see 47:9 for a parallel in which this seems not to work, and cf. also, if I recall right, Tsumura on 1 Sam, who somewhere has a discussion on “shield” as a metaphor for (military?) leader.

Ps 89:34

Regarding *אפיר* see the research notes on 85:5 above.

Ps 89:51

For *כל רבים* the reading *כלמת* would make good sense, but it is not so clear that there is really external support for this exact reading, and it is not clear that alternative reconstructions really carry conviction.

In another matter, cf. HALOT 1: 774b, where *Secunda* is adduced along with (see BHS) *Gmss* and *S* for a singular *עבדך*. But is this really better in the broader context of the psalm?

Ps 90:17

The phrase seems odd, and might be dittography, especially if indeed the proto-M exemplar was written schotmertrically such that the scribe resumed copying one line earlier. The weaknesses are (1) that *עלינו* is not here repeated, but the scribe might have noticed his error by that point (only to have his cancellation marks, if supplied, overlooked in a future generation), and (2) the *waw* at the end of *כוננו*, but this could be an emendation or corrupt dittography before the following *ישב*. Alternatively, perhaps the two-fold repetition of *עלינו* in the verse triggered the dittography in a manner like those attested in the Textus 2018 article; in this scenario, a stichometric exemplar is possible but not necessary.

Ps 93:1

תכן or תכון? The same variant (or pseudo-variant?) occurs in 96:10.

Ps 94:1

Gottingen lists no variants on the OG imperative, and Davidson lists no Hebrew-language variants for הופיע. Thus, while the evidence BHS adduces *might* indicate that MT does not reflect M here, but rather that the loss of *he* on an original הופיעה is due to haplography before הנשא, we would then have to say that this errors happened *twice*: Once in the M tradition, and once in the G tradition. Such is certainly possible. But another approach is to see here a {precativ perfect}, making this a relatively rare instance where disputed points of grammar play into a disputed variation unit. Since as I write this phenomenon seems to be established, it seems preferable to retain MT (leaving open the question whether הופיעה in some witnesses is dittography, emendation, or a pseudo-variant only).

Ps 95:1

Concerning the superscription issue, it is striking that OG has αἰνος only here and in 90:1, 92:1 (both psalms with no superscription in MT), Sir 15:9, v10; thus the word never corresponds to something in Hebrew. {Unless one or both verses of Sirach are extant in Hebrew? Check on this} {Also, could αἰνος be a doublet? Seems unlikely though.}

Ps 95:6

M's ונברכה makes good sense, if arguable redundant, and is a harder reading in that the verb in *this* sense is relatively rare. G's ונבכה is the harder reading on the face of it, yet may point forward to the contrition called for in the following verses. Either reading could be a transcriptional error; slightly more likely is that G is the error, for it can be analyzed as a simple loss of a single letter, that letter being, particularly in the square script, visually similar to the surrounding letters. Returning to the intrinsic evidence, the contrition is potential, not present; indeed, the opening of the psalm, seems to speak of happiness. All in all, M seems preferable.

Ps 95:9

Hebrews quotes the OG which points a plural, viz פַּעֲלֵי. Such a nicety is beside his points however, at least insofar as “work” can be collective in reference. Since the singular of this word is often apparently original in Psalms where some witnesses question the grammatical number, it seems best to retain MT.

Ps 100:3

External evidence is sharply divided. Most Massoretic MSS have וְלֹא, but the tradition notes the existence of וְלִי, and some MSS have the latter reading as their text. That וְלִי might be the proto-M reading is suggested (but not demanded) by the Vulgate, the Targum, and Aquilla. The LXX (99:3) supports וְלֹא, though one should observe that there an important textual variant there: In place of Rahlfs's ἡμεῖς a range of witnesses have ἡμεῖς ἡμεῖς δὲ. The longer reading, if original to the LXX or if reflecting a Hebrew-language witness known to a scribe, might reflect an alternative *Vorlage*. Most likely, however, the long reading is simply an inner-LXX corruption, an attempt to smooth out the syntax (part of the motivation for our preferred solution presented below) or an assimilation (so Rahlfs, 2:107) to 78:13 (in the LXX); note as well the testimony of the Gallican Psalter and the rarity of δὲ in the LXX. The Syriac supports וְלֹא either as present in the Hebrew-language MS(S) from which it derives in the Psalter or as original to (or widespread in) the LXX. (The evidence from Symmachus is difficult to assess.) Gie Vleugels (evangelicaltextualcriticism.blogspot.com/2005/12/ketiv-qere-in-ps-100-3-christian.html) points out possible support for וְלִי from 1 Cor 8:6, and possible support for וְלֹא from Odes of Solomon 7:12. Paul is probably not citing Ps 100:3, however, for 1 Cor 8:6 bears strong resemblance to several other Pauline statements (Rom 11:36, 1 Cor 11:2, and Col 1:16), all which use the word πάντα, a term with no equivalent in Ps 100:3. (One should also note the frequency with which Christian interpretation equates יהוה, or more commonly κύριος, with God the Son, yet in 1 Cor 8:6 the reference is to the Father.) The Odes of Solomon, on the other hand, probably is dependent on the Psalter, for KEL (3:186 n⁵) observes that “nowhere [outside of Ps 100:3] do we find such a reference to self-creation” (cf. NICOT 736 n⁸).

Modern scholarship is similarly divided: J-M (§154i n²) appears to support ולא, as do Constable, Davidson, and NEB, but KEL (3:185-86), NET, NICOT (736), and BHS favor וּלֹ. DCH 4: 495^a tentatively prefers an asseverative *lamedh*. Some editors feel no need to make their opinion explicit.

Turning to transcriptional evidence, in the sequence יהוה הוא אלהים הוא עשנו every other word end with an *aleph*; accordingly, an original וּלֹ, two words after the second הוא, could have been accidentally turned into ולא. Another possible scenario is that the words immediately preceding and following an autographic ולא led to *aleph* becoming *waw* by a similar type of assimilation. To our knowledge, these sorts of assimilation have been little studied, and so it is difficult to assess how likely either scenario is. NET (1028 n¹⁵) notes that “the two sound identical,” so confusion going in either direction is possible. (This identity, or near identity, obtains most likely only in phases of Hebrew that postdate the author of this psalm, so intentional ambiguity is quite improbable.) KEL (3:186 n⁵) states that “15 times in the Bible the text has לֹ where לוֹ is meant,” but this claim is simplistic: The instances referred to are those in which the Massoretes prefer לוֹ over לֹ, but their preference might or not be substantiated by the evidence; these fifteen “passages must be considered each upon its own merits” (BDB 520^b). (Note that the Massoretes in 1 Sam 2:16 and 20:2 prefer לֹ over לוֹ.)

As for intrinsic evidence, we have already noted one intrinsic difficulty involved in ולא. It also leaves עֲמֹ without an explicit subject. This objection to ולא, however, would seem to apply to וּלֹ as well. Of וּלֹ KEL (ibid) says, “[it] fits the context better, but it has the difficulty of being slightly tautological.” Both readings as traditionally represented face difficulties, though on intrinsic grounds וּלֹ would seem to be preferable.

One way out of the impasse is probably to accept ולא but to vocalize it in a manner the Massoretes would not have thought of (so Lewis; Whitley is similar): If one vocalizes the word וְלֹא (an asseverative form; cf. Huehnergard) and groups ולא אֲנַחְנוּ with what follows rather than with what precedes, then one obtains a good sense for ולא and a subject for מְרַעֲתוֹ. Even this solution is not without difficulty, however, for metrical considerations would seem to favor וּלֹ.

In light of the merits of וְלֹא thus vocalized, we print ולא as the main text..

Ps 102:24-25

See WBC.

Ps 103:11 M involves, as far as the consonants are concerned, the omission of a single, four-letter word, and may have been prompted by a recollection of 117:2. Metrical considerations seem to favor G, and while 117:2 might be taken as favoring M, notice there are other differences in wording between the two passages; 117:2 seems to be a similar thought but cast in a somewhat different light in a rather different context. Notice as well that the LXX does not supply κυριος in a comparable place in v11, so it is not a simple case of translational or targumic expansion.

Ps 104:5

On the repointing of יִסֵּד see Hong (TC 2018 article, pp. 9-10) and WBC.

Ps 104:16

The M text could easily be a more common term for God for a less common one, as is seen elsewhere. It is also difficult to account for the G text apart from originality, for this terminology is not common elsewhere, visual error is impossible, and considerations of piety would hardly due away with YHWH in a deliberate manner. The only possibility is partial assimilation from earlier in the chapter, but this is a long shot. Such leaves the question of pointing. A שֹׁדֵה (and presumably a שֹׁדֵי), the pointing of the LXX, can have trees, though the emphasis is more on the open and wild nature of the land. Lebanon is largely thought of in the OT as a mountain range. The term שֹׁדֵי, by contrast, fits well intrinsically, for (a) David does us it elsewhere, (b) it appears often in Job, where creation theology is similarly prominent, and (c) Lebanon is referred to in Eze (see the NET note here) as “the garden of God,” making a special link between God (not a field) and this area.

{Post-script: But substitution of this kind is extremely rare in M. G might an assimilation to Eze 17:24, 31:4, 5, 15, Joel 1:12, 19; cf. also v11 in our psalm.}

Ps 104:17

Out בברושים be read? So Kidner, though he thinks there should only be one *beth*, it doing double duty as a preposition and initial radical. Or ought the consonants of M be retained by the *shin* becomes a *sin* (accusative of location)? Kraus (2: 297) thinks M is fine.

Ps 105:6

Cf. 1 chr 16:13.

Ps 105:28

Probably M is correct: In this psalm there is a repeated idea that the Israelites as God's chosen people were irresistible: The patriarchs could not be touched as they wandered, Joseph became undisputed master, and, here, Moses and Aaron were made to be authoritative. The subject of the verb is either the people of Egypt (who held Moses in awe and ultimately listened to him and to the Israelites, despite Pharaoh's resistance) or to the זבירים of the previous verse. (It is possible, though unlikely, that M should be pointed as an asseverative *lamedh*, לָא.)

{Post-script: But see WBC.}

{Post-post-script: Kidner's solution is similar to mine, yet this seems strained. Also, what the psalm is leading up to (v45) is that *Israel* will be an obeyer of God, not the non-elect nations. Kraus' (2: 308) emendation is very elegant; barring that, an asseverative *lamedh* seems the best solution (G S being an emendation, and early testimony to the difficulty). The whole-world asseverative *lamedh* is mostly a Joban feature, but does occur elsewhere in Book IV (100:3). "For they emphatically rebelled against His decree."}

Ps 106:7

Difficult. As the MT stands, בים סוף could be in apposition to על ים, explaining what is meant by it ("they rebelled at the sea, that is, in the matter of the Red Sea"), or it could be an emphatic repetition ("they rebelled at the sea, even in connection with the Red Sea"). The LXX reading hardly makes sense, but, having no word division in their MS, they could have thought only of the participial pointing and failed to consider whether it was a preposition with an enclitic mem (spelled defectively). (On the singular reference, cf. GKC §103f n³) The meaning would thus be "they rebelled against him at the Red Sea." Problematic for this approach is that there is no example elsewhere of מרה used with על. That could be due to the limited corpus available, however: There are many verbs that are used with more than one preposition, so מרה with על is not much of a stretch to imagine. More problematic than the preposition is the putative spelling עלימ: I am not aware off-hand of clear examples of a final *o*-class vowel *not* indicated by a *waw* or *he*.

The Gottingen apparatus, after noting that the OG εν τη ερυθρα θαλασση is rendered something like *in mare rubram* (the OL MS tradition is considerably divided), quotes Augustine thus: "duobus uerbis ultimis, quod dictum est <Lt>mare rubrum</>, stella [= asteriscus] fuerat praenotata, qua significantur quae in Hebraeo sunt et in interpretatione LXX non sunt". Does this mean that the OG originally lacked בים סוף? If so, perhaps such is a doublet (or even a gloss on; cf WBC 48) for על ים in M. Yet the meter might suffer from a deletion (cf. WBC); moreover, perhaps G (probably not OG, given its translation technique) dropped it as redundant. {Check Sabbatier}

{Post-script: Kraus (2: 315) wishes to emend to "Most Hight." Could G be a defective spelling wherein the word-terminal /m/ has shifted to /n/? Seemingly this psalm would have to be extremely late if so.}

Ps 106:45

WBC (49) cites Joel 2:13, Jonah 4:2 in favor the Kt.

Ps 106:48

Since the last two psalms ended with הללו יה it would be easy for a scribe to end thus here as well, especially as the doxology tipped him off that the end of the psalm was coming soon. It is true that the external support (G) for הללו יה at the beginning of 107 is somewhat suspect, but G might have taken its cue for its later emendations

precisely from this text.

{Postscript: Probably M should rather be retained, for in M 113, 146, 147, 148, 149, and 150 begin and end with הללו יה.}

Ps 107:3 On the one hand, the scribal propensity of add conjunctions favors the short reading. On the other, the conjunction is somewhat difficult and might have been dropped by G or LXX due to this difficulty. It is difficult to take v3a as the second rather than the first of a poetic couplet, and it is at the second (or third or fourth) such line that additive vavs tend to occur. Given this, the rarity but not impossibility of this use of the vav (perhaps gone from the language by the time of the LXX, and so left untranslated?), and the general reliability of M, M is probably preferable.

Ps 107:8

Some witnesses have חסדיו, and just possibly this is original, but יד"ה in the hiph'il seems always to take a singular object, and assimilation or near dittography could be at work here.

Ps 107:25

See Kraus (2: 325) and, tacitly, HALOT on retaining M.

Ps 107:43

See BHS. If the OL preserves the OG here, perhaps ויתבונן is the original reading, M ויתבוננו being a mechanical completion of an unconsciously absorbed pattern (*waw-nun-nun-waw*). Possibly relevant here is the last verse of Hosea. On the other hand, this might be an inner-latin emendation to the expected grammatical number. WBC (60) thinks MT can stand. {Also favoring M is Kraus (3: 325).}

Ps 109:2

WBC 1st ed. (72) so changed MT, but WBC 2nd ed. (98) does not, citing Watson's book. But the gender matching stands with the change, does it not? At least for the time being, to be consistent with (iirc) the approach taken elsewhere, I maintain the pointing change.

Ps 109:16

Emphatic *lamedh*; see WBC (74; citing Dahood). The meaning is much the same, but the syntax evidently improved.

Ps 109:17-18 Pointing as a simple schwa is several times possible here, but such would most naturally be taken as intent (*so that it may come*, etc.) which hardly seems possible. Cf. the NET note; the MT is probably preferable.

Ps 109:21 A word could easily have dropped out. The has lines should probably be rendered *because your lovingkindness is good, deliver me*, as in Ps 16 (*because he is at my right hand*). BHS suggests conjoining the last word with the next v, but note the nature of the parallelism there: Both lines give his difficult state, not the request for deliverance as such.

Ps 109:22

Re the pointing, see HALOT 1: 320a.

Ps 110:3

WBC finds the *plene* spelling in ילדיך problematic in an early text, but this seems *not* to be a problem because (1) there is in fact ample use of *plene* spellings even in early Hebrew texts, and (2) *seghol* in this context (pre-*qamatz*) is apparently an allophone of *tsere* (cf. Blau 4.4.5.7.1), and such a law might not have been operative in early Hebrew (cf. Blau 3.5.6.2.1).

Ps 111:7

It appears that often in the Psalter מעשה occurs in the singular with reference to God's earthly intervention. The external evidence is equivocal, but it might be the original M reading. (G, to go off Gottingen, appears certainly to have the plural.) On the other hand, מעשי יד is less common than מעשה יד, so the singular might be an assimilation. The plural occurs in JC and MM as well as in L.

Ps 114-115

In addition to the comments in PCE-Ps, note that 114 stresses Israel's uniqueness as God's people via its special inception in the Exodus and wanderings and that, consonant with this, 115 stresses Israel's uniqueness in its relationship with the true God. There is thus a theological continuity here.

Ps 114:2

See WBC (2nd ed., at least). M could also be a plural of majesty, but while such refers to persons of authority, I am not so sure about polities. But Allen's explanation of how M came about seems unlikely to me. Perhaps M is corrupt dittography followed by the insertion of a *plene* marker before the *taw*, but as this is a slightly complex scenario without a super clear trigger, and to my mind there remains some possibility that M is possible, it is surely best to retain M, if tentatively.

Ps 115:7

The long reading could be assimilation or the tendency to add conjunctions. On the other hand, scribes did sometimes omit conjunctions, as is illustrated earlier in this verse twice and possibly earlier in the psalm. Moreover, the short reading could be due to the immediately preceding *vay*, especially if, as seems to be the case, the VU is a purely intra-MT matter (dots no longer being used to separate words at that stage). Since the long reading is smoother and the short reading may be due to TR, the long reading is preferable.

Ps 116:1

See J-M 93p, but it M seems plausible and safest.

Ps 116:10

M is peculiar. Perhaps it is to be explained thus: In a damaged or hastily copied paleo exemplar, the initial *lamedh* of לכן was overlooked and the final *nun* mistaken for a *yodh* under the influence of the very common word כי.

{Post-script: But M can be understood, and לכן is (1) hard to use as a basis for deriving כי and (2) might be an inner-greek error (see WBC, though certainly the NT is early testimony to the διο reading). On 2 Cor 4:13, the wording of BECNT is interesting.}

Ps 118:22

Given the generally literal style of OG-Psalms, perhaps οὗτος represents הֵיא a corrupt dittograph of הֵיְתָהּ.

Ps 119:41

See WBC (cf. also on v98 below).

Ps 119:43

"Heb. תצל is probably defectively written for תאצל. MT... is contextually unsuitable" (WBC 136). {But 2nd ed. makes no comment, and see HALOT.}

Ps 119:88

See WBC (2nd. ed., at least).

Ps 119:96

This would be the only place in this highly structured psalm where מצוה is used in singular (but cf. the notes on v98 below). On the grammar cf. Ges 145r.

Ps 119:98

BHS recommends pointing as a singular, presumably to match תהכמי. The grammar is hard to explain, but then so is the MT pointing; why would a *naqdan* point this way? Assimilation?

{Post-script: Probably “yes” to assimilation, for WBC-Ps (vol. 3) notes places elsewhere where the pointing seems to have been influenced by assimilation here citing v77.}

{Post-post-script: At least JC and Ginsburg agree with L. Perhaps this is a kind of mixed reading, a questioning of whether מצותך should be understood as singular or plural, influenced by היא in the second half of the verse.}

Ps 119:103

So WBC (137). Confusion over the number seems common in this psalm, which is perhaps not surprising.

Ps 119:137

See Flint 235. It is possible that the original reading was ישרם, and that M is haplography (note the first letter of the following word), but probably the form, likely as not ישרים as in 11QPs^a, is an unnecessary grammatical “correction” (see Ges 145r).

Ps 119:147

WBC (2nd. ed.) prefer Qr, but OG apparently has the Kt. The Gottingen apparatus lists no relevant variants.

Ps 119:150

See WBC.

Ps 121:1

שיר למעלות differs from every other Song of Ascent, which has שיר המעלות. *He/lamedh* confusion is attested elsewhere, though usually in the direction [original *lamedh* → secondary *he*]. But assimilation is quite possible, and M is sensible. Perhaps the situation is to be explained in the fact that Songs of Ascent of various authorship have here in Book V been collected; this Song of Ascent was composed by some author who preferred the preposition to the construct chain for this meaning.

Ps 122:1

WBC argues against לדוד, arguing that “[1] it is spoken by a visitor to Jerusalem (vv1-2) and [2] presupposes the existence of the temple. [3] V 5 probably inspired the annotation” (155 n^{1.b}). But as to [1], the visit is to the sacred space of YHWH, and David did not live there (though admittedly the many other references to Jerusalem as such in this psalm are congruent with Allen's interpretation). As to [2], the word בית can refer to the Tabernacle (BDB cites Jdg 8:31 sub בית). As to [3], this is possible (especially if something similar happened in SS), but do note that, within the Songs of Ascent, the name David occurs 2x in 132 and 2x in 137 without prompting an addition of לדוד to either psalm. Continuing to argue against the minus, two further points can be raised: (a) The minus could easily be an assimilation, since the previous two Songs of Ascent (which are also the first two Songs of Ascent in the sequence) lack any ascription; indeed, out of the 15 Songs of Ascent, only 4 others include an ascription [לדוד in 124, 131, and 133; לשלמה in 127]. (b) In the OG MS tradition, there is significant variation in each of the five ascribed psalms just mentioned, so it is possible that we have an inner-greek error here. Here is the OG external evidence (as best as I can extract from the computer file; would a trip to VP help if they have it?):

121 minus: 1Bop Sa R'Aug Uulg L'A" | plus: SBop LaG Ga Sy [H-P has the minus w/o note of this plus]

123 minus: 1 | plus: S Ga(non Uulg) [H-P has the minus w/o note of this plus]

126 minus: S L A" | plus: Bop Sa R" G Lpau" He [H-P has the minus, noting rather scattered evidence for Solomon; they give VL has supporting the minus]

130 minus: Bop Sa-2017 G L' 1219' | plus: 1 SBop R" Uulg SyHe A [H-P has the minus, giving a singular reading somewhat like the plus but probably independent in origin]

132 minus: Bo Sa-2017 L' 55 | plus: 1 S R" Ga Sy A(ex corr.?) [H-P has the minus, giving the plus as Alex sub asterisk and VL as supporting the plus]

(In the first two R prefers the *minus*; in the last three, he prefers the *plus*. The numbering is OG.)

In keeping with the OG text-critical principles of preferring the non-MT reading (where transcriptional factors are not present) and the OG-Ps principle of preferring the Lucianic text, it seems (tentatively) best to read the *minus* in 121, 123, 126, and 130. 132 is less clear, given VL and Alex, and that the minus in some witnesses could be assimilation; but the external evidence (cf. that for 130) seems to lean toward the minus (?). The minus, then, appears to be the OG reading in 122:1 (to return to the MT numeration), but this in a context of *systematic* deletion. True, we might posit an original minus in 122:1, to which the original pluses in the other psalms were assimilated via deletion in G-Ps, but this seems unlikely on two counts: For G to assimilation 4x by deletion rather than 1x by addition seems unlikely, and for M to add even in one place (where transcriptional triggers are lacking) seems unlikely.

Ps 127:2

Departure from L is probably *not* warranted: If כִּי stood in the text for כֵּן, OG would have most likely rendered στῆ, not στᾶν (this latter could be an attempt to make sense of כֵּן). The form כֵּן probably means “The Reliable One,” i.e., God (cf. Althann, *A Philological Analysis of Jeremiah 4-6 in the Light of Northwest Semitic*, 35; BDB כֵּן sub כֵּן meaning #3; Pr 11:19).

Ps 127:2

On לִידִידוֹ cf. WBC (177).

Ps 128:3

See on 1 Sam 25:7 above.

Ps 128:4

Corrupt dittography. Cf. WBC (182) [and Kraus (2: 457)].

{But note the similarly curious כִּי in v2 (which Kraus, at least accepts; cf. DCH 4:388, third full paragraph). More likely, tradents in both cases are smoothing over the somewhat unusual style (dialect?) of this psalmist.}

Ps 129:3

The Kt (“furrows”) is confirmed by Ugaritic (WBC 187).

Ps 135:1

Just possibly the two clauses of this verse (after the liturgical opening) should be transposed, matching 113:1 and supplying an object for הלל (viz., שם יהוה, delayed for effect). However (1) the external support for this (11Q5) is rather dubious, and (2) Jer 31:7 (=OG 38:7) would seem to indicate that הלל can be used without an object. Alternatively to this second point, it could be that v2 is an extended apposition to the phrase עבדי יהוה and that v3 then with its יהוה הללו את יהוה repeats the verb and then supplies its object.

Ps 135:11

Some (e.g., WBC) think that there are asseverative *lamedhs* here. If so, for לְסִיחֹן we should read לְסִיחֹן; for וְלַעֲוִי we should read וְלַעֲוִי; and for וְלַכָּל we should read וְלַכָּל. But, tentatively, I think these are better explained as specification (HALOT ל I, section 22 iirc) than emphasis. If they *are* asseverative, then quite a few other places ought to be reinterpreted as also asseverative. Something to revisit, preferably after I have had a chance to read

Jenni.

Ps 135:15

The external evidence for מעשי is not unimpressive, but cf. 115:4.

Ps 137:1

PPS proposes (with Q [Ulrich 3:718]) בבבל. A preposition within a construct chain seems a bit surprising for a late poem (but check grammars on this), but the fact that it is found within a Q scroll, which would be the source most likely to eliminate such a linguistic phenomenon, might point in its favor. It might, however, be dittography. On the other hand, in the face of three identical letters in a row, haplography seems more likely than dittography, but it's hard to be sure. *PPP* also argues that metrical considerations favor the long reading. Further, the archaic/poetic form in v6 suggests an archaic/poetic form here.

Ps 137:5

PPS proposes reading אשכחכי; this would be (he argues) better metricly and would be parallel with אזכרכי in v6. The MT reading, he argues, could be haplography due to the following ירושלם. It is possible that such a form is hidden behind the Greek of the LXX.

Ps 137:8

“you devastator” (WBC 235; discussion is on 237).

Ps 138:8

See WBC. This is a difficult case, because while the external support is slender, the error could be polygenetic. Allen cites 139:14 as a possible source of the corruption, but it is difficult for me to decide whether he is right on that point or whether on the contrary that verse suggests that M here is plausible. The case being unclear and the external evidence for a change weak, I continue to retain M, if tentatively.

Ps 139:1-2

See WBC. (The pointing of ותדע in MT is pausal; we derive the non-pausal form from Jer 6:27, Dan 9:25, accounting for the *waw* consecutive form found here.)

Ps 139:14

WBC (at least) thinks that the OG is εθαυμαστωθης, but the external support for such appears slim, whereas the vast majority of MSS have εθαυμαστωθην (which Rahlfs prefers, in both his earlier and his later work). The 2nd person reading formally matches S {so WBC; have not checked Leiden} and V {so WBC; have not checked BSV}; the 1st person form matches MT (which Rotherham renders “fearfully was my soul distinguished”). Normally the non-MT reading would be preferable, but with the combination (a) the external evidence seems weak (?) for the 2nd person and (b) the difference between the two forms in but a single letter, the reading εθαυμαστωθης, it seems to me, could be an error for εθαυμαστωθην. (Not only the visual similarity, but εθαυμαστωθην is difficult, more so, it seems, even that MT, so εθαυμαστωθης might be an inner-greek emendation.)

Ps 139:18

From צ”צ” II, “to come to an end”: see HALOT (2:1098b, with 1126a).

Ps 139:20

Walters (319), with an ancient Greek witness (ε’), would read ימרך. In fact, M(T) might be an unusual spelling for just that. Yet there are quite a few difficult aspects to this verse, and so much more study is needed. {Revisit}

Ps 140:3

Tentatively, we take the Kt to be a *plene* spelling of יָגִירוּ (“they incite,” from גִּירָה); cf. WBC 264 n^{3.a}.

Ps 145:5-6

The different reading here (starting with the 4th word in MT) are likely due to transcriptional error in the paleo script (aleph and yodh looking very similar); if M's transposition of the first and last letters of the first word under consideration is due to an over-hasty scribe, this would strengthen the case for the long reading in v13.

Ps 145:16

Against repointing /et/ as /ata/ (as in the 1st edition {and 2nd?} of SRO), cf. 104:28b. Note the surrounding context in both places, and the non-use in 104 of the direct objective particle vs. its use in our psalm. Ps 104 also amply shows that a grammatical subject need not be near a participle, at least in this genre of poetry.

Ps 147:19

In favor of the Kt (pointed as a singular), see WBC.

Pr 1:27

It is difficult to decide whether the Kt is as a metathesis (so HBCE) or simply a nonstandard spelling (comparable cases?).

Pr 2:7

The Qr is probably the easier reading in context, and transcriptional error could explain the Kt. Yet in the two comparable cases in this book (of Kt-Qr, albeit in the opposite direction) the Kt seems preferable (asyndeton, fairly rare in the book), so probably the Kt is here as well. Also, the similar use of a *waw* consecutive perfect in 3:26 may provide intrinsic support for the Kt here.

Pr 2:8

The Kt could be pointed as a singular, but a plural pointing seems more likely in view of (1) the impulse seen in (at least) Qr, (O)G, and (2) the (somewhat) parallel passage Ps 37:28.

Pr 2:22

See HBCE comments.

Pr 3:8

See HBCE comments.

Pr 5:16

HBCE makes the most plausible case (near dittography); Ginsburg's solution is also possible (loss of a small word without specific trigger) and would earn a place in the margin.

{Post-script: But this is unnecessary (see Ges), and if the (O)G plus is not interpretive, it would be corrupt dittography.}

Pr 5:19

Is some verb missing from the first line? Cf. OG.

Pr 5:22

Is **את הרשע** a gloss?? {If so, other possible glosses in M might need to be revisited!} Or, as Ges suggests, is the suffix on the verb incorrect? Tentatively, I have retained M as there are multiple fuzzy areas here, and M does *not* seem impossible.

Pr 6:16

Qr is probably an assimilation to similar phraseology elsewhere in Pr.

Pr 8:29

It is difficult to decide what to read here. HALOT (1: 347b), Anchor and HBCE (at least) recommend בְּחִזְקוֹ, positing waw/zayin confusion (to which we can add assimilation to v27). But that last-mentioned verse, together with the noun חֶק in our verse, suggest that the root might חֶקֶק might be being used here. Especially given the cloudy external evidence for the Greek wording that itself is somewhat equivocal (cf. HBCE 159-160), it seems best to retain M.

Pr 8:35

While the Kt could be dittography inspired by the shape of the previous word, G seems to = the Kt, and the next verse parallels (in a chiasmic way) the alternation between grammatical plural and singular.

Pr 10:3

HBCE argues plausibly that we should read וְחִית here with G. However, HALOT on root חוה has, also plausibly, a meaning “desire” which might have gone unrecognized here. Moreover, a G tradent might have simply thought he saw the more common root חיה.

Pr 10:28

Following Anchor (82).

Pr 11:31

בְּעֶצֶב יִשְׁנֶה by way of transcriptional error in M for G's יִשְׁנֶה בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׁלֵם?

Or is LXX interpretive? See HBCE, where an analogous treatment of שלם by the translator elsewhere is seen. The first word is harder to account for, but aural error seems to occur in the LXX or its *Vorlage* on occasion, especially as regards the gutturals, and metathesis is common in G-Pr (so much so that BHQ regards it as an exegetical/translational technique, though HBCE is skeptical that it is not simply scribal inadvertent error in all cases); thus, we might have an aural error of understanding *ayin* for *aleph* and a corrupt metathesis of *resh-tsadde* (does the HBCE appendix cite many other examples of *resh-beit* confusion?).

{Post-script: On examination, the other cases of שלם as rendered by OG do not seem to me to support Fox's contention. In addition, I have become reasonably convinced of the deeply theological nature (this term might be Wilson's) of Proverbs, not least this chapter, and this sort of reference to the final judgment would fit in with similar material so far in the book.}

{Post-post-script: But עֶצֶב cannot, it seems to me, bear the sense required, so G is probably a transcriptional error (or, less likely to my mind, a paraphrase as so many suppose). The theological importance is maintained by M: See esp. Concordia and NICOT.}

Pr 12:16

Following among others Anchor (90).

Pr 12:28

Following, if a bit tentatively, Concordia (cf. also HBCE) and Anchor (91).

Pr 13:23

Anchor (94) proposes reading *riv ochel* (i.e., “litigation devours”).

Pr 14:1

See the references in Ges and in BDB.

Pr 14:3

Concerning גאֹוה see NET for a helpful summary of a common position, but there do not seem to be grounds for understanding the *aleph* in this word as a *mater lectionis*, for the first vowel in גוה “back” is not /a/ but /e/. So “pride” or something similar must be the meaning.

Pr 14:7

On ובל ידעת see NICOT.

Pr 15:10

It does not seem to me that רע can bear the sense “severe” (that is, “difficult for the moment, but ultimately beneficial”). Nor does “Bad advice belongs to those who forsake the [right] path” seems possible, for מוסר can probably not be used in this way. (Incidentally, ארה probably does not *by itself* mean “the right way”; BDB cites Isa 30:11, but the sense there is different. Rather, what is denoted is losing one's way – an idea which, if I understand correctly occurs a number of times in Pr – though *possibly* there is a moral connotation, at least by way of reanalysis [physical → moral] when the following line is reached.) The important and positive roles of neighbors is something Solomon shows an interest in. Indeed, very nearly the same idea is to be found in 12:26.

Pr 17:4

See HALOT 2: 1650a.

Pr 17:21

Asseverative *lamedh* suggested by DCH 4: 484^{a-b}. (Although Pr sits arguably late in the canon, it avowedly draws on ancient sources, so unless any linguistic updating has been extremely thorough, an asseverative *lamedh* might have survived.)

Pr 19:8

NICOT argues that the infinitive is fine, instancing 18:24, but that passage feels different: There a *tendency* is expressed, while here a more certain sentiment is surely in Solomon's mind.

{Post-script: But cf. such verses as 11:19, 19:23. There is enough uncertainty here that it seems best to refrain from making a change.}

Pr 19:18

That is, “his loud protest.” Cf. DCH, HALOT.

Pr 21:4

Revocalizing “breadth” with 1 Ki 5:9 (so HBCE 287; *contra* ib., however, נר probably does *not* need revocalization).

Pr 20:30

While the Hiph'il is not elsewhere attested (so BDB), the semantics of the verb make it highly plausible that a *hiph'il* could exist.

Pr 24:17

Re רובשלו: the *naqdanim* seem to understand this as a *niph'al* with syncope (cf. J-M 54b), but this would be an unusual case even in the category, and see Hornkohl, *Historical Depth*, 199.

Pr 25:9

Re the pointg of the last word see Ges 75bb.

Pr 25:18

This was brought to my attention by NICOT-Nah (Renz) (112 n^a).

Pr 25:19

BDB, Ges wish to repoint the participle, but I am reluctant to do so without clearer evidence that MT is not a legitimate form.

Pr 27:20

In support of Qr see Ex 3:15.

Pr 28:2

Cf. 17:24 (מבין חכמה) and the rather notable use of infinitive absolutes in Proverbs.

Pr 30:1 (middle)

BHQ 13* lists L as having a break here, but none appears in WLC 4.14 or 4.20. (The style of colometric printing in JC-Pr makes its testimony silent on this matter.) No break appears in MM or Ginsburg.

Pr 30:18

Re Kt-Qr: The gender of the number vacillates in the relevant verses (15, 18, 21, 29); hence the Qr is probably an unnecessary “correction.”

Pr 31:21

The sense is “doubly,” i.e. she makes sure they have extra clothing for the cold months. Cf. HALOT 2: 1603^b and NET, both of which identify MT as problematic but retain it as the harder reading, despite the fact that the matter is purely one of vocalization.

Job 1:4

As the Masorah points out, the Kt also occurs (with the *waw* conjunction) in 1 Chr 2:16. (This is suggestive of a late date for Job, or of a shared dialectal feature.)

Job 1:18

Re יָדָה, pointed thus, see Rendsburg (331 in Huehnergard FS), noting also the discussion in *ibid.* re שִׁים לֵב עַל in 2:3 and the late canonical position of the book.

{Post-script: But יָדָה is used in vv16 and 17 as part of a set formula. While *ad* could be stylistic variation, a defective spelling seems a much more parsimonious explanation.}

Job 1:21a

We take the Kt as a variant spelling, but it is also possible that it is corruption haplography before *taw* in the paleo script.

Job 2:8

BHQ has L reading לַהֲתַגֵּר, an inner-MT error. But UXLC has a final *daleth*.

Job 3:4

Re מַמְעַל see DeCaen and Drescher, 354 in: Hornkohl and Khan ed., *Studies in Semitic Vocalization and Reading Traditions*.

Job 5:7 (re לַעֲמַל, re יוֹלֵד, and re רֶשֶׁף)

The prefix on לַעֲמַל could be an asseverative *lamedh* (suggested at least by DCH 4: 484^a; perhaps to be pointed לַעֲמַל, on the analogy of the interrogative *he*, as in הֲעֵבֶדְךָ, Jer 2:14), and יוֹלֵד be pointed as יוֹלֵד: “For man indeed breeds trouble.” But does this fit the context?

OG and V {check Leiden re P} appear to reflect not רֶשֶׁף but נוֹשֵׁר, for which MT could be a visual error:

“And the young of eagles/vultures soar above” (a bit loosely; cf. OG rendering). WBC adduces strong evidence for a Canaanite deity Resheph (see further NAC and TWO). In any case the traditional (going back at least to KJV) appearance of “as” in Job 5:7b seems illegitimate: The *waw* does not bear this sense. (See, though he is more equivocal, WBC.) The sense could be (a) addition (=, b/c of parallelism, reinforcement; “And [in like manner] birds/flames/sons of Resheph rise upward”), (b) contrast (“but”), (c) concession (“though”), (d) circumstance (“while”), or (e) sequence (“then”; WBC makes a strong argument for this). The first would possibly make sense if 5:7a is understood as “For man indeed breeds trouble,” but this is a bit uncertain, especially as it is not clear that either the רשף or the נשר bears strong connotations of trouble or death in the OT. If the sense is (1) “For man is born for trouble,” the first three options all seem possible: (1a) Man is *by nature* troubled; birds/flames *by nature* rise high; (1b) Man is by nature *troubled*, but birds/flames fly *high*; or (1c) *Man* is troubled, though *birds/flames* fly high. If the sense is (2) “For man begets evil,” options would seem to include: if נשר is read, (2a) “Man begets evil, and birds take wing on high,” the height of v7b contrasting with the terrestrial imagery of v6; (2b) “Man authors evil, but the bird [standing in for the animal realm] flies high [above strife-riven earth; cf. again v6]”; or, if רשף is read, (2c) “Man authors evil, and opens Pandora's Box” (the idea, not the wording, see WBC).

Now as WBC notes, if one points יולד one need not then point לעמל (cf. BDB sub ל section 3a). (Also, do I recall that the author of Job uses ל for the direct object another of times elsewhere? On the other hand, probably at least some such cases could, at least in theory, be vocalized as asseveratives.)

Also relevant here is how to understand v6: Are the two occurrences of לא there negative, or asseverative? If the former, then evidence v7 comes to explain where trouble *does* come from. Such might support לעמל יולד, though MT might also follow logically: Nature is not the source of man's toil (v6); rather, such is bound up in the human condition (v7). If the latter, then the idea there is that trouble is all around, and would tend to support the MT in v7.

Both יולד and יולד seems to express thoughts found elsewhere in the book: For יולד, see 7:1-2, 9:25, and esp. 14:1; for יולד, see 4:17, 9:2, 14:4, 15:14, and 25:4.

Tentatively, we accept the hiph'il form, since (a) Eliphaz's primary argument is that men cause trouble for themselves by their evil, and (b) the parallel line instances an *active* rather than a *passive* activity (though admittedly the nature of the parallelism is a bit unclear).

{Post-script: UBCS seems agreeable to this line of reasoning. Also note the possible relevance of the (very difficult) third line of v5.}

Job 5:21a

LXX might support a reading משיט, and then we would not have to posit “from” as a meaning of פ here. On the other hand, it might not mean that anyway (“in the scourge of the tongue” = “when the tongue scourges men”). Moreover, the root חבה appears nowhere else to be used with מן, the context everywhere making it clear from what one is hiding, and the parallelism favors the idea of temporality over fear per se (“when it/he comes”).

Job 5:21b

As (NICOT? Clines? Both?) note(s), שד is used in the next verse. Moreover, שד is both a rare word and one that the theologically squeemish might want to avoid. Finally, Eliphaz's interest in the spirit world makes this pointing intrinsically likely.

Job 6:14

MT and versions are difficult to evaluate. CDCH cites a clear Qumranic usage of מס, such that MT could be left as is and rendered “To the one failing of courage.” But it is hard to make sense of the verse on this model.

Job 6:21

G P לי is apparently a waw/yodh error derived from the Qr, suggesting that, as often elsewhere, the Qr was a(unmarked?) Kt in some ancient MSS.

Job 9:2

Perhaps the verb יִצְדֵּק should be repointed as *pi'el*, but is difficult to be sure, and so no action has been taken.

Job 9:21

It seems possible that for **הָאֲנִי** G has **אֲנִי אֵלֵּל** or something similar, in which case **לֹא אֶדַע נַפְשִׁי** means “I am unaware in my soul”; either M or G could be an assimilation to the near context assisting by *aleph/taw* confusion in the paleo script. But it seems improbable that Job would even allow the *possibility* that he was in the wrong, and as a whole picture the path from putative G to M seems a bit strained. Therefore M is preferable (probably **לֹא** must be taken as asseverative?)

Job 9:16

Ginsburg's **עָתָה** for **אֵתָה** is attractive, but the external support (Syriac) is weak. {Double-check Leiden}

Job 9:19

For **וְהָנָה וְאֵם** should we read **הָנָה וְאֵם**? (The retroversion of the OG is very equivocal at this point.)

Job 11:11

If the M pointing is retained, {}

Job 13:1

See NICOT 217 n¹ for an argument for inserting **זֹאת** on metrical grounds. Such does not apparently have documentary support, but OG's **ταυτα** elsewhere at times represents **אֵלֶּה**, and such is not too far in form from **כֹּל**, and reading **אֵלֶּה** instead of (not in addition to) **כֹּל** would presumably balance the meter. Yet WBC feels no adjustment to the text is necessary. In light of the uncertainty of metrical considerations, and the paraphrastic nature of OG (a variety of things are rendered by **ταυτα**), it seems safest to stick with M, though perhaps a marginal reading would be merited.

Job 13:21

Asseverative *lamedh* suggested in DCH 4: 484^b as well as in {}.

Job 13:15

G seems to have had **לֹא**, understood as a reference to God (see HALOT on root **לֹאֵה**) as the subject of **יִקְטְלֵנִי**. Just possibly this understanding is correct (if so, the pointing show reflect the Hebrew reflect of the Ugartic *i* vowel), Job being the place for a rare term and the use of **יָחַל** without a preposition being somewhat distinctive of Job, as BDB shows. In any case, G + M^{Kt} makes a strong case for the consonants **לֹא**, tentatively pointed here as an asseverative *lamedh*.

{Post-script: In *support* of the overall approach (to which some adjustments should be made I think) – and *against* the approach of pointing **לֹא** – note that this verb in the *pi'el* does not elsewhere take a direct object, but does (including in Job) at times stand absolutely.}

Job 13:20

Cf. Viganò (29-30). V points as MT, but OG, apparently recognizing a difficulty, emends by dropping **אֵל**. P (Leiden) renders **בְּרֵם תִּרְתִּין לֹא תַעֲבֵר מִיָּנִי**. If we revocalize **אֵל** (“Only two things, O God, do with me, / And I will not hide from your face”), then next verse provides the two things Job wants God to do (viz. withdraw his hand, and not permit his dread to befall Job). Admittedly MT could be interpreted sensibly, if the withdrawal of the hand is understood in the sense of *not* besetting him.

Job 14:5

Kt is preferable and is to be pointed as a singular, for **קָם** elsewhere in Job is apparently always singular.

Job 15:12

Reading ירמון w/ G (while this verb is not elsewhere rendered with ἐπιφρω, this retroversion seems quite plausible to me, and WBC agrees, though rejecting the reading) is intriguing. If so, M would be *waw/zayin* error facilitated by scribal knowledge of the verb רמז. But there are transcriptional and intrinsic weaknesses to this approach, for it assumes the substitution of a common letter by a rare one and meaningless metathesis, and pride seems to fit less well than anger with the parallel line. Of course the key objection to M is that the root is not elsewhere attested. But while I do not have real data on this, it seems to me that cross-linguistically metathesis, where it occurs, tends to involve sibilants. Therefore, M seems sensible, and certainly is the more difficult reading in a way that explains the other reading (not to mention MSS ירמון).

Job 15:22

Re Kt see Ges 75v.

Job 16:13

See HALOT (2:1173b).

Job 16:16

Re Kt see Ges 145h.

Job 17:5a

Jenni (3: 207) flags. In the first edition of my commentary, I rendered, “As touching one’s eternal destiny, one might speak harsh things.” But using a 3ms vb in this way is unusual from a Hebrew perspective. Now: “One’s eternal destiny might etc.”

Job 19:16

Credit to BHQ for spotting this error in L.

Job 19:24

It is difficult to decide between לַעַד and לְעַד. WBC inclines, though apparently not strongly, toward MT; NICOT finds the alternative appealing but in its view the external support for it is too weak. Andersen and NAC do not directly comment, but both are surely right to stress durability of substance as an emphasis here; סֶפֶר as here collocated with חֶקֶק, with בְּרוֹז, and with other such terms does not mean “papyrus” but “copper” or “clay,” even “stone.” Thus intrinsic evidence – the most important in matters of pointing in our view – seems to support the Masoretic pointing.

Job 20:19

Cf. CDCH 318b (and related lexemes in HALOT) and OG.

Job 20:26

The peculiar pointing of תַּאֲכִלְהוּ is so firmly embedded in the MT tradition and so hard to explain that it seems best to retain it, pending further linguistic explanation (Blau does not cite this verse; Gordis is cited as thinking it is a form of the pi'el).

{Post-script: But is it a mixed form? But see J-M 63b.}

Job 20:28a-b

See WBC and especially NICOT.

Job 21:13

Pace Tawil (137), cf. Isa 65:22.

Job 21:24

See HALOT sub עטין. Tentatively, I retain MT but understand it is as a linguistic variation (note *m/n* variation in final position in late Hebrew: See Wise) and so translate “thighs” (cf. 15:27 for the thought), repointing חלב.

Job 22:11

NICOT protests that א does not make sense here, but WBC does not seem troubled, and indeed, while arguably a harder reading than אור, seems to make sense, and the latter reading might be an emendation or an unconscious assimilation to a more common word. Note too a probable corruption in G on the other side of חשך: It appears (this is partly from a source cited in WBC and partly from use of Muraoka's index taking into account paleographic confusion) to have לא תראה for לך תצא.

Job 25:5

M(T)'s יאהיל appears to be meaningless. On the basis of LXX (at least) we restore יהיל, taking M(T) to be a doublet of a single letter due to aural error. 31:26 provides intrinsic evidence for this as well. A marginal reading would, however, be merited, as the case is quite peculiar, and evidence might yet turn up for a homophone אהל that makes sense here.

{Post-script: But aural dittography of this kind is extremely rare. Another approach is to assume with many a root הלל, but to posit a *plene* spelling with *aleph*, comparable to spellings like קאם in MinP.} {Indeed, cf. the textual commentary on 23:13 and the repointing at 27:19}

Job 28:4

Among other sources, cf. Gentry p. 88.

Job 28:13

See WBC. Since in neither the paleo nor the modern script do *ayin* and *daleth* resemble one another, and “house” is a plausible meaning for ערך per CDCH, it is best to retain MT.

Job 30:22

Very tentatively, I derive this verb from the same root seen (in noun form) in Ps 35:17 (on the use of *pi'el*, cf. Ges 52h).

Job 31:1

It is possible that for ומה we should with G V read וְלָהּ, but probably these versions either are translating a tad loosely or are aware of a possible (here probable) sense of the Hebrew (cf. on Jer 10:6 above).

Job 31:7

A spelling of מום influenced by the (always or sometimes silent) *aleph* in the word מואמה (so HALOT 1:776b).

Job 31:10

Perhaps תטחן should be a niph'al (HALOT 1:374a)? If so, is the use of ל here an Aramaism?

Job 31:11a, b

It is possible the 3rd person pronouns have been reversed, but it is difficult to substantiate either credible external evidence for this or a true grammatical need.

Job 35:15

It is possible that a single letter (*ayin*) has dropped off by accident from בפשע, though there are no definable transcriptional causes for this. It is also possible that פש means “(moral) foolishness” or “arrogance” (cf. WBC 18A: 792). In the uncertainty of the case MT is retained.

Job 36:33a

On the form cf. Ges 75pp.

Job 38:14

A possible reconstruction of this (to me) very difficult verse:

הֲתִפִּיק כְּחֹמֶר חַיִּית וַיִּתְּצֻבוּ עָלַי גְּבוּל

“Can you produce as from clay living creatures, that they may take their stand upon the dry land?” (The last word might also be יבשה or יבשת.) But this involves cherry-picking from the paraphrastic (and here, possibly desperate) OG, using some less-than-common correspondences, and assigning a dubious sense to פֹּקֶה *hiph'il*.

With so much obscure, it seems best at this time to retain the MT.

Job 40:19

Does G have, for יגש חרבו, something like אֶשְׁדּוּ (cf. Dt 33:2)? Is the verb (εγκαταπαίξεσθαι) somehow borrowed from v20 (ישחקו)?

Job 40:30

G seems to have read בני, and HALOT (1:288b) wishes to follow it. Both M and G make sense, but the preposition בֵּין is used with the verb חצה in Num 31:27, while בני כנען occurs nowhere else in the Hebrew Bible. So it seems M is preferable, G being an example of a transcriptional error (metathesis) which happens to be sensible.

Job 41:1a, b

i.e., *hiph'il* 3ms from נטל, taking מראה here to be an alternate way of saying נשא פנה (on the nuances of which see BDB sub נשא), admittedly a speculative solution to a difficult text (but commendable in that it affects the vowels only). (This *might* be Oort's solution; I'm not quite sure what he means, or how much my train of thought is dependent on him, though probably in part it is.)

Job 41:4

We have pointed on the understanding that this is הֵן "grace" in a *plene* spelling (so NICOT, q.v.).

Job 42:6

A famously difficult verse (so NAC notes). It should be understood in the light of (1) the narrator and God's positive assessments of Job elsewhere and (2) the immediate context, in which Job (a) finds a new awe in God and (b) discounts his earlier challenges as presumptuous. The meaning, then, is roughly: “In light of this [viz. the grandeur of God and Job's own inadequacy], I reject [viz. his case that a trial would unfairly will be declared in God's favor only unfairly and without a proper hearing of Job's case] and relent [viz. of his plans in such a meeting], / [I am] a child of dust and ashes [i.e. “I am small and so very mortal in the presence of such a mighty and unending God (cf. Gen 18:27; this cross-reference is from NICOT p. 537)].” The second line is more commonly “on dust and ashes,” but the sense is probably not mourning (cf. the Gen reference as just noted) but temporality. The proposal of vocalizing על as “child” in the Semitic sense of characterization thus makes better sense than a locative על; this revocalization comes from a source mentioned in a NAC footnote, though that source probably understands the verse somewhat to extremely differently than the present proposal. (The use of על over בֶּן can be explained either as recherche wording for poetry [cf. the statistics in *No Small Difference* on how few repetitions there are of any given noun or verb there are across the entirety of SS] or assonance with עפר and to a lesser extent אפר, or both. Note also that the author of Job uses this rare word elsewhere, and the word occurs in literature that is closely related to Job.)

NAC's statement that Job's God was formerly too small is perhaps a bit simplistic, but strikes at what is ultimately the heart of the matter.

Job 42:8

Perhaps with OG לֹא is to be inserted after כִּי אִם, but BDB notes that with oaths כִּי אִם can mean something like “surely,” and it is far from certain that G had לֹא.

Ruth 1:8

The Qr is probably an attempt to harmonize to standard biblical grammar. The Kt is hard to account for as a scribal error. Intrinsically, if Ruth is a late book, the Kt might reflect the gradual disappearance of the apocaphated form in LBH. Cf. 1:17 (יִצְחָק, יִסְיָר, יִפְרִיד); the form יְהִי does occur in 2:19, but this particular form was probably so common in this use as to become frozen.

Ruth 1:11

A case could be made for וְלִמָּה, assuming near haplography after the preceding *yodh*. But OG has καὶ να τι for לִמָּה also in v21 (the only other place in Ruth where either לִמָּה or *וְלִמָּה occurs), so this seems to be the work of the translator (or possibly his *Vorlage*, but if so, a stylistically edited one).

Ruth 1:14

Homoeotetuon might explain the short reading (see BHS), but the varied attempts to clarify the sense found in the versions (see BHQ) suggest that G is not original here.

Ruth 2:6

JC and Ginsburg w/ no note have מְשֻׁדֵּי for L's מְשֻׁדָּה, which latter reading could easily be aural error or assimilation. Accordingly, the former reading {pending a look into P and V, and secondarily T} is probably the M reading. However, it is probably not the original reading: See OG (which I have verified w/ Gottingen) and note that wherever מוֹאֵב is referred to in this book, שָׂדֶה is plural, but the latter word is singular where a piece of property is in view.

Ruth 2:14

לָהּ is marked לִית in ML (at least), and appears also in MM (at least), so it appears to be a Masoretic, rather than L-specific, anomaly. Perhaps it is a remnant of inconsistent *niqud*-practice in the earliest pointed MSS.

Ruth 2:16

At the beginning of the verse G seems to have had וְהִטֹּת תִּטּוּ, “and you shall incline [the sheaves]”—just possibly original and accidentally dropped in M, but I suspect a corrupt dittograph of וְגַם שֶׁל תִּשְׁלֹו.

Ruth 3:5

The short reading could be homoeotetuon, but the long reading could be explication. On the basis of the external evidence here and of the similar variant in v11, we prefer the long reading.

Ruth 3:14b

With HALOT, we tentatively accept the Kt has an otherwise unattested alternate form. It is possible, however, that it is a corrupt dittography of the *resh*, if the MT exemplar was produced in a square script.

{Post-script: Is there a connection with the Qumran תִּוְחָה? Cf. HALOT s.v. תִּוְחָה. If so, however, it is hard to know if such would make M an error from a scribe speaking a different dialect or support the notion that Ruth is a late book and the notion that M is quite trustworthy (in that it has preserved what from the vantage point of both Tiberian and medieval Hebrew is an incorrect spelling).}

Ruth 4:5

Re וּמֵאֵת רוּת see the Tyndale Bulletin 1990 article (available free online) for extensive discussion, ultimately deciding in favor of retaining M.

SS 1:3

Jenni (3: 282) flags this verse as textually suspect, and the two parallel passages in SS both have ורייה. BH suggests so reading, but as part of a larger rereading based on G, which reading, however, is probably an assimilation; moreover, the error waw -> lamedh is rare. More likely, an asseverative lamedh. HALOT (usage 19b) cites besides this verse only Ecc 7:19, which seems different; Jenni (Rubrik 932) does not list that verse, but does list 1 Sam 16:7, 23:20, 2 Sam 22:45 = Ps 18:45, Isa 11:3, Job 12:5, Job 42:5.

SS 1:5

See BHQ (*57).

SS 1:5

Re שלמה: So BHK; for discussion, see the commentary in BHQ.

SS 2:17

The reading of G is uncertain. The rarer form is slightly preferable on the grounds that a scribe might easily supply the commoner form (or overlook a letter). The long form appears in 4:8, increasing the intrinsic probability that the same author would use it here.

{Post-script: But the MS that has this reading is *quite* unreliable. Probably it is an assimilation.}

Song 3:2

The M reading (G is uncertain) might be a conscious or unconscious regularization of the grammar, but the reading of 4QCant^b might simply be a mistake.

SS 3:11

The 4QCant^a reading might be haplography (and perhaps such explains the presence of this reading in S), but, given the propensity of expansionistic texts to add the conjunction, as well as the possibility of dittography, the asyndetic form may be preferable.

{Post-script: This MS does not not further research seem to be especially trustworthy.}

SS 4:2

4QCant^a if preferable in 4:8-6:10 is likely preferable here, despite some apparent touching up here and there (see introduction and אינה later in the present verse), especially as the MG reading might be an assimilation to the first part of the verse.

SS 4:3

The M reading (G is again uncertain) might be an assimilation to 6:7 or, less likely, a lexical update (on מזקנתך, the vocalization of which is uncertain, see BHQ *61). The 4QCant^a reading, on the other hand, could itself be a lexical update (רקיה being rare in the OT).

{Post-script: It seems safer to stick with M, but מִזְקֶנְתְּךָ would perhaps merit a place in the margin.}

{Post-post script: On the assumption of the priority of the 4QCant^a minus in 4:8-6:10, it seems consistent to accept the 4QCant^a reading here.}

SS 4:6

Assumes priority of 4QCant^a in 4:8-6:10.

SS 4:8

There is no evidence in biblical or (to judge from Jastrow) in Mishnaic Hebrew for the verb אתה being used with the preposition מְ, so the MT pointing should be retained (*pace* ancient versions, but these perhaps not recognizing the by-their-time rare usage of את as “with”; and with, iirc, most modern commentators).

SS 4:10

4:10c your oils: The Old Greek has “your garments” (שלמנתיך), which reading could be an assimilation to 11c, unless the massoretic reading is a visual error. As Mitchel {sp?} () points out, the Old Greek appears to translate the massoretic version of the present line in 1:3, so most likely the שלמנתיך reading here is an anticipatory assimilation that transpired *after* the more deliberate scribal error in 1:3. And the intrinsic evidence for M here is perhaps not as difficult as it first appears (to me); cf. 1:12 and the generalized use of oil in ancient Greece.

SS 5:12-14

OG order: 5:12, 14b, 13, 14a

OG	M
Head	head
locks	locks
eyes	eyes
abdomen	cheeks
cheeks	lips
lips	Hands (arms?)
Hands (arms?)	abdomen
lower legs	lower legs
appearance	appearance
mouth	mouth

The OG probably is as represented, for word order was a major concern to ancient translators and correction to MT is more likely than a movement away from the MT word order.

As to which is original, M is more logical in its consistent downward movement. Yet how to explain G? Intrinsic evidence (assuming the author would have been consistent) and the need to explain the rival reading seem to run against each other. The answer might be that the author felt no need to be consistent as to movement; while the poem in 4 generally goes down and the one in 7 goes up, neither seems to be entirely consistent. {But 7 arguably *is* internally consistent, allowing that it backtracks in a way twice—from the belly button to the belly that contains it; and from} This might tip internal weight in favor of G. External evidence would seem to point there too; cf. the various asyndetic constructions in the book and especially the non-inclusion of 1:1. But more study would be nice

Msc notes:

-Ending on the mouth might recall 1:2.

-In G, arms and legs might be juxtaposed

{-12b and 14b bear a remarkable visual resemblance; might a stichometric arrangement have led to the latter being accidentally dropped, then reinserted at the wrong place? Alternatively, perhaps in such a MS a copyist (or translator) jumped from 12b to 14b, then noticed the mistake and filled in the missing material—such would account for the lack of order in (O)G as being a mistake, and the order in M as being artistic artistry.

-Note that the two halves of v14 contained passive plural participles, and then sound better together than separated, proving intrinsic evidence in favor of M; on the other hand, for similar reasons 14a pairs well with 15a}

SS 6:11

If 4QCanta correct in 4:8-6:10, this reading *might* be original, as other examples (not many) of לראות in an inquisitive sense have ה following, such that M might be an assimilation to usual usage here. On the other hand, might 4QCanta be a syntactical update? Should look into the diachronics here (Segal?).

SS 7:7

Depends on 4QCanta.

SS 7:10

M is most difficult to extract sense from, but G fits very well (especially as the wife's comments often involve personal reference). A difficulty is determining whether an enclitic *mem* should be included in the text. On the one hand, it would help to explain the origin of M. On the other hand, BHQ (*63) notes that “no certain examples of enclitic מ after a possessive suffix” are to be found, and the enclitic *mem* seem not regularly to occur alongside conjunctions.

{Post-script: But the resultant text is impossible—see Ges re the repetition of suffixed pronouns, and note the literal character of OG-SS. Note the rhyme in M (of למישרים to ישנים) and the methodological issue that if M is difficult, it is not clear that G clears things up (so why alter the base text when the passage remains almost hopelessly obscure?).}

Ecc 1:13

BHQ argues for האלהים here, but the reasoning seems quite dubious. Far more likely, G is an assimilation: A search for אלהים in WTM in BibleWorks9 shows that the article is very common with this word in Ecc.

Ecc 1:15

BHQ makes a strong case for להמלות, particularly when it notes the loss of *aleph* and the confusion with lamed-he verbs in late Hebrew. Nevertheless, external evidence is weak indeed. Perhaps the *nun* form is a dialectical variation? Is there a connection with (the opposite movement perhaps seen in) השולמית in SS 7:1?

Ecc 1:17c

On the presence of אני see BHQ 69*, noting (a) the great literalness and (b) the tendency of the author to use redundant pronouns and (c) the possibility of homoeoteleuton in M. On the pointing of this pronoun, see J-M 39a.

{Post-script: But in deference to the Gottingen edition's judgment concerning the original text of OG, and noting also that BHQ is ambivalent about which reading intrinsic evidence supports, I tentatively am retaining M.}

Ecc 2:10

The second מכל viz. before עמל could be an assimilation. However, G's בכל could also be a visual error or an assimilation in that שמה typically uses כ rather than מ, but there are a few cases of the latter, so the rarer form tentatively is preferred, especially given G-Ecc's (not OG-Ecc's) facilitating tendency.

Ecc 2:12

Tentatively, we take the first waw in MT עשוה to be corrupt dittography (placed first, as usual for dittographs) of the right half of the *he* (phenomena at least similar are seen a few times elsewhere); it appears M, with G, had עשוה. The addition of כבר is difficult to imagine, and its absence can be accounted for either as due to the difficulty the ancient translators experienced with this verse or h.t. after אשר; furthermore, it does seem to make sense. Taking a cue from WBC (*q.v.*), we translate (paraphrasing somewhat): “I moved on to consider [another case of] madness and folly, viz. whoever should follow after the king can do no better than the king already did[, locking the kingdom in an endless cycle of failed policies].”

{Post-script: But Gottingen has εποιησαν, and while I am not greatly familiar with the text-critical issues involved with OG-Ecc, -σαν could easily, it seems to me, be an inner-greek corruption, whether visual or by

correction to the sense.}

Ecc 2:22

It is hard to be sure whether BHQ is right or whether G has accidentally skipped over a small word (near haplography?). Both understandings seem to make sense. הָנֶה is a “late” feature, to be expected in this book.

Ecc 3:18

On הָמָה see the Research Notes file under “Peculiar Pronouns.” G might have emended; a transcriptional path from וגם or גַּם to הָמָה seems improbable. {Is it, though? In the square script the former does bear some resemblance to הָמָה.}

Ecc 4:14

I am skeptical that הַסֹּרִים, however pointed, can (e.g. Ges 35d) stand for הַסֹּרִים. I suppose rather that MT (not M) has suffered the loss of a letter due to aural error, *he* and *aleph* sounding the same in that stage of Hebrew.

Moreover, it seems highly probable that G had הַסֹּרִים, else OG would have rendered differently than it does.

{Post-script: But see on 2 Chr 22:5.}

Ecc 5:5

A difficult case. M's הַמֶּלֶךְ could be (1a) corrupt metathesis (in a script before final letter were introduced), (1b) clarification, or (1c) orthodox corruption. G's הַאֱלֹהִים could be (2a) corrupt metathesis, (2b) clarification, or (3c) assimilation to הַאֱלֹהִים later in the verse.

Of these options, 1b is probably *least* likely, since it is hard to argue that M is clearer than G here, and for M to intervene in such an opaque way, when it seems rarely, if ever, to intervene deliberately elsewhere in Ecc at all seems improbable indeed. 3c seems rather likely (granting that the assimilation was inadvertent), especially since the phrase לִפְנֵי הַאֱלֹהִים occurs 3x elsewhere in this book (2:26, 5:1, 7:26) without objection from M (and suggesting that this phrase is something of a favorite of the author's).

WBC thinks M is better (46 n^{5.b}), saying “the reference is to one of the temple personnel, such as a priest.” NICOT (154) thinks that an official from the Temple is meant, though admitting that such is unattested elsewhere. (Ibid, cites in the main text Christian Ginsburg, but the footnote [37] refers to H. L. Ginsburg; I have not checked the sources to see which man he means.) NET takes the same take (n^{16tc}) and cites (n^{16tn}) a particularly interesting example, viz. Mal 2:7 (interesting b/c, like Ecc, it is a late book). NEB retains M. BHQ (83*) is ambivalent, but seems to lean toward saying that M is an orthodox corruption. NAC (311-312) is a little unclear in his reasoning, retaining M and thinking the reference is either to an angel (“possibly the angel of death,” 311) or to a “messenger” who is not a priest (he deems a reference to a priest “doubtful” [312], without saying why a messenger from the Temple is more likely than a priest from or at the Temple).

In the end, transcriptional and intrinsic factors seem to favor retaining M.

{Post-script: ICC, which I've only had opportunity to skim on this point, proposes emending as a piel (infinitive, iirc) from the root מִל"א with a 2ms suffix, eliminating the initial *he*; he cites an alternative proposal to keep the consonants and have a niph'al infinitive, though he questions whether מִל"א can have the required meaning in that stem (particularly with the suffix, no?).}

Ecc 6:10

We take Kt to be corrupt dittography. Cf. Holmstedt 203. For another approach, see BHQ.

{See Garr and Fassberg 1: 207 and cf. the situation in 10:3, and the similar situation in 4:14.}

Ecc 7:16

Following J-M 53e (*pace* Ges 54c).

Ecc 7:18

Anchor (236) proposes repointing the last verb as a hiph'il; there is uncertainty about the verb, but it is not clear that this change would clear things up, so I have left MT as is for the time being at least.

Ecc 7:25

G seems to read וסכלות, but it is hard to see how M's והסכלות could have arisen, while G could be facilitating. Moreover, the author of Ecc seems elsewhere to be a bit inconsistent in his use or non-use of arthrous forms.

Ecc 8:9

The first word in G is a dittography (see the end of v8).

Ecc 9:1

See BHQ, adding this: The LXX is probably an indirect witness to the original text, ראה having been transposed with את כל by scribal fatigue either within the *Vorlage* or in the mind of the translator. In other words, M and G both err here, but in different ways (M visual corruption and loss of some letters, G by transposition (seen, perhaps, elsewhere, e.g. G-7:14).

{But (1) some MS at one time read ולבי ראה, such could be error, viz. misreading of ולבור combined with corrupt dittography of the following את. Moreover, (2) if M stemmed from a misreading, it seems strange that a morphologically rare form would be chosen. Cf. BDB, }

Ecc 9:2

Might we repoint אל to obtain, “And afterward—the god of the dead!”? But this is not less abrupt than MT, and it is far from clear that the author of this book (who frequently uses circumlocutions comparable to מקדם ה) would say this, even by way of a frozen form.

Ecc 9:4b

The parallel clause is articular, the article of כלב is hidden in the unpointed text due to the *lamedh* prefix, and before the *chet* of ה a *he* could easily have dropped out (corrupt haplography). That the LXX supports the reading we adopt is admittedly not wholly certain, yet in general the LXX tends to match articular usage where it can (see BIOSCS article and my own research), and LXX-Ecc is extremely literal, so it seems warranted to assume that such underlies the LXX. Finally, note the evident slip-up in M earlier in the same verse.

{Post-script: But the author is not always consistent in his use of articles in parallel expressions, and, given translation technique, OG seems to represent a *Vorlage* החי הכלב, where the *he* for *lamedh* at the beginning of the first word is hard to account for beyond facilitation. }

Ecc 10:10

It is difficult to know whether לא should be read or not. If yes, then וחילים יגבר is a negative outcome (wasted effort, working harder not smarter). If no, then it is a positive, for his wide maintenance of his tool has overcome his difficulties. The immediately preceding verses seem to highlight the need for caution in the work environment, but it is unclear how this plays in. Tentatively, we take G as homoeoteleuton.

Ecc 10:20

With OG (Gottingen) we might read דברך. But the error could go in either direction (and also be an inadvertent error on the level of translation), and the lack here of את and the way in which the author seems to vacillate with regard to the use of the article (contrast את הקול in the parallel line) suggest that M should be retained. I am also not aware of any critics who see a need to adjust M here. Cf. also Ruth 3:18.

Ecc 12:9

It seems more likely that M is a transcriptional error (skipping a letter + aural error) than the reverse, though assimilation in G is not impossible. The word עם occurs elsewhere only in 4:16, making it intrinsically unlikely that the author would introduce such a general reference to his audience here. On the other hand, might G be

avoiding the idea that study is for עַם הָאָרֶץ? The case is less than clear.

Lam 1:1

The *daghesh* in the *resh* in the second רבתי in this verse is not found in JC or in Ginsburg's Massorah (on which see the special section near the top of this file). Perhaps the scribe anticipated the *daghesh* he was about to put in the following letter.

Lam 1:5

For HALOT (1:385b) suggests (here and in v12) reading הוֹנִי (from ינ"ה), but S{} does not agree regarding the versional evidence, and, the obscurity behind the Hebrew lexeme (וַיִּג"ה) notwithstanding, for this error to have occurred twice seems to be an unlikely and unnecessary supposition.

“her rebellions”: One might repoint פשעיה to be a qal participle (“her rebels”), but as HALOT {} points out, Ps 5:11 provides a parallel to the phraseology here.

Lam 2:20a

See Freedman, *PPP*, 28.

Lam 3:3

G lacks יהפך. Perhaps the word is a doublet for ישב, but M-Lam is generally sound in this regard. Very tentatively, I suppose that the presence of the word fits the meter better; a bit less tentatively, it seems to fit the style of the chapter better, with its multiplication of synonymous or related verbs (though this case might be different if ישב is semi-grammaticalized → an adverb). The loss of יהפך in G is explainable as homoioteleuton (in the paleo script) or, more likely in this case, of homoeoarchon (in any script).

Lam 3:25

See ICC (229).

Lam 3:32

The singular הָסִיד usually occurs after רב, but at least Ps 106:6 (in at least M^L and M^A) is an exception.

Lam 3:36

Cf. DCH 4: 495a. v35b forms a parallel: despite the Most High's presence, they do injustice; here: they pervert justice, despite the Lord's watchfulness. Cf. NICOT on the train of thought.

Lam 3:38

Cf. on v36 above.

Lam 4:3a

Re תנין: Intrinsic evidence is offered by Jer 51:9 (where apparently the same author uses the *nun* form of this word).

Lam 4:3b

Suggested by DCH 4: 484b and {}. Would not the sense “become cruel” require a verb?

On the pointing of the asseverative *lamedh* before a guttural, cf. on Job 5:7 above.

Lam 4:10

=“for food” (see ICC).

Lam 4:12

Corrupt dittography or near haplography in the paleo script (ארץ וכל) could account for the variation; indeed, if the Kt is to be retained, haplography in the G text should be posited to account for the OG rendering. It is not completely clear to me why Qr prefers the longer reading; perhaps a Kt-Qr switch? But MT-Lam seems to have an unusual density of slightly odd Kt-Qrs pertaining to conjunctions.

Est 1:22

Is the end of the v a corrupt dittograph? But probably not: G is a very weak witness for such a reading, and stylistically Esther feels somewhat prolix at times.

Est 2:9

Kahana 458 notes a VU not noted in BHQ, the absence in G of a second לתת. She prefers this shorter reading, but it seems to us that the text reads with it, and while, as she notes, it could easily have been added accidentally by assimilation, it could also have been dropped by homoeoteleuton after the previous word or by homoeoarchon before the following word.

Est 2:14

See Talmon 147-148 for a possible solution, but cf. NET and note the possibility that Est was written in a square, not a paleo, script.

Est 3:3

The LXX as it stands (καὶ ἐλάλησαν οἱ ἐν τῇ αὐλῇ) seemingly cannot be retroverted, as ויאמרו אשר בשער is impossible Hebrew. Thus perhaps the omission of עבדי המלך is due to the translator (viz. either his dislike of the word מלך, although he does render it right after השער in reflection of the MT, or his interest in concision, but then why add the Additions or the new material relative to AT if the AT was earlier as Jobes argues?). But there seems to be a lot of evidence for a short *Vorlage* of Esther (see the Introduction to Esther above), and the AT here (viz. in the “gap”) has οἱ παιδὲς τοῦ βασιλεως. The LXX might be due to homoeoarchon, then (ΚΑΙΕΛΑΛΗΣΕΝΟΙΠΙΑΙΔΕΣΤΟΥΒΑΣΙΛΕΩΣΟΙΕΝΤΗΑΥΛΗ), especially if it was based in some measure on the AT or some common parent text.

Est 3:4

Apparently the Kt is widely preferred (see BHQ comments), so the L text need only be pointed in accordance with this text-critical stance.

Esther 3:12

The omission in G (3rd grey box in Kahane 157) is most likely homoeoteleuton. Note the final conjunction, without which the text is awkward.

Esther 3:13a

It is difficult to decide whether ספרים is original. Kahana cites J-M as saying that an expressed subject is rare for an infinitive absolute, and furthermore a scribe of LBH might have felt it necessary to express the rather vague subject. On the other hand, the LXX might express the word by rendering הרצים by βιβλαφορον, in which case there is apparently no external support for the omission. It seems safest, then, to stick with M here.

Est 3:13b

Kahana 458 notes a probable VU which BHQ fails to, namely עם היהודים for כל היהודים. This is a bit hard to account for, though in the paleo script – if this book was originally thus written – *mem* and *kaph* could be confused and then transposed; certainly the words share the same letter count (also, the word עם is not rare in this book so might have been on a tradent's mind). As far as intrinsic evidence, the G reading seems unlikely, as עם is never thus used with the plural of יהודי in this book.

Esther 3:13d

Might בְּשִׁלּוּשֵׁי עֶשֶׂר have dropped due to virtual homoeoteleuton?

Est 4:7

On the gentile plural ending see Blau p. 276 (4.4.6.8)

Est 9:4

Kahane 459 retroverts LXX as having וְשֵׁמוֹ הָלַךְ. While we are inclined to accept her retroversion, usage of MT שמע supports MT here; additionally, the accidental loss of *ayin* (possibly only in the mind of the translator) is easier to account for than its wrongful addition. Thus, MT is to be preferred.

(Cf. the VU in 2 chr 9:1, 1 Ki 10:1)

Est 9:19

BibleWorks9 points הפְּרוּזִים, but see HALOT 2: 965^a.

Dan 1:4

A spelling of מֶרֶם influenced by the (always or sometimes silent) *aleph* in the word מֶרֶמָה (so HALOT 1:776b).

Dan 1:12

See HALOT 1: 283^a (BHS concurs; Concordia retains MT). Both OG and Th translate consistently in v12 and v16, strongly suggesting that the same form occurred in both places. The form in v16 is well attested outside the OT, but not so the v12 form; it, then, is a ghost word, due either to loss of the *nun* due to its visual similarity to the following *yodh* or to an unconscious (or, less likely, conscious) simplification of the word based on recognition of the common root זָרַע.

{Post-script: Looking now at Jastrow, the form זָרַע occurs a number of times in targumic Aramaic and talmudic sources. Daniel, late and fluent in both Hebrew and Aramaic, seems a likely candidate for such a form, and assimilation / adaption to more standard Hebrew usage serves as a ready explanation for the other reading. Thus it seems best to retain MT. (WBC, I think, makes a distinction between the terms; it is also worth considering whether the terms are synonyms for Daniel.)}

Dan 2:8

See Rosenthal, 4 on this and other questionable pointing matters. JC shares this and one or two other peculiarities with L, which suggests that the error is old within MT (some other MSS having consciously or unconsciously shifted to the linguistically non-abberant form). Such does not require us to accept the peculiar vocalization(s).

Dan 2:31

In general I have not added U-class lines where a daghesh is at issue since ancient Hebrew probably lacked the bgdkft alophony. But this passage is in Aramaic, so it is marginally more significant.

Dan 2:39a

Re אֲרַע (A=1): L seems idiosyncratic in *not* having a Qr אֲרַע, although the pointing might be its way of indicating a Qr. It is impossible to know which form underlies the versions. BDB cites T-Ruth 4:4 in favor of the anarthrous form. On the other hand, Rosenthal notes the form וְעֵלָא מְנַהֵן in 6:3. The Qr could be an assimilation to later in verse (or to the more common form). In the end, it seems safer to retain the Kt, though the matter is not clear.

Dan 3:5

See J-M p470 n1 for possible tendentious pointings here and elsewhere in Daniel. If so, however, the program

was not carried out consistently. On tselem, HALOT, without committing itself, cites Bauer-Leander as suggesting Hebrew influence. The case for a theological intervention in the case of te'am is a bit stronger (see HALOT 2:1885b), but note Dan 3:29 where this particular decree would seem a strange one to stigmatize. So something to revisit, but it seems safest to retain MT in these instances.

Dan 3:13

See BHS. HALOT 2: 1829^a. Based on a look at BHS, WLC, JC, and VDH, the terminal letter as printed in HALOT might be a typo.

As far as tagging, this is an error not unique to L but characteristic of the MT tradition as a whole (BHS lists two exceptions).

Dan 3:15

As BHS notes, v17 confirms this vocalization (as already Th noticed).

Dan 3:18a

This is a place where WLC 4.20 differ from BHS re a Kt-Qr (also from WLC 4.14, which is the basis for the WTT module in BibleWorks9).

Dan 3:21

The vocalization follows BDB, not BibleWorks9.

Dan 3:29a

See Concordia (190-191).

Dan 4:1

So BHS, HALOT 2: 1834^a.

The tagging is debatable: The pointing belong not to L uniquely but to a certain Massoretic school.

Dan 4:4a

For the pointing cf. in part 5:8 (BibleWorks9).

Dan 4:9

We take the Kt to be metathesis, facilitated by the facts that the masculine form is presumably more common and the (feminine) subject (צפרִי) follows rather than precedes the subject.

{Post-script: But while metathesis is certainly plausible, Kt could also represent yduron; note, in BA, a *cholan* waw to represent this vowel in words like קִתְרוֹס in 3:7 (SR spelling) and אֲנוּשָׁא in 4:14.}

Dan 4:13 (+14b)

It is possible that the Kt is an error from a scribe whose main language was Hebrew, but see HALOT for some evidence that in some dialects אֲנוּשָׁא was a legitimate Aramaic form.

Dan 4:19b

See Rosenthal (55; so also HALOT 2:1976b); cf. also Malone ({see near end of book, where BA forms are listed in alphabetical order}).

Dan 4:33

The reading הִדְרִית is appealing on intrinsic grounds (see BDB sub הִדָּר), but the external evidence (Rashi G⁰) is quite weak without compelling transcriptional reasons for MT. Moreover, sense can be made of MT (by grouping the work with what follows rather than with what precedes).

Dan 4:33b

See Concordia 249-250.

Dan 5:5a

Re Kt-Qr, perhaps Hebrew interference, but more likely a faded left half of the *he*.

[transferred from Textual Commentary to first edition]]Dan 5:5a

It would seem that in the first edition I forgot to make a note here, despite saying “Yes.” At any rate, although the commentators tend not to deal with this and BH and BHS are not committal, a search of the grammars and lexica does not suggest that this form is possible, and Rosenthal in general prefers Qr readings, and iirc with reference to this place and/or to 7:20 cites the passage in its Qr form. A lamedh followed by he could be mistaken for a lamedh + waw; that it happened twice in this book suggests a MS with large lamedhs (certainly plausible, given the DDS).

{Post-script: But see now Gzella 120n10.}

Dan 5:7

On תלחי see Concordia 268-269; in short, MT is the harder, but sensible, reading, without transcriptional explanations otherwise and so is to be retained.

Dan 5:12a, c

So BHS. Grammatical parallelism with ואחריית seems to demand this shift.

Dan 5:13b

See Stevenson, par38.3.

Dan 5:20

MT also seems possible, but the MT reading tradition is perhaps not the most trustworthy here (see on v12 above). (Concordia's translation [p. 278] seems to be based on MT, but paraphrasing in such a way that really prefers the alternate pointing.)

Dan 5:21a

Re *first* Kt-Qr: Cf. Rosenthal p. 40, §83.

Dan 5:23d

See Folmer 485n800 and cf. Rosenthal p71.

Dan 6:11

On הוה (BHS a) see Concordia 309-310. My observation: The words כל קבל די הוה עבד would possibly be redundant if the word here was repointed. MT, then, seems preferable, though the matter is less than wholly clear.

Dan 7:8a

Cf. WBC and HALOT s.v. (mixed form).

Dan 7:10a

Re *first* Kt-Qr: Rosenthal thinks a Hebraism (along with some other examples). But if so, it might go back to the author, whose first language was Hebrew.

Dan 7:15

See Concordia 362. BHS's reading is intriguing, but the external evidence is very weak indeed, especially as it is

transcriptionally much easier to derive MT from the reading proposed than the other way around.

Dan 7:17

Concerning BHS a see Concordia 365 (his reference to 8:20-21 is the most convincing part of his argument).

Dan 8:23

For discussion of the pointing of הפשעים see Concordia 410, adding to this that the plural of פָּשַׁע never occurs in this book.

Dan 8:27

It seems possible that נהיית is a dittograph (so, among others, Ginsburg). However, DCH 5:630a gives ancient extrabiblical attestation for a word נהיה possibly meaning “lamentation,” so perhaps the verb here means “became distraught” and was omitted in OG b/c unknown or b/c redundant.

Mic 2:4 is possibly relevant in this connection also.

Dan 9:10

Intrinsic evidence (see on Lev 26:46 above) would seem to favor the singular (unless Daniel is too late to have observed this distinction; he evidences already the trend toward the use of אֲדָנִי in this very chapter), but whether such has support depends upon which branch of the LXX is accepted (according to BibleWorks, Theo has the plural and non-Theo has the singular; note how Studies in the Text of the OT by Barthelemy shows that Theo is rather closely aligned to M).

{Post-script: The qualification עֲבָדֵי הַנְּבִיאִים points to a broader conception that *just* the Mosaic Law *as such*. Furthermore, OG (alone? Certainly Th supports M) is in this book a highly dubious source. Probably the OG is an assimilation to common usage and most likely the plural of M is to be preferred.}

Dan 9:22

For MT (at least) NET (w/o comment), Concordia (w/o comment), WBC, NEB; for G (at least) Ginsburg, Oort, HALOT (122a). In the pHab script, *aleph* and *nun* resemble one another. Also, the root בִּין, while strange here, is conspicuously common in Daniel, and therefore might have influenced what the scribe expected to see.

{Post-script: But see v23 and cf. 10:11. Thus intrinsic evidence favors M, and transcriptional error explains G, along with the greater frequency in the HB of the root בּוּא.}

Dan 10:19

To judge from JC, Ginsburg, it appear that the MT reading is וּכְדַבְּרוֹ. OG and Th represent, along with L, וּבְדַבְּרוֹ, however. {Have not check other versions.} It seems that the *kaph* preposition in a temporal sense is not especially common, but whether this is not decisive as a scribe might have written what he expected, i.e. the more common form. Does Daniel use one form or the other elsewhere. {Looking into this might be helpful for a number of Kt-Qrs in other books, depending how closely linked the resolution of this VU is to the relatively late date of Dan.}

Dan 11:1

Both EN and Dan carefully distinguish Cyrus and Darius elsewhere, so identity is unlikely. Is דְּרִיּוֹשׁ הַמֶּדִּי a visual error for כּוֹרֶשׁ הַמֶּלֶךְ? The latter phrase is Danielic; and Darius is referred to much more often in the book than Cyrus. The form הַמֶּדִּי does not occur elsewhere, but this is of little consequence, for מֶדִּי occurs a few times.

Dan 11:5

The pointing מְשָׁל in this syntactic context is perplexing, but Ginsburg registers no objection, and BDB and HALOT seem prepared to accept it.

Dan 11:10a

It is notable that OG clearly represents the Kt, though it mispoints.

Dan 11:10c

We are a bit bold here, in that we conjecture a new word (not attested, at least, in CDCH), viz. קְעוֹזָה (here spelled defectively), a feminine counterpart to קְעוֹז (pointed on the analogy of מְנוּחָה as the feminine counterpart of מְנוּחָה); the existence of such counterparts is widespread in the language, and “new” (from the perspective of the biblical corpus) words often crop up in late Hebrew.

The alternatives are (1) seeing the rare 3rd person masculine suffix *-o*, or (2) seeing the Kt as some sort of scribal error. But it seems unlikely that so late a book as Daniel would use this spelling, and the error is hard to account for, and also it hard to derive from either OG or Th.

Dan 11:18

Re Kt-Qr, cf. v19 (as pointed out in BDB).

Dan 11:22

BHS's repointing suggestion (in note “a”) has its attractions, but it is not clear that Daniel, with his late Hebrew, uses this construction (the closest he comes elsewhere seems to be וּבֹא בֹא in 11:10 and יְבוֹא בֹא in 11:13, both of which are odd and both of which involve the root בּוֹא, not at issue here).

Dan 12:3

M: וּמַצְדִּיקֵי הָרַבִּים

G: וּמַחְזִיקֵי דְבָרִי

Whichever is the wrong reading here is probably due to transcriptional error. Positing G to be original, we have a swapping of *chet* to *tsadde* (a change hard to account for in either direction; possibly due to a damaged exemplar or significant lapse in attention); a swap of *zayin* to *daleth* (visually similar and somewhat similar in sound); a visual error of *he* for final *mem* combined with a grouping error; *resh* for *daleth* (visual confusion prompted by the frequency of forms of רב in this book); and addition of a final *mem* (accidental, thinking י to be the beginning of the ים plural grapheme, or an emendation after producing רבי, which does not make sense). The path from M to G is obviously similar.

Turning to intrinsic evidence, 11:33 might support M, though the subject is וְהַמְשָׁכִילִים, the subject of the first part, not the present part, of the verse under consideration, and the verb is יְבִינוּ. Mat 13:43 might also, although “righteous” there might be a synonym for “wise,” or an approving quotation of Th here. Phil 2:16 cites the OG here (see Beale, *A NT Biblical Theology*, 283), so NT references potentially cut both ways. In terms of usage generally, צַדִּיק hiph'il is, according to BDB, used in this sense only here in the OT (it compares two verses from Aboth). Moreover, it is not clear whether Daniel elsewhere used a construct noun with an objective head noun as here in M. In terms of canonical echoes, M could be tied to the importance of the Great Commission and the great in-gathering spoken of in Rev, while G could bespeak the need for perseverance of the saints amidst end-times tribulation; the latter connection seem marginally more plausible. On the other hand, apart from the phrase דְּבַר יְהוָה, which occurs as part of a means of citing the book of Jeremiah, דְּבַר seems not to have the sort of theological sense required by G here elsewhere in Dan. 11:32 lends some support to G here, even using חֲזָק; cf. also 10:21. The first-person form in G is a bit difficult in that an angel, not God, is speaking, but the observation made above that דְּבַר is not in Daniel a technical term for Scripture might combine with verses like 12:4 and v9 to give intrinsic strength to G – those who heed the warnings implicit in the angelic message will be blessed (cf. the similar statements in Revelation).

Tentative conclusion: Transcriptionally, G seems easier to derive from M than the other way around, G is not a great witness in this book, and the 1st person pronoun seems highly problematic. Thus, M seems preferable.

Ezra 1:6

in addition to all (לְכָל): HALOT 1:109a, citing 1 Esdras (2:6) and P, tentatively suggest reading לָרַב (the meaning of the last part of the v would presumably then be, “valuable gifts in great number at the impetus of every sort of

voluntary giving”). However, 1 Esdras seems to be an error of a different nature (see Talshir, 96) and/or a paraphrase; and while P *might* support the proposed reading, that it quite weak external evidence to appeal to, and the later preposition על becomes in my opinion difficult to construe.

Ezra 1:7

The VL *dei* (possibly = האלהים; cf. Neh 13:9) could be the original reading, *rel* being an assimilation (בית יהוה) being quite a bit more common than בית אלהים or בית האלהים, but it also be an inner-Latin corruption or an inner-Greek corruption (2 Chr 36:18). Because grounds are uncertain for reading differently in the LXX, and even if so grounds would be uncertain to read differently in the Hebrew, it is best to retain M (which quite possibly = G as well).

{The phrase כלִי בֵּית יְהוָה occurs elsewhere only in Jeremiah; the phrase כלִי בֵּית הָאֱלֹהִים occurs (sic always the article) in Chronicles (2 Chr 28:24, 36:18), Neh (13:9), and Dan (1:2). Seemingly then a late phrase? Indeed, בית האלהים predominates in late books, though }

{A note I wrote elsewhere: For יהוה VL has *dei*, suggesting its OG *Vorlage* had (του) θεου, which in turn could reflect a Hebrew *Vorlage* האלהים. The phrase בית האלהים is characteristic of the later books of the OT, while בית יהוה is characteristic of the earlier books. It is difficult to rule out either reading altogether, however. Indeed, *either* reading could easily be a conscious or unconscious assimilation to nearby or to related phraseology. But the movement from “Yahweh” to “God” could have occurred at the Hebrew, Greek, or Latin level; and in the Old Greek versions, including 2 Esdras, such a shift is amply attested. So it seems best to retain M.}

Ezra 2:2

A personal name מספר is attested extra-biblically (so DCH; I have not yet verified from Davies), but the pointing change suggested in WBC seems compelling enough to adopt (meaning something like “official, secretary”; perhaps it is abbreviation for “my father is official recorder” or some such).

Ezra 2:61

WBC would w/ 1 Esdras 5:38 read שמו for שמם, but as 1 Es is not a hugely reliable witness, and as the weight of scholarly opinion is behind MT (explicitly, BHQ; implicitly, Ginsburg, Oort, NICOT; NAC follows NIV, which is unclear [paraphrasing?], without comment), it seems best to retain M.

Ezra 4:9

דְּהוּא is the form preferred by Rosenthal (who often prefers Qrs), occurs only here in the OT, and is the Kt, so most likely is to be preferred.

{Post-script: But see Concordia (239).}

Ezra 4:13

WBC (iirc) suggests, assuming an orthography וְשׁוּרִיָּה, favors a pointing by which a possessive pronoun is assumed, but not only is the external evidence for this orthography dubious, but v12 (as read in SRO) seems to point to an emphatic (non-possessed) state for this noun here.

Ezra 5:8

WBC argues for a plus from 1 Es 6:8 on the basis of the Ezra 5:9 reference to “these elders.” The material could have been lost due to homoeotetuton, but there are so many pluses in 1 Es here that it raises suspicion. *Pace* WBC, it does *not* seem to be a great leap from a survey of the city to a discussion with the elders of that city. So it seems best to retain the MG minus.

Ezra 7:9

While some find יָסַד thus pointed “extremely awkward” (WBC), it seems to me that the phraseology is reminiscent of similar dating formulas elsewhere, and it also seems to be strange – from a Hebrew style perspective – to have הוּא as a reference here to Ezra. So while I acknowledge I am going against several notable

modern scholars, I prefer here the the scholarship of the medieval and/or ancient *naqdanim*.

Ezra 7:17

i.e., a *haph'el*. See Folmer 136.

Ezra 7:25

The matter of וּשְׁפָטִים is difficult (WBC, NICOT [pp. 103-104, 107], HALOT sub [Aramaic] שָׁפַט and indirectly [Aramaic] סָפַר, and THB 3C sub 2 Esdras sub Ezra-Nehemiah all make important contributions to the discussion. In the end, alteration is probably not necessary; see especially NICOT.

Ezra 10:3

How to point אֲדָנִי? Probably w/ a *patach*, but it might be in pause. (MT might be interpreting it as a reference to God, but cf. v2: It is probably a reference to Ezra.)

Neh 4:9

Kt is almost certainly correct, being an example of the late biblical Hebrew simplification of the prefix tense(s).

Neh 7:6

For אֵלֶּה, the OG (if Hanhart is correct; the L-group and some other witnesses omit Καί) has וְאֵלֶּה (as in Ezra 2:2). The conjunction seems a bit unnecessary from the Greek point of view, but quite acceptable in Hebrew (as the parallel passage shows). Along the same lines, one could argue that M here is haplography after the preceding בּוֹ. But the intervening paragraph break in the Hebrew undercuts this second point. G, meanwhile, could be either assimilation to the parallel passage or assimilation to expected (but not required) Hebrew usage.

Neh 7:32

It is tempting to read מֵאֵתִים with L-2 Es (=Ez 2:28), but the L group in 2 Esdras has a strong assimilating tendency, and it is hard not see its reading as not influenced by the editor's prior decision in 2 Es 2:28 where, faced with a choice between the OG reading ("300") and the M reading ("200") picked up in the B revision, he chose the latter. Moreover, while assimilation to the מֵאָה in 2 Es 7:31 is a possible explanation for "100," nonetheless it is improbable that such happened both in M-Neh *and* in 2 Esdras *apart from* the L group.

Neh 9:35

See Ges 126x.

Neh 11:12

It is hard to say whether עָשָׂה or עָשִׂי is the original MT reading, but, given G and the parallel passage, the former is probably the autographic text in any case.

Neh 12:8

A mixed form; the meaning of the Kt is "song of praise." See *The American Journal of Semitic Languages and Literatures* Vol. 34, No. 2 (Jan., 1918), pp. 129-130.

Num 12:44

Jenni (3: 27) flags the *lamedh* on לִשְׂרִי, and if there were strong external evidence for מִשְׂרִי it would be something to consider (assimilation in M, given the large number of *lamedh* prefixes). However, (1) a *beit* prefix occurred nearby without triggering such assimilation, (2) G seems to read שְׂרִי, with its own visual error but apparently not reading a *mem* prefix, and (3) Jenni lists several similar passages in post-exilic literature elsewhere.

